

NCE Books 2-4

204 articles

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Book 2

1. A Private Conversation

Last week I went to the theatre. I had a very good seat. The play was very interesting. I did not enjoy it. A young man and a young woman were sitting behind me. They were talking loudly. I got very angry. I could not hear the actors. I turned round. I looked at the man and the woman angrily. They did not pay any attention. In the end, I could not bear it. I turned round again. 'I can't hear a word!' I said angrily.

'It's none of your business,' the young man said rudely. 'This is a private conversation!'

私人谈话

上星期我去看戏。我的座位很好，戏很有意思，但我却无法欣赏。一青年男子与一青年女子坐在我的身后，大声地说着话。我非常生气，因为我听不见演员在说什么。我回过头去怒视着那一男一女，他们却毫不理会。最后，我忍不住了，又一次回过头去，生气地说：“我一个字也听不见了！”

“不关你的事，”那男的毫不客气地说，“这是私人间的谈话！”

2. Breakfast or lunch?

It was Sunday. I never get up early on Sundays. I sometimes stay in bed until lunchtime. Last Sunday I got up very late. I looked out of the window. It was dark outside. 'What a day!' I thought. 'It's raining again.' Just then, the telephone rang. It was my aunt Lucy. 'I've just arrived by train,' she said. 'I'm coming to see you.'

'But I'm still having breakfast,' I said.

'What are you doing?' she asked.

'I'm having breakfast,' I repeated.

'Dear me,' she said. 'Do you always get up so late? It's one o'clock!'

早餐还是午餐？

那是个星期天，而在星期天我是从来不早起的，有时我要一直躺到吃午饭的时候。上个星期天，我起得很晚。我望望窗外，外面一片昏暗。“鬼天气！”我想，“又下雨了。”正

在这时，电话铃响了。是我姑母露西打来的。“我刚下火车，”她说，“我这就来看你。”

“但我还在吃早饭，”我说。

“你在干什么？”她问道。

“我正在吃早饭，”我又说了一遍。

“天啊，”她说，“你总是起得这么晚吗？现在已经1点钟了！”

3. Please Send Me a Card

Postcards always spoil my holidays. Last summer, I went to Italy. I visited museums and sat in public gardens. A friendly waiter taught me a few words of Italian. Then he lent me a book. I read a few lines, but I did not understand a word. Every day I thought about postcards. My holidays passed quickly, but I did not send cards to my friends. On the last day I made a big decision. I got up early and bought thirty-seven cards. I spent the whole day in my room, but I did not write a single card!

请给我寄一张明信片

明信片总搅得我假日不得安宁。去年夏天，我去了意大利。我参观了博物馆，还去了公园。一位好客的服务员教了我几句意大利语，之后还借给我一本书。我读了几行，但一个字也不懂。我每天都想着明信片的事。假期过得真快，可我还没有给我的朋友们寄过一张明信片。到了最后一天，我作出了一项重大决定。我早早起了床，买来了37张明信片。我在房间里关了整整一天。然而竟连一张明信片也没写成！

4. An exciting trip

I have just received a letter from my brother, Tim. He is in Australia. He has been there for six months. Tim is an engineer. He is working for a big firm and he has already visited a great number of different places in Australia. He has just bought an Australian car and has gone to Alice Springs, a small town in the centre of Australia. He will soon visit Darwin. From there, he will fly to Perth. My brother has never been abroad before, so he is finding this trip very exciting.

激动人心的旅行

我刚刚收到弟弟蒂姆的来信，他正在澳大利亚。他在那儿已经住了6个月了。蒂姆是个工程

师，正在为一家大公司工作，并且已经去过澳大利亚的不少地方了。他刚买了一辆澳大利亚小汽车，现在去了澳大利亚中部的小镇艾利斯斯普林斯。他不久还将到达尔文去，从那里，他再飞往珀斯。我弟弟以前从未出过国，因此，他觉得这次旅行非常激动人心。

5. No wrong numbers

Mr. James Scott has a garage in Silbury and now he has just bought another garage in Pinhurst.

Pinhurst is only five miles from Silbury, but Mr. Scott cannot get a telephone for his new garage, so he has just bought twelve pigeons.

Yesterday, a pigeon carried the first message from Pinhurst to Silbury. The bird covered the distance in three minutes.

Up to now, Mr. Scott has sent a great many requests for spare parts and other urgent messages from one garage to the other.

In this way, he has begun his own private 'telephone' service.

无错号之虞

詹姆斯·斯科特先生在锡尔伯里有一个汽车修理部，现在他刚在平赫斯特买了另一个汽车修理部。

平赫斯特离锡尔伯里只有5英里，但詹姆斯·斯科特先生未能为他新的汽车修理部搞到一部电话机，所以他买了12只鸽子。

昨天，一只鸽子把第一封信从平赫斯特带到锡尔伯里。这只鸟只用了3分钟就飞完了全程。

到目前为止，斯科特先生从一个汽车修理部向另一个发送了大量索取备件的信件和其他紧急函件。

就这样，他开始了自己的私人“电话”业务。

6. Percy Buttons

I have just moved to a house in Bridge Street. Yesterday a beggar knocked at my door. He asked me for a meal and a glass of beer. In return for this, the beggar stood on his head and sang songs. I gave him a meal. He ate the food and drank the beer. Then he put a piece of cheese in his pocket and went away. Later a neighbour told

me about him. Everybody knows him. His name is Percy Buttons. He calls at every house in the street once a month and always asks for a meal and a glass of beer.

珀西·巴顿斯

我刚刚搬进了大桥街的一所房子。昨天一个乞丐来敲我的门，问我要一顿饭和一杯啤酒。作为回报，那乞丐头顶地倒立起来，嘴里还唱着歌。我给了他一顿饭。他把食物吃完，又喝了酒。然后把一块乳酪装进衣袋里走了。后来，一位邻居告诉了我他的情况。大家都认识他，他叫珀西·巴顿斯。他每月对这条街上的每户人家光顾一次，总是请求给他一顿饭和一杯啤酒。

7. Too late

The plane was late and detectives were waiting at the airport all morning. They were expecting a valuable parcel of diamonds from South Africa. A few hours earlier, someone had told the police that thieves would try to steal the diamonds. When the plane arrived, some of the detectives were waiting inside the main building while others were waiting on the airfield. Two men took the parcel off the plane and carried it into the Customs House. While two detectives were keeping guard at the door, two others opened the parcel. To their surprise, the precious parcel was full of stones and sand!

为时太晚

飞机误点了，侦探们在机场等了整整一上午。他们正期待从南非来的一个装着钻石的贵重包裹。数小时以前，有人向警方报告，说有人企图偷走这些钻石。当飞机到达时，一些侦探等候在主楼内，另一些侦探则守候在停机坪上。有两个人把包裹拿下飞机，进了海关。这时两个侦探把住门口，另外两个侦探打开了包裹。令他们吃惊的是，那珍贵的包裹里面装的全是石头和沙子！

8. The Best and the Worst

Joe Sanders has the most beautiful garden in our town. Nearly everybody enters for 'The Nicest Garden Competition' each year, but Joe wins every time. Bill Frith's garden is larger than Joe's. Bill works harder than Joe and grows more flowers and vegetables, but Joe's garden is more interesting. He has made neat paths and has built a wooden bridge over a pool. I like gardens too, but I do not like hard work. Every year I enter for the garden competition too, and I always win a little prize for

the worst garden in the town!

最好的和最差的

乔·桑德斯拥有我们镇上最漂亮的花园。几乎每个人每年都参加“最佳花园竞赛”，而每次都是乔获胜。比尔·弗里斯的花园比乔的花园大。比尔比乔更勤奋，种植的花卉和蔬菜也更多，但乔的花园更富有情趣。他修筑了一条条整洁的小路，并在一个池塘上架了一座小木桥。我也喜欢花园，但我不喜欢辛苦的劳动。每年我也参加花园竞赛，而且总是为镇上最差的花园赢得一个小奖！

9. A Cold Welcome

On Wednesday evening, we went to the Town Hall. It was the last day of the year and a large crowd of people had gathered under the Town Hall clock. It would strike twelve in twenty minutes' time. Fifteen minutes passed and then, at five to twelve, the clock stopped. The big minute hand did not move. We waited and waited, but nothing happened. Suddenly someone shouted, 'It's two minutes past twelve! The clock has stopped!' I looked at my watch. It was true. The big clock refused to welcome the New Year. At that moment, everybody began to laugh and sing.

冷遇

星期三的晚上，我们去了市政厅。

那是一年的最后一天，一大群人聚集在市政厅的大钟下面。再过20分钟，大钟将敲响12下。15分钟过去了，而就在11点55分时，大钟停了。那根巨大的分针不动了。我们等啊等啊，可情况没有变化。突然有人喊道：“已经12点零2分了！那钟已经停了！”我看了一下我的手表，果真如此。那座大钟不愿意迎接新年。此时，大家已经笑了起来，同时唱起了歌。

10. Not For Jazz

We have an old musical instrument. It is called a clavichord. It was made in Germany in 1681. Our clavichord is kept in the living room. It has belonged to our family for a long time. The instrument was bought by my grandfather many years ago. Recently it was damaged by a visitor. She tried to play jazz on it! She struck the keys too hard and two of the strings were broken. My father was shocked. Now we are not allowed to touch it. It is being repaired by a friend of my father's.

不适于演奏爵士乐

我家有件古乐器，被称作古钢琴，是1681年德国造的。我们的这架古钢琴存放在起居室里。我们家有这件乐器已经很久了，是我祖父在很多年以前买的。可它最近被一个客人弄坏了，因为她用它来弹奏爵士乐。她在击琴键时用力过猛，损坏了两根琴弦。我父亲大为吃惊，不许我们再动它。父亲的一个朋友正在修理这件乐器。

11. One Good Turn Deserves Another

I was having dinner at a restaurant when Tony Steele came in.

Tony worked in a lawyer's office years ago, but he is now working at a bank.

He gets a good salary, but he always borrows money from his friends and never pays it back.

Tony saw me and came and sat at the same table.

He has never borrowed money from me.

While he was eating, I asked him to lend me twenty pounds.

To my surprise, he gave me the money immediately.

'I have never borrowed any money from you,' Tony said, 'so now you can pay for my dinner!'

礼尚往来

我正在一家饭馆吃饭，托尼·斯蒂尔走了进来。

托尼曾在一家律师事务所工作，而现在正在一家银行上班。

他的薪水很高，但他却总是向朋友借钱，并且从来不还。

托尼看见了我，就走过来和我坐到一张桌子前。

他从未向我借过钱。当他吃饭时，我提出向他借20英镑。

令我惊奇的是，他立刻把钱给了我。

“我还从未向你借过钱，”托尼说道，“所以现在你可以替我付饭钱了！”

12. Goodbye and Good Luck

Our neighbour, Captain Charles Alison, will sail from Portsmouth tomorrow.

We'll meet him at the harbour early in the morning.

He will be in his small boat, Topsail.

Topsail is a famous little boat.

It has sailed across the Atlantic many times.

Captain Alison will set out at eight o'clock, so we'll have plenty of time.

We'll see his boat and then we'll say goodbye to him.

He will be away for two months.

We are very proud of him.

He will take part in an important race across the Atlantic.

再见，一路顺风

我们的邻居查尔斯·艾利森船长明天就要从朴次茅斯启航了。明天一大早我们将在码头为他送行。他将乘坐他的“涛波赛”号小艇。“涛波赛”号是艘有名的小艇，它已经多次横渡大西洋。艾利森船长将于8点钟启航，因此我们有充裕的时间。我们将参观他的船，然后和他告别。他要离开两个月，我们真为他感到自豪，他将参加一次重大的横渡大西洋的比赛。

13. The Greenwood Boys

The Greenwood Boys are a group of pop singers.

At present, they are visiting all parts of the country.

They will be arriving here tomorrow.

They will be coming by train and most of the young people in the town will be meeting them at the station. Tomorrow evening they will be singing at the Workers' Club.

The Greenwood Boys will be staying for five days.

During this time, they will give five performances.

As usual, the police will have a difficult time.

They will be trying to keep order.

It is always the same on these occasions.

绿林少年

绿林少年是一个流行歌曲演唱团。目前他们正在全国各地巡回演出，明天就要到达此地。他们将乘火车来，镇上的大部分青年人将到车站迎接他们。明晚他们将在工人俱乐部演出。绿林少年准备在此逗留5天。在此期间，他们将演出5场。同往常一样，警察的日子将不好过，他们将设法维持秩序。每逢这种场合，情况都是这样。

14. Do you speak English?

I had an amusing experience last year.

After I had left a small village in the south of France, I drove on to the next town.

On the way, a young man waved to me.

I stopped and he asked me for a lift.

As soon as he had got into the car, I said good morning to him in French and he replied in the same language. Apart from a few words, I do not know any French at all.

Neither of us spoke during the journey.

I had nearly reached the town, when the young man suddenly said, very slowly, "Do you speak English?"

As I soon learnt, he was English himself!

你会讲英语吗？

去年我有过一次有趣的经历。在离开法国南部的一个小村庄后，我继续驶往下一个城镇。途中，一个青年人向我招手。我把车停下，他向我提出要求搭车。他一上车，我就用法语向他问早上好，他也同样用法语回答我。除了个别几个单词外，我根本不会法语。旅途中我们谁也没讲话。就要到达那个镇时，那青年突然开了口，慢慢地说道：“你会讲英语吗？”我很快了解到，他自己就是个英国人！

15. Good News

The secretary told me that Mr. Harmsworth would see me.

I felt very nervous when I went into his office.

He did not look up from his desk when I entered.

After I had sat down, he said that business was very bad.

He told me that the firm could not afford to pay such large salaries.

Twenty people had already left.

I knew that my turn had come.

'Mr. Harmsworth,' I said in a weak voice.

'Don't interrupt,' he said.

Then he smiled and told me I would receive an extra thousand pounds a year!

佳音

秘书告诉我说哈姆斯沃斯先生要见我。我走进他的办公室，感到非常紧张。我进去的时候，他连头也没抬。待我坐下后，他说生意非常不景气。他还告诉我，公司支付不起这么庞大的工资开支，有20个人已经离去。我知道这次该轮到我了。

“哈姆斯沃斯先生，”我无力地说。

“不要打断我的话，”他说。

然后他微笑了一下告诉我说，我每年将得到1,000 英镑的额外收入。

16. A polite request

If you park your car in the wrong place, a traffic policeman will soon find it.

You will be very lucky if he lets you go without a ticket.

However, this does not always happen.

Traffic police are sometimes very polite.

During a holiday in Sweden, I found this note on my car: 'sir, we welcome you to our city. This is a "No Parking" area.

You will enjoy your stay here if you pay attention to our street signs. This note is only a reminder.'

If you receive a request like this, you cannot fail to obey it!

彬彬有礼的要求

一旦你把汽车停错了地方，交警很快就会发现。如果他没给你罚单就放你走了，算你走运。然而，情况并不都是这样，交警有时也很客气。有一次在瑞典度假，我发现我的车上有这样一个字条：“先生，欢迎您光临我们的城市。此处是‘禁止停车’区。如果您对我们街上的标志稍加注意，您在此会过得很愉快的。谨此提请注意。”如果你收到这样的恳求，你是不会不遵照执行的！

17. Always young

My aunt Jennifer is an actress.

She must be at least thirty-five years old.

In spite of this, she often appears on the stage as a young girl.

Jennifer will have to take part in a new play soon.

This time, she will be a girl of seventeen.

In the play, she must appear in a bright red dress and long black stockings.

Last year in another play, she had to wear short socks and a bright, orange-coloured dress.

If anyone ever asks her how old she is, she always answers, 'Darling, it must be terrible to be grown up!'

青春常驻

我的姑姑詹妮弗是位演员，她至少也有35岁了。尽管如此，她却常在舞台上扮演小姑娘。詹妮弗很快又要参加一个新剧的演出。这一次，她将扮演一个17岁的少女。演出时她必须穿一条鲜红色的裙子和黑色的长筒袜。去年在演另一个剧时，她不得不穿短袜和一件鲜艳的橘红色的衣服。一旦有人问起她有多大年纪，她总是回答：“亲爱的，长成大人真可怕啊！”

18. He often does this!

After I had had lunch at a village pub, I looked for my bag.

I had left it on a chair beside the door and now it wasn't there!

As I was looking for it, the landlord came in.

'Did you have a good meal?' he asked.

'Yes, thank you,' I answered, 'but I can't pay the bill. I haven't got my bag.'

The landlord smiled and immediately went out.

In a few minutes he returned with my bag and gave it back to me.

'I'm very sorry,' he said. 'My dog had taken it into the garden. He often does this!'

他经常干这种事!

我在一家乡村小酒店吃过午饭后, 就找我的提包。

我曾把它放在门边的椅子上, 可这会儿不见了!

当我正在寻找时, 酒店老板走了进来。

“您吃得好吗?” 他问。

“很好, 谢谢。” 我回答, “但我付不了帐, 我的提包没有了。”

酒店老板笑了笑, 马上走了出去。

一会儿工夫他拿着我的提包回来了, 把它还给了我。

“实在抱歉,” 他说。 “我的狗把它弄到花园里去了, 他常干这种事!”

19. Sold out

The play may begin at any moment, I said.

'It may have begun already,' Susan answered.

I hurried to the ticket office. 'May I have two tickets please?' I asked.

'I'm sorry, we've sold out,' the girl said.

'What a pity!' Susan exclaimed.

Just then, a man hurried to the ticket office.

' Can I return these two tickets?' he asked.

' Certainly,' the girl said.

I went back to the ticket office at once.

' Could I have those two tickets please?' I asked.

' Certainly,' the girl said, 'but they're for next Wednesday's performance. Do you still want them?'

I might as well have them,' I said sadly.

票已售完

“剧马上就要开演了，”我说。

“也许已经开演了呢，”苏珊回答说。

我匆匆赶到售票处。“我可以买两张票吗？”我问。

“对不起，票已售完。”那位姑娘说。

“真可惜！”苏珊大声说。

正在这时，一个男子匆匆奔向售票处。

“我可以退掉这两张票吗？”他问。

“当然可以，”那姑娘说。

我马上又回到售票处。

“我可以买那两张票吗？”我问。

“当然可以，不过这两张票是下星期三的，您是否还要呢？”

“我还是买下的好，”我垂头丧气地说。

20. One man in a boat

Fishing is my favourite sport. I often fish for hours without catching anything. But this does not worry me. Some fishermen are unlucky. Instead of catching fish, they catch old boots and rubbish. I am even less lucky. I never catch anything - not even old boots. After having spent whole mornings on the river, I always go home with an empty bag. 'You must give up fishing!' my friends say. 'It's a waste of time.' But

they don't realize one important thing. I'm not really interested in fishing. I am only interested in sitting in a boat and doing nothing at all!

独坐孤舟

钓鱼是我特别喜爱的一项运动。我经常一钓数小时却一无所获，但我从不为此烦恼。有些垂钓者就是不走运，他们往往鱼钓不到，却钓上来些旧靴子和垃圾。我的运气甚至还不如他们。我什么东西也未钓到过——就连旧靴子也没有。我总是在河上呆上整整一上午，然后空着袋子回家。“你可别再钓鱼了！”我的朋友们说，“这是浪费时间。”然而他们没有认识到重要的一点，我并不是真的对钓鱼有兴趣，我感兴趣的只是独坐孤舟，无所事事！

21. Mad or not

Aeroplanes are slowly driving me mad. I live near an airport and passing planes can be heard night and day. The airport was built years ago, but for some reason it could not be used then. Last year, however, it came into use. Over a hundred people must have been driven away from their homes by the noise. I am one of the few people left. Sometimes I think this house will be knocked down by a passing plane. I have been offered a large sum of money to go away, but I am determined to stay here. Everybody says I must be mad and they are probably right.

是不是疯了

飞机正在逐渐把我逼疯。我住在一个机场附近，过往飞机日夜不绝于耳。机场是许多年前建的，但由于某种原因当时未能启用。然而去年机场开始使用了。有100多人肯定是被噪音逼得已经弃家远去，我是少数留下来的人中的一个。有时我觉得这房子就要被一架飞过的飞机撞倒。有人曾向我提供一大笔钱让我搬走，但我决定留在这儿。大家都说我肯定是疯了，也许他们说的是对的。

22. A Glass Envelope

My daughter, Jane, never dreamed of receiving a letter from a girl of her own age in Holland. Last year, we were travelling across the Channel and Jane put a piece of paper with her name and address on it into a bottle. She threw the bottle into the sea. She never thought of it again, but ten months later, she received a letter from a girl in Holland. Both girls write to each other regularly now. However, they have decided to use the post office. Letters will cost a little more, but they will certainly

travel faster.

玻璃信封

我的女儿简从未想过会收到荷兰一位同龄姑娘的来信。去年，我们横渡英吉利海峡时，简把写有她姓名和住址的一张纸条装进了一只瓶子，又将瓶子扔进了大海。此后她就再没去想那只瓶子。但10个月以后，她收到了荷兰一位姑娘的来信。现在这两位姑娘定期通信了。然而她们还是决定利用邮局。这样会稍微多花点钱，但肯定是快得多了。

23. A New House

I had a letter from my sister yesterday. She lives in Nigeria. In her letter, she said that she would come to England next year. If she comes, she will get a surprise. We are now living in a beautiful new house in the country. Work on it had begun before my sister left. The house was completed five months ago. In my letter, I told her that she could stay with us. The house has many large rooms and there is a lovely garden. It is a very modern house, so it looks strange to some people. It must be the only modern house in the district.

新居

昨天我收到了姐姐的一封信。她住在尼日利亚。在信中她说她明年将到英国来。如果她来了，她会感到非常惊奇了。我们现在住在乡间的一栋漂亮的新住宅里。这栋房子在我姐姐离开之前就已动工了，是在5个月以前竣工的。我在信中告诉她，她可以和我们住在一起。这栋房子里有许多房间，还有一个漂亮的花园。它是一栋非常现代化的住宅，因此在有些人看来很古怪。它肯定就是这个地区唯一的一栋现代化住宅。

24. It could be worse

I entered the hotel manager's office and sat down. I had just lost £50 and I felt very upset. 'I left the money in my room,' I said, 'and it's not there now.' The manager was sympathetic, but he could do nothing. 'Everyone's losing money these days,' he said. He started to complain about this wicked world but was interrupted by a knock at the door. A girl came in and put an envelope on his desk. It contained £50. 'I found this outside this gentleman's room,' she said. 'Well,' I said to the manager, 'there is still some honesty in this world!'

不幸中之万幸

我走进饭店经理的办公室，坐了下来。我刚刚丢了50英镑，感到非常烦恼。“我把钱放在房间里，”我说，“可现在没有了。”经理深表同情，但却无能为力。“现在大家都在丢钱，”他说。他开始抱怨起这个邪恶的世道来，却被一阵敲门声打断了。一个姑娘走了进来，把一个信封放在了他桌上。它里面装着50英镑。“我在这位先生的房门外捡到的，”她说。“是啊，”我对那位经理说，“这世界上还是有诚实可言的！”

25. Do the English speak English?

I arrived in London at last. The railway station was big, black and dark. I did not know the way to my hotel, so I asked a porter. I not only spoke English very carefully, but very clearly as well. The porter, however, could not understand me. I repeated my question several times and at last he understood. He answered me, but he spoke neither slowly nor clearly. 'I am a foreigner,' I said. Then he spoke slowly, but I could not understand him. My teacher never spoke English like that! The porter and I looked at each other and smiled. Then he said something and I understood it. 'You'll soon learn English!' he said. I wonder. In England, each person speaks a different language. The English understand each other, but I don't understand them! Do they speak English?

英国人讲的是英语吗？

我终于到了伦敦。火车站很大，又黑又暗。我不知道去饭店的路该怎么走，于是向一个搬运工打听。我的英语讲得不但非常认真，而且咬字也非常清楚。然而搬运工却不明白我的话。我把问话重复了很多遍。他终于听懂了。他回答了，但他讲得既不慢也不清楚。“我是个外国人，”我说。于是他说得慢了，可我还是听不懂。我的老师从来不那样讲英语！我和搬运工相视一笑。接着，他说了点什么，这回我听懂了。“您会很快学会英语的！”他说。我感到奇怪。在英国，人们各自说着一种不同的语言。英国人之间相互听得懂，可我却不懂他们的话！他们说的是英语吗？

26. The Best Art Critics

I am an art student and I paint a lot of pictures.

Many people pretend that they understand modern art.

They always tell you what a picture is 'about'.

Of course, many pictures are not 'about' anything.

They are just pretty patterns.

We like them in the same way that we like pretty curtain material.

I think that young children often appreciate modern art better than anyone else.

They notice more.

My sister is only seven, but she always tells me whether my pictures are good or not.

She came into my room yesterday.

'What are you doing?' she asked.

'I'm hanging this picture on the wall,' I answered.

'It's a new one.

Do you like it?'

She looked at it critically for a moment.

'It's all right,' she said, 'but isn't it upside down?'

I looked at it again.

She was right! It was!

最佳艺术评论家

我是个学艺术的学生，画了很多画。

有很多人装成很懂现代艺术的样子。

他们总是告诉你一幅画的“意思”是什么。

当然，有很多画是什么“意思”也没有的。

它们就是些好看的图案。

我们喜爱它们就像我们喜欢漂亮的窗帘布一样。

我觉得小孩子们往往比任何人都更能欣赏现代艺术。

他们观察到的东西更多。

我的妹妹只有七岁，但她总能说出我的画是好还是坏。

昨天她到我房里来了。

“你在干什么呢？”她问。

“我正把这幅画挂到墙上去。”我回答说，“这是幅新画。你喜欢吗？”

她用挑剔的目光看了一会儿。

“还可以吧。”她说，“不过，是不是挂倒了？”

我又看了一下。

她是对的！画确实是挂倒了！

27. A wet night

Late in the afternoon, the boys put up their tent in the middle of a field. As soon as this was done, they cooked a meal over an open fire. They were all hungry and the food smelled good. After a wonderful meal, they told stories and sang songs by the campfire. But some time later it began to rain. The boys felt tired so they put out the fire and crept into their tent. Their sleeping bags were warm and comfortable, so they all slept soundly. In the middle of the night, two boys woke up and began shouting. The tent was full of water! They all leapt out of their sleeping bags and hurried outside. It was raining heavily and they found that a stream had formed in the field. The stream wound its way across the field and then flowed right under their tent!

雨夜

傍晚时分，孩子们在田野中央搭起了帐篷。这件事刚刚做完，他们就在篝火上烧起了饭。他们全都饿了，饭菜散发出阵阵香味。他们美美地吃了一顿饭后，就围在营火旁讲起了故事，唱起了歌。但过了一阵子。天下起雨来，孩子们感到困倦了，于是他们扑灭了篝火，钻进了帐篷。睡袋既暖和又舒服，所以，他们都睡得很香。午夜前后，有两个孩子醒了，大声叫了起来。原来帐篷里到处都是水！他们全都跳出睡袋，跑到外面。雨下得很大，他们发现地上已经形成了一条小溪。那小溪弯弯曲曲穿过田野，然后正好从他们的帐篷底下流过去。

28. No parking

Jasper White is one of those rare people who believes in ancient myths. He has just bought a new house in the city, but ever since he moved in, he has had trouble with cars and their owners. When he returns home at night, he always finds that someone has parked a car outside his gate. Because of this, he has not been able to get his own car into his garage even once. Jasper has put up 'No Parking' signs outside his

gate, but these have not had any effect. Now he has put an ugly stone head over the gate. It is one of the ugliest faces I have ever seen. I asked him what it was and he told me that it was Medusa, the Gorgon. Jasper hopes that she will turn cars and their owners to stone. But none of them has been turned to stone yet!

禁止停车

贾斯珀·怀特是少有的相信古代神话的人之一。他刚在城里买下一所新房子，但自从搬进去后，就和汽车及车主们发生了摩擦。当他夜里回到家时，总是发现有人把车停在他家大门外。为此，他甚至一次也没能把自己的车开进车库。贾斯珀曾把几块“禁止停车”的牌子挂在大门外边，但没有任何效果。现在他把一个丑陋的石雕头像放在了大门上边，这是我见过的最丑陋的头像之一。我问他那是什么？他告诉我那是蛇发女怪美杜莎。贾斯珀希望她把汽车和车主们都变成石头。但到目前为止还没有一个人变成石头呢！

29. Taxi

Captain Ben Fawcett has bought an unusual taxi and has begun a new service. The 'taxi' is a small Swiss aeroplane called a 'Pilatus Porter'. This wonderful plane can carry seven passengers. The most surprising thing about it, however, is that it can land anywhere: on snow, water, or even on a ploughed field. Captain Fawcett's first passenger was a doctor who flew from Birmingham to a lonely village in the Welsh mountains. Since then, Captain Fawcett has flown passengers to many unusual places. Once he landed on the roof of a block of flats and on another occasion, he landed in a deserted car park. Captain Fawcett has just refused a strange request from a businessman. The man wanted to fly to Rockall, a lonely island in the Atlantic Ocean, but Captain Fawcett did not take him because the trip was too dangerous.

出租车

本·弗西特机长买了一辆不同寻常的出租汽车，并开始了一项新的业务。这辆“出租汽车”是一架小型瑞士飞机，叫“皮勒特斯·波特”号。这架奇妙的飞机可以载7名乘客。然而，最令人惊奇的是它可以在任何地方降落：雪地上、水面上，甚至刚耕过的田里。弗西特机长的第一名乘客是位医生，他从伯明翰飞往威尔士山区一个偏僻的村庄。从那时开始，弗西特机长已经载送乘客到过许多不寻常的地方。一次，他把飞机降落在了一栋公寓大楼的屋顶上；还有一次，他降落在一个废弃的停车场上。弗西特机长刚刚拒绝了一位商人的奇怪要求。这个人想要飞往大西洋中的一个孤岛——罗卡尔岛，弗西特机长之所以不送他去，是因为那段飞行太危险了。

30. Football or Polo?

The Wayle is a small river that cuts across the park near my home. I like sitting by the Wayle on fine afternoons. It was warm last Sunday, so I went and sat on the river bank as usual. Some children were playing games on the bank and there were some people rowing on the river. Suddenly, one of the children kicked a ball very hard and it went towards a passing boat. Some people on the boat shouted at the children. But they did not hear them. The ball struck one of the oarsmen on the nose and knocked him out. The man was very angry as he was in pain. He did not catch the ball either. Everyone laughed except the man! Then he sat down and laughed too.

足球还是水球?

威尔河是横穿过我家附近公园的一条小河。我喜欢在天气晴朗的下午到河边坐坐。上星期日天气很暖和。于是我和往常一样，又去河边坐着。河岸上有些孩子正在玩耍，河面上有些人正在划船。突然，一个孩子狠狠地踢了一脚球，球便向着一只划过来的小船飞去。船上的一些人对着那些孩子大声叫嚷，可他们没有听到。球重重地打在一个划手的鼻子上，他一下子落入水中。他很生气，因为他的鼻子很疼。他也没有接住球。大家都笑了，只有他没有笑。后来他也坐下来笑了。

31. Success Story

Yesterday afternoon Frank Hawkins was telling me about his experiences as a young man. Frank is now the head of a very large business company, but as a boy he used to work in a small shop. It was his job to repair bicycles and at that time he used to work fourteen hours a day. He saved money for years and in 1958 he bought a small workshop of his own. In his twenties Frank used to make spare parts for aeroplanes. At that time he had two helpers. In a few years the small workshop had become a large factory which employed seven hundred and twenty - eight people. Frank smiled when he remembered his hard early years and the long road to success. He was still smiling when the door opened and his wife came in. She wanted him to repair their son's bicycle!

成功者的故事

昨天下午弗兰克·霍金斯向我讲述了他年轻时的经历。弗兰克现在是一家非常大的商业公司的老板，但当他还是个孩子的时候，他曾在一家小铺里做工。他那时的工作是修理自行车，并且通常一天工作14个小时。他多年来一直省钱，1958年他买了一个属于他自己的小车间。20多岁的时候，弗兰克曾生产飞机零配件。那时他有两个帮手。几年之后，小车间变

成了一个雇有728人的大工厂。当弗兰克回想起他早年的艰苦岁月和漫长的成功之路时，他笑了。他正笑着的时候门开了，他的妻子走了进来。她叫他去修理他们儿子的自行车！

32. Shopping Made Easy

People are not so honest as they once were. The temptation to steal is greater than ever before-especially in large shops. A detective recently watched a well - dressed woman who always went into a large store on Monday mornings. One Monday, there were fewer people in the shop than usual when the woman came in, so it was easier for the detective to watch her. The woman first bought a few small articles. After a little time, she chose one of the most expensive dresses in the shop and handed it to an assistant who wrapped it up for her as quickly as possible. Then the woman simply took the parcel and walked out of the shop without paying. When she was arrested, the detective found out that the shop - assistant was her daughter. The girl 'gave' her mother a free dress once a week!

购物变得很方便

人们不再像以前那样诚实了。偷窃的诱惑力比以往任何时候都更强烈——特别是在大的商店里。一名侦探最近注意上了一位穿着讲究的妇女，她总是在星期一上午进入一家大商场。有一个星期一，当这位妇女走进这家商场时，里面的人比往常少，因此，侦探比较容易监视她。这位妇女先是买了几样小商品。过了一会儿，她又选了商场里最昂贵的一件衣服，把它递给了售货员。那售货员以最快的速度为她包好了衣服。然后，那妇女拿过包就走出了商场，根本没有付钱。她被逮捕后。侦探发现原来那售货员是她的女儿。那姑娘每星期“送”她母亲一件免费的衣服！

33. Out of the Darkness

Nearly a week passed before the girl was able to explain what had happened to her. One afternoon she set out from the coast in a small boat and was caught in a storm. Towards evening, the boat struck a rock and the girl jumped into the sea. Then she swam to the shore after spending the whole night in the water. During that time she covered a distance of eight miles. Early next morning, she saw a light ahead. She knew she was near the shore because the light was high up on the cliffs. On arriving at the shore, the girl struggled up the cliff towards the light she had seen. That was all she remembered. When she woke up a day later, she found herself in hospital.

冲出黑暗

几乎过了一个星期，那姑娘才能讲述自己的遭遇。一天下午，她乘小船从海岸出发，遇上了风暴。天将黑时，小船撞在了一块礁石上，姑娘跳进了海里。她在海里游了整整一夜才游到岸边。在那段时间里，她游了8英里。第二天凌晨，她看到前方有灯光，知道自己已经接近岸边了，因为那灯光是在高高的峭壁上。一到岸边，姑娘就朝着她看到的灯光方向挣扎着往峭壁上爬去。她所记得的就是这些。第二天她醒来时，发现自己躺在医院里。

34. Quick work

Dan Robinson has been worried all week. Last Tuesday he received a letter from the local police. In the letter he was asked to call at the station. Dan wondered why he was wanted by the police, but he went to the station yesterday and now he is not worried any more. At the station, he was told by a smiling policeman that his bicycle had been found. Five days ago, the policeman told him, the bicycle was picked up in a small village four hundred miles away. It is now being sent to his home by train. Dan was most surprised when he heard the news. He was amused too, because he never expected the bicycle to be found. It was stolen twenty years ago when Dan was a boy of fifteen!

破案 “神速”

丹·鲁宾逊焦虑了整整一个星期。上星期二他收到当地警察局的一封信，要他到警察局去一趟。丹奇怪警察为什么找他，但昨天还是去了，结果他不再担心了。在警察局里，一位面带笑容的警察告诉他，他的自行车找到了。那位警察对他说，那辆自行车是5天前在400英里外的一个小村里发现的，现在正用火车给他运回家来。丹听到这个消息后，惊奇万分，但又感到非常好笑，因为他从未指望那辆自行车还能找到。这是20年前丹还是一个15岁的孩子时被人偷走的！

35. Stop Thief!

Roy Trenton used to drive a taxi. A short while ago, however, he became a bus driver and he has not regretted it. He is finding his new work far more exciting. When he was driving along Catford Street recently, he saw two thieves rush out of a shop and run towards a waiting car. One of them was carrying a bag full of money. Roy acted quickly and drove the bus straight at the thieves. The one with the money got such a fright that he dropped the bag. As the thieves were trying to get away in

their car, Roy drove his bus into the back of it. While the battered car was moving away, Roy stopped his bus and telephoned the police. The thieves' car was badly damaged and easy to recognize. Shortly afterwards, the police stopped the car and both men were arrested.

捉贼!

罗伊·特伦顿过去常开出租车。然而就在前不久，他开上了公共汽车，而且他不后悔。他发觉自己的新工作令人兴奋得多。最近，当他正开车在凯特福德街上行驶时，他看到有两个小偷从一家商店里冲出来，奔向等在那里的一辆汽车。其中一个提着一只装满钱的提包。罗伊行动迅速，开车直冲窃贼而去。拿钱的那个小偷吓得把包都扔了。当那两个小偷企图乘车逃跑时，罗伊驾驶他的公共汽车撞在了那辆车的后尾上。当那辆被撞坏的车开走后，罗伊停下车，给警察挂了电话。小偷的车损坏严重，很容易辨认。没过多久，警察就截住了那辆车，两个小偷都被抓住了。

36. Across the Channel

Debbie Hart is going to swim across the English Channel tomorrow. She is going to set out from the French coast at five o'clock in the morning. Debbie is only eleven years old and she hopes to set up a new world record. She is a strong swimmer and many people feel that she is sure to succeed. Debbie's father will set out with her in a small boat. Mr. Hart has trained his daughter for years. Tomorrow he will be watching her anxiously as she swims the long distance to England. Debbie intends to take short rests every two hours. She will have something to drink but she will not eat any solid food. Most of Debbie's school friends will be waiting for her on the English coast. Among them will be Debbie's mother, who swam the Channel herself when she was a girl.

横渡海峡

黛比·哈特准备明天横渡英吉利海峡。她打算早上5点钟从法国海岸出发。黛比只有11岁，她希望创一项新的世界纪录。她是一个游泳能手，很多人认为她一定能成功。黛比的父亲将乘一条小船同她一道出发。哈特先生训练她的女儿已经多年了。明天在她游很长的距离到达英国时，他将焦急地注视着她。黛比计划每两小时休息一下。她将喝些饮料，但不吃固体食物。黛比的大部分同学将在英国海岸等候她。他们当中还会有黛比的母亲，她本人还是个姑娘时，也曾横渡过英吉利海峡。

37. The Olympic Games

The Olympic Games will be held in our country in four years' time. As a great many people will be visiting the country, the government will be building new hotels, an immense stadium, and a new Olympic-standard swimming pool. They will also be building new roads and a special railway line. The Games will be held just outside the capital and the whole area will be called 'Olympic City'. Workers will have completed the new roads by the end of this year. By the end of next year, they will have finished work on the new stadium. The fantastic modern buildings have been designed by Kurt Gunter. Everybody will be watching anxiously as the new buildings go up. We are all very excited and are looking forward to the Olympic Games because they have never been held before in this country.

奥林匹克运动会

4年以后，奥林匹克运动会将在我们国家举行。由于将有大批的人到我们国家来，所以政府准备建造一些新的饭店、一个大型体育场和一个新的奥运会标准游泳池。他们还将修筑一些新的道路和一条铁路专线。奥运会就在首都郊举办，整个地区将被称作“奥林匹克城”。工人们将在今年年底前把新路铺好；到明年年底，他们将把新体育场建成。这些巨大的现代化建筑是由库尔特·冈特设计的。大家都将急切地注视着新建筑的建成。我们都非常激动，盼望着奥运会的到来，因为在这个国家里还从未举办过奥运会。

38. Everything except the weather

My old friend, Harrison, had lived in the Mediterranean for many years before he returned to England. He had often dreamed of retiring in England and had planned to settle down in the country. He had no sooner returned than he bought a house and went to live there. Almost immediately he began to complain about the weather, for even though it was still summer, it rained continually and it was often bitterly cold. After so many years of sunshine, Harrison got a shock. He acted as if he had never lived in England before. In the end, it was more than he could bear. He had hardly had time to settle down when he sold the house and left the country. The dream he had had for so many years ended there. Harrison had thought of everything except the weather.

唯独没有考虑到天气

我的老朋友哈里森在回到英国以前曾多年居住在地中海地区。过去他常幻想退休后到英国，并计划在乡间安顿下来。他刚一回到英国便买下了一幢房子住了进去。但紧接着他就开始抱怨那里的天气了。因为即使那时仍为夏季，但雨总是下个不停，而且常常冷得厉害。

在阳光下生活了那么多年的哈里森对此感到惊奇。他的举动就好像他从未在英国生活过一样。最后，他再也忍受不住，还没等安顿下来就卖掉了房子，离开了这个国家。他多年来的幻想从此破灭。哈里森把每件事情都考虑到了，唯独没想到天气。

39. Am I all right?

While John Gilbert was in hospital, he asked his doctor to tell him whether his operation had been successful, but the doctor refused to do so. The following day, the patient asked for a bedside telephone. When he was alone, he telephoned the hospital exchange and asked for Doctor Millington. When the doctor answered the phone, Mr. Gilbert said he was inquiring about a certain patient, a Mr. John Gilbert. He asked if Mr. Gilbert's operation had been successful and the doctor told him that it had been. He then asked when Mr. Gilbert would be allowed to go home and the doctor told him that he would have to stay in hospital for another two weeks. Then Dr. Millington asked the caller if he was a relative of the patient. 'No,' the patient answered, 'I am Mr. John Gilbert.'

我是否痊愈？

当约翰·吉尔伯特住院的时候，他问医生他的手术是否成功，但医生拒绝告诉他。第二天，这位病人要了一部床头电话。当房里只剩他一个人时，他挂通了医院的交换台，要求与米灵顿医生讲话。当这位医生接过电话时，吉尔伯特先生说他想询问一个病人的情况，是一位名叫约翰·吉尔伯特的先生。他问吉尔伯特先生的手术是否成功，医生告诉他，手术很成功。然后他又问吉尔伯特先生什么时候可以回家，医生说他在医院还必须再住上两个星期。之后，米灵顿医生问打电话的人是否是病人的亲属。“不是，”病人回答说，“我就是约翰·吉尔伯特先生。”

40. Food and Talk

Last week at a dinner - party, the hostess asked me to sit next to Mrs. Rumbold. Mrs. Rumbold was a large, unsmiling lady in a tight black dress. She did not even look up when I took my seat beside her. Her eyes were fixed on her plate and in a short time, she was busy eating. I tried to make conversation.

"A new play is coming to 'The Globe' soon," I said. "Will you be seeing it?"

"No," she answered.

"Will you be spending your holidays abroad this year?" I asked.

"No," she answered.

"Will you be staying in England?" I asked.

"No," she answered.

In despair, I asked her whether she was enjoying her dinner.

"Young man," she answered, "if you ate more and talked less, we would both enjoy our dinner!"

进餐与交谈

在上星期的一次宴会上，女主人安排我坐在兰伯尔德夫人的身旁。兰伯尔德夫人是一位身材高大、表情严肃的女人，穿一件紧身的黑衣服。当我在她身旁坐下来的时候，她甚至连头都没有抬一下。她的眼睛盯着自己的盘子，不一会儿就忙着吃起来了。我试图找个话题和她聊聊。

我说：“一出新剧很快就要在‘环球剧场’上演了。”你去看吗？”

她回答说：“不。”

我又问：“您今年去国外度假吗？”

她回答说：“不。”

我再问：“您就呆在英国吗？”

她回答说：“不。”

失望之中我问她饭是否吃得满意。

她回答说：“年轻人，如果你多吃点，少说点，我们两个就都会吃得好的！”

41. Do You Call That a Hat?

'Do you call that a hat?' I said to my wife.

'You needn't be so rude about it,' my wife answered as she looked at herself in the mirror.

I sat down on one of those modern chairs with holes in it and waited. We had been in the hat shop for half an hour and my wife was still in front of the mirror.

'We mustn't buy things we don't need,' I remarked suddenly. I regretted saying it

almost at once.

'You needn't have said that,' my wife answered. 'I needn't remind you of that terrible tie you bought yesterday.'

'I find it beautiful,' I said. 'A man can never have too many ties.'

'And a woman can't have too many hats,' she answered.

Ten minutes later we walked out of the shop together. My wife was wearing a hat that looked like a lighthouse!

你把那个叫帽子吗？

“你把那个叫帽子吗？”我对妻子说。

“你说话没必要这样不客气，”我的妻子边回答边照着镜子。

我坐在一个新式的满是网眼儿的椅子上，等待着。我们在这家帽店已经呆了半个小时了，而我的妻子仍在镜子面前。

“我们不应该买我们不需要的东西，”我突然发表意见说，但马上又后悔说了这话。

“你没必要这么说，”我妻子回答说，“我也不必提醒你昨天买的那条糟糕透了的领带。”

“我觉得它好看，”我说，“男人有多少领带也不会嫌多。”

“女人有多少帽子也不嫌多。”她回答。

10分钟以后，我们一道走出了商店。我妻子戴着一顶像灯塔一样的帽子。

42. Not very musical

As we had had a long walk through one of the markets of Old Delhi, we stopped at a square to have a rest. After a time, we noticed a snake charmer with two large baskets at the other side of the square, so we went to have a look at him. As soon as he saw us, he picked up a long pipe which was covered with coins and opened one of the baskets. When he began to play a tune, we had our first glimpse of the snake. It rose out of the basket and began to follow the movements of the pipe. We were very much surprised when the snake charmer suddenly began to play jazz and modern pop songs. The snake, however, continued to 'dance' slowly. It obviously could not tell the difference between Indian music and jazz!

并非很懂音乐

当我们穿过旧德里的市场时走了很长一段路，我们在一个广场上停下来休息。过了一会儿，我们注意到广场的那一边有一个带着两个大筐的耍蛇人，于是就走过去看看。他一见我们，就拿起了一个长长的上面镶有硬币的管乐器，并打开了其中一个筐的盖子。当他开始吹奏一支曲子时，我们才第一次看到那条蛇。它从筐里探出身子，随着乐器的摆动而扭动。当耍蛇人突然又吹奏起爵士乐和现代流行乐曲时，我们感到非常惊奇。然而那蛇却还是缓慢地“舞动”着。显然，它分辨不出印度音乐和爵士乐！

43. Over the South Pole

In 1929, three years after his flight over the North Pole, the American explorer, R.E. Byrd, successfully flew over the South Pole for the first time. Though, at first, Byrd and his men were able to take a great many photographs of the mountains that lay below, they soon ran into serious trouble. At one point, it seemed certain that their plane would crash. It could only get over the mountains if it rose to 10,000 feet. Byrd at once ordered his men to throw out two heavy food sacks. The plane was then able to rise and it cleared the mountains by 400 feet. Byrd now knew that he would be able to reach the South Pole which was 300 miles away, for there were no more mountains in sight. The aircraft was able to fly over the endless white plains without difficulty.

飞越南极

美国探险家R.E.

伯德在飞越北极3年之后，于1929年第一次成功地飞越了南极。虽然开始时伯德和他的助手们拍下了飞机下面连绵群山的大量照片，但他们很快就陷入了困境。在有个地方，飞机似乎肯定要坠毁了。只有在飞至10,000英尺的高度时，它才能飞过这些山头。伯德马上命令他的助手们把两个沉重的食物袋扔掉，于是飞机可以上升了，它在离山头400英尺的高度飞越了过去。伯德这时知道他能够顺利飞抵300英里以外的南极了，因为前面再没有山了。飞机可以毫无困难地飞过这片茫茫无际的白色原野！

44. Through the Forest

Mrs. Anne Sterling did not think of the risk she was taking when she ran through a forest after two men. They had rushed up to her while she was having a picnic at the edge of a forest with her children and tried to steal her handbag. In the struggle, the strap broke and, with the bag in their possession, both men started running through

the trees. Mrs. Sterling got so angry that she ran after them. She was soon out of breath, but she continued to run. When she caught up with them, she saw that they had sat down and were going through the contents of the bag, so she ran straight at them. The men got such a fright that they dropped the bag and ran away. 'The strap needs mending,' said Mrs. Sterling later, 'but they did not steal anything.'

穿过森林

安·斯特林夫人在穿过森林追赶两个男人时，她并没有考虑到所冒的风险。当她和孩子们正在森林边上野餐的时候，这两个人冲到她跟前，企图抢走她的手提包。在争抢中，手提包的带断了，包落入这两个人手里，他们拔腿跑进了树林。斯特林夫人非常气愤，向着他们追了过去。只追了一会儿便上气不接下气了，但她还是继续追赶。当她赶上他们时，发现他们已经坐了下来，正翻着包里的东西。于是她直冲过去。这两个人吓了一跳，扔下包逃跑了。“这提包带需要修理，”斯特林夫人事后说道，“不过他们什么也没偷走。”

45. A Clear Conscience

The whole village soon learnt that a large sum of money had been lost. Sam Benton, the local butcher, had lost his wallet while taking his savings to the post office. Sam was sure that the wallet must have been found by one of the villagers, but it was not returned to him. Three months passed, and then one morning, Sam found his wallet outside his front door. It had been wrapped up in newspaper and it contained half the money he had lost, together with a note which said: 'A thief, yes, but only 50 per cent a thief!' Two months later, some more money was sent to Sam with another note: 'Only 25 per cent a thief now!' In time, all Sam's money was paid back in this way. The last note said: 'I am 100 per cent honest now!'

问心无愧

整个村子很快知道，有一大笔钱丢失了。当地的屠户萨姆·本顿在把存款送往邮局的途中把钱包丢了。萨姆确信那钱包一定是被某个村民捡到了，可是却不见有人来送还给他。3个月过去了，后来在一天早晨，萨姆在自己的大门外发现了他的钱包。钱包是用报纸包着的，里面有他丢失的钱的一半，而且还附着一张纸条，上面写着：“一个小偷，是的，但只是一个50%的小偷！”又过了两个月，又有一些钱送还给了萨姆，又附了一张字条：“这回只是25%的小偷了！”很快，萨姆全部的钱都用同样的方式还了回来。最后的那张字条上写道：“我现在是一个100%的诚实人了！”

46. Expensive and Uncomfortable

When a plane from London arrived at Sydney airport, workers began to unload a number of wooden boxes which contained clothing.

No one could account for the fact that one of the boxes was extremely heavy. It suddenly occurred to one of the workers to open up the box. He was astonished at what he found. A man was lying in the box on top of a pile of woolen goods.

He was so surprised at being discovered that he did not even try to run away. After he was arrested, the man admitted hiding in the box before the plane left London. He had had a long and uncomfortable trip, for he had been confined to the wooden box for over eighteen hours. The man was ordered to pay £3,500 for the cost of the trip. The normal price of a ticket is £2,000!

既昂贵又受罪

当一架来自伦敦的飞机抵达悉尼机场时，工人们开始卸下装有服装的一批木箱。

其中有只箱子特别重，可谁也弄不清是怎么回事。突然一个工人想到打开箱子看看。看到的情景使他吃惊，箱内有一个人正躺在一堆毛织品之上。

他由于被人发现而感到非常吃惊，甚至都没有企图逃跑。此人被逮捕后，承认他是在飞机离开伦敦前躲进箱里的。他经受了一次漫长而又难受的旅程，因为他在那木箱里闷了18个多小时。此人被责令交付旅费3,500英镑，而正常票价是2,000英镑！

47. A Thirsty Ghost

A public house which was recently bought by Mr. Ian Thompson is up for sale. Mr. Thompson is going to sell it because it is haunted. He told me that he could not go to sleep one night because he heard a strange noise coming from the bar. The next morning, he found that the doors had been blocked by chairs and the furniture had been moved. Though Mr. Thompson had turned the lights off before he went to bed, they were on in the morning. He also said that he had found five empty whisky bottles which the ghost must have drunk the night before. When I suggested that some villagers must have come in for a free drink, Mr. Thompson shook his head. The villagers have told him that they will not accept the pub even if he gives it away.

嗜酒的鬼魂

伊恩·汤普森先生最近才买的一个小酒店现在又要卖出去。汤普森先生之所以想卖它，是因

为那里常闹鬼。他告诉我有天夜里他怎么也睡不着，因为他听到酒吧里传来一阵奇怪的响声。第二天早上，他发现酒吧间的门被椅子堵上了，家具也被挪动过。虽然汤普森临睡觉时把灯关了，但早晨灯却都亮着。他还说他发现了五只空的威士忌瓶子，肯定是鬼魂昨天晚上喝的。当我暗示说一定是村里有些人来喝不花钱的酒时，汤普森先生摇了摇头。村里的人已经告诉他，即使他把小酒店白送人，他们也不要。

48. Did you want to tell me something?

Dentists always ask questions when it is impossible for you to answer. My dentist had just pulled out one of my teeth and had told me to rest for a while. I tried to say something, but my mouth was full of cotton-wool. He knew I collected match boxes and asked me whether my collection was growing. He then asked me how my brother was and whether I liked my new job in London. In answer to these questions I either nodded or made strange noises. Meanwhile, my tongue was busy searching out the hole where the tooth had been. I suddenly felt very worried, but could not say anything. When the dentist at last removed the cotton-wool from my mouth, I was able to tell him that he had pulled out the wrong tooth.

你想对我说什么吗？

牙科医生们总是在你无法作出回答的时候向你提出问题。我的牙科医生刚刚给我拔掉了一颗牙，叫我休息一会儿。我想说点什么，但我嘴里塞满了药棉。他知道我收集火柴盒，于是问我收藏的火柴盒是否在增加。接着他又问我的兄弟近来如何，问我是否喜欢伦敦的新工作。作为对这些问题的回答，我不是点头，就是发出奇怪的声音。与此同时，我的舌头正在忙着寻找刚拔掉的那颗牙的伤口。我突然非常着急起来，但却什么也说不出。当那位牙医最后将药棉从我嘴中取出时，我总算有可能告诉他，他拔错了牙。

49. The end of a dream

Tired of sleeping on the floor, a young man in Teheran saved up for years to buy a real bed. For the first time in his life, he became the proud owner of a bed which had springs and a mattress. Because the weather was very hot, he carried the bed on to the roof of his house. He slept very well for the first two nights, but on the third night, a storm blew up. A gust of wind swept the bed off the roof and sent it crashing into the courtyard below. The young man did not wake up until the bed had struck the ground. Although the bed was smashed to pieces, the man was miraculously unhurt. When he woke up, he was still on the mattress. Glancing at the bits of wood

and metal that lay around him, the man sadly picked up the mattress and carried it into his house. After he had put it on the floor, he promptly went to sleep again.

美梦告终

德黑兰的一个年轻人由于对睡地板感到厌倦，于是积蓄多年买了一张真正的床。他平生第一次自豪地拥有了一张既有弹簧又带床垫的床。由于天气很热，他把床搬到了他的屋顶上。头两天晚上，他睡得非常好。但第三天晚上起了风暴。一阵大风把床从屋顶上刮了下来，把它摔碎在下面的院子里。那年轻人直到床撞到地上才醒了过来。尽管床摔成了碎片，但年轻人却奇迹般地没有受伤。他醒来时，仍然躺在床垫上。年轻人看了一眼周围的碎木片和碎金属片，伤心地捡起了床垫，把它拿进了屋。他把床垫往地板上一放，很快又睡着了。

50. Taken for a ride

I love travelling in the country, but I don't like losing my way. I went on an excursion recently, but my trip took me longer than I expected.

'I'm going to Woodford Green,' I said to the conductor as I got on the bus, 'but I don't know where it is.'

'I'll tell you where to get off,' answered the conductor.

I sat in the front of the bus to get a good view of the countryside. After some time, the bus stopped. Looking round, I realized with a shock that I was the only passenger left on the bus.

'You'll have to get off here,' the conductor said. 'This is as far as we go.'

'Is this Woodford Green?' I asked.

'Oh dear,' said the conductor suddenly. 'I forgot to put you off.'

'It doesn't matter,' I said. 'I'll get off here.'

'We're going back now,' said the conductor.

'Well, in that case, I prefer to stay on the bus,' I answered.

乘车兜风

我喜欢在乡间旅行，却不愿意迷路。最近我作了一次短途旅行，但这次旅行所花费的时间比我预计的要长。

“我要去伍德福德草地，”我一上车就对售票员说，“但我不知道它在什么地方。”

“我来告诉您在哪儿下车，”售票员回答说。

我坐在汽车的前部，以便饱览农村风光。过了一些时候，车停了。我环视了一下身旁，惊奇地发现车里就只剩我一个乘客了。

“您得在这里下车，”售票员说，“我们的车就到此为止了。”

“这里是伍德福德草地吗？”我问道。

“哎呀，”售票员突然说，“我忘了让您下车了。”

“没关系，”我说，“我就在这儿下吧。”

“我们现在要返回去，”售票员说。

“好吧，既然如此，我还是留在车上吧。”我回答说。

51. Reward for Virtue

My friend, Hugh, has always been fat, but things got so bad recently that he decided to go on a diet. He began his diet a week ago. First of all, he wrote out a long list of all the foods which were forbidden. The list included most of the things Hugh loves: butter, potatoes, rice, beer, milk, chocolate; and sweets. Yesterday I paid him a visit. I rang the bell and was not surprised to see that Hugh was still as fat as ever. He led me into his room and hurriedly hid a large parcel under his desk. It was obvious that he was very embarrassed. When I asked him what he was doing, he smiled guiltily and then put the parcel on the table. He explained that his diet was so strict that he had to reward himself occasionally. Then he showed me the contents of the parcel. It contained five large bars of chocolate and three bags of sweets!

对美德的奖赏

我的朋友休一直很胖，但是近来情况变得越发糟糕，以致他决定节食。他是一星期前开始节食的。首先，他开列了一张长长的单子，上面列了所有禁吃的食物。这张单子上的大多数食物都是休喜欢吃的：黄油、土豆、米饭、啤酒、牛奶、巧克力和糖果。昨天我去看望了他。我按响了门铃，当看到休仍和往常一样胖时，我并不感到惊奇。他把我领进屋，慌忙把一个大包藏到了桌子下面。显然他感到很尴尬。当我问他正干什么时，他内疚地笑了，然后把那个包拿到了桌上。他解释说，他的饮食控制得太严格了，以致不得不偶尔奖赏自己一下。接着他给我看了包里的东西。里面装了五大块巧克力和三袋糖果！

52. A pretty carpet

We have just moved into a new house and I have been working hard all morning. I have been trying to get my new room in order. This has not been easy because I own over a thousand books. To make matters worse, the room is rather small, so I have temporarily put my books on the floor. At the moment, they cover every inch of floor space and I actually have to walk on them to get in or out of the room. A short while ago, my sister helped me to carry one of my old bookcases up the stairs. She went into my room and got a big surprise when she saw all those books on the floor. 'This is the prettiest carpet I have ever seen,' she said. She gazed at it for some time then added, 'You don't need bookcases at all. You can sit here in your spare time and read the carpet!'

漂亮的地毯

我们刚刚搬进一所新房子，我辛辛苦苦地干了整整一个上午。我试图把我的新房间收拾整齐，但这并不容易，因为我有1000多本书。更糟糕的是房间还非常小，所以我暂时把书放在了地板上。这会儿，书把地板的每一点空隙都占据了，我实际上是踩着这些书进出房间的。片刻之前，我妹妹帮我把一个旧书橱抬上了楼。她走进我的房间，当她看到地板上的那些书时，大吃一惊。“这是我见过的最漂亮的地毯，”她说。她盯着“地毯”看了一会儿，又说：“你根本用不着书橱，空闲时你可以坐在这儿读地毯！”

53. Hot Snake

At last firemen have put out a big forest fire in California. Since then, they have been trying to find out how the fire began. Forest fires are often caused by broken glass or by cigarette ends which people carelessly throw away. Yesterday the firemen examined the ground carefully, but were not able to find any broken glass. They were also quite sure that a cigarette end did not start the fire. This morning, however, a fireman accidentally discovered the cause. He noticed the remains of a snake which was wound round the electric wires of a 16,000 - volt power line. In this way, he was able to solve the mystery. The explanation was simple but very unusual. A bird had snatched up the snake from the ground and then dropped it on to the wires. The snake then wound itself round the wires. When it did so, it sent sparks down to the ground and these immediately started a fire.

触电的蛇

消防队员们终于扑灭了加利福尼亚的一场森林大火。从那时起，他们一直试图找出起火的原因。森林火灾时常由破碎的玻璃或人们随手扔掉的香烟头引起。昨天，消防队员仔细查

看了地面，但未能发现任何碎玻璃。他们还十分肯定火灾也不是由烟头引起的。然而今天上午，一个消防队员偶然发现了起火的原因。他发现了缠绕在16,000伏高压线上的一条死蛇。就这样，他解开了起火之谜。解释很简单，却异乎寻常。一只鸟把蛇从地上抓起来，然后把它扔到了电线上。于是蛇就缠住了几根电线。当它这样做时，把火花送到了地面，这些火花立刻引起了一场大火。

54. Sticky fingers

After breakfast, I sent the children to school and then I went to the shops. It was still early when I returned home. The children were at school, my husband was at work and the house was quiet. So I decided to make some meat pies. In a short time I was busy mixing butter and flour and my hands were soon covered with sticky pastry. At exactly that moment, the telephone rang. Nothing could have been more annoying. I picked up the receiver between two sticky fingers and was dismayed when I recognized the voice of Helen Bates. It took me ten minutes to persuade her to ring back later. At last I hung up the receiver. What a mess! There was pastry on my fingers, on the telephone, and on the doorknobs. I had no sooner got back to the kitchen than the doorbell rang loud enough to wake the dead. This time it was the postman and he wanted me to sign for a registered letter!

粘糊的手指

早饭后，我送孩子们上学，然后就去了商店。我回到家时，时间还早。孩子们在上学，我丈夫在上班，家里清静得很。于是我决定做些肉馅饼。不一会儿我就忙着调拌起了黄油和面粉，很快我的手上就沾满了粘粘的面糊。恰恰在此时，电话铃响了。没有什么能比这更烦人了。我用两个沾满面糊的手指捏起了话筒。当我听出是海伦·贝茨的声音时，非常丧气。我用了10分钟的时间才说服她过会儿再来电话。我终于挂上了话筒。真是糟糕透了！我的手指上、电话机上以及门的把手上，都沾上了面糊。我刚回到厨房，门铃又响了起来，响声足以把死人唤醒。这次是邮递员，他要我签收一封挂号信！

55. Not a gold mine

Dreams of finding lost treasure almost came true recently. A new machine called 'The Revealer' has been invented and it has been used to detect gold which has been buried in the ground. The machine was used in a cave near the seashore where-it is said-pirates used to hide gold. The pirates would often bury gold in the cave and then fail to collect it. Armed with the new machine, a search party went into the cave

hoping to find buried treasure. The leader of the party was examining the soil near the entrance to the cave when the machine showed that there was gold under the ground. Very excited, the party dug a hole two feet deep. They finally found a small gold coin which was almost worthless.

The party then searched the whole cave thoroughly but did not find anything except an empty tin trunk. In spite of this, many people are confident that 'The Revealer' may reveal something of value fairly soon.

并非金矿

最近,找到失踪宝藏的梦想差一点儿变成现实。一种叫“探宝器”的新机器已经发明出来,并被人们用来探测地下埋藏的金子。在靠近海边的一个据说过去海盗常在里面藏金子的岩洞里,这种机器被派上了用场。海盗们过去常把金子埋藏在那个洞里,可后来却没能取走。一支用这种新机器装备起来的探宝队进入了这个岩洞,希望找到埋藏着的金子。当这个队的队长正在检查洞口附近的土壤时,那台机器显示出它的下面埋有金子。队员们异常激动,就地挖了一个两英尺深的坑,但最后找到的是一枚几乎一钱不值的小金币。

接着,这支探宝队对整个洞彻底搜寻了一遍,除了一只空铁皮箱外什么也没找到。尽管如此,很多人仍然相信“探宝器”很快就会探出值钱的东西来。

56. Faster than Sound!

Once a year, a race is held for old cars. A lot of cars entered for this race last year and there was a great deal of excitement just before it began. One of the most handsome cars was a Rolls - Royce Silver Ghost. The most unusual car was a Benz which had only three wheels. Built in 1885, it was the oldest car taking part. After a great many loud explosions, the race began. Many of the cars broke down on the course and some drivers spent more time under their cars than in them! A few cars, however, completed the race. The winning car reached a speed of forty miles an hour - much faster than any of its rivals. It sped downhill at the end of the race and its driver had a lot of trouble trying to stop it. The race gave everyone a great deal of pleasure. It was very different from modern car races but no less exciting.

比声音还快!

旧式汽车的比赛每年举行一次。去年有很多汽车参加了这项比赛。比赛开始之前,人们异常激动。最漂亮的汽车之一是罗尔斯 -

罗伊斯生产的银鬼汽车,而最不寻常的一辆则要属只有3个轮子的奔驰牌汽车了。该车造于1885年,是参赛车中最老的一辆。在好一阵喧闹的爆炸声之后,比赛开始了。很多汽车在途中就抛了锚,而有些驾驶员花在汽车底下的时间比坐在汽车里面的时间还长。然而还是

有几辆汽车跑完了全程。获胜的那辆车达到了时速40英里——远远超过任何对手。它在接近终点时，冲下了山坡，驾驶员费了好大劲才把车停下来。这次比赛使每个人都挺开心。它虽然与现代汽车比赛大不相同，但激动人心的程度并不亚于现代汽车大赛。

57. Can I help you, madam?

A woman in blue jeans stood at the window of an expensive shop. Though she hesitated for a moment, she finally went in and asked to see a dress that was in the window. The assistant who served her did not like the way she was dressed. Glancing at her scornfully, he told her that the dress was sold. The woman walked out of the shop angrily and decided to punish the assistant next day. She returned to the shop the following morning dressed in a fur coat, with a handbag in one hand and a long umbrella in the other. After seeking out the rude assistant, she asked for the same dress. Not realizing who she was, the assistant was eager to serve her this time. With great difficulty, he climbed into the shop window to get the dress. As soon as she saw it, the woman said she did not like it. She enjoyed herself making the assistant bring almost everything in the window before finally buying the dress she had first asked for.

你要买什么，夫人？

一位穿着蓝色牛仔褲的婦女站在一家高檔商店的櫥窗前。她雖然猶豫了片刻，但終於還是走進了商店，要求把陳列在櫥窗里的一件衣服拿給她看。接待她的售貨員不喜歡她的那副打扮，輕蔑地看了她一眼後，便告訴她那件衣服已經賣出去了。這位婦女怒氣沖沖地走出了商店，決定第二天教訓一下那個售貨員。第二天上午，她又來到這家商店，穿了一件裘皮大衣，一只手拎着一只手提包，另一只手拿着一把長柄傘。找到那個無禮的售貨員後，她還要看昨天的那件衣服。那個售貨員沒有認出她是誰，這一回接待她的態度非常殷勤。費了好大勁兒，他爬進櫥窗去取那件衣服。這位婦女對那件衣服只看一眼，就說不喜歡。她開心地迫使那位售貨員把櫥窗里几乎所有的東西都拿了出來，最後才買下了她最先要看的那一件。

58. A Blessing in Disguise

The tiny village of Frinley is said to possess a 'cursed tree'. Because the tree was mentioned in a newspaper, the number of visitors to Frinley has now increased. The tree was planted near the church fifty years ago, but it is only in recent years that it has gained an evil reputation. It is said that if anyone touches the tree, he will have

bad luck; if he picks a leaf, he will die. Many villagers believe that the tree has already claimed a number of victims. The vicar has been asked to have the tree cut down, but so far he has refused. He has pointed out that the tree is a useful source of income as tourists have been coming from all parts of the country to see it. In spite of all that has been said, the tourists have been picking leaves and cutting their names on the tree - trunk. So far, not one of them has been struck down by sudden death!

因祸得福

据说弗林利这个小村里有一棵“该诅咒的树”。就因为报上提到过这棵树，所以现在来弗林利参观的人越来越多。这棵树是50年前栽在教堂附近的，但只是近几年才得到了一个坏名声。据说，谁要是触摸了这棵树，谁就会交上恶运；如果谁摘了一片树叶，谁就会死去。很多村民相信此树已经害了不少人。人们曾请求教区的牧师叫人把树砍掉，但他直到现在也没有同意。他指出，由于人们从全国各地纷纷前来参观这棵树，它成了一个有用的财源。尽管有上述种种说法，但游客们还是照常摘树叶和把他们的名字刻在树干上。然而到目前为止，还没有一个人暴死呢！

59. In or out

Our dog, Rex, used to sit outside our front gate and bark. Every time he wanted to come into the garden he would bark until someone opened the gate. As the neighbours complained of the noise, my husband spent weeks training him to press his paw on the latch to let himself in. Rex soon became an expert at opening the gate. However, when I was going out shopping last week, I noticed him in the garden near the gate. This time he was barking so that someone would let him out! Since then, he has developed another bad habit. As soon as he opens the gate from the outside, he comes into the garden and waits until the gate shuts. Then he sits and barks until someone lets him out. After this he immediately lets himself in and begins barking again. Yesterday my husband removed the gate and Rex got so annoyed we have not seen him since.

进来还是出去

我家的狗雷克斯，过去常坐在大门外面叫。每当它想到花园里来时，便汪汪叫个不停，直到有人把门打开。由于邻居们对狗叫很有意见，所以我丈夫花了几个星期的时间训练它用脚爪按住门闩把自己放进来。雷克斯很快成了开门的专家。然而上星期我正要出去买东西时，发现它正呆在花园里边靠门的地方。这次它叫着让人把它放出去！从那以后，它养成了另外一种坏习惯。它从外面把门一打开，就走进花园，等着门自动关上。这之后他就坐下汪汪叫起来，直到有人来把它放出去。出去之后，它又马上把自己放进来，接着再开始

叫。昨天，我丈夫把大门卸了下来，雷克斯很生气，此后我们便再也没有见到它。

60. The Future

At a village fair, I decided to visit a fortune - teller called Madam Bellinsky. I went into her tent and she told me to sit down. After I had given her some money, she looked into a crystal ball and said: 'A relation of yours is coming to see you. She will be arriving this evening and intends to stay for a few days. The moment you leave this tent, you will get a big surprise. A woman you know well will rush towards you. She will speak to you and then she will lead you away from this place. That is all.' As soon as I went outside, I forgot all about Madam Bellinsky because my wife hurried towards me. 'Where have you been hiding?' she asked impatiently. 'Your sister will be here in less than an hour and we must be at the station to meet her. We are late already.' As she walked away, I followed her out of the fair.

未来

在一个乡村集市上，我决定去拜访一位名叫别林斯基夫人的算命人。我走进她的帐篷，她叫我坐下。我给了她一些钱后，她便查看着一个水晶球说道：“您的一个亲戚就要来看您了。她将于今天傍晚到达，并准备住上几天。您一走出这个帐篷，就会大吃一惊。一位您很熟悉的女人将向您冲来。她会对您说话，然后她将带您离开这个地方。就这些。”我一走出帐篷，就把别林斯基夫人的话忘得一干二净了，因为我的妻子正匆匆向我跑来。“你躲到哪儿去了？”她不耐烦地问，“再有不到一个小时你姐姐就要到这儿了，我们得去车站接她。现在已经晚了。”当她走开时，我也跟着她出了集市。

61. Trouble with the Hubble

The Hubble telescope was launched into space by NASA on April 20, 1990 at a cost of over a billion dollars.

Right from the start there was trouble with the Hubble. The pictures it sent us were very disappointing because its main mirror was faulty! NASA is now going to put the telescope right, so it will soon be sending up four astronauts to repair it. The shuttle Endeavour will be taking the astronauts to the Hubble.

A robot-arm from the Endeavour will grab the telescope and hold it while the astronauts make the necessary repairs. Of course, the Hubble is above the earth's

atmosphere, so it will soon be sending us the clearest pictures of the stars and distant galaxies that we have ever seen.

The Hubble will tell us a great deal about the age and size of the universe. By the time you read this, the Hubble's eagle eye will have sent us thousands and thousands of wonderful pictures.

哈勃望远镜的困境

哈勃望远镜于1990年4月20日由美国国家航空航天局发射升空，耗资10多亿美元。

从最开始哈勃望远镜就有问题。它传送给我们的图像很令人失望，因为它的主要镜子有误差。美国国家航空航天局现在打算纠正这一错误，为此将把4名宇航员送入太空修复望远镜。“奋进”号航天飞机将把宇航员送上哈勃。

当宇航员进行必要的修复工作时，“奋进”号上的一只机械臂将抓住望远镜并托住它。当然，哈勃位于地球的大气层之外，因此，它很快就会给我们传送我们所见到过的、有关行星和远距离星系的最清晰的照片。

哈勃将告诉我们有关宇宙的年龄和大小的许多事情。等到你读到这篇文章时，敏锐的哈勃望远镜已经为我们送来了成千上万张精彩的照片。

62. After the Fire

Firemen had been fighting the forest fire for nearly three weeks before they could get it under control. A short time before, great trees had covered the countryside for miles around. Now, smoke still rose up from the warm ground over the desolate hills. Winter was coming on and the hills threatened the surrounding villages with destruction, for heavy rain would not only wash away the soil but would cause serious floods as well. When the fire had at last been put out, the forest authorities ordered several tons of a special type of grass - seed which would grow quickly. The seed was sprayed over the ground in huge quantities by aeroplanes. The planes had been planting seed for nearly a month when it began to rain. By then, however, in many places the grass had already taken root. In place of the great trees which had been growing there for centuries, patches of green had begun to appear in the blackened soil.

大火之后

消防队员们同那场森林大火搏斗了将近三个星期才最后把火势控制住。就在不久之前，参天大树还覆盖着方圆数英里的土地。而现在，发热的地面上仍然升腾着烟雾，弥漫在荒凉的山丘上。冬季即将来临，这些山丘对周围的村庄具有毁灭性的威胁，因为大雨不仅会冲

走土壤，而且还会引起严重的水灾。在大火最后被扑灭后，森林管理当局订购了好几吨一种生长迅速的特殊类型的草籽。飞机把这种草籽大量地撒播在地上。飞机撒播近一个月后，开始下起雨来。然而到那时，很多地方的草已经生了根。一片片的绿草开始出现在这片烧焦的土地上，代替了多少世纪以来一直生长在那里的参天大树。

63. She was not amused

Jeremy Hampden has a large circle of friends and is very popular at parties. Everybody admires him for his great sense of humour - everybody, that is, except his six - year - old daughter, Jenny. Recently, one of Jeremy's closest friends asked him to make a speech at a wedding reception. This is the sort of thing that Jeremy loves. He prepared the speech carefully and went to the wedding with Jenny. He had included a large number of funny stories in the speech and, of course, it was a great success. As soon as he had finished, Jenny told him she wanted to go home. Jeremy was a little disappointed by this but he did as his daughter asked. On the way home, he asked Jenny if she had enjoyed the speech. To his surprise, she said she hadn't. Jeremy asked her why this was so and she told him that she did not like to see so many people laughing at him!

她并不觉得好笑

杰里米·汉普登交际甚广，是各种聚会上深受大家欢迎的人。人人都钦佩他那绝妙的幽默感——人人，就是说，除他6岁的女儿珍妮之外的每一个人。最近，杰里米的一个最亲密的朋友请他在一个婚礼上祝词。这正是杰里米喜欢做的事情。他认真准备了讲稿，带着珍妮一道去参加了婚礼。他在祝词里面加进了大量逗人的故事，自然大获成功。他刚一讲完，珍妮就对他说她要回家。这不免使杰里米有点扫兴，但他还是按照女儿的要求做了。在回家的路上，他问珍妮是否喜欢他的祝词。使他吃惊的是，她说她不喜欢。杰里米问她为何不喜欢，她说她不愿意看到那么多人嘲笑他！

64. The Channel Tunnel

In 1858, a French engineer, Aime Thome de Gamond, arrived in England with a plan for a twenty - one - mile tunnel under the English Channel. He said that it would be possible to build a platform in the centre of the Channel. This platform would serve as a port and a railway station. The tunnel would be well - ventilated if tall chimneys were built above sea level. In 1860, a better plan was put forward by an Englishman, William Low. He suggested that a double railway - tunnel should be

built. This would solve the problem of ventilation, for if a train entered this tunnel, it would draw in fresh air behind it. Forty - two years later a tunnel was actually begun. If, at the time, the British had not feared invasion, it would have been completed. The world had to wait almost another 100 years for the Channel Tunnel. It was officially opened on March 7, 1994, finally connecting Britain to the European continent.

英吉利海峡隧道

1858年，一位名叫埃梅·托梅·德·干蒙的法国工程师带着建造一条长21英里、穿越英吉利海峡的隧道计划到了英国。他说，可以在海峡的中心建造一座平台。这座平台将用作码头和火车站。如果再建些伸出海面的高大的烟囱状通风管，隧道就具备了良好的通风条件。1860年，一位名叫威廉·洛的英国人提出了一项更好的计划。他提议建一条双轨隧道，这样就解决了通风问题。因为如果有一列火车开进隧道，它就把新鲜空气随之抽进了隧道。42年以后，隧道实际已经开始建了。如果不是因为那时英国人害怕入侵，隧道早已建成了。世界不得不再等将近100年才看到海峡隧道竣工。它于1994年3月7日正式开通，将英国与欧洲大陆连到了一起。

65. Jumbo versus the police

Last Christmas, the circus owner, Jimmy Gates, decided to take some presents to a children's hospital. Dressed up as Father Christmas and accompanied by a 'guard of honour' of six pretty girls, he set off down the main street of the city riding a baby elephant called Jumbo. He should have known that the police would never allow this sort of thing. A policeman approached Jimmy and told him he ought to have gone along a side street as Jumbo was holding up the traffic. Though Jimmy agreed to go at once, Jumbo refused to move. Fifteen policemen had to push very hard to get him off the main street. The police had a difficult time, but they were most amused. 'Jumbo must weigh a few tons,' said a policeman afterwards, 'so it was fortunate that we didn't have to carry him. Of course, we should arrest him, but as he has a good record, we shall let him off this time.'

小象对警察

去年圣诞节，马戏团老板吉米·盖茨决定送些礼物给儿童医院。他打扮成圣诞老人，在由6个漂亮姑娘组成的“仪仗队”的陪同下，骑上一头名叫江伯的小象，沿着城里的主要街道出发了。他本该知道警察绝不会允许这类事情发生。一个警察走过来告诉吉米，他应该走一条小路，因为江伯阻碍了交通。虽然吉米同意马上就走，但江伯却拒绝移动。15个警察不得不用很大的力气把它推离主要街道。警察虽然吃了苦头，但他们还是感到很有趣。“江伯一定有好几吨重，”一个警察事后这样说，“值得庆幸的是它没让我们抬它走。当然

，我们应该逮捕它，但由于它一贯表现很好，这次我们饶了它。”

66. Sweet as Honey

In 1963 a Lancaster bomber crashed on Wallis Island, a remote place in the South Pacific, a long way west of Samoa. The plane wasn't too badly damaged, but over the years, the crash was forgotten and the wreck remained undisturbed. Then in 1989, twenty - six years after the crash, the plane was accidentally rediscovered in an aerial survey of the island. By this time, a Lancaster bomber in reasonable condition was rare and worth rescuing. The French authorities had the plane packaged and moved in parts back to France. Now a group of enthusiasts are going to have the plane restored. It has four Rolls - Royce Merlin engines, but the group will need to have only three of them rebuilt. Imagine their surprise and delight when they broke open the packing cases and found that the fourth engine was sweet as honey - still in perfect condition. A colony of bees had turned the engine into a hive and it was totally preserved in beeswax!

像蜜一样甜

1963年，一架兰开斯特轰炸机在瓦立斯岛坠毁。那是南太平洋中一个很偏僻的小岛，位于萨摩亚群岛以西，距离群岛还有很长一段距离。飞机损坏的程度并不严重，但是，多年来这起飞机失事已被遗忘，飞机残骸也没受到破坏。于是，到了1989年，飞机失事26年后，在对小岛的一次航空勘查中那架飞机被意外地发现了。到了那个时候，状况良好的兰开斯特轰炸机实属罕见，值得抢救。法国政府让人把飞机包装起来，一部分一部分地搬回法国。一群热心人计划修复这架飞机。该飞机装配有4台罗尔斯-罗伊斯的默林发动机，但是，他们只需要修复其中的3台。想象一下他们打开包装时的惊喜吧，他们发现第4台发动机就像蜂蜜一样甜——发动机完好无损。一群蜜蜂把发动机当作了蜂房，发动机在蜂蜡中被完整地保存了下来！

67. Volcanoes

Haroun Tazieff, the Polish scientist, has spent his lifetime studying active volcanoes and deep caves in all parts of the world. In 1948, he went to Lake Kivu in the Congo to observe a new volcano which he later named Kituro. Tazieff was able to set up his camp very close to the volcano while it was erupting violently. Though he managed to take a number of brilliant photographs, he could not stay near the volcano for very long. He noticed that a river of liquid rock was coming towards

him. It threatened to surround him completely, but Tazieff managed to escape just in time. He waited until the volcano became quiet and he was able to return two days later. This time, he managed to climb into the mouth of Kituro so that he could take photographs and measure temperatures. Tazieff has often risked his life in this way. He has been able to tell us more about active volcanoes than any man alive.

火山

波兰科学家哈罗恩·塔捷耶夫花了毕生的精力来研究世界各地的活火山和深洞。1948年他去了刚果的基伍湖，对一座后来被他命名为基图罗的新火山进行观察。当火山正在猛烈地喷发时，塔捷耶夫有办法把帐篷搭在离它非常近的地方。尽管他设法拍了一些十分精彩的照片，但他却不能在火山附近停留太长的时间。他发现有一股岩浆正向他流过来，眼看就要将他团团围住，但塔捷耶夫还是设法及时逃离了。他等到火山平静下来，两天以后又返回去了。这次他设法爬进了基图罗火山口，以便能拍摄照片和测量温度。塔捷耶夫经常冒这样的生命危险。他能告诉我们的有关活火山的情况比任何在世的人都要多。

68. Persistent

I crossed the street to avoid meeting him, but he saw me and came running towards me. It was no use pretending that I had not seen him, so I waved to him. I never enjoy meeting Nigel Dykes. He never has anything to do. No matter how busy you are, he always insists on coming with you. I had to think of a way of preventing him from following me around all morning.

'Hello, Nigel,' I said. 'Fancy meeting you here!'

'Hello, Elizabeth,' Nigel answered. 'I was just wondering how to spend the morning - until I saw you. You're not busy doing anything, are you?'

'No, not at all,' I answered. 'I'm going to...'

'Wouldn't you like to come with me?' he asked, before I had finished speaking.

'Actually, I'm going to the dentist,' I said.

'Oh, what a pity!' Nigel said. 'Then I'll come with you. There's always plenty to read in the waiting room!'

坚持不懈

我穿过马路以便避开他，但他看到我并朝我跑过来。若再装作没有看到他已是没有用了，我只好向他招手。我就怕遇到奈杰尔·戴克斯。他从来都是无事可做，不管你有多忙，他总

是坚持要跟你去。我得想办法不让他整个上午缠着我。

“你好，奈杰尔，想不到在这儿见到你。”我说。

“你好，伊丽莎白，”奈杰尔回答说，“我正不知道怎么消磨这一上午呢，正好见到你。你不忙，是吗？”

“不，不忙，我打算去……”我回答。

“你不想同我一起去吗？”没等我说完话他就问道。

“其实我打算去看牙医，”我说。

“噢，太遗憾了！”奈杰尔说，“那我也跟你去，候诊室里总有很多东西可供阅读！”

69. But not murder!

I was being tested for a driving licence for the third time. I had been asked to drive in heavy traffic and had done so successfully. After having been instructed to drive out of town, I began to acquire confidence. Sure that I had passed, I was almost beginning to enjoy my test. The examiner must have been pleased with my performance, for he smiled and said. 'Just one more thing, Mr. Eames. Let us suppose that a child suddenly crosses the road in front of you. As soon as I tap on the window, you must stop within five feet.' I continued driving and after some time, the examiner tapped loudly. Though the sound could be heard clearly, it took me a long time to react. I suddenly pressed the brake pedal hard and we were both thrown forward. The examiner looked at me sadly. 'Mr. Eames,' he said, in a mournful voice, 'you have just killed that child!'

并非谋杀！

我第3次接受驾驶执照考试。按照要求在车辆拥挤的路上驾驶，我圆满地完成了。在接到把车开出城的指令后，我开始有了信心。确信我已通过考试，所以我几乎开始喜欢起这次考试。主考人对我的驾驶想必是满意的，因为他微笑着说：“埃姆斯先生，只剩1项了。让我们假设一个小孩子突然在你前面穿过马路。我一敲车窗，你必须把车停在5英尺之内。”我继续开车，过了一会儿，主考人砰砰地敲了起来。虽然声音听得很清楚，但我过了好一会儿才作出反应。我突然用力踩紧刹车踏板，结果我俩的身体都向前冲去。主考人伤心地看着我。“埃姆斯先生，”他以悲伤的声调说，“你刚刚把那个小孩压死了！”

70. Red for Danger

During a bullfight, a drunk suddenly wandered into the middle of the ring. The crowd began to shout, but the drunk was unaware of the danger. The bull was busy with the matador at the time, but it suddenly caught sight of the drunk who was shouting rude remarks and waving a red cap. Apparently sensitive to criticism, the bull forgot all about the matador and charged at the drunk. The crowd suddenly grew quiet. The drunk, however, seemed quite sure of himself. When the bull got close to him, he clumsily stepped aside to let it pass. The crowd broke into cheers and the drunk bowed. By this time, however, three men had come into the ring and they quickly dragged the drunk to safety. Even the bull seemed to feel sorry for him, for it looked on sympathetically until the drunk was out of the sight.

危险的红色

在一次斗牛时，一个醉汉突然溜达到斗牛场中间。人们开始大叫起来，但醉汉却没有意识到危险。当时那公牛正忙于对付斗牛士，但突然它看见了醉汉，只见他正大声说着粗鲁的话，手里挥动着一顶红帽子。对挑衅显然非常敏感的公牛完全撇开斗牛士，直奔醉汉而来。观众突然静了下来。然而，醉汉像是很有把握似的。当公牛逼近他时，他踉跄地往旁边一闪，牛扑空了。观众欢呼起来，醉汉向人们鞠躬致谢。然而，此时已有3个人进入斗牛场，迅速把醉汉拉到安全的地方。好像连牛也在为他感到遗憾，因为它一直同情地看着醉汉，直到他的背影消逝，不见为止。

71. A Famous Clock

When you visit London, one of the first things you will see is Big Ben, the famous clock which can be heard all over the world on the B.B.C. If the Houses of Parliament had not been burned down in 1834, the great clock would never have been erected. Big Ben takes its name from Sir Benjamin Hall who was responsible for the making of the clock when the new Houses of Parliament were being built. It is not only of immense size, but is extremely accurate as well. Officials from Greenwich Observatory have the clock checked twice a day. On the B.B.C. you can hear the clock when it is actually striking because microphones are connected to the clock tower. Big Ben has rarely gone wrong. Once, however, it failed to give the correct time. A painter who had been working on the tower hung a pot of paint on one of the hands and slowed it down!

一个著名的大钟

当你游览伦敦时，首先看到的東西之一就是“大本”钟，即那座从英国广播公司的广播中

全世界都可以听到它的声音的著名大钟。如果不是国会大厦在1834年被焚毁的话，这座大钟永远也不会建造。“大本”钟得名于本杰明·霍尔爵士，因为当建造新的国会大厦时，他负责建造大钟。此钟不仅外型巨大，而且走时也非常准确。格林尼治天文台的官员们每天两次派人矫正此钟。当大钟打点的时候，你可以从英国广播公司的广播中听到，因为钟塔上接了麦克风。“大本”钟很少出差错。然而有一次，它却把时间报错了。在钟塔上干活的一位油漆工把一只油漆桶挂在了一根指针上，把钟弄慢了！

72. A car called Bluebird

The great racing driver, Sir Malcolm Campbell, was the first man to drive at over 300 miles per hour. He set up a new world record in September 1935 at Bonneville Salt Flats, Utah. Bluebird, the car he was driving, had been specially built for him. It was over 30 feet in length and had a 2,500 - horsepower engine. Although Campbell reached a speed of over 304 miles per hour, he had great difficulty in controlling the car because a tyre burst during the first run. After his attempt, Campbell was disappointed to learn that his average speed had been 299 miles per hour. However, a few days later, he was told that a mistake had been made. His average speed had been 301 miles per hour. Since that time, racing drivers have reached speeds over 600 miles per hour. Following in his father's footsteps many years later, Sir Malcolm's son, Donald, also set up a world record. Like his father, he was driving a car called Bluebird.

“蓝鸟”汽车

杰出的赛车选手马尔科姆·坎贝尔爵士是第一个以每小时超过300英里的速度驾车的人。他于1935年9月在犹他州的邦纳维尔盐滩创造了一项新的世界纪录。他驾驶的“蓝鸟”牌汽车是专门为他制造的。它的车身长30多英尺，有一个2,500马力的发动机。尽管坎贝尔达到了每小时超过304英里的速度，但他很难把汽车控制住，因为在开始的行程中爆了一只轮胎。比赛结束后，坎贝尔非常失望地得知他的平均时速是299英里。然而，几天之后，有人告诉他说弄错了。他的平均时速实际是301英里。从那时以来，赛车选手已达到每小时600英里的速度。很多年之后，马尔科姆爵士的儿子唐纳德踏着父亲的足迹，也创造了一项世界纪录。同他父亲一样，他也驾驶着一辆名叫“蓝鸟”的汽车。

73. The record-holder

Children who play truant from school are unimaginative. A quiet day's fishing, or eight hours in a cinema seeing the same film over and over again, is usually as far as they get. They have all been put to shame by a boy who, while playing truant, travelled 1,600 miles. He hitchhiked to Dover and, towards evening, went into a boat to find somewhere to sleep. When he woke up next morning, he discovered that the boat had, in the meantime, travelled to Calais. No one noticed the boy as he crept off. From there, he hitchhiked to Paris in a lorry. The driver gave him a few biscuits and a cup of coffee and left him just outside the city. The next car the boy stopped did not take him into the centre of Paris as he hoped it would, but to Perpignan on the French - Spanish border. There he was picked up by a policeman and sent back to England by the local authorities. He has surely set up a record for the thousands of children who dream of evading school.

纪录保持者

逃学的孩子们都缺乏想象力。他们通常能够做到的，至多也就是安静地钓上一天鱼，或在电影院里坐上8个小时，一遍遍地看同一部电影。而有一个小男孩，他在逃学期间旅行了1,600英里，从而使上述所有逃学的孩子们都相形见绌了。他搭便车到了多佛，天快黑时钻进了一条船，想找个地方睡觉。第二天早上他醒来时，发现船在这段时间已经到了加来。当男孩从船里爬出来时，谁也没有发现他。从那里他又搭上卡车到了巴黎。司机给了他几块饼干和一杯咖啡，就把他丢在了城外。男孩截住的下一辆车，没有像他希望的那样把他带到巴黎市中心，而是把他带到了法国和西班牙边界上的佩皮尼昂。他在那儿被一个警察抓住了，之后被当局送回了英国。他无疑为成千上万梦想逃避上学的孩子们创造了一项纪录。

74. Out of the Limelight

An ancient bus stopped by a dry river bed and a party of famous actors and actresses got off. Dressed in dark glasses and old clothes, they had taken special precautions so that no one should recognize them. But as they soon discovered, disguises can sometimes be too perfect.

This is a wonderful place for a picnic, said Gloria Gleam.

It couldn't be better, Gloria, Brinksley Meers agreed.

No sooner had they sat down than they found it was surrounded by ants. The ants had been quick to find an entrance to their nest.

I thought you said your dog didn't bite! shouted Aunt Elizabeth to the young man as she bandaged her knee.

It doesn't, said the young man.

These are not my dogs, he added, as soon as four policemen arrived to arrest him.

舞台之外

一辆古旧的汽车停在一条干涸的河床边，一群著名男女演员下了车。他们戴着墨镜，穿着旧衣裳，特别小心以防别人认出他们。但他们很快就发觉，化妆的效果有时过分完美了。

“在这个地方野餐简直太妙了，”格洛丽亚·格利姆说。

“是再好不过的了，格洛丽亚。”布林克斯利·米尔斯表示同意。

他们刚坐下，就发现周围都是蚂蚁。蚂蚁很快找到了进入他们巢穴的入口。

“你不是说你的狗不咬人吗？”伊丽莎白姨妈一边包扎膝盖一边大声地对年轻人说。

“它是不咬人。”年轻人说道。

“这些不是我的狗，”他补充说，就在这时四个警察到了并要逮捕他。

75. SOS

When a light passenger plane flew off course some time ago, it crashed in the mountains and its pilot was killed. The only passengers, a young woman and her two baby daughters, were unhurt. It was the middle of winter. Snow lay thick on the ground. The woman knew that the nearest village was miles away. When it grew dark, she turned a suitcase into a bed and put the children inside it, covering them with all the clothes she could find. During the night, it got terribly cold. The woman kept as near as she could to the children and even tried to get into the case herself, but it was too small. Early next morning, she heard planes passing overhead and wondered how she could send a signal. Then she had an idea. She stamped out the letters 'SOS' in the snow. Fortunately, a pilot saw the signal and sent a message by radio to the nearest town. It was not long before a helicopter arrived on the scene to rescue the survivors of the plane crash.

求救信号

不久前，一架轻型客机偏离了航线，在山区坠毁，飞行员丧生。机上仅有的乘客，一位年轻的妇女和她的两个女婴却平安无事。此时正值隆冬季节，地上积着厚厚的雪。这位妇女知道，即使最近的村庄也有数英里远。天黑下来的时候，她把提箱当作小床，把两个孩子

放了进去，又把所有能找到的衣服都盖在了孩子们身上。夜里，天冷得厉害。这位妇女尽可能地靠近孩子，甚至自己也想钻进箱子里去，只是箱子太小了。第二天一大早，她听到头顶上有飞机飞过，但不知道怎样才能发个信号。后来她有了一个主意。她在雪地上踩出了“SOS”这3个字母。幸运得很，一位飞行员看到这个信号，用无线电给最近的城镇发了报。不久，一架直升飞机飞抵飞机失事现场，来搭救这几个幸存者。

76. To the Antarctic

In 1956, a Brazilian expedition arrived in Antarctica to explore a region which was completely unknown until then. The aim of the expedition was to study the geology and wildlife of the area. They also hoped to find new species of plants and animals.

The first problem the expedition faced was the extreme cold. Temperatures often dropped to minus 60 degrees Celsius. Despite this, the scientists worked hard, collecting samples of rocks and fossils, and observing the behavior of the penguins and seals.

One day, a member of the expedition noticed something strange in the ice. It was the shape of a large animal. As they dug deeper, they found the frozen body of a prehistoric mammoth. This was an amazing discovery, as it was the first time that such a well - preserved mammoth had been found in Antarctica.

The expedition also had some difficulties with their equipment. Their radio stopped working, and they had problems with their vehicles. But they managed to overcome these problems and continued their research.

After several months, the expedition returned home with a great deal of valuable information. Their findings will help scientists to learn more about the history of the Earth and the evolution of life.

到南极

1956年，一支巴西探险队到达南极，去探索一个此前完全未知的地区。探险队的目的是研究该地区的地质和野生动植物。他们还希望发现新的动植物种类。

探险队面临的第一个问题就是极度严寒。气温常常降到零下60摄氏度。尽管如此，科学家们仍努力工作，收集岩石和化石样本，观察企鹅和海豹的行为。

一天，探险队的一名队员注意到冰里有个奇怪的东西。那是一个大型动物的形状。当他们往更深处挖掘时，他们发现了一具史前猛犸象的冰冻尸体。这是一个惊人的发现，因为这是首次在南极发现保存如此完好的猛犸象。

探险队的设备也出了些问题。他们的无线电停止工作了，他们的车辆也出故障了。但是他们设法克服了这些问题并继续他们的研究。

几个月之后，探险队带着大量有价值的信息返回了家乡。他们的发现将有助于科学家更多地了解地球的历史和生命的进化。

77. A successful operation

The mummy of an Egyptian woman who died in 800 B.C. has just had an operation. The mummy is that of Shepenmut who was once a singer in the Temple of Thebes. As there were strange marks on the X - ray plates taken of the mummy, doctors have been trying to find out whether the woman died of a rare disease. The only way to do this was to operate. The operation, which lasted for over four hours, proved to be very difficult because of the hard resin which covered the skin.

The doctors removed a section of the mummy and sent it to a laboratory. They also found something which the X - ray plates did not show: a small wax figure of the god Duamutef. This god which has the head of a cow was normally placed inside a mummy. The doctors have not yet decided how the woman died.

一例成功的手术

死于公元前800年的一位埃及妇女的木乃伊刚刚接受了一次手术。这是曾在底比斯神殿里当过歌手的赛潘姆特的木乃伊。由于在给这个木乃伊拍摄的X光片子上有奇怪的斑点，所以，医生们一直试图搞清这位妇女是否死于一种罕见的疾病。搞清的唯一办法就是手术。手术持续了四个多小时，非常难做，因为皮肤上覆盖着一层硬硬的树脂。

医生们从木乃伊身上取下一个切片，送去化验。他们还发现了X光片子上所没有显示的东西：一个蜡制的杜瓦木特夫神小塑像。这种牛头人身的神像通常被放在木乃伊体内。医生们至今还未确定这位妇女的死因。

78. The Last One

After reading an article entitled 'Cigarette Smoking and Your Health' I lit a cigarette to calm my nerves. I smoked with concentration and pleasure as I was sure that this would be my last cigarette. For a whole week I did not smoke at all and during this time, my wife suffered terribly. I had all the usual symptoms of someone giving up smoking: a bad temper and an enormous appetite. My friends kept on offering me

cigarettes and cigars. They made no effort to hide their amusement whenever I produced a packet of sweets from my pocket. After seven days of this I went to a party. Everybody around me was smoking and I felt extremely uncomfortable. When my old friend Brian urged me to accept a cigarette, it was more than I could bear. I took one guiltily, lit it and smoked with satisfaction. My wife was delighted that things had returned to normal once more. Anyway, as Brian pointed out, it is the easiest thing in the world to give up smoking. He himself has done it lots of times!

最后一枝

读完一篇题为《吸烟与健康》的文章之后，我点上了一枝香烟，来镇定一下自己紧张的神经。我聚精会神而又愉快地吸着这枝烟。因为我确信这是我最后一枝烟了。整整一个星期我根本没有吸烟。在此期间，我妻子吃尽了苦头。我具备了戒烟者通常表现出来的所有症状：脾气暴躁和食欲旺盛。我的朋友们不断地向我递香烟和雪茄。每当我从口袋里掏出一包糖果时，他们都毫不掩饰地表现出他们对此感到非常好笑。这样过了7天以后，我去参加一次聚会。我周围的每个人都在吸烟，我感到非常不自在。当我的老朋友布赖恩极力劝我接受一枝香烟时，我再也忍不住了。我内疚地接过一枝点上，心满意足地抽起来。我妻子很高兴，因为一切又恢复到正常状况。不管怎么说，正如布赖恩指出的那样，戒烟是世界上最容易的事情，他自己就已戒了很多次了！

79. By air

I used to travel by air a great deal when I was a boy. My parents used to live in South America and I used to fly there from Europe in the holidays. A flight attendant would take charge of me and I never had an unpleasant experience. I am used to traveling by air and only on one occasion have I ever felt frightened. After taking off, we were flying low over the city and slowly gaining height, when the plane suddenly turned round and flew back to the airport. While we were waiting to land, a flight attendant told us to keep calm and to get off the plane quietly as soon as it had touched down. Everybody on board was worried and we were curious to find out what had happened. Later we learnt that there was a very important person on board. The police had been told that a bomb had been planted on the plane. After we had landed, the plane was searched thoroughly. Fortunately, nothing was found and five hours later we were able to take off again.

乘飞机

我在幼年的时候，曾多次乘飞机旅行。我的父母曾经住在南美洲，所以假期里我常从欧洲乘飞机到他们那儿。我总是由一位空中乘务员照管，从未遇到过不愉快的经历。我习惯了乘飞机旅行，只是有一次把我吓坏了。起飞之后，我们在城市上空低低地飞行，然后慢慢

爬高。这时飞机突然调转头来，飞回了机场。在我们等待降落时，一位空中乘务员告诉我们要保持镇静，待飞机一着陆，就安静地离开飞机。飞机上的人都很着急，大家都急于想知道究竟出了什么事。后来我们才得知，飞机上坐了一位非常重要的人物。有人报告警察，说飞机上安放了一枚炸弹。我们降落之后，飞机被彻底搜查了一遍。幸运的是，什么也没有找到。5个小时后，我们又起飞了。

80. The Crystal Palace

Perhaps the most extraordinary building of the nineteenth century was the Crystal Palace, which was built in Hyde Park for the Great Exhibition of 1851. The Crystal Palace was different from all other buildings in the world, for it was made of iron and glass. It was one of the biggest buildings of all time and a lot of people from many countries came to see it. A great many goods were sent to the exhibition from various parts of the world. There was also a great deal of machinery on display. The most wonderful piece of machinery on show was Nasmyth's steam hammer. Though in those days, travelling was not as easy as it is today, steam boats carried thousands of visitors across the Channel from Europe. On arriving in England, they were taken to the Crystal Palace by train. There were six million visitors in all, and the profits from the exhibition were used to build museums and colleges. Later, the Crystal Palace was moved to South London. It remained one of the most famous buildings in the world until it was burnt down in 1936.

水晶宫

19世纪最不寻常的建筑也许要数水晶宫了，它是为1851年的“世界博览会”而建在海德公园的。水晶宫与世界上所有的建筑都不同，因为它用铁和玻璃建成的。它是有史以来最高大的建筑物之一，因此，有许多国家的人来参观。大量的商品从世界各地运送到了博览会，参展的还有很多机器，其中最奇妙的是内史密斯的蒸汽锤。尽管在当时旅行不像现在这么容易，但汽船还是把成千上万的参观者从欧洲大陆送过了英吉利海峡。一到英国，火车就把他们送到了水晶宫。参观的人数总共是600万。博览会的赢利被用来建造博物馆和高等学校。后来，“水晶宫”被移到了伦敦南部。在1936年被焚毁之前，它一直是世界上最著名的建筑物之一。

81. Escape

When he had killed the guard, the prisoner of war quickly dragged him into the bushes. Working rapidly in the darkness, he soon changed into the dead man's clothes. Now, dressed in a blue uniform and with a rifle over his shoulder, the prisoner marched boldly up and down in front of the camp. He could hear shouting in the camp itself. Lights were blazing and men were running here and there: they had just discovered that a prisoner had escaped. At that moment, a large black car with four officers inside it, stopped at the camp gates. The officers got out and the prisoner stood to attention and saluted as they passed. When they had gone, the driver of the car came towards him. The man obviously wanted to talk. He was rather elderly with grey hair and clear blue eyes. The prisoner felt sorry for him, but there was nothing else he could do. As the man came near, the prisoner knocked him to the ground with a sharp blow. Then, jumping into the car, he drove off as quickly as he could.

脱逃

那个战俘杀死卫兵以后，迅速地把尸体拖进了灌木丛。他在黑暗中忙活了一阵儿，很快就换上了死者的衣服。现在他身穿蓝军装，肩扛步枪，在军营门前大胆地来回走着。他听得军营里面的喧闹声。那里灯米通明，人们在东奔西跑：他们刚刚发现有一个俘虏跑了。正此时，一辆黑色大轿车在军营门口停了下来。里面坐了4个军官。军官们下了车，战俘立正站好，并在他们从他面前经过时敬了礼。他们走后，汽车司机向他走来，这人显然是想聊天。他上了年纪，有着灰白的头发和明亮的蓝眼睛。战俘为他感到惋惜，但却没有别的选择。当这个人走近时，战俘一拳把他打倒在地，然后跳进车里，以最快的速度把车开走了。

82. Monster or fish

Fishermen and sailors sometimes claim to have seen monsters in the sea. Though people have often laughed at stories told by seamen, it is now known that many of these 'monsters' which have at times been sighted are simply strange fish.

Occasionally, unusual creatures are washed to the shore, but they are rarely caught out at sea. Some time ago, however, a peculiar fish was caught near Madagascar. A small fishing boat was carried miles out to sea by the powerful fish as it pulled on the line. Realizing that this was no ordinary fish, the fisherman made every effort not to damage it in any way. When it was eventually brought to shore, it was found to be over thirteen feet long. It had a head like a horse, big blue eyes, shining silver skin, and a bright red tail. The fish, which has since been sent to a museum where it

is being examined by a scientist, is called an oarfish. Such creatures have rarely been seen alive by man as they live at a depth of six hundred feet.

是妖还是鱼

渔夫和水手们有时声称自己看到过海里的妖怪。虽然人们常常对水手们讲的故事付诸一笑，但现在看来，人们有时看到的这些“妖怪”很多不过是些奇怪的鱼。一些异常的生物偶尔会被冲到岸上来，但它们在海上却极少能被捕到。然而不久前，在马达加斯加附近捕到了一条奇怪的鱼。一条小渔船被一条咬住钩的强壮的大鱼拖到了几英里以外的海面上。那位渔民意识到这根本不是一条普通的鱼，于是千方百计不让它受到丝毫伤害。当终于把它弄上岸后，人们发现它身長超过了13英尺。它的头像马，有一双大的蓝眼睛，闪闪发光的银色皮肤和一条鲜红的尾巴。此鱼叫桨鱼，被送进了博物馆，现正接受一位科学家的检查。人们很少能看到活着的这类动物，因为它们生活在600英尺深的水下。

83. After the Elections

The former Prime Minister, Mr. Wentworth Lane, was defeated in the recent elections. He is now retiring from political life and has gone abroad. My friend, Patrick, has always been a fanatical opponent of Mr. Lane's Radical Progressive Party. After the elections, Patrick went to the former Prime Minister's house. When he asked if Mr. Lane lived there, the policeman on duty told him that since his defeat, the ex - Prime Minister had gone abroad. On the following day, Patrick went to the house again. The same policeman was just walking slowly past the entrance, when Patrick asked the same question. Though a little suspicious this time, the policeman gave him the same answer. The day after, Patrick went to the house once more and asked exactly the same question. This time, the policeman lost his temper. 'I told you yesterday and the day before yesterday,' he shouted, 'Mr. Lane was defeated in the elections. He has retired from political life and gone to live abroad!'

'I know,' answered Patrick, 'but I love to hear you say it!'

大选之后

前首相温特沃兹。

莱恩先生在最近的大选中被击败。他现在退出了政界，到国外去了。我的朋友帕特里克一直是莱恩先生的激进党的强烈反对者。大选结束后，帕特里克来到了前首相的住处。当他询问莱恩先生是否住在那里时，值班的警察告诉他这位前首相落选后出国去了。第二天，帕特里克再次来到首相的住处。昨天的那位警察正从门口慢慢走过，帕特里克上前问了和昨天同样的问题。虽然那位警察这次有点疑心，但还是对他作了同样的回答。第三天，帕特里克又去了，提出了同前两天完全一样的问题。这一次警察火了。“我昨天和前天都告诉过您了，”他大叫着，“莱恩先生在大选中被击败了，他已经退出了政界去国外了！”

“我知道，” 帕特里克回答说，“可我就是喜欢听你说出这些话来！”

84. On Strike

Busmen have decided to go on strike next week. The strike is due to begin on Tuesday. No one knows how long it will last. The busmen have stated that the strike will continue until general agreement is reached about pay and working conditions. Most people believe that the strike will last for at least a week. Many owners of private cars are going to offer 'free rides' to people on their way to work. This will relieve pressure on the trains to some extent. Meanwhile, a number of university students have volunteered to drive buses while the strike lasts. All the students are expert drivers, but before they drive any of the buses, they will have to pass a special test. The students are going to take the test in two days' time. Even so, people are going to find it difficult to get to work. But so far, the public has expressed its gratitude to the students in letters to the Press. Only one or two people have objected that the students will drive too fast!

罢工

公共汽车司机决定下星期罢工。罢工定于星期二开始，谁也不知道会持续多久。司机们声称此次罢工将一直持续到就工资和工作条件问题达成全面协议的时候为止。多数人认为此次罢工至少会持续一个星期。很多私人汽车的车主正准备为乘车上班的人们提供“免费乘车”的服务，这将在某种程度上减轻对火车的压力。与此同时，有一部分大学生自愿在罢工期间驾驶公共汽车。所有的学生都是开车的能手，但在驾驶公共汽车之前，他们必须通过一项专门测验。学生们准备在两天后就接受测验。即使这样，人们仍会感到上班有困难。但到目前为止，公众已经向新闻界写信表达他们对大学生们的感激之情了。只有一两个人提出反对意见，说学生们会把车开得太快！

85. Never too old to learn

I have just received a letter from my old school, informing me that my former headmaster, Mr. Stuart Page, will be retiring next week. Pupils of the school, old and new, will be sending him a present to mark the occasion. All those who have contributed towards the gift will sign their names in a large album which will be sent to the headmaster's home. We shall all remember Mr. Page for his patience and understanding and for the kindly encouragement he gave us when we went so unwillingly to school. A great many former pupils will be attending a farewell

dinner in his honour next Thursday. It is a curious coincidence that the day before his retirement, Mr. Page will have been teaching for a total of forty years. After he has retired, he will devote himself to gardening. For him, this will be an entirely new hobby. But this does not matter, for, as he has often remarked, one is never too old to learn.

活到老学到老

我刚刚收到母校的一封信，通知我说以前的校长斯图亚特·佩奇先生下星期就退休了。为了纪念这个日子，学校的学生——无论老同学还是新同学——将送他一件礼物。所有凑钱买此礼品的人都将自己的名字签在了一本大签名簿上，签名簿将被送到校长的家里。我们不会忘记佩奇先生对我们既有耐心又充满理解，也不会忘记在我们不愿去上学时他给予我们的亲切鼓励。很多老同学都将参加下星期四为他举行的告别宴会。佩奇先生退休的前一天正好是他执教满40年的日子，这真是奇妙的巧合。他退休后，将致力于园艺。对于他来说，这将是一种全新的爱好。但这没有关系，因为正如他常说的那样，人要活到老学到老。

86. Out of control

As the man tried to swing the speedboat round, the steering wheel came away in his hands. He waved desperately to his companion, who had been water skiing for the last fifteen minutes. Both men had hardly had time to realize what was happening when they were thrown violently into the sea. The speedboat had struck a buoy, but it continued to move very quickly across the water. Both men had just begun to swim towards the shore, when they noticed with dismay that the speedboat was moving in a circle. It now came straight towards them at tremendous speed. In less than a minute, it roared past them only a few feet away. After it had passed, they swam on as quickly as they could because they knew that the boat would soon return. They had just had enough time to swim out of danger when the boat again completed a circle. On this occasion, however, it had slowed down considerably. The petrol had nearly all been used up. Before long, the noise dropped completely and the boat began to drift gently across the water.

失控

当那人试图让快艇转弯时，方向盘脱手了。他绝望地向他的伙伴挥手，他的伙伴在之前的15分钟里一直在滑水。他们两个还没来得及意识到究竟发生了什么事情，就被猛地抛入了海里。快艇撞上了一个浮标，但它仍在水面上快速行驶着。两个人刚开始向岸边游去，就突然惊愕地发现快艇正在转着圈行驶，它现在正以惊人的速度直冲他们驶来。不到1分钟的工夫，它从离他们只有几英尺远的地方呼啸着驶了过去。它过去之后，他们以最快的速度向前游去，因为他们知道快艇马上就要转回来。他们刚刚来得及游出危险区，快艇就又转完

了一圈。然而这一次它的速度慢多了。汽油几乎已经用光。没过多久，噪音便彻底消失，快艇开始在水面上慢悠悠地漂流。

87. A Perfect Alibi

At the time the murder was committed, I was travelling on the 8 o'clock train to London, said the man.

Do you always catch such an early train? asked the inspector.

Of course I do, answered the man. I must be at work at 10 o'clock. My employer will confirm that I was there on time.

Would a later train get you to work on time? asked the inspector.

I suppose it would, but I never catch a later train.

At what time did you arrive at the station?

At ten to eight. I bought a paper and waited for the train.

And you didn't notice anything unusual?

Of course not.

I suggest, said the inspector, that you are not telling the truth. I suggest that you did not catch the 8 o'clock train, but that you caught the 8.25 which would still get you to work on time. You see, on the morning of the murder, the 8 o'clock train did not run at all. It had broken down at Ferngreen station and was taken off the line.

极好的不在犯罪现场的证据

“在凶杀发生的时候，我正坐在8点钟开往伦敦的火车上。”那人说。

“您总是赶这样早的火车吗？”探长问。

“当然是的，”那人回答。“我必须在10点钟上班，我的雇主会证明我是按时到了那儿的。”

“晚一点儿的车也能送您按时上班吗？”

“我认为可以，但我从来不乘晚一点儿的车。”

“您几点钟到的火车站？”

“7点50分。我买了张报纸，等着车来。”

“您没有注意到有什么异常情况发生吗？”

“当然没有。”

“我提醒您，”探长说，“您讲的不是实话。您没有赶上8点钟的火车，而是赶上了8点25分的，这趟车同样能使您按时上班。您看，在凶杀发生的那天早晨，8点钟的那次火车根本就没有发。它在芬格林车站出了故障而被取消了。”

88. Trapped in a mine

Six men have been trapped in a mine for seventeen hours. If they are not brought to the surface soon they may lose their lives. However, rescue operations are proving difficult. If explosives are used, vibrations will cause the roof of the mine to collapse. Rescue workers are therefore drilling a hole on the north side of the mine. They intend to bring the men up in a special capsule. If there had not been a hard layer of rock beneath the soil, they would have completed the job in a few hours. As it is, they have been drilling for sixteen hours and they still have a long way to go. Meanwhile, a microphone, which was lowered into the mine two hours ago, has enabled the men to keep in touch with their closest relatives. Though they are running out of food and drink, the men are cheerful and confident that they will get out soon. They have been told that rescue operations are progressing smoothly. If they knew how difficult it was to drill through the hard rock, they would lose heart.

困在矿井里

6个人被困在矿井里已有17个小时了。如果不把他们尽快救到地面上来，他们就有可能丧生。然而事实证明营救工作非常困难。如果用炸药爆破，震动会引起矿顶塌落。因此，营救人员在矿井的北侧钻了一个洞。他们准备用一种特制的容器把这6个人救上来。如果不是因为土壤下面有一层坚硬的岩石，他们的营救工作仅用几个小时就可以完成了。实际情况是，他们已连续钻了16个小时了，但离钻透还早着呢。与此同时，两个小时以前放下井去的一只麦克风使井下的人可以与其亲属保持联系。虽然他们的食物和饮料都快消耗尽了，但这些人心情很好，坚信他们很快就会出去。他们一直被告知营救工作进行得非常顺利。如果他们知道了钻透那坚硬的岩石有多么困难，他们会丧失信心的。

89. For Sale

Good afternoon. I believe that this house is for sale.

That's right.

May I have a look at it, please?

Yes, of course. Come in.

How long have you lived here?

I've lived here for twenty years.

Twenty years! That's a long time.

Yes, I've been here since 1976.

Then why do you want to sell it?

Because I've just retired. I want to buy a small house in the country.

How much does this house cost?

\$68,500.

That's a lot of money!

It's worth every penny of it.

Well, I like the house, but I can't decide yet. My wife must see it first.

Women always have the last word.

待售

下午好。我想这房子是要出售的吧！

是的。

我可以看一看吗？

可以，当然可以。请进。

您在这里住了多长时间？

我在这里已经住了20年了。

20年！那时间可不短。

是啊，从1976年起我就住在这里。

那么，您为什么要卖掉它呢？

因为我刚退休。我想在乡下买幢小房子。

这座房子卖多少钱？

68,500美元。

那可真是一大笔钱呢！

它确实值这么多钱。

嗯，我喜欢这房子，但我还不能决定。我妻子必须先来看一看。

女人总是最后说了算的。

90. What's for supper?

Fish and chips has always been a favourite dish in Britain, but as the oceans have been overfished, fish has become more and more expensive. So it comes as a surprise to learn that giant fish are terrifying the divers on North Sea oil rigs. Oil rigs have to be repaired frequently and divers, who often have to work in darkness a hundred feet under water, have been frightened out of their wits by giant fish bumping into them as they work. Now they have had special cages made to protect them from these monsters. The fish are not sharks or killer whales, but favourite eating varieties like cod and skate which grow to unnatural sizes, sometimes as much as twelve feet in length. Three factors have caused these fish to grow so large: the warm water round the hot oil pipes under the sea; the plentiful supply of food thrown overboard by the crews on the rigs; the total absence of fishing boats around the oil rigs. As a result, the fish just eat and eat and grow and grow in the lovely warm water. Who eats who?

晚餐吃什么？

油煎鱼加炸土豆片一直是英国人喜爱的一道菜，但是随着海洋里的滥捕滥捞，鱼已经变得越来越昂贵。因此，听说北海石油钻井平台上的潜水员受到巨型鱼类的恐吓，确实很让人吃惊。钻井平台需要经常修理，潜水员常常要在水面100英尺以下摸黑工作，他们曾在工作时被撞到他们身上的大鱼吓得惊惶失措。现在他们有了特制的笼子，用来保护他们免受大鱼的侵袭。这些鱼并不是鲨鱼或逆戟鲸，而是深受人们喜爱的食用鱼品种，如鳕鱼和鲽鱼，只不过它们长得出奇地大，有时长达12英尺。这些鱼能长得这么大是由三个因素造成的：海底热的输油管道附近的温暖的海水；钻井平台工作人员抛到海里充足的食物；钻井平台周围根本没有捕鱼船只。结果是，这些鱼就在可爱的温暖的水流中吃呀吃，长呀长。究竟谁吃谁呢？

91. Three Men in a Basket

A pilot noticed a balloon which seemed to be making for a Royal Air Force Station nearby. He informed the station at once, but no one there was able to explain the mystery. The officer in the control tower was very angry when he heard the news, because balloons can be a great danger to aircraft. He said that someone might be spying on the station and the pilot was ordered to keep track of the strange object. The pilot managed to circle the balloon for some time. He could make out three men in a basket under it and one of them was holding a pair of binoculars. When the balloon was over the station, the pilot saw one of the men taking photographs. Soon afterwards, the balloon began to descend and it landed near an airfield. The police were called in, but they could not arrest anyone, for the basket contained two Members of Parliament and the Commanding Officer of the station! As the Commanding Officer explained later, one half of the station did not know what the other half was doing!

三人同篮

一位飞行员注意到一个气球，它像是正飞往附近的一个皇家空军基地。他马上把情况报告了该基地，但那里的人没有一个能解释这到底是怎么回事。控制塔上的官员得知这一消息后，非常气愤，因为气球有可能给飞机造成极大的危险。他说可能有人正对基地进行侦察，因此命令那个飞行员跟踪那个奇怪的飞行物。飞行员设法绕着气球飞了一阵。他看清了气球下面有3个人呆在一只筐里，其中一个举着望远镜。当气球飞临基地上空时，飞行员看见有一个人在拍照。不久，气球开始降落，在一个停机坪附近着了陆。警察被召来了，但他们却不能逮捕任何人，因为筐里是两名国会议员和一名基地的指挥官！正如指挥官后来解释的那样，基地的这半边不知道那半边正在干什么！

92. Asking for Trouble

It must have been about two in the morning when I returned home. I tried to wake up my wife by ringing the doorbell, but she was fast asleep, so I got a ladder from the shed in the garden, put it against the wall, and began climbing towards the bedroom window. I was almost there when a sarcastic voice below said, 'I don't think the windows need cleaning at this time of the night.' I looked down and nearly fell off the ladder when I saw a policeman. I immediately regretted answering in the way I did, but I said, 'I enjoy cleaning windows at night.'

'So do I,' answered the policeman in the same tone. 'Excuse me for interrupting you. I hate to interrupt a man when he's busy working, but would you mind coming with

me to the station?'

'Well, I'd prefer to stay here,' I said. 'You see. I've forgotten my key.'

'Your what?' he called.

'My key,' I shouted.

Fortunately, the shouting woke up my wife who opened the window just as the policeman had started to climb towards me.

自找麻烦

我回到家时，肯定已是凌晨两点左右了。我按响了门铃，试图唤醒我的妻子，但她睡得很熟。于是，我从花园的小棚里搬来了一个梯子，把它靠在墙边，开始向卧室的窗口爬去。快要爬到窗口时，下面一个人用讽刺的口吻说：“我看不必在夜里这个时候擦窗子吧。”我向下面看去。当我看清是一个警察时，差一点儿从梯子上掉下去。我回答了他的话，但马上又后悔不该那样说，我是这样说的：“我喜欢在夜里擦窗子。”

“我也是的，”警察用同样的声调回答，“请原谅我打断了您。当一个人在忙着干活时，我是不愿意去打扰他的，但请您跟我到警察局去一趟好吗？”

“可我更愿意呆在这儿，”我说，“您瞧，我忘带钥匙了。”

“什么？”他大声问。

“我的钥匙，”我喊道。

幸运得很，这喊声惊醒了我的妻子。就在警察开始向我爬上来时，她打开了窗子。

93. A noble gift

One of the most famous monuments in the world, the Statue of Liberty, was presented to the United States of America in the nineteenth century by the people of France.

The great statue, which was designed by the sculptor Auguste Bartholdi, took ten years to complete. The actual figure was made of copper supported by a metal framework which had been especially constructed by Eiffel. Before it could be transported to the United States, a site had to be found for it and a pedestal had to be built. The site chosen was an island at the entrance of New York Harbour. By 1884, a statue which was 151 feet tall had been erected in Paris. The following year, it was taken to pieces and sent to America.

By the end of October 1886, the statue had been put together again and it was officially presented to the American people by Bartholdi. Ever since then, the great monument has been a symbol of liberty for the millions of people who have passed through New York Harbour to make their homes in America.

崇高的礼物

世界上最著名的纪念碑之一的自由女神雕像是在19世纪时由法国人民赠送给美国的。

这座由雕像家奥古斯特·巴索尔地设计的巨大雕像是用10年时间雕像刻成的。雕像的实体用铜制成，由爱斐尔特制的金属框架支撑着。在雕像被运往美国之前，必须为它选好一块场地，同时必须建造一个基座。场地选在了纽约港入口处的一个岛上。到1884年，一座高度达151英尺的雕像在巴黎竖立起来了。第二年，它被拆成若干小块，运到美国。

到1886年10月底，这座雕像被重新组装起来，由巴索尔地正式赠送给美国人民。从那时起，这座伟大的纪念碑对通过纽约港进入美国定居的千百万人来说就一直是自由的象征。

94. Future Champions

Experiments have proved that children can be instructed in swimming at a very early age. At a special swimming pool in Los Angeles, children become expert at holding their breath under water even before they can walk. Babies of two months old do not appear to be reluctant to enter the water. It is not long before they are so accustomed to swimming that they can pick up weights from the floor of the pool. A game that is very popular with these young swimmers is the underwater tricycle race. Tricycles are lined up on the floor of the pool seven feet under water. The children compete against each other to reach the other end of the pool. Many pedal their tricycles, but most of them prefer to push or drag them. Some children can cover the whole length of the pool without coming up for breath even once. Whether they will ever become future Olympic champions, only time will tell. Meanwhile, they should encourage those among us who cannot swim five yards before they are gasping for air.

未来的冠军

实验证明，儿童在很小的时候就可以开始学习游泳。在洛杉矶的一个特设的游泳池里，孩子们甚至在还没有学会走路时就已经能熟练地在水下屏住呼吸了。两个月的婴儿并未显得不愿意入水。他们很快便适应了游泳，以致能捡起池底的物品。这些幼小的游泳运动员非常喜爱的一种游戏是水下三轮车比赛。三轮车并排放在7英尺深的游泳池底上。孩子们比赛看谁先到达游泳池的另一端。很多孩子用脚蹬车，但多数孩子更愿意推或是拉着三轮车。有些孩子能够跑完游泳池的全长而不用露出水面换气。他们将来是否能成为奥林匹克的冠军，这只能由时间来作出回答。与此同时，他们对我们中的那些游不了5码就已喘不过气来

的人应该是种鼓舞。

95. A fantasy

When the Ambassador of Escalopia returned home for lunch, his wife got a shock. He looked pale and his clothes were in tatters.

'What has happened?' she asked. 'How did your clothes get into such a mess?'

'A fire extinguisher, my dear,' answered the Ambassador drily. 'University students set the Embassy on fire this morning.'

'Good heavens!' exclaimed his wife. 'And where were you at the time?'

'I was in my office as usual,' answered the Ambassador. 'The fire broke out in the basement. I went down immediately, of course, and that fool, Horst, aimed a fire extinguisher at me. He thought I was on fire. I must definitely get that fellow posted.'

The Ambassador's wife went on asking questions, when she suddenly noticed a big hole in her husband's hat.

'And how can you explain that?' she asked.

'Oh, that,' said the Ambassador. 'Someone fired a shot through my office window. Accurate, don't you think? Fortunately, I wasn't wearing it at the time. If I had been, I would not have been able to get home for lunch.'

纯属虚构

当艾斯卡罗比亚国的大使回到家吃午饭时，他的妻子大吃了一惊。他面色苍白，衣服也搞得不成样子。

“发生了什么事？”她问，“你的衣服怎么搞得一塌糊涂？”

“灭火器弄的，亲爱的，”大使冷冷地回答，“今天上午大学生们放火点着了大使馆。”

“天哪！”他妻子惊叫道，“那你当时在什么地方？”

“我和往常一样，在办公室里，”大使回答说。“地下室突然着火，我当然马上下去了。但那个傻瓜霍斯特把灭火器对准了我。他以为是我着火了。我一定要把那个家伙打发走。”

大使夫人还在不停地提问，她突然又发现丈夫的帽子上有个洞。

“那么你对那又作何解释呢？”她问。

“那个嘛，”大使说，“有人向我办公室窗户开了一枪。真够准的，是不是？幸亏我当时没戴帽子。如果真戴着它，我现在就不能回家来吃午饭了。”

96. The dead return

A Festival for the Dead is held once a year in Japan. This festival is a cheerful occasion, for on this day, the dead are said to return to their homes and they are welcomed by the living. As they are expected to be hungry after their long journey, food is laid out for them. Specially-made lanterns are hung outside each house to help the dead to find their way. All night long, people dance and sing. In the early morning, the food that had been laid out for the dead is thrown into a river or into the sea as it is considered unlucky for anyone living to eat it. In towns that are near the sea, the tiny lanterns which had been hung in the streets the night before, are placed into the water when the festival is over. Thousands of lanterns slowly drift out to sea guiding the dead on their return journey to the other world. This is a moving spectacle, for crowds of people stand on the shore watching the lanterns drifting away until they can be seen no more.

亡灵返乡

日本每年过一次“亡灵节”。这个节日是个欢乐的日子，因为据说在这一天，死者要回到他们的家里来，活着的人则对他们表示欢迎。因为预料到他们在经过长途旅行之后会感到饥饿，所以为他们摆放好了食品。特制的灯笼挂在各家的门外，为的是帮助死者看清道路。整个夜晚人们载歌载舞。一大早，人们便把为死者摆放的食品扔进河中或海里，因为人们认为活着的人吃了这些东西是不吉利的。在靠海的城镇中，头天夜里挂在大街小巷的小灯笼在节后就放到了水里。成千上万只灯笼慢慢漂向大海，指引着亡灵返回另一个世界。这是一个感人的场面，人们成群地伫立在海岸上，注视着灯笼远去，直到再也看不见为止。

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Book 3

1. A Puma at large

Pumas are large, cat-like animals which are found in America. When reports came into London Zoo that a wild puma had been spotted forty-five miles south of London, they were not taken seriously. However, as the evidence began to accumulate, experts from the Zoo felt obliged to investigate, for the descriptions given by people who claimed to have seen the puma were extraordinarily similar.

The hunt for the puma began in a small village where a woman picking blackberries saw 'a large cat' only five yards away from her. It immediately ran away when she saw it, and experts confirmed that a puma will not attack a human being unless it is cornered. The search proved difficult, for the puma was often observed at one place in the morning and at another place twenty miles away in the evening. Wherever it went, it left behind it a trail of dead deer and small animals like rabbits.

Footprints were seen in a number of places and puma fur was found clinging to bushes. Several people claimed to have seen the puma at different times, but they all agreed that it was a large cat with a long tail and a light-brown coat. All the evidence pointed to the fact that the puma was in the area.

In the end, the mystery was solved when the puma was caught by a farmer in a trap. It was a young puma which had strayed from its mother and decided to go exploring on its own. It must have been in the area for some time, for it had already eaten some of the deer and small animals that were in the area. It was taken to London Zoo, where it lived for several months before it died.

逃遁的美洲狮

美洲狮是一种体形似猫的大动物，产于美洲。当伦敦动物园接到报告说，在伦敦以南45英里处发现一只美洲狮时，这些报告并没有受到重视。可是，随着证据越来越多，动物园的专家们感到有必要进行一番调查，因为凡是声称见到过美洲狮的人们所描述的情况竟是出奇地相似。

搜寻美洲狮的工作是从一座小村庄开始的。那里有位妇女在采摘黑莓时的看见“一只大猫”，离她仅5码远，她刚看见它，它就立刻逃走了。专家证实，美洲狮除非被逼得走投无路，是决不会伤人的。事实上搜寻工作很困难，因为常常是早晨在甲地发现那只美洲狮，晚上却在20英里外的乙地发现它的踪迹。无论它走哪儿，一路上总会留下一串死鹿及死兔子之类的小动物。

在许多地方看见了爪印，灌木丛中发现了粘在上面的美洲狮毛。好几个人在不同的场合见到过这只美洲狮，但是他们都一致认为那是一只长着长尾巴、浅棕色皮毛的大猫。所有的证据都表明，美洲狮就在这个地区。

最后，谜团终于解开了，那只美洲狮被一位农场主用陷阱逮住了。那是一只幼狮，它离开了母狮，决定独自去闯荡。它肯定在这个地区呆了一段时间，因为它已经吃了当地的一些鹿和小动物。它被带到伦敦动物园，在那儿生活了几个月后死去。

2. Thirteen Equals One

Our vicar is always raising money for one cause or another, but he has never managed to get enough money to have the church clock repaired. The big clock which used to strike the hours day and night was damaged many years ago and has been silent ever since.

One night, however, our vicar woke up with a start: the clock was striking the hours! Looking at his watch, he saw that it was one o'clock, but the bell struck thirteen times before it stopped. Armed with a torch, the vicar went up into the clock tower to see what was going on. In the torchlight, he caught sight of a figure whom he immediately recognized as Bill Wilkins, our local grocer.

'Whatever are you doing up here Bill?' asked the vicar in surprise.

'I'm trying to repair the bell,' answered Bill. 'I've been coming up here night after night for weeks now. You see, I was hoping to give you a surprise.'

'You certainly did give me a surprise!' said the vicar. 'You've probably woken up everyone in the village as well. Still, I'm glad the bell is working again.'

'That's the trouble, vicar,' answered Bill. 'It's working all right, but I'm afraid that at one o'clock it will strike thirteen times and there's nothing I can do about it.'

We shall have to get the bell fixed, said the vicar, 'but not yet.

I'm afraid it will not be over until the last stroke has been struck. And the last stroke may not be for some time yet.'

十三等于一

我们教区的牧师总是为各种各样的事筹集资金，但始终未能筹足资金把教堂的钟修好。教堂的大钟以前不分昼夜打点报时，但很多年前遭到毁坏，从此便无声无息了。

一天夜里，我们的牧师突然被惊醒了，大钟又在“打点”报时了！他一看表，才1点钟，可

是那钟一边敲了13下才停。牧师拿着一支电筒走上钟楼想去看看究竟发生了什么事情。借着电筒光。他看见一个人，马上认出那是本地杂货店店主比尔·威尔金斯。

“你究竟在这上面干什么，比尔？”牧师惊讶地问。

“我想把这口钟修好，”比尔回答说。“好几个星期了，我天天夜里到钟楼上来。嗯，我是想让你大吃一惊。”

“你确实使我大吃了一惊！”牧师说，“也许同时你把村里所有的人都吵醒了。不过，钟又能报时了，我还是很高兴的。”

“问题就在这里，牧师，”比尔回答说。“不错，钟能报时了，但是，恐怕每到1点钟，它总要敲13下，对此我已无能为力了。”

“我们得把钟修一修，”牧师说，“不过现在还不行。因为恐怕在最后一声打点之前还会出些问题。而且最后一声打点可能还得过一段时间才会敲响呢。”

3. An unknown goddess

Some time ago, an interesting discovery was made by archaeologists on the Aegean island of Kea. An American team explored a temple which stands in an ancient city on the promontory of Ayia Irini. The city at one time must have been prosperous, for it enjoyed a high level of civilization. Houses -- often three storeys high -- were built of stone. They had large rooms with beautifully decorated walls. The city was even equipped with a drainage system, for a great many clay pipes were found beneath the narrow streets.

The temple which the archaeologists explored was used as a place of worship from the fifteenth century B.C. until Roman times. In the most sacred room of the temple, clay fragments of fifteen statues were found. Each of these represented a goddess and had, at one time, been painted. The body of one statue was found among remains dating from the fifteenth century B.C. Its missing head happened to be among remains of the fifth century B.C.

This head must have been found in Classical times and carefully preserved. It was very old and precious even then. When the archaeologists reconstructed the fragments, they were amazed to find that the goddess turned out to be a very modern - looking woman. She stood three feet high and her hands rested on her hips. She was wearing a full - length skirt which swept the ground. Despite her great age, she was very graceful indeed, but, so far, the archaeologists have been unable to discover her identity.

无名女神

不久之前，在爱琴海的基亚岛上，考古工作者有一项有趣的发现。一个美国考古队在阿伊亚·依里尼海角的一座古城里考察了一座庙宇。这座古城肯定一度很繁荣，因为它曾享有高度的文明。房子一般有3层楼高，用石块修建而成。里面房间很大，墙壁装饰华丽。城里甚至还敷设了排水系统，因为在狭窄的街道底下发现了许多陶土制作的排水管道。

考古工作者考察的这座庙宇从公元前15世纪直至罗马时代一直是祭祀祈祷的场所。在庙中最神圣的一间殿堂里发现了15尊陶制雕像的碎片。每一尊雕像代表一位女神，而且一度上过色。其中有一尊雕像，她的躯体是在公元前15世纪的历史文物中发现的，而她那身首异处的脑袋却碰巧是在公元前5世纪的文物中找到的。

这颗脑袋一定是在古希腊罗马时代就为人所发现，并受到精心的保护。即使在当时，它也属历史悠久的珍奇之物。考古工作者把这些碎片重新拼装起来后，惊奇地发现那位女神原来是一位相貌十分摩登的女郎。她身高3英尺，双手叉腰。她身穿一条拖地长裙。尽管上了年纪，但体态确实优美。不过，到目前为止，考古工作者还未能确定这位女神的身份。

4. The double life of Alfred Bloggs

These days, people who do manual work often receive far more money than people who work in offices. People who work in offices are frequently referred to as 'white-collar workers' for the simple reason that they usually wear a collar and tie to go to work. Such is human nature, that a great many people are often willing to sacrifice higher pay for the privilege of becoming white-collar workers. This can give rise to curious situations, as it did in the case of Alfred Bloggs who worked as a dustman for the Ellesmere Corporation.

When he got married, Alf was too embarrassed to say anything to his wife about his job. He simply told her that he worked for the Corporation. Every morning, he left home dressed in a smart black suit. He then changed into overalls and spent the next eight hours as a dustman. Before returning home at night, he took a shower and changed back into his suit. Alf did this for over two years and his fellow dustmen kept his secret. Alf's wife has never discovered that she married a dustman and she never will, for Alf has just found another job. He will soon be working in an office. He will be earning only half as much as he used to, but he feels that his rise in status is well worth the loss of money.

阿尔弗雷德·布洛格斯的双重生活

如今，从事体力劳动的人的收入一般要比坐办公室的人高出许多。坐办公室的人之所以常常被称作“白领工人”，就是因为他们通常是穿着硬领白衬衫，系着领带去上班。许多人

常常情愿放弃较高的薪水以换取做白领工人的殊荣，此乃人之常情。而这常常会引起种种奇怪的现象，在埃尔斯米尔公司当清洁工的艾尔弗雷德·布洛格斯就是一个例子。

艾尔弗结婚时，感到非常难为情，而没有将自己的职业告诉妻子。他只说在埃尔斯米尔公司上班。每天早晨，他穿上一身漂亮的黑色西装离家上班，然后换上工作服，当8个小时清洁工。晚上回家前，他洗个淋浴，重新换上那身黑色西服。两年多以来，艾尔弗一直这样，他的同事也为他保守秘密。艾尔弗的妻子一直不知道她嫁给了一个清洁工，而且她永远也不会知道了，因为艾尔弗已找到新职，不久就要坐在办公室里工作了。他将来挣的钱只有他现在的一半。不过他觉得，地位升高了，损失点儿钱也值得。

5. The facts

Editors of newspapers and magazines often go to extremes to provide their readers with unimportant facts and statistics. Last year a journalist had been instructed by a well - known magazine to write an article on the president's palace in a new African republic. When the article arrived, the editor read the first sentence and then refused to publish it. The article began: 'Hundreds of steps lead to the high wall which surrounds the president's palace.' The editor at once sent the journalist a fax instructing him to find out the exact number of steps and the height of the wall.

The journalist immediately set out to obtain these important facts, but he took a long time to send them. Meanwhile, the editor was getting impatient, for the magazine would soon go to press. He sent the journalist two more faxes, but received no reply. He sent yet another fax informing the journalist that if he did not reply soon he would be fired. When the journalist finally replied, he said that he had been arrested while counting the steps in front of the president's palace. The police had told him that he was not allowed to park his car there. As he had no place to stay, he decided to spend the night in the station. He counted the steps again, and then the height of the wall. When he got home, he sent the editor the facts as he had promised.

确切数字

报刊杂志的编辑常常为了向读者提供一些无关紧要的事实和统计数字而走向极端。去年，一位记者受一家有名的杂志的委托写一篇关于非洲某个新成立共和国总统府的文章。稿子寄来后，编辑看了第一句话就拒绝予以发表。文章的开头是这样的：“几百级台阶通向环绕总统府的高墙。”编辑立即给那位记者发去传真，要求他核实一下台阶的确切数字和围墙的高度。

记者立即出发去核实这些重要的事实，但过了好长时间不见他把数字寄来，在此期间，编辑等得不耐烦了，因为杂志马上要付印。他给记者先后发去两份传真，但对方毫无反应。于是他又发了一份传真，通知那位记者说，若再不迅速答复，将被解雇。记者终于答复了

，他说他在数总统府前的台阶时被捕了。警察告诉他，他不可以把车停在那里。由于无处可住，他决定在车站过夜。他又数了一遍台阶，然后再量了一下围墙的高度。回家后，他就按他答应的那样把事实发送给了编辑。

6. Smash-and-grab

The expensive shops in a famous arcade near Piccadilly were just opening. At this time of the morning, the arcade was almost empty. Mr Taylor, the owner of a jewellery shop was admiring a new window display. Two of his assistants had been working busily since 8 o'clock and had only just finished. Diamond necklaces and rings had been beautifully arranged on a background of black velvet. After gazing at the display for several minutes, Mr Taylor went back into his shop.

The silence was suddenly broken when a large car, with its headlights on and its horn blaring, roared down the arcade. It came to a stop outside the jeweller's. One man stayed at the wheel while two others with black stockings over their faces jumped out and smashed the window of the shop with iron bars. While this was going on, Mr Taylor was upstairs. He and his staff began throwing furniture out of the window. Chairs and tables went flying into the arcade. One of the thieves was struck by a heavy statue, but he was too busy helping himself to diamonds to notice any pain. The raid was all over in three minutes, for the men scrambled back into the car and it moved off at a fantastic speed. Just as it was leaving, Mr Taylor rushed out and ran after it throwing ashtrays and vases, but it was impossible to stop the thieves. They had got away with thousands of pounds worth of diamonds.

砸橱窗抢劫

皮卡迪利大街附近的一条著名拱廊街道上，几家高档商店刚刚开始营业。在早晨的这个时候，拱廊街上几乎空无一人。珠宝店主泰勒先生正在欣赏新布置的橱窗。他手下两名店员从早上8点就开始忙碌，这时刚刚布置完毕。钻石项链、戒指漂亮地陈列在黑色丝绒上面。泰勒先生站在橱窗外凝神欣赏了几分钟就回到了店里。

宁静突然被打破，一辆大轿车亮着前灯，响着喇叭，呼啸着冲进了拱廊街，在珠宝店门口停了下来。一人留在驾驶座上，另外两个用黑色长筒丝袜蒙面的人跳下车来。他们用铁棒把商店橱窗的玻璃砸碎。这一切发生时，泰勒先生正在楼上。他与店员动手向窗外投掷家具，椅子，桌子飞落到拱廊街上。一个窃贼被一尊很重的雕像击中，但由于他忙着抢钻石首饰，竟连疼痛都顾不上了。这场抢劫只持续了3分钟，因为窃贼们争先恐后地爬上轿车，以惊人的速度开跑了。就在轿车离开的时候，泰勒先生从店里冲了出来，跟在车后追赶，一边还往车上扔烟灰缸、花瓶。但他已无法抓住那些窃贼了。他们已经带着价值数千镑的首饰逃之夭夭了。

7. Mutilated ladies

Has it ever happened to you? Have you ever put your trousers in the washing machine and then remembered there was a large bank note in your back pocket?

When you rescued your trousers, did you find the note was whiter than white?

People who live in Britain needn't despair when they make mistakes like this (and a lot of people do)! Fortunately for them, the Bank of England has a team called Mutilated Ladies which deals with claims from people who fed their money to a machine or to their dog. Dogs, it seems, love to chew up money!

A recent case concerns Jane Butlin whose fiancé, John, runs a successful furniture business. John had a very good day and put his wallet containing £3,000 into the microwave oven for safekeeping. Then he and Jane went horse - riding. When they got home, Jane cooked their dinner in the microwave oven and without realizing it, cooked her fiancé's wallet as well. Imagine their dismay when they found a beautifully - cooked wallet and notes turned to ash! John went to see his bank manager who sent the remains of wallet and the money to the special department of the Bank of England in Newcastle: the Mutilated Ladies! They examined the remains and John got all his money back. 'So long as there's something to identify, we will give people their money back,' said a spokeswoman for the Bank. 'Last year, we paid out over £1.5m on 21,000 claims.'

残钞鉴别组

这种事情在你身上出现过吗？你有没有把裤子塞洗衣机，然后又想起在裤子的后兜有一张大面值的纸币？当你把裤子抢救出来时，你有没有发现那张纸币已经变得比白纸还白？当英国人犯这种错误时（而且这种人还不少），他们不必感到绝望。对他们来说，值得庆幸的是英国银行有一个残钞鉴别组，负责处理那些把钱塞进机器或塞给狗的人提出的索赔要求。看起来，狗很喜欢咀嚼钱币。

最近的一个案例与简·巴特林有关，她的未婚夫约翰拥有一家生意兴隆的家具店。有一天约翰的生意很好，他把一只装有3,000英镑的钱包放进微波炉内保存。然后，他和简一起去骑马。回家后，简用微波炉煮了晚饭，无意之中把她未婚夫的钱包也一起煮了。可以想像他们发现一只煮得很好看的钱包，钞票已化成灰时的沮丧心情。约翰去找银行经理，经理把约翰的钱包和纸币的残留物送到英国银行在纽卡斯尔的一个专门部门——残钞鉴别组。他们鉴定了这些残留物。约翰拿回了 he 损失的全部数额。“只要有东西可供识别，我们会把钱还给人家的，”银行的一位女发言人说。“去年，我们对21,000起索赔要求支付了150万英镑。”

8. A famous monastery

The Great St. Bernard Pass connects Switzerland to Italy. At 2,473 metres, it is the highest mountain pass in Europe. The famous monastery of St. Bernard, which was founded in the eleventh century, lies about a mile away. For hundreds of years, St. Bernard dogs have saved the lives of travellers crossing the dangerous Pass. These friendly dogs, which were first brought from Asia, were used as watch - dogs even in Roman times. Now that a tunnel has been built through the mountains, the Pass is less dangerous, but each year, the dogs are still sent out into the snow whenever a traveller is in difficulty. Despite the new tunnel, there are still a few people who rashly attempt to cross the Pass on foot.

During the summer months, the monastery is very busy, for it is visited by thousands of people who cross the Pass in cars. As there are so many people about, the dogs have to be kept in a special enclosure. In winter, however, life at the monastery is quite different. The temperature drops to - 30 and very few people attempt to cross the Pass. The monks prefer winter to summer for they have more privacy. The dogs have greater freedom, too, for they are allowed to wander outside their enclosure. The only regular visitors to the monastery in winter are parties of skiers who go there at Christmas and Easter. These young people, who love the peace of the mountains, always receive a warm welcome at St. Bernard's monastery.

著名的修道院

圣伯纳德大山口连接着瑞士与意大利，海拔2,473米，是欧洲最高的山口。11世纪建造的著名的圣伯纳德修道院位于离山口1英里远的地方。几百年来，圣伯纳德狗拯救了许多穿越这个危险山口的旅行者的生命。这些最先从亚洲引进的狗，待人友好，早在罗马时代就给人当看门狗了。如今由于在山里开挖了隧道，翻越山口已不那么危险了。但每年还要派狗到雪地里去帮助那些遇到困难的旅游者。尽管修通了隧道，但仍有一些人想冒险徒步跨越圣伯纳德山口。

夏天的几个月里，修道院十分忙碌，因为有成千上万的人驾车通过山口，顺道来修道院参观。由于来人太多，狗被关在专门的围栏里。然而到了冬天，修道院里的生活则是另一番景象。气温下降到零下30度，试图翻越山口的人寥寥无几。修道士们喜欢冬天，而不太喜欢夏天。因为在冬天，他们可以更多地过无人打扰的生活。狗也比较自由，被放出围栏，四处遛达。冬天常来修道院参观的只有一批批滑雪者。他们在圣诞节或复活节到那儿去。这些热爱高山清静环境的年轻人每年都受到圣伯纳德修道院的热列欢迎。

9. Flying Cats

Cats never fail to fascinate human beings. They can be friendly and affectionate towards humans, but they lead mysterious lives of their own as well. They never become submissive in the way that dogs and horses do, and they seem to have a mysterious intelligence of their own.

Some cats are reputed to have remarkable powers of perception and are able to sense the approach of thunderstorms long before they break. This feline sensitivity to one of the principle forces of nature has been used to explain certain phenomena which otherwise remain inexplicable. For instance, a cat is said to instinctively know which room in a house contains its mistress without ever having entered it. In one instance which has been reported, a cat left his house, crossed several roads, climbed a fence, proceeded along the top of the fence, entered a neighbor's garden, and walked straight into their house to a room where the owner was sleeping, just in time to wake her up when a fire had just broken out. (There were some people who thought that this was all part of an elaborate plot!) There are also stories about cats who supposedly have the power to predict earthquakes. Japanese researchers have been able to make their own cats misbehave just by giving them a tiny electric shock: they have been trying to find out whether cats can really detect earthquakes early or whether it was a false alarm.

Most of us have seen cats rubbing their faces against the legs of the people they live with or curling up in their laps. They do this not only to be affectionate but also to mark out their territory. When cats are communicating with each other, they use a variety of different vocalizations as well as a whole range of body postures and facial expressions. They spit, hiss and growl when they are angry or frightened. They arch their backs and make their fur stand on end when they feel threatened. They purr when they are contented. The language of cats is still only partly understood by humans, but it is obvious that they have a complex system of communication.

Cats also have a very accurate sense of time. They know when it is time to get up, when it is time to go to bed, and when it is time to eat. They are also very good at finding their way home. Even if they are taken to a strange place many miles away, they are able to find their way back to their original home. This homing instinct, as it is called, is still not fully understood by scientists, but it is thought to be related to the cat's highly developed sense of smell and its ability to recognize certain landmarks.

Finally, cats are very good at taking care of themselves. They groom themselves

constantly, licking their fur clean and removing any dirt or parasites. They also keep their claws sharp by scratching on suitable surfaces. This self-care is important for their survival, because cats are solitary animals and they have to be able to look after themselves in the wild.

飞猫

猫总能引起人们的极大兴趣。它们可以对人友好，充满柔情。但是，它们又有自己神秘的生活方式。它们从不像狗和马一样变得那么顺从。它们似乎有自己神秘的智慧。

据说，有些猫有非凡的感知能力，能在暴风雨来临前很早就能感觉到。这种对大自然主要力量之一的猫科动物的敏感性被用来解释某些原本无法解释的现象。例如，据说猫本能地知道房子里哪间房间里住着它的女主人，即使它从未进去过。有一个报道的事例是，一只猫离开家，穿过几条马路，爬上一道栅栏，沿着栅栏顶往前走，进入邻居的花园，径直走进他们的房子，来到主人正在睡觉的房间，正好在火灾发生时把她叫醒。（有些人认为这一切都是精心策划的阴谋的一部分！）还有一些关于猫据称有预测地震能力的故事。日本研究人员只要给猫一个微小的电击就能让它们行为失常：他们一直在试图弄清楚猫是否真的能早期察觉地震，还是那只是一个假警报。

我们大多数人都见过猫用脸蹭同它们一起生活的人的腿，或者蜷缩在人的膝盖上。它们这样做不仅是表示亲热，也是为了标明自己的领地。当猫互相交流时，它们使用各种各样不同的叫声以及一系列的身体姿势和面部表情。当它们生气或害怕时，它们会发出嘶嘶声、呼噜声和咆哮声。当它们感到受到威胁时，它们会弓起背，让毛竖起来。当它们感到满足时，它们会发出咕噜声。猫的语言人类仍然只了解一部分，但很明显它们有一个复杂的交流系统。

猫也有非常准确的时间感。它们知道什么时候该起床，什么时候该睡觉，什么时候该吃饭。它们也非常擅长找到回家的路。即使它们被带到数英里之外的一个陌生地方，它们也能找到回到原来家的路。这种被称为归巢本能的现象，科学家们仍然没有完全理解，但人们认为它与猫高度发达的嗅觉和识别某些地标的的能力有关。

最后，猫非常善于照顾自己。它们不断地梳理自己，舔干净自己的毛，去除任何污垢或寄生虫。它们还通过在合适的表面抓挠来保持爪子锋利。这种自我照顾对它们的生存很重要，因为猫是独居动物，它们必须能够在野外照顾自己。

10. The Loss of the Titanic

The great ship, Titanic, sailed for New York from Southampton on April 10th, 1912. She was carrying 1,316 passengers and a crew of 891. Even by modern standards, the 46,000 ton Titanic was a colossal ship. At that time, however, she was not only the largest ship that had ever been built, but was regarded as unsinkable, for she had sixteen watertight compartments. Even if two of these were flooded, she would still

be able to float. The tragic sinking of this great liner will always be remembered, for she went down on her first voyage with heavy loss of life.

Four days after setting out, while the Titanic was sailing across the icy waters of the North Atlantic, a huge iceberg was suddenly spotted by a lookout. After the alarm had been given, the great ship turned sharply to avoid a direct collision. The Titanic turned just in time, narrowly missing the immense wall of ice which rose over 100 feet out of the water beside her. Suddenly, there was a slight trembling sound from below, and the captain went down to see what had happened. The noise had been so faint that no one thought that the ship had been damaged. Below, the captain realized to his horror that the Titanic was sinking rapidly, for five of her sixteen watertight compartments had already been flooded! The order to abandon ship was given and hundreds of people plunged into the icy water. As there were not enough lifeboats for everybody, 1,500 lives were lost.

“泰坦尼克”号的沉没

1912年4月10日，巨型客轮“泰坦尼克”号从南安普敦起锚驶向纽约。船上载有1,316名乘客与891名船员。即使用现代标准来衡量，46,000吨的“泰坦尼克”号也算得上一艘巨轮了。当时，这艘轮船不仅是造船史上建造的最大的一艘船，而且也被认为是不会沉没的。因为船由16个密封舱组成，即使有两个舱进水，仍可漂浮的水面上。然而，这艘巨轮首航就下沉，造成大批人员死亡。人们将永远记着这艘巨轮的沉没惨剧。

“泰坦尼克”号起航后的第4天，它正行驶在北大西洋冰冷的海面上。突然，瞭望员发现一座冰山。警报响过不久，巨轮急转弯，以避免与冰山正面相撞。“泰坦尼克”号这时才得以急转弯，勉强避开了高耸在它旁边超过海面100英尺的一块巨大的冰墙。突然，从舱底传来一声轻微的颤音；船长走下船舱去查看究竟。由于这个声音非常轻，没人会想到船身已遭损坏。在下面，船长惊恐地发现“泰坦尼克”号正在急速下沉，16个密封舱已有5个进水。于是，他发出了弃船的命令，几百人跳进了冰冷刺骨的海水里。由于没有足够的救生艇运载所有乘客，结果，1,500人丧生。

11. Not Guilty

Customs Officers are quite tolerant these days. They are paid to turn a blind eye to things. Only a few, like Sergeant Custard, earn their pay by being eagle-eyed. One such officer was Tim Smith, who controlled the southern frontier of the city. He had a reputation for being tough on smugglers. Every day he would see a lorry load of goods pass through his area and he was always suspicious. He often had a hunch that something was wrong, even when there was no evidence to support his feeling. One

day, he noticed a small van which was parked outside a large store. It was early in the morning and the van was unoccupied. Smith decided to keep an eye on it. As the day progressed, he saw people coming and going from the store, but no one went near the van. By lunchtime, Smith was really beginning to wonder what was going on. Then, just after lunch, a man came out of the store, walked over to the van and opened the back door. Smith immediately rushed over. 'What are you doing?' he demanded. 'I'm just making a delivery,' the man replied. 'Oh, really?' said Smith. 'Then why has this van been sitting here all morning with no one near it?' 'I don't know,' said the man. 'I'm just following my orders.' Smith was not convinced. He decided to search the van. He found nothing suspicious inside. Just as he was about to give up, he noticed a small compartment under the floor. He opened it and found a large quantity of cigarettes. 'What's this?' he asked the man. 'I - I don't know,' stammered the man. 'It's not mine.' 'Well, it's in your van,' said Smith. 'You're under arrest for smuggling.' 'But I'm not guilty,' protested the man. 'I didn't put those cigarettes there.' 'Then who did?' asked Smith. 'I don't know,' said the man. 'I'm just a delivery man.' Smith took the man to the police station. There, he was questioned further. But he still maintained his innocence. In the end, the police had to let him go. They had no evidence to prove that he was guilty. Smith was disappointed. He had been so sure that the man was a smuggler. But he had to admit that he had been wrong. He learned a valuable lesson that day: not to jump to conclusions.

无罪

现在的海关官员往往相当宽容。他们受雇对某些事视而不见。只有少数像卡斯塔德警官那样的人，通过目光敏锐地查禁走私而挣得薪水。蒂姆·史密斯就是这样一位官员，他负责控制城市的南部边境。他有着严厉打击走私者的名声。每天他都会看到一辆载满货物的卡车通过他的辖区，他总是心存疑虑。他常常有一种预感，觉得事情有些不对劲，即便没有证据支持他的这种感觉。一天，他注意到一辆小货车停在一家大商店外面。当时是清晨，车上没有人。史密斯决定监视这辆车。随着时间的推移，他看到人们在商店里进进出出，但没有人靠近那辆货车。到午饭时间了，史密斯真的开始纳闷到底是怎么回事。然后，刚过午饭，一个男人从商店里出来，走到货车旁并打开了后门。史密斯立刻冲了过去。“你在做什么？”他质问道。“我只是在送货。”那人回答道。“哦，真的吗？”史密斯说。“那为什么这辆货车一上午都停在这儿，而且周围没有人呢？”“我不知道，”那人说，“我只是在按命令行事。”史密斯并不相信。他决定搜查这辆货车。他在车里没有发现可疑的东西。就在他打算放弃的时候，他注意到车地板下有一个小隔间。他打开隔间，发现了大量的香烟。“这是什么？”他问那人。“我——我不知道，”那人结结巴巴地说，“这不是我的。”“嗯，可它在你的货车里，”史密斯说，“你因走私被捕了。”“但我是无罪的，”那人抗议道，“我没有把那些香烟放在那儿。”“那是谁放的呢？”史密斯问。“我不知道，”那人说，“我只是个送货员。”史密斯把那个人带到了警察局。在那里，他受到了进一步的审问。但他仍然坚称自己是无辜的。最后，警察不得不放了他。他们没有证据证明他有罪。史密斯很失望。他一直非常确信那个人是个走私者。但他不得不承认

自己错了。那天他学到了宝贵的一课：不要仓促下结论。

12. Life on a Desert Island

Most of us have formed an unrealistic picture of life on a desert island. We sometimes imagine a desert island to be a sort of paradise where the sun always shines. Life there is simple and good. Ripe fruit falls from the trees and you never have to work. The other side of the picture is quite the opposite. Life on a desert island is wretched. You either starve to death or live like Robinson Crusoe, waiting for a boat which never comes. Perhaps there is an element of truth in both these pictures, but few of us have had the opportunity to find out. Two men who recently spent five days on a coral island wished they had stayed there longer. They were taking a badly damaged boat from the Virgin Islands to Miami to have it repaired. During the journey, their boat began to sink. They quickly loaded a small rubber dinghy with food, matches, and cans of beer and rowed for a few miles across the Caribbean until they arrived at a tiny coral island. There were hardly any trees on the island and there was no water, but this did not prove to be a problem. The men collected rain - water in the rubber dinghy. As they had brought a spear gun with them, they had plenty of food. They caught lobster and fish every day, and, as one of them put it 'ate like kings'. When a passing tanker rescued them five days later, both men were genuinely sorry that they had to leave.

荒岛生活

我们许多人对于荒岛生活有一种不切实际的想法。我们有时想象荒岛是阳光终日普照的天堂。那里的生活简单又美好。成熟的水果从树上掉下来，人们根本无需劳动。另一种想法恰恰相反，认为荒岛生活很可怕，要么饿死，要么像鲁滨孙那样，天天盼船来，却总不见船影。也许，这两种想法都有可信之处。但很少有人能有机会去弄个究竟。最近有两个人在一座珊瑚岛上呆了5天，他们真希望在那儿再多呆一些日子。他们驾着一条严重损坏的小船从维尔京群岛去迈阿密修理。途中，船开始下沉，他们迅速把食物、火柴、罐装啤酒往一只救生筏上装。然后在加勒比海上划行了几英里，到了一座珊瑚岛上。岛上几乎没有一棵树，也没有淡水，但这不算什么问题。他们用橡皮艇蓄积雨水。由于他们随身带了一支捕鱼枪，因此，吃饭不愁。他们天天捕捉龙虾和鱼，正如其中一位所说，吃得“像国王一样好”。5天后，一条油轮从那儿路过，搭救了他们。这二位不得不离开那个荒岛时，还真的感到遗憾呢。

13. It's only me

After her husband had gone to work. Mrs. Richards sent her children to school and went upstairs to her bedroom. She was too excited to do any housework that morning, for in the evening she would be going to a fancy - dress party with her husband. She intended to dress up as a ghost and as she had made her costume the night before, she was impatient to try it on. Though the costume consisted only of a sheet, it was very effective. After putting it on, Mrs. Richards went downstairs. She wanted to find out whether it would be comfortable to wear.

Just as Mrs. Richards was entering the dining room, there was a knock on the front door. She knew that it must be the baker. She had told him to come straight in if ever she failed to open the door and to leave the bread on the kitchen table. Not wanting to frighten the poor man, Mrs. Richards quickly hid in the small storeroom under the stairs.

She heard the front door open and heavy footsteps in the hall. Suddenly the door of the storeroom was opened and a man entered. Mrs. Richards realized that it must be the baker. She coughed to draw his attention to her presence, but the man did not look up. Instead, he just stared at her, then he let out a cry and jumped back several feet. When Mrs. Richards walked towards him, he fled, slamming the door behind him.

Mrs. Richards was astonished. Then she smiled as she realized that the man was blind. He had come to read the meter.

是我，别害怕

理查兹夫人等丈夫上班走后，把孩子送去上学，然后来到楼上自己的卧室。那天上午，她兴奋得什么家务活都不想做，因为晚上她要同丈夫一起参加一个化装舞会。她打算装扮成鬼的模样。头天晚上她已把化装服做好，这时她急于想试试。尽管化装服仅由一个被单制成，却十分逼真。理查兹夫人穿上化装服后下了楼，想看穿起来是否舒服。

理查兹夫人刚刚走进餐厅，前门就传来敲门声。她知道来人一定是面包师。她曾告诉过面包师，如果她不去开门，他可直接进门，把面包放在厨房的桌上。理查兹夫人不想吓唬这个可怜人，便赶紧躲到了楼梯下的小储藏室里。

她听见前门被打开，走廊里响起重重的脚步声。突然贮藏室门开了，一个男人走了进来。理查兹夫人这才想到一定是面包师。她咳嗽了一声，想引起他的注意，但那男人连头都没抬。相反，他只是死死地盯着她看，然后发出一声尖叫，后退了几步。当理查兹夫人向他走去时，他拔腿就跑，砰地一声关上了门。

理查兹夫人感到十分惊讶。后来她笑了，因为她意识到那个男人是个盲人。他是来查电表的。

14. A noble gangster

There was a time when the owners of shops and businesses in Chicago had to pay large sums of money to gangsters in return for 'protection'. If the money was not paid promptly, the gangsters would quickly put a man out of business by destroying his shop. Obtaining 'protection money' is not a modern crime. As long ago as the fourteenth century, an Englishman, Sir John Hawkwood, made the remarkable discovery that people would rather pay large sums of money than have their life work destroyed by gangsters.

Six hundred years ago, Sir John Hawkwood arrived in Italy with a band of soldiers and settled near Florence. He soon made a name for himself and came to be known to the Italians as Giovanni Acuto. Whenever the Italian city - states were at war with each other, Hawkwood used to hire his soldiers to princes who were willing to pay the high price he demanded. In times of peace, when business was bad, Hawkwood and his men would march into a city - state and, after burning down a few farms, would offer to go away if protection money was paid to them. Hawkwood made large sums of money in this way. In spite of this, the Italians regarded him as a sort of hero. When he died at the age of eighty, the Florentines gave him a state funeral and had a picture painted which was dedicated to the memory of 'the most valiant soldier and most notable leader, Signor Giovanni Acuto'.

贵族歹徒

曾经有一个时期,芝加哥的店主和商行的老板们不得不拿出大笔的钱给歹徒以换取'保护'。如果交款不及时,歹徒们就会很快捣毁他的商店,让他破产。榨取'保护金'并不是一种现代的罪恶行径。早在14世纪,英国人约翰·霍克伍德爵士就有过非凡的发现:人们宁愿拿出大笔的钱,也不愿毕生的心血毁于歹徒之手。

600年前,约翰·霍克伍德爵士带着一队士兵来到意大利,在佛罗伦萨附近驻扎下来。他很快就出了名,意大利人叫他乔凡尼·阿库托。每逢意大利各城邦之间发生战争,霍克伍德便把他的士兵雇佣给愿出高价的君主。和平时期,当生意萧条时,霍克伍德便带领士兵进入某个城邦,纵火烧毁一两个农场,然后提出,如向他们缴纳保护金,他们便主动撤离。霍克伍德用这种方法挣了大笔钱。尽管如此,意大利人还是把他视作某种英雄。他80岁那年死去时,佛罗伦萨人为他举行了国葬,并为他画像以纪念这位'骁勇无比的战士、杰出的领袖乔凡尼·阿库托先生'。

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15. Fifty pence worth of trouble

Children always appreciate small gifts of money. Father, of course, provides a regular supply of pocket-money, but uncles and aunts are always a source of extra income. With some children, small sums go a long way. If sixpences are not exchanged for sweets, they rattle for months inside money-boxes. Only very thrifty children manage to fill up a money - box. For most of them, sixpence is a small price to pay for a satisfying bar of chocolate.

My nephew, George, has a money-box but it is always empty. Very few of the sixpences I have given him have found their way there. I gave him sixpence yesterday and advised him to save it. Instead, he bought himself sixpence worth of trouble.

On his way to the sweet - shop, he dropped his sixpence and it rolled along the pavement and then disappeared down a drain.

George took off his jacket, rolled up his sleeves and pushed his right arm through the drain cover. He could not find his sixpence anywhere, and what is more, he could not get his arm out. A crowd of people gathered round him and a lady rubbed his arm with soap and butter, but George was firmly stuck.

The fire - brigade was called and two firemen freed George using a special type of grease. George was not too upset by his experience because the lady who owns the sweet shop heard about his troubles and rewarded him with a large box of chocolates.

五十便士的麻烦

孩子们总是喜欢得到一些零花钱。当然，父亲会经常给零花钱，但是，叔舅阿姨也是额外收入的源泉。对于有些孩子来说，少量的钱可以花很长一段时间。如果六便士不拿来换糖吃，它们会在储蓄罐里格格作响好几个月。只有特别节俭的孩子才会把储蓄罐装满。对大部分孩子来说，用六便士买一块满意的巧克力，是算不了什么的。

我的外甥乔治有一个储蓄罐，但总是空空的。我给了他不少六便士的硬币，但没有几个存到储蓄罐里。昨天，我给了他六便士，并建议他把钱存起来。他却拿这钱给自己买了个麻烦。

在去糖果店的路上，他把六便士的硬币掉到地上，硬币沿着人行道滚走了，掉进阴沟里不见了。

乔治脱掉外套，卷起袖子，将右胳膊伸进了阴沟盖。他哪里也找不到那六便士硬币，而且他的胳膊也拿不出来了。一群人围在他身边，一位女士用肥皂和黄油涂抹他的胳膊，但乔治的胳膊仍然卡得紧紧的。

有人打电话叫来消防队，两位消防队员使用了一种特殊的润滑剂才使乔治得以解脱。不过，此事并没有使乔治过于伤心，因为糖果店老板娘听说了他遇到的麻烦后，赏给他一大盒巧克力。

16. Mary had a Little Lamb

Mary and her husband Dimitri lived in the tiny village of Perachora in southern Greece. One of Mary's prize possessions was a little white lamb which her husband had given her. She kept it tied to a tree in a field during the day and went to fetch it every evening. One evening, however, the lamb was missing. The rope had been cut, so it was obvious that the lamb had been stolen.

When Dimitri came in from the fields, his wife told him what had happened. Dimitri at once set out to find the thief. He knew it would not prove difficult in such a small village. After telling several of his friends about the theft, Dimitri found out that his neighbour, Aleko, had suddenly acquired a new lamb. Dimitri immediately went to Aleko's house and angrily accused him of stealing the lamb. He told him he had better return it or he would call the police. Aleko denied taking it and led Dimitri into his backyard. It was true that he had just bought a lamb, he explained, but his lamb was black. Ashamed of having acted so rashly, Dimitri apologized to Aleko for having accused him. While they were talking it began to rain and Dimitri stayed in Aleko's house until the rain stopped. When he went outside half an hour later, he was astonished to find that the little black lamb was almost white. Its wool, which had been dyed black, had been washed clean by the rain!

玛丽有只小羊羔

玛丽与丈夫迪米特里住在希腊南部一个叫波拉考拉的小村庄里。玛丽最珍贵的财产之一就是丈夫送给她的一只白色小羔羊。白天，玛丽把羔羊拴在地里的一棵树上，每天晚上把它牵回家。可是，一天晚上，那只羔羊失踪了。绳子被人割断，很明显小羔羊是被人偷走了。

迪米特里从地里回来，妻子把情况跟他一说，他马上出去找偷羔羊的人。他知道在这样一个小村庄里抓住小偷并不困难。把失窃的事告诉几个朋友后，迪米特里发现他的邻居阿列科家突然多了一只小羔羊。迪米特里立刻去了阿列科家，气呼呼地指责他偷了羔羊，告诉他最好把羊交还，否则就去叫警察。阿列科不承认，并把迪米特里领进院子。不错，他的确刚买了一只羔羊，阿列科解释说，但他的羔羊是黑色的。迪米特里为自己的鲁莽而感到不好意思，向阿列科道了歉，说是错怪了他。就在他俩说话的时候，天下起了雨，迪米特里便呆在阿列科家里避雨，一直等到雨停为止。半小时后，当他从屋里出来时，他惊奇地发现小黑羔羊全身几乎都变成白色。原来羊毛上染的黑色被雨水冲掉了！

17. The longest suspension bridge in the world

Verrazano, an Italian about whom little is known, sailed into New York Harbour in 1524 and named it Angouleme. He described it as 'a very agreeable situation located within two small hills in the midst of which flowed a great river.' Though Verrazano is by no means considered to be a great explorer, his name will probably remain immortal, for on November 21st, 1964, the longest suspension bridge in the world was named after him.

The Verrazano Bridge, which was designed by Othmar Ammann, joins Brooklyn to Staten Island. It has a span of 4,260 feet. The bridge is so long that the shape of the earth had to be taken into account by its designer. Two great towers support four huge cables. The towers are built on immense underwater platforms made of steel and concrete. The platforms extend to a depth of over 100 feet under the sea. These alone took sixteen months to build. Above the surface of the water, the towers rise to a height of nearly 700 feet. They support the cables from which the bridge has been suspended. Each of the four cables contains 26,108 lengths of wire. It has been estimated that if the bridge were packed with cars, it would still only be carrying a third of its total capacity. However, size and strength are not the only important things about this bridge. Despite its immensity, it is both simple and elegant, fulfilling its designer's dream to create 'an enormous object drawn as faintly as possible'.

世界上最长的吊桥

1524年，一位鲜为人知的意大利人维拉萨诺驾船驶进纽约港，并将该港命名为安古拉姆。他对该港作了这样的描述：“地理位置十分适宜，位于两座小山的中间，一条大河从中间流过。”虽然维拉萨诺绝对算不上一个伟大的探险家，但他的名字将流芳百世，因为1964年11月21日建成的世界上最长的吊桥是以他的名字命名的。

维拉萨诺大桥由奥斯马·阿曼设计，连结着布鲁克林与斯塔顿岛，桥长4,260英尺。由于桥身太长，设计者不得不考虑了地表的形状。两座巨塔支撑着4根粗大的钢缆。塔身建在巨大的水下钢筋混凝土平台上。平台深入海底100多英尺。仅这两座塔就花了16个月才建成。塔身高出水面将近700英尺。高塔支撑着钢缆，而钢缆又悬吊着大桥。4根钢缆中的每根由26,108股钢绳组成。据估计，若桥上摆满了汽车，也只不过是桥的总承载力的1/3。然而，这座桥重要特点不仅是它的规模与强度。尽管此桥很大，但它的结构简单，造型优美，实现了设计者企图创造一个“尽量用细线条勾画出一个庞然大物”的梦想。

18. Electric Currents in Modern Art

Modern sculpture rarely surprises us any more. The idea that modern art can only be seen in museums is mistaken. Even people who take no interest in art cannot have failed to notice examples of modern sculpture on display in public places. Strange forms stand in gardens, and outside buildings and shops. We have got quite used to them. Some so - called 'modern' pieces have been on display for nearly eighty years.

In spite of this, some people - including myself - were surprised by a recent exhibition of modern sculpture. The first thing I saw when I entered the art gallery was a notice which said: 'Do not touch the exhibits. Some of them are dangerous!' The objects on display were pieces of moving sculpture. Oddly shaped forms that are suspended from the ceiling and move in response to a gust of wind are quite familiar to everybody. These objects, however, were different. Lined up against the wall, there were long thin wires attached to metal spheres. The spheres had been magnetized and attracted or repelled each other all the time. In the centre of the hall, there were a number of tall structures which contained coloured lights. These lights flickered continuously like traffic lights which have gone mad. Sparks were emitted from small black boxes and red lamps flashed on and off angrily. It was rather like an exhibition of pre - historic electronic equipment. These peculiar forms not only seemed designed to shock people emotionally, but to give them electric shocks as well!

I soon learnt about all the tricks of the trade. Early in the morning, we were told, there is a large pool of water in the centre of the hall which reflects the sculptures. This, apparently, is to give the illusion that the sculptures are floating in mid - air. Next to the pool there is a deep pit with a ladder, so that visitors can descend into it and experience these curious sculptures more fully. There is also an art gallery in the pit, which displays some modern paintings. The paintings look so real that they seem to be floating on the wall. I was so intrigued by these works of art that I decided to buy a catalogue. As I was leaving, I noticed that all the visitors were given a small electric shock as they passed through the turnstile. It was a most unusual exhibition.

现代艺术中的电流

现代雕塑不再使我们感到惊讶了。那种认为现代艺术只能在博物馆里才能看到的观点是错误的。即使是对艺术不感兴趣的人也不会不注意到在公共场所展示的现代雕塑作品。在花园里、建筑物和商店外面，都矗立着奇形怪状的雕塑。我们已经对它们习以为常了。有些所谓的“现代”艺术品已经展出了将近80年了。

尽管如此，最近的一个现代雕塑展览还是让包括我在内的一些人感到惊讶。我进入美术馆

看到的第一件东西是一则告示，上面写着：“请勿触摸展品。有些展品有危险！”展出的物品是一些活动的雕塑。那些形状奇特、悬挂在天花板上、随风摆动的雕塑大家都很熟悉。然而，这些展品却不同。靠墙排列着许多细长的电线，电线连着金属球。这些金属球经过磁化，互相之间不停地吸引或排斥。大厅中央有一些高大的结构物，里面有彩色的灯。这些灯像发疯的交通灯一样不停地闪烁。小黑盒子里迸出火花，红色灯泡发怒似的忽明忽暗。这很像一次史前电子设备展览。这些奇特的造型设计好像不仅是为了在情感上给人以震撼，而且还想给人以电击！

我很快就了解了这一行的所有诀窍。我们被告知，清晨时分，大厅中央有一大片水，水中倒映着雕塑。显然，这是为了造成一种雕塑漂浮在空中的错觉。水池旁边有一个深洞，洞中有梯子，这样参观者就可以下到洞里，更充分地体验这些奇特的雕塑。洞里还有一个美术馆，里面展出一些现代绘画。这些画看起来如此逼真，就好像是漂浮在墙上一样。我对这些艺术品非常着迷，于是决定买一本展品目录。当我离开的时候，我注意到所有的参观者在通过旋转栅门时都被轻微地电了一下。这是一次非常不寻常的展览。

19. A Very Dear Cat

Kidnappers are rarely interested in animals, but they recently took considerable interest in Mrs. Eleanor Ramsay's cat. Mrs. Eleanor Ramsay, a very wealthy old lady, has shared a flat with her cat, Rastus, for a great many years. Rastus leads an orderly life. He usually takes a short walk in the evenings and is always home by seven o'clock. One evening, however, he failed to arrive. Mrs. Ramsay got very worried. She looked everywhere for him but could not find him.

Three days after Rastus' disappearance, Mrs. Ramsay received an anonymous letter. The writer stated that Rastus was in safe hands and would be returned immediately if Mrs. Ramsay paid a ransom of £1,000. Mrs. Ramsay was instructed to place the money in a cardboard box and to leave it outside her door. At first, she decided to go to the police, but fearing that she would never see Rastus again - the letter had made that quite clear - she changed her mind. She drew £1,000 from her bank and followed the kidnapper's instructions. The next morning, the box had disappeared but Mrs. Ramsay was sure that the kidnapper would keep his word. Sure enough, Rastus arrived punctually at seven o'clock that evening. He looked very well, though he was rather thirsty, for he drank half a bottle of milk. The police were astounded when Mrs. Ramsay told them what she had done. She explained that Rastus was very dear to her. Considering the amount she paid, he was dear in more ways than one!

一只贵重的宝贝猫

绑架者很少对动物感兴趣。最近，绑架者却盯上了埃莉诺·拉姆齐太太的猫。埃莉诺·拉姆齐太太是一个非常富有的老妇人，多年来，她同她养的猫拉斯特斯一直住在一所公寓里。拉斯特斯生活很有规律，傍晚常常出去溜达一会儿，并且总是在7点钟以前回来。可是，有一天晚上，它出去后再也没回来。拉姆齐太太急坏了，四处寻找，但没有找着。

拉斯特斯失踪3天后，拉姆齐太太收到一封匿名信。写信人声称拉斯特斯安然无恙，只要拉姆齐太太愿意支付1,000

英镑赎金，可以立即将猫送还。他让拉姆齐太太把钱放在一个纸盒里，然后将纸盒放在门口。一开始拉姆齐太太打算报告警察，但又害怕再也见不到拉斯特斯——这点，信上说得十分明白——于是她改变了主意。她从银行取出1,000英镑，并照绑架者的要求做了。第二天早晨，放钱的盒子不见了。但拉姆齐太太确信绑架者是会履行诺言的。果然，当天晚上7点整，拉斯特斯准时回来了。它看上去一切正常，只是口渴得很，喝了半瓶牛奶。拉姆齐太太把她所做的事告诉了警察，警察听后大为吃惊。拉姆齐太太解释说心疼她的猫。想到她所花的那笔钱，她的心疼就具有双重意义了。

20. Pioneer Pilots

In 1908 Lord Northcliffe offered a prize of £1,000 to the first man who would fly across the English Channel.

Over a year passed before the first attempt was made.

On July 19th, 1909, in the early morning, Hubert Latham took off from the French coast in his plane the 'Antoinette IV'.

He had travelled only seven miles across the Channel when his engine failed and he was forced to land on the sea.

The 'Antoinette' floated on the water until Latham was picked up by a ship.

Two days later, Louis Bleriot arrived near Calais with a plane called 'No. XI'.

Bleriot had been making planes since 1905 and this was his latest model.

A week before, he had completed a successful overland flight during which he covered twenty - six miles.

Latham, however, did not give up easily.

He, too, arrived near Calais on the same day with a new 'Antoinette'.

It looked as if there would be an exciting race across the Channel.

Both planes were going to take off on July 25th, but Latham failed to get up early

enough.

After making a short test flight at 4.15 a.m., Bleriot set off half an hour later.

His great flight lasted thirty - seven minutes.

When he landed near Dover, the first person to greet him was a local policeman.

Latham made another attempt a week later and got within half a mile of Dover, but he was unlucky again.

His engine failed and he landed on the sea for the second time.

飞行员的先驱

1908年，诺斯科克利夫勋爵拿出1,000英镑，作为对第一个飞越英吉利海峡的人的奖励。

然而一年多过去了才有人出来尝试。

1909年7月19日清晨，休伯特·莱瑟姆驾驶“安特瓦奈特4号”飞机从法国海岸起飞。

但他只在海峡上空飞行7英里，引擎就发生了故障，他只好降落在海面上。

“安特瓦奈特”号飞机在海上漂浮，后来有船经过，莱瑟姆方才获救。

两天之后，路易斯·布莱里奥驾驶一架名为“11号”的飞机来到加来附近。

布莱里奥从1905年起便开始研制飞机，“11号”飞机是他制作的最新型号。

一周以前，他曾成功地进行了一次26英里的陆上飞行。

但是莱瑟姆不肯轻易罢休。

同一天，他驾驶一架新的“安特瓦奈特”号飞机来到了加来附近。

看来会有一场激烈的飞越英吉利海峡的竞争。

两架飞机都打算在7月25日起飞，但是莱瑟姆那天起床晚了。

布莱里奥凌晨4点15分作了一次短距离试飞，半小时后便正式出发了。

他这次伟大的飞行持续了37分钟。

当他在多佛着陆后，第一个迎接他的是当地一名警察。

莱瑟姆在一周后又作了一次尝试，飞到了离多佛不到半英里的地方。

但是他又运气不佳。

他的引擎出了故障，飞机再次降落在海面上。

21. Daniel Mendoza

Boxing matches were very popular in England two hundred years ago. In those days, boxers fought with bare fists for prize money. Because of this, they were known as 'prize - fighters'. However, boxing was very crude, for there were no rules and a prize - fighter could be seriously injured or even killed during a match.

One of the most colourful figures in boxing history was Daniel Mendoza, who was born in 1764. The use of gloves was not introduced until 1860, when the Marquis of Queensberry drew up the first set of rules. Though he was technically a prize - fighter, Mendoza did much to change crude prize - fighting into a sport, for he brought science to the game. In his day, Mendoza enjoyed tremendous popularity. He was adored by rich and poor alike.

Mendoza rose to fame swiftly after a boxing - match when he was only fourteen years old. This attracted the attention of Richard Humphries who was then the most eminent boxer in England. He offered to train Mendoza and his young pupil was quick to learn. In fact, Mendoza soon became so successful that Humphries turned against him. The two men quarrelled bitterly and it was clear that the argument could only be settled by a fight. A match was held at Stilton, where both men fought for an hour. The public bet a great deal of money on Mendoza, but he was defeated. Mendoza met Humphries in the ring on a later occasion and he lost for a second time.

It was not until his third match in 1790 that he finally beat Humphries and became Champion of England. Meanwhile, he founded a highly successful Academy and even Lord Byron became one of his pupils. He earned enormous sums of money and was paid as much as 100 pounds for a single appearance. Despite this, he was so extravagant that he was always in debt. After he was defeated by a boxer called Gentleman Jackson, he was quickly forgotten. He was sent to prison for failing to pay his debts and died in poverty in 1836.

丹尼尔·门多萨

两百年前，拳击比赛在英国非常盛行。当时，拳击手们不戴手套，为争夺奖金而搏斗。因此，他们被称作“职业拳击手”。不过，拳击是十分野蛮的，因为当时没有任何比赛规则，职业拳击手有可能在比赛中受重伤，甚至丧命。

拳击史上最引人注目的人物之一是丹尼尔·门多萨，他生于1764年。1860年昆斯伯里侯爵第一次为拳击比赛制定了规则，拳击比赛这才用上了手套。虽然门多萨严格来讲不过是个职业拳击手，但在把这种粗野的拳击变成一种体育运动方面，他作出了重大贡献。是他把科学引进了这项运动。门多萨在他的全盛时期深受大家欢迎，无论是富人还是穷人都对他崇拜备至。

门多萨在14岁时参加了一场拳击赛后一举成名。这引起了当时英国拳坛名将理查德·汉弗莱斯的注意。他主动提出教授门多萨，而年少的门多萨一学就会。事实上，门多萨不久便名声大振，致使汉弗莱斯与他反目为仇。两个人争吵不休，显而易见，只有较量一番才能解决问题。于是两人在斯蒂尔顿设下赛场，厮打了一个小时。公众把大笔赌注下到了门多萨身上，但他却输了。后来，门多萨与汉弗莱斯再次在拳击场上较量，门多萨又输了一场。

直到1790年他们第三次对垒，门多萨才终于击败汉弗莱斯，成了全英拳击冠军。同时，他建立了一所拳击学校，办得很成功，连拜伦勋爵也成了他的学生。门多萨挣来大笔大笔的钱，一次出场费就可多达100英镑。尽管收入不少，但他挥霍无度，经常负债累累。他在被一个叫杰克逊绅士的拳击手击败后很快被人遗忘。他因无力还债而被捕入狱，最后于1836年在贫困中死去。

22. By Heart

Some plays are so successful that they run for years on end. In many ways, this is unfortunate for the poor actors who are required to go on repeating the same lines night after night. One would expect them to know their parts by heart and never have cause to falter. Yet this is not always the case.

A famous actor in a highly successful play was once cast in the role of an aristocrat who had been imprisoned in the Bastille for twenty years. In the last act, a gaoler would always come on to the stage with a letter which he would hand to the prisoner. Even though the noble was expected to read the letter at each performance, he always insisted that it should be written out in full.

One night, the gaoler decided to play a joke on his colleague to find out if, after so many performances, he had managed to learn the contents of the letter by heart. The curtain went up on the final act of the play and revealed the aristocrat sitting alone behind bars in his dark cell. Just then, the gaoler appeared with the precious letter in his hands. He entered the cell and presented the letter to the aristocrat. But the copy he gave him had not been written out in full as usual. It was simply a blank sheet of paper. The gaoler looked on eagerly, anxious to see if his fellow - actor had at last learnt his lines. The noble stared at the blank sheet of paper for a few seconds. Then, squinting his eyes, he said: 'The light is dim. Read the letter to me.' And he promptly handed the sheet of paper back to the gaoler. Finding that he could not remember a word of the letter either, the gaoler replied: 'The light is indeed dim, sire. I must get my glasses.' With this, he hurried off the stage. Much to the aristocrat's amusement, the gaoler returned a few moments later with a pair of glasses and the usual copy of the letter which he proceeded to read to the prisoner.

熟记台词

有些剧目十分成功，以致连续上演好几年。这样一来，可怜的演员们可倒霉了。因为他们需要一夜连着一夜地重复同样的台词。人们以为，这些演员一定会把台词背得烂熟，绝不会临场结巴的，但情况却并不总是这样。

有一位名演员曾在一出极为成功的剧目中扮演一个贵族角色，这个贵族已在巴士底狱被关押了20年。在最后一幕中，狱卒手持一封信上场，然后将信交给狱中那位贵族。尽管那个贵族每场戏都得念一遍那封信。但他还是坚持要求将信的全文写在信纸上。

一天晚上，狱卒决定与他的同事开一个玩笑，看看他反复演出这么多场之后，是否已将信的内容记熟了。大幕拉开，最后一幕戏开演，贵族独自一人坐在铁窗后的黑暗牢房里。这时狱卒上场，手里拿着那封珍贵的信。狱卒走进牢房，将信交给贵族。但这回狱卒给贵族的信没有像往常那样把全文写全，而是一张白纸。狱卒热切地观察着，急于想了解他的同事是否记熟了台词。贵族盯着白纸看了几秒钟，然后，眼珠一转，说道：“光线太暗，请给我读一下这封信。”说完，他一下子把信递给狱卒。狱卒发现自己连一个字也记不住，于是便说：“陛下，这儿光线的确太暗了，我得去把眼镜拿来。”他一边说着，一边匆匆下台。贵族感到非常好笑的是：一会儿工夫，狱卒重新登台，拿来一副眼镜以及平时使用的那封信，然后为那囚犯念了起来。

23. One Man's Meat is Another Man's Poison

People become quite illogical when they try to decide what can be eaten and what cannot be eaten. If you lived in the Mediterranean, for instance, you would consider octopus a great delicacy. You would not be able to understand why some people find it repulsive. On the other hand, your stomach would turn at the idea of frying potatoes in animal fat -- the normally accepted practice in many northern countries. The sad truth is that most of us have been brought up to eat certain foods and we stick to them all our lives.

No creature has received more praise and abuse than the common garden snail. Cooked in wine, snails are a great luxury in various parts of the world. There are countless people who, ever since their early years, have learned to associate snails with food. My friend, Robert, lives in a country where snails are despised. As his flat is in a large town, he has no garden of his own. For years he has been asking me to collect snails from my garden and take them to him.

The idea never appealed to me very much, but one day, after a heavy shower, I happened to be walking in my garden when I noticed a huge number of snails taking a stroll on some of my prize plants. Acting on impulse, I collected several dozen, put them in a paper bag, and took them to Robert. Robert was delighted to see me and

equally pleased with my little gift. I left the bag in the hall and Robert and I went into the living room where we talked for a couple of hours. I had forgotten all about the snails when Robert suddenly said that I must stay to dinner. Snails would, of course, be the main dish. I did not fancy the idea and I reluctantly followed Robert out of the living room. To my dismay, I saw that there were snails everywhere: they had escaped from the paper bag and had taken complete possession of the hall! I have never been able to look at a snail since then.

各有所爱

在决定什么能吃而什么不能吃的时候，人们往往变得不合情理。比如，如果你住在地中海地区，你会把章鱼视作是美味佳肴，同时不能理解为什么有人一见章鱼就恶心。另一方面，你一想到动物油炸土豆就会反胃，但这在北方许多国家却是一种普通的烹饪方法。不无遗憾的是，我们中的大部分人，生来就只吃某几种食品，而且一辈子都这样。

没有一种生物所受到的赞美和厌恶会超过花园里常见的蜗牛了。蜗牛加酒烧煮后，便成了世界上许多地方的一道珍奇的名菜。有不计其数的人从小就知道蜗牛可做菜。我的朋友罗伯特住在一个厌恶蜗牛的国家中。由于他住的是大城市里的一所公寓，没有自己的花园。多年来，他一直让我把我园子里的蜗牛收集起来给他捎去。

一开始，这个主意并没有特别吸引我。有一天，一场大雨后，我在花园里漫无目的地散步，突然注意到许许多多蜗牛在我的一些心爱的花木上慢悠悠地蠕动着。我一时冲动，逮了几十只，装进一只纸袋里，带着去找罗伯特。罗伯特见到我很高兴，对我的薄礼也感到满意。我把纸袋放在门厅里，便和罗伯特一起进了起居室，在那里聊了好几个钟头。我把蜗牛的事已忘得一干二净，罗伯特突然提出一定要我留下来吃晚饭，这才提醒了我。蜗牛当然是道主菜。我并不喜欢这个主意，所以我勉强跟着罗伯特走出了起居室。使我惊愕的是门厅里到处爬满了蜗牛：它们从纸袋里逃了出来，爬得满厅都是！从那以后，我再也不能看一眼蜗牛了。

24. A skeleton in the cupboard

We often read in novels how a seemingly respectable person or family has some terrible secret which has been concealed from strangers for years. The English language possesses a vivid saying to describe this sort of situation. The terrible secret is called 'a skeleton in the cupboard'. At some dramatic moment in the story, the terrible secret becomes known and a reputation is ruined. The reader's hair stands on end when he reads in the final pages of the novel that the heroine, a dear old lady who had always been so kind to everybody, had, in her youth, poisoned every one of her five husbands.

It is all very well for such things to occur in fiction. To varying degrees, we all have

secrets which we do not want even our closest friends to learn, but few of us have skeletons in the cupboard. The only person I know who has a skeleton in the cupboard is George Carlton, and he is very proud of the fact. George studied medicine in his youth. Instead of becoming a doctor, however, he became a successful writer of detective stories. I once spent an uncomfortable weekend which I shall never forget at his house. George showed me to the guestroom which, he said, was very quiet, but I was horrified to find that it looked out onto a cemetery.

'Oh, that's all right,' George said when I told him how I felt. 'I don't mind the view at all.' That was the start of an uncomfortable weekend. The first night, I had scarcely closed my eyes when a strange little man appeared at my bedside. 'I'm sorry to disturb you,' he said, 'but I think there is something wrong with my stomach.' I was in no mood to pass a pleasantry with him, so I simply stared at him until he went away. The next morning I got up early. I had a good breakfast and a pleasant morning stroll. After lunch, I settled down to read in the garden, but the book I was reading could not hold my attention. Every few minutes I raised my head to look at the view. It was not a pleasant view. I decided to go for a walk. I had not gone far when I saw a figure in the distance. I recognized George. He was walking slowly towards me. When he came near, I noticed that he looked very pale. 'I'm sorry to have troubled you last night,' he said. 'I had a bad night myself. I thought I heard something moving in the cupboard. It was probably a mouse, but it sounded like a skeleton. I'm not used to having skeletons in the cupboard, you know.'

“家丑”

在小说中，我们经常读到一个表面上受人尊重的人物或家族，却有着某种多年不为人知的骇人听闻的秘密。英语中有一个生动的说法来形容这种情况。惊人的秘密称作“柜中骷髅”。在小说的某个戏剧性时刻，可怕的秘密泄漏出来，接着便是某人的声誉扫地。当读者读到小说最后几页了解到书中女主人公，那位一向待大家很好的可爱的老妇人年轻时一连毒死了她的五个丈夫时，不禁会毛骨悚然。

这种事发生在小说中是无可非议的。尽管我们人人都有各种大小秘密，连最亲密的朋友都不愿让他们知道，但我们当中极少有人有柜中骷髅。我所认识的唯一的在柜中藏骷髅的人便是乔治·卡尔顿，他甚至引以为自豪。乔治年轻时学过医。然而，他后来没当上医生，却成了一位成功的侦探小说作家。我曾在他家中度过了一个不愉快的周末，这事我永远不会忘记。乔治把我领进客房，说这间房间很安静。但使我大为吃惊的是，我发现客房窗外是一片墓地。

“噢，那没关系，”当我告诉他我的感受时，乔治说，“我一点也不在意这种景色。”这个周末就这么开始了，很不舒服。头天晚上，我刚合眼不久，一个奇怪的小个子男人出现在我床边。“很抱歉打扰你，”他说，“我想我的肚子有点毛病。”我没心思跟他开玩笑，只是冷冷地瞪着他，直到他走掉。第二天早晨我起得很早。我吃了一顿丰盛的早餐，然后出去散步，度过了一个愉快的早晨。午饭后，我在花园里安下心来读书，但是我所读的

书却无法引起我的兴趣。每隔几分钟我就抬起头来看看景色。那景色并不美。我决定去走走。我没走多远就看到远处有一个人影。我认出那是乔治。他正慢慢地向我走来。当他走近时，我发现他脸色很苍白。“很抱歉昨晚打扰你了，”他说，“我自己昨晚也没睡好。我原以为我听到橱柜里有动静。可能是只老鼠，但听起来像是骷髅的声音。你知道，我是不习惯在橱柜里有骷髅的。”

25. The Cutty Sark

One of the most famous sailing ships of the nineteenth century, the Cutty Sark, can still be seen at Greenwich. She stands on dry land and is visited by thousands of people each year. She serves as an impressive reminder of the great ships of the past. Before they were replaced by steam-ships, sailing vessels like the Cutty Sark were used to carry tea from China and wool from Australia. The Cutty Sark was one of the fastest sailing ships that has ever been built. The only other ship to match her was the Thermopylae. Both these ships set out from Shanghai on June 18th, 1872 on an exciting race to England. This race, which went on for exactly four months, was the last of its kind. It marked the end of the great tradition of ships with sails and the beginning of a new era. The first of the two ships to reach Java after the race had begun was the Thermopylae, but on the Indian Ocean, the Cutty Sark took the lead. It seemed certain that she would be the first ship home, but during the race she had a lot of bad luck. In August, she was struck by a very heavy storm during which her rudder was torn away. The Cutty Sark rolled from side to side and it became impossible to steer her. A temporary rudder was made on board from spare planks and it was fitted with great difficulty. This greatly reduced the speed of the ship, for there was a danger that if she travelled too quickly, this rudder would be torn away as well. Because of this, the Cutty Sark lost her lead. After crossing the Equator, the captain called in at a port to have a new rudder fitted, but by now the Thermopylae was over five hundred miles ahead. Though the new rudder was fitted at tremendous speed, it was impossible for the Cutty Sark to win. She arrived in England a week after the Thermopylae. Even this was remarkable, considering that she had had so many delays. There is no doubt that if she had not lost her rudder she would have won the race easily.

After she had been retired, she was put on display in Greenwich in 1954. A great deal of work was done to restore her, and she is now in perfect condition. Even though she was never actually sailed, the Cutty Sark remains one of the most famous ships of all time.

“卡蒂萨克”号帆船

人们在格林威治仍可看到19世纪最有名的帆船之一“卡蒂萨克”号。它停在陆地上，每年接待成千上万的参观者。它给人们留下深刻的印象，使人们回忆起历史上的巨型帆船。在蒸汽船取代帆船之前，“卡蒂萨克”号之类的帆船被用来从中国运回茶叶，从澳大利亚运回羊毛。“卡蒂萨克”号是帆船制造史上建造的最快的一艘帆船。唯一可以与之一比高低的是“塞姆皮雷”号帆船。两船于1872年6月18日同时从上海启航驶往英国，这是一次扣人心弦的比赛。这场比赛持续了整整4个月，是这类比赛中的最后一次，它标志着帆船伟大传统的结束与一个新纪元的开始。比赛开始后，“塞姆皮雷”号率先抵达爪哇岛。但在印度洋上，“卡蒂萨克”号驶到了前面。看来，它首先返抵英国是确信无疑的了，但它却在比赛中连遭厄运。8月，它遭到一场特大风暴的袭击，失去了舵。“卡蒂萨克”号向一侧倾斜，无法操纵。船员用备用的木板在船上赶制了一只应急用的舵，并克服重重困难将舵安装

好。这样一来，大大降低了船的航速。因为船不能开得太快，否则就有危险，应急舵也会被刮走。因为这个缘故，“卡蒂萨克”号落到了后面。越过赤道后，船长将船停靠在一个港口，在那儿换了一只舵。但此时，“塞姆皮雷”号早已在500多英里之遥了。尽管换装新舵时分秒必争，但“卡蒂萨克”号已经不可能取胜了，它抵达英国时比“塞姆皮雷”号晚了1个星期。但考虑到路上的多次耽搁，这个成绩也已很不容易了。毫无疑问，如果中途没有失去舵，“卡蒂萨克”号肯定能在比赛中轻易夺冠。

“卡蒂萨克”号于1954年退役，之后被陈列在格林威治。人们为修复它花了大量的精力，它现在状况良好。尽管它从未真正航行过，但“卡蒂萨克”号至今仍是最著名的船之一。

26. Wanted: a large biscuit tin

No one can avoid being influenced by advertisements. Much as we may pride ourselves on our good taste, we are no longer free to choose the things we want, for advertising exerts a subtle influence on us. In their efforts to persuade us to buy this or that product, advertisers have made a close study of human nature and have classified all our little weaknesses.

Advertisers discovered years ago that all of us love to get something for nothing. An advertisement which begins with the magic word FREE can rarely go wrong. These days, advertisers not only offer free samples, but free cars, free houses, and free trips round the world as well. They devise hundreds of competitions which will enable us to win huge sums of money. Radio and television have made it possible for advertisers to capture the attention of millions of people in this way.

During a radio programme, a company of biscuit manufacturers once asked listeners to bake biscuits and send them to their factory. They offered to pay \$10 a pound for the biggest biscuit baked by a listener. The response to this competition was

tremendous. Before long, biscuits of all shapes and sizes began arriving at the factory. One lady brought in a biscuit on a wheelbarrow. It weighed nearly 500 pounds. A little later, a man came along with a biscuit which occupied the whole of his car boot. All the biscuits that were sent were carefully weighed. The largest was 713 pounds. It seemed certain that this would win the prize. But just before the competition closed, a lorry arrived at the factory with a truly colossal biscuit which weighed 2,400 pounds. It had been baked by a college student who had used over 1,000 pounds of flour, 800 pounds of sugar, 200 pounds of fat, and 400 pounds of various other ingredients. It was so large that the lorry that carried it could barely move. The manufacturers had to pay more than they had anticipated, for they bought the biscuit from the student for \$24,000.

征购大饼干筒

没有人能避免受广告的影响。尽管我们可以自夸自己的鉴赏力如何敏锐，但我们已经无法独立自主地选购自己所需的东西了。这是因为广告在我们身上施加着一种潜移默化的影响。做广告的人在力图劝说我们买下这种产品或那种产品之前，已经仔细地研究了人的本性，并把人的弱点进行了分类。

做广告的人们多年前就发现我们大家都喜欢免费得到东西。凡是用“免费”这个神奇的字眼开头的广告很少会失败的。目前，做广告的人不仅提供免费样品，而且还提供免费汽车，免费住房，免费周游世界。他们设计数以百计的竞赛，竞赛中有人可赢得巨额奖金。电台、电视使做广告的人可以用这种手段吸引成百万人的注意力。

有一次，在电台播放的节目里，一个生产饼干的公司请听众烘制饼干送到他们的工厂去。他们愿意以每磅10美元的价钱买下由听众烘制的最大的饼干。这次竞赛在听众中引起极其热烈的反响。不久，形状各异，大小不一的饼干陆续送到工厂。一位女士用手推车运来一个饼干，重达500磅左右。相隔不一会儿，一个男子也带来一个大饼干，那个饼干把汽车的行李箱挤得满满的。凡送来的饼干都仔细地称量。最重的一个达713磅。看来这个饼干肯定会拿冠军，可是就在竞赛截止时间将到之际，一辆卡车驶进了工厂，运来了一个特大无比的饼干，重达2400磅。它是由一个大学生烘制的，用去1000多磅面粉、800磅食糖、200磅油脂和400磅其他各种原料。它是那么大，以至运送它的卡车差点都开不动了。饼干公司不得不付出比他们预计多得多的钱，因为为买下那学生烘制的饼干他们支付了24000美元。

27. Nothing to Sell and Nothing to Buy

It has been said that everyone lives by selling something. In the light of this statement, teachers live by selling knowledge, philosophers by selling wisdom and priests by selling spiritual comfort. Though it may be possible to measure the value

of material goods in terms of money, it is extremely difficult to estimate the true value of the services which people perform for us. There are times when we would willingly give everything we possess to save our lives, yet we might grudge paying a surgeon a high fee for offering us precisely this service. The conditions of society are such that skills have to be paid for in the same way that goods are paid for at a shop. Everyone has something to sell.

Tramps seem to be the only exception to this general rule. Beggars almost sell themselves as human beings to arouse the pity of passers - by. But real tramps are not beggars. They have nothing to sell and require nothing from others. In seeking independence, they do not sacrifice their human dignity. A tramp may ask you for money, but he will never ask you to feel sorry for him. He has deliberately chosen to lead the life he leads and is fully aware of the consequences. He may never be sure where the next meal is coming from, but he is free from the thousands of anxieties which afflict other people. His few material possessions make it possible for him to move from place to place with ease. By having to sleep in the open, he gets far closer to the world of nature than most of us ever do. He may hunt, beg, or steal occasionally to keep himself alive; he may even, in times of real need, do a little work; but he will never sacrifice his freedom. We often speak of tramps with contempt and put them in the same class as beggars, but how many of us can honestly say that we have not felt a little envious of their simple way of life and their freedom from care?

不卖也不买

据说每个人都靠出售某种东西来维持生活。根据这种说法，教师靠卖知识为生，哲学家靠卖智慧为生，牧师靠卖精神安慰为生。虽然物质产品的价值可以用金钱来衡量，但要估算人们为我们提供的服务的真正价值却极为困难。有时，我们为了挽救生命，愿意付出我们所占有的一切。但就在外科大夫给我们提供了这种服务后，我们却可能为所支付的昂贵费用而抱怨。社会上的情况就是如此，技术是必须付钱去买的，就像在商店里要花钱买商品一样。人人都有东西可以出售。

在这条普遍性的规律面前，好像只有流浪汉是个例外。乞丐出售的几乎是他本人，以引起过路人的怜悯。但真正的流浪汉并不是乞丐。他们既不出售任何东西，也不需要从别人那儿得到任何东西。在追求独立自由的同时，他们并不牺牲为人的尊严。流浪汉可能会向你讨钱，但他从来不要你可怜他。他是故意在选择过那种生活的，并完全清楚以这种方式生活的后果。他可能从不知道下顿饭有无着落，但他不像有人那样被千万桩愁事所折磨。他几乎没有什么财产，这使他能够轻松自如地在各地奔波。由于被迫在露天睡觉，他比我们中许多人都离大自然近得多。为了生存，他可能会去打猎、乞讨，偶尔偷上一两回；确实需要的时候，他甚至可能干一点儿活，但他决不会牺牲自由。说起流浪汉，我们常常带有轻蔑并把他们与乞丐归为一类。但是，我们中有多少人能够坦率地说我们对流浪汉的简朴生活与无忧无虑的境况不感到有些羡慕呢？

28. Five pounds too dear

Small boats loaded with wares sped to the great liner as she was entering the harbour. Before she had anchored, the men from the boats had climbed on board and the decks were soon covered with colourful rugs from Persia, silks from India, copper coffee pots, and beautiful handmade silverware. It was difficult not to be tempted.

Many of the tourists on board had begun bargaining with the tradesmen, but I decided not to buy anything until I had disembarked. I had no sooner got off the ship than I was assailed by a man who wanted to sell me a diamond ring. I had no intention of buying one, but I could not conceal the fact that I was impressed by the size of the diamonds. Some of them were as big as marbles. The man went to great lengths to prove that the diamonds were real. As we were walking past a shop, he held a diamond firmly against the window and made a deep impression in the glass. It took me over half an hour to get rid of him.

The next man to approach me was selling expensive pens and watches. I examined one of the pens closely. It certainly looked genuine. At the base of the gold cap, the words 'made in the U.S.A.' had been neatly inscribed. The man said that the pen was worth £50, but as a special favour, he would let me have it for £30. I shook my head and held up a finger indicating that I was willing to pay a pound. Gesticulating wildly, the man acted as if he found my offer outrageous, but he eventually reduced the price to £10. Shrugging my shoulders, I began to walk away when, a moment later, he ran after me and thrust the pen into my hands. Though he kept throwing up his arms in despair, he readily accepted the pound I gave him. I felt especially pleased with my wonderful bargain--until I got back to the ship. No matter how hard I tried, I could not fill this beautiful pen with ink and it was only when I got off the plane that I realised that I had been tricked by the man. The pen was worthless; it was not even made of gold.

五镑太贵了

当一艘大型班轮进港的时候，许多小船载着各种杂货快速向客轮驶来。大船还未下锚。小船上的人就纷纷爬上客轮。一会儿工夫，甲板上就摆满了色彩斑斓的波斯地毯。印度丝绸。铜咖啡壶以及手工制作的漂亮的银器。要想不为这些东西所动心是很困难的。

船上许多游客开始同商贩讨价还价起来，但我打定主意上岸之前什么也不买。我刚下船，就被一个人截住，他向我兜售一枚钻石戒指。我根本不想买，但我不能掩饰这样一个事实：其钻石之大给我留下了深刻的印象。有的钻石像玻璃球那么大。那人竭力想证明那钻石是真货。我们路过一家商店时，他将一颗钻石使劲地往橱窗上一按，在玻璃上留下一道深痕。我花了半个多小时才摆脱了他的纠缠。

向我兜售的第二个人是卖名贵钢笔和手表的。我仔细察看了一枝钢笔，那看上去确实不假，金笔帽下方整齐地刻有“美国制造”字样。那人说那支笔值50英镑，作为特别优惠，他愿意让我出30英镑成交。我摇摇头，伸出一根手指表示我只愿出1英镑。那人激动地打着手势，仿佛我的出价使他不能容忍。但他终于把价钱降到了10英镑。我耸耸肩膀掉头走开了。一会儿，他突然从后追了上来，把笔塞到我手里。虽然他绝望地举起双手，但他毫不迟疑地收下了我付给他的1英镑。在回到船上之前，我一直为我的绝妙的讨价还价而洋洋得意。然而不管我如何摆弄，那枝漂亮的钢笔就是吸不进墨水来。直到我下了飞机之后，才意识到我被那个人愚弄了。那支笔毫无价值，甚至连金的也不是。

29. Funny or not

The sense of humour is mysteriously bound up with national characteristics. For instance, the French word for "funny" hardly has the same meaning as the English equivalent. If you ask a Frenchman whether the English have a sense of humour, he will probably answer, "Yes, but it's rather peculiar." You can find the same thing in other countries. Each nation has its own ideas of what is funny, and what is in bad taste.

In general, the English and the Americans do not laugh at the same things. The English, for example, do not laugh at the same kind of humour as the Americans. The things which make an Englishman laugh are not always the things which make an American laugh, and vice versa. The fact that they laugh at different things may well make it difficult for a foreigner to understand what is really funny in either country.

Most funny stories are based on comic situations. In spite of national differences, certain funny situations have a universal appeal. No matter where you live, you would find it difficult not to laugh at, say, Charlie Chaplin's early films. However, a new type of humour, which stems from America, has recently come into fashion. It is called "sick humour". Comedians base their jokes on tragic situations like violent death or serious accidents. Many people find this sort of joke distasteful. The following example of "sick humour" will enable you to judge for yourself.

A man who had broken his right leg was taken to hospital a few weeks before Christmas. From the moment he arrived there, he kept on pestering his doctor to tell him when he would be able to go home. He dreaded having to spend Christmas in hospital. Though the doctor did his best, the patient's recovery was slow. On Christmas day, the man still had his right leg in plaster.

He spent a miserable day in bed thinking of all the fun he was missing. The following day, his mood was better. He was able to sit up in bed and look out of the window. He saw a man being taken into the hospital on a stretcher. As the man was being carried past the window, he caught sight of his neighbour's face. He was horrified to see that his neighbour had his right leg in plaster too. He called out to the man on the stretcher, "I say, what happened to you?" The man on the stretcher groaned and said, "I broke my left leg."

是否可笑

幽默感与民族特性神秘地联系在一起。例如，法语中表示“好笑”的词与英语中相应的词几乎没有相同的含义。如果你问一个法国人英国人是否有幽默感，他可能会回答：“有，但相当特别。”你在其他国家也能发现同样的情况。每个民族对于什么是好笑的，什么是低俗的都有自己的看法。

一般来说，英国人和美国人不会因同样的事情发笑。例如，英国人并不像美国人那样欣赏同一种幽默。使英国人发笑的事情并不总是能使美国人发笑，反之亦然。他们因不同的事情而发笑这一事实很可能会使外国人难以理解这两个国家中真正好笑的东西。

大部分滑稽故事都是基于滑稽情景的。尽管存在民族差异，但某些滑稽情景具有普遍的吸引力。不管你住在哪里，比如说，你都会觉得很难不笑看查理·卓别林的早期电影。然而，一种源于美国的新型幽默最近流行起来。它被称为“病态幽默”。喜剧演员根据诸如暴死或严重事故等悲惨情景来编笑话。许多人觉得这种笑话令人厌恶。下面这个“病态幽默”的例子能让你自己来判断。

圣诞节前几周，一个右腿骨折的人被送进了医院。从他到医院的那一刻起，他就不断缠着医生问他什么时候能回家。他害怕不得不在医院里过圣诞节。尽管医生尽了最大努力，但病人的康复很慢。圣诞节那天，这个人的右腿还打着石膏。

他在床上凄惨地过了一天，想着自己错过的种种乐趣。第二天，他的心情好多了。他能在床上坐起来，向窗外望去。他看到一个人被用担架抬进医院。当那个人被抬过窗户时，他瞥见了邻居的脸。他惊恐地看到邻居的右腿也打着石膏。他向担架上的人喊道：“喂，你怎么了？”担架上的人呻吟着说：“我摔断了左腿。”

30. The death of a ghost

For years villagers believed that Endley Farm was haunted. The farm was owned by two brothers, Joe and Bob Cox. They employed a few farm hands, but no one was willing to work there long. Every time a worker gave up his job, he told the same story. Farm labourers said that they always woke up to find the work had been done overnight. Hay had been cut and cowsheds had been cleaned. A farm worker, who stayed up all night, claimed to have seen a figure cutting corn in the moonlight. In

time, it became an accepted fact that the Cox brothers employed a conscientious ghost that did most of their work for them.

No one suspected that there might be someone else on the farm who had never been seen. This was indeed the case. A short time ago, villagers were astonished to learn that the ghost of Endley had died. Everyone went to the funeral, for the 'ghost' was none other than Eric Cox, a third brother who was supposed to have died as a young man. After the funeral, Joe and Bob revealed a secret which they had kept for over fifty years.

Eric had been the eldest son of the family, very much older than his two brothers. He had been obliged to join the army during the Second World War. As he hated army life, he decided to desert his regiment. When he learnt that he would be sent abroad, he returned to the farm and his father hid him until the end of the war. Fearing the authorities, Eric remained in hiding after the war as well. His father told everybody that Eric had been killed in action. The only other people who knew the secret were Joe and Bob. They did not even tell their wives. When their father died, they thought it their duty to keep Eric in hiding. All these years, Eric had lived as a recluse. He used to sleep during the day and work at night, quite unaware of the fact that he had become the ghost of Endley. When he died, however, his brothers found it impossible to keep the secret any longer.

幽灵之死

多年来，村民们一直认为恩得利农场在闹鬼。恩得利农场属于乔·考科斯和鲍勃·考科斯兄弟俩所有。他们雇了几个农工，但谁也不愿意在那儿长期工作下去。每次雇工辞职后都叙述着同样的故事。雇工们说，常常一早起来发现有人在夜里把活干了，干草已切好，牛棚也打扫干净了。有一个彻夜未眠的雇工还声称他看见一个人影在月光下收割庄稼。随着时间的流逝，考科斯兄弟雇了一个尽心尽责的鬼，他们家的活大部分都让鬼给干了，这件事成了公认的事实。

谁也没想到农场里竟会有一个从未露面的人。但事实上确有此人。不久之前，村民们惊悉恩得利农场的鬼死了。大家都去参加了葬礼，因为那“鬼”不是别人，正是农场主的兄弟埃里克·考科斯。人们以为埃里克年轻时就死了。葬礼之后，乔和鲍勃透露了他们保守了长达50多年的秘密。

埃里克是这家人的长子，年龄比他两个弟弟大很多。第二次世界大战期间，他被迫参军。由于他厌恶军旅生活，他决定逃离所在部队。当他了解到自己将被派遣出国时，他逃回农场，父亲把他藏了起来，直到战争结束。由于害怕当局，埃里克战后继续深藏不露。他的父亲告诉大家，埃里克在战争中被打死了。除此之外，只有乔和鲍勃知道这个秘密。但他俩连自己的妻子都没告诉。父亲死后，他们兄弟俩认为有责任继续把埃里克藏起来。这些年来，埃里克过着隐士生活，白天睡觉，夜里出来干活，一点不知道自己已成了恩得利农场的活鬼。他死后，他的弟弟们才觉得无法再保守这个秘密了。

31. A Lovable Eccentric

True eccentrics never deliberately set out to draw attention to themselves. They disregard social conventions without being conscious that they are doing anything extraordinary. This invariably wins them the love and respect of others, for they add colour to the dull routine of everyday life.

Up to the time of his death, Richard Colson was one of the most notable figures in our town. He was a shrewd and wealthy business - man, but most people in the town hardly knew anything about this side of his life. He was known to us all as Dickie and his eccentricity had become legendary long before he died.

Dickie disliked snobs intensely. Though he owned a large car, he hardly ever used it, preferring always to go on foot. Even when it was raining heavily, he refused to carry an umbrella. One day, he walked into an expensive shop after having been caught in a particularly heavy shower. He wanted to buy a \\$300 watch for his wife, but he was in such a bedraggled state that an assistant refused to serve him. Dickie left the shop without a word and returned carrying a large cloth bag. As it was extremely heavy, he dumped it on the counter. The assistant asked him to leave, but Dickie paid no attention to him and requested to see the manager. Recognizing who the customer was, the manager was most apologetic and 'rushed' Dickie into the back room. Dickie took out a thick roll of \$100 bills and started peeling them off one at a time onto the counter. On seeing this, the manager hastened to add the watch to Dickie's bill and then apologized for having been so rude before. Dickie, however, had his own way of doing things. He calmly picked up the watch, put his money back into the bag and left the shop without a word.

The following day, the manager of the shop sent his assistant to Dickie's house with a letter. In the letter, he apologized for his rudeness and begged Dickie to come back to the shop. Dickie accepted the apology and later became a regular customer of the shop.

可爱的怪人

真正古怪的人从不有意引人注意。他们不顾社会习俗，意识不到自己所作所为有什么特殊之处。他们总能赢得别人的喜爱与尊敬，因为他们给平淡单一的日常生活增添了色彩。

理查德·科尔森生前是我们镇上最有名望的人之一。他是个精明能干、有钱的商人，但镇上大部分人对他的这一个方面几乎一无所知。大家都管他叫迪基，在他去世前很久，他的怪癖就已经成了传奇故事了。

迪基痛恨势利小人。虽然他有一辆豪华小轿车，但却很少使用，常常喜欢以步代车。即使大雨倾盆，他也总是拒绝带伞。一天，他遇上一场瓢泼大雨，淋得透湿。他走进一家高档

商店，想要为妻子买一块价值300美元的手表。但他浑身泥水的样子实在不怎么雅观，售货员都不肯接待他。迪基二话没说就走了。一会儿，他带着一个大布口袋回到店里。布袋很沉，他重重地把布袋扔在柜台上。售货员让他离开，他置之不理，并要求见经理。经理认出了这位顾客，表示了深深的歉意，然后毕恭毕敬地把迪基请到里屋。迪基从口袋里掏出一大卷100美元面额的钞票，开始一张一张地往柜台上数。经理看到这种情形，立即把手表加进迪基的账单，然后为先前的无礼向迪基道歉。然而，迪基有他自己做事的方式。他若无其事地拿起手表，把钱放回口袋，一言不发地离开了商店。

第二天，商店经理派人把一封信送到迪基的家里。信中对前一天的无礼表示道歉，并恳请迪基再次光顾商店。迪基接受了道歉，后来成了这家商店的常客。

32. A lost ship

The salvage operation had been a complete failure. The small ship, Elkor, which had been searching the Barents Sea for weeks, was on its way home. A radio message from the mainland had been received by the ship's captain instructing him to give up the search. The captain knew that another attempt would be made later, for the sunken ship he was trying to find had been carrying a precious cargo of gold bullion.

Nevertheless, he was still unwilling to leave the area. 'I'll give it another day or two,' he said to his officers. 'We may as well start looking again. There's still a faint chance that we may find it. It's true that we've been unlucky so far, but we mustn't give up hope.'

Just as the captain was speaking, a large fish, which was almost as long as the ship itself, swam swiftly under the ship and struck it with great force. The ship shook violently and there was a loud explosion. Water flooded into the engine room and the ship sank quickly, with all hands. The captain and his officers were not the only victims. Many of the crew also lost their lives. The few survivors swam as far as they could from the sinking ship until they were picked up by a passing ship.

The Elkor's captain and his officers were taken to a nearby port. From there, they were flown back to their own country. A court of inquiry was held. The captain was blamed for the loss of the ship and for the deaths of the crew. He was found guilty and was sentenced to ten years' imprisonment. The ship's owners were also held responsible for the accident. They were ordered to pay a large sum of money in compensation.

The Elkor was a small ship, but it was carrying a very valuable cargo. It was not

surprising that the search for it had been so difficult. The Barents Sea is a very large and stormy area. The ship had been missing for weeks before the Elkor started its search. It had been sailing in a remote part of the sea when it disappeared. There had been no sign of a struggle or of any damage to the ship before it sank. It was as if the ship had simply vanished into thin air.

The Elkor's search had been thorough. The ship had covered a large area of the sea. It had used the latest equipment. The captain had been experienced and determined. But in spite of all these things, the search had been a failure. It was a sad end to a long and difficult search.

一艘沉船

打捞工作彻底失败了。小船“埃尔科”号在巴伦支海搜寻了几个星期之后，正在返航途中。船长收到了大陆发来的电报，指示他放弃这次搜寻。船长知道日后还会再作尝试，因为他试图寻找的沉船上载有一批珍贵的金条。

然而，他还是不情愿离开这个海域。“我将再试一两天，”他对船员们说，“我们不妨再重新搜寻一遍。找到它的可能性仍然很小。的确，到目前为止我们运气不佳，但我们不应该放弃希望。”

就在船长说话的时候，一条大鱼，几乎和船一样长，迅速地从船下穿过，猛力地撞击了它。船剧烈地摇晃起来，接着是一声巨响。海水涌进了轮机舱，船迅速下沉，全体船员都遇难了。船长和船员们并不是唯一的受害者。许多船员也丧生了。少数幸存者尽可能地远离正在下沉的船，直到被一艘过往的船救起。

“埃尔科”号的船长和船员被带到附近的一个港口。从那里，他们被空运回自己的国家。进行了一次调查审讯。船长因船只失事和船员丧生而受到指责。他被判有罪，被判处10年监禁。船主们也被认为应对这次事故负责。他们被责令支付一大笔赔偿金。

“埃尔科”号是一艘小船，但它载着非常贵重的货物。难怪搜寻它是如此困难。巴伦支海是一个非常辽阔且多风暴的海域。在“埃尔科”号开始搜寻之前，这艘船已经失踪好几个星期了。它消失的时候正在这片海域的一个偏远区域航行。在船沉没之前，没有挣扎的迹象，也没有任何损坏的迹象。就好像这艘船凭空消失了一样。

“埃尔科”号的搜寻工作做得很彻底。这艘船已经搜索了大片海域。它使用了最先进的设备。船长经验丰富且意志坚定。但尽管有这些有利条件，搜寻工作还是失败了。这是一次漫长而艰难的搜寻的悲惨结局。

33. A day to remember

We have all experienced days when everything goes wrong. A day may begin well enough, but suddenly everything seems to get out of control. What invariably happens is that a great number of things choose to go wrong at precisely the same moment. It is as if a single unimportant event set up a chain of reactions. Let us suppose that you are preparing a meal and keeping an eye on the baby at the same time. The telephone rings and this marks the prelude to an unforeseen series of catastrophes. While you are on the phone, the baby pulls the table - cloth off the table, smashing half your best crockery and cutting himself in the process. You hang up hurriedly and attend to baby, crockery, etc. Meanwhile, the meal gets burnt. As if this were not enough to reduce you to tears, your husband arrives, unexpectedly bringing three guests to dinner. Things can go wrong on a big scale, as a number of people recently discovered in Parramatta, a suburb of Sydney. During the rush hour one evening two cars collided and both drivers began to argue. The woman immediately behind the two cars happened to be a learner. She suddenly got into a panic and stopped her car. This made the driver following her brake hard. His wife was sitting beside him holding a large cake. As she was thrown forward, the cake went right through the windscreen and landed on the road. Seeing a cake flying through the air, a lorry - driver who was drawing up alongside the car, pulled up all of a sudden. The lorry was loaded with empty beer bottles and hundreds of them slid off the back of the lorry and on to the road. This led to yet another angry argument. Meanwhile, the traffic piled up behind. It took the police nearly an hour to get the traffic on the move again. In the meantime, the lorry - driver had to sweep up hundreds of broken bottles. Only two stray dogs benefited from all this confusion, for they greedily devoured the remains of the cake. It was just one of those days!

难忘的一天

我们大家都有过事事不顺心的日子。一天开始时，可能还不错，但突然间似乎一切都失去了控制。情况经常是这样的，许许多多的事情都偏偏赶在同一时刻出问题，好像是一件无关紧要的小事引起了一连串的连锁反应。假设你在做饭，同时又在照看孩子。这时电话铃响了。它预示着一连串意想不到的灾难的来临。就在你接电话时，孩子把桌布从桌子上扯了下来，将家中最好的陶瓷餐具半数摔碎，同时也弄伤了他自己。你急急忙忙挂上电话，赶去照看孩子和餐具。这时，饭又烧糊了。好像这一切还不足以使你急得掉泪，你的丈夫接着回来了，事先没打招呼就带来3个客人吃饭。就像许多人最近在悉尼郊区帕拉马塔所发现的那样，有时乱子会闹得很大。一天傍晚交通最拥挤时，一辆汽车撞上前面一辆汽车，两个司机争吵起来。紧跟其后的一辆车上的司机碰巧是个初学者，她一惊之下突然把车停住了。她这一停使得跟在后头的司机也来了个急刹车。司机的妻子正坐在他身边，手里托着块大蛋糕。她往前一冲，蛋糕从挡风玻璃飞了出去掉到马路上。此时，一辆卡车正好从后边开到那辆汽车边上，司机看见一块蛋糕从天而降，紧急刹车。卡车上装着空啤酒瓶，

成百只瓶子顺势从卡车后面滑出车外落在马路上。这又引起了一场唇枪舌剑的争吵。与此同时，后面的车辆排成了长龙，警察花了将近一个小时才使车辆重新开起来。在这段时间里，卡车司机不得不清扫那几百只破瓶子。只有两只野狗从这一片混乱中得到了好处，它们贪婪地吃掉了剩下的蛋糕。这就是事事不顺心的那么一天！

34. A Happy Discovery

Antique shops exert a peculiar fascination on a great many people. The more expensive kind of antique shop where rare objects are beautifully displayed in glass cases to keep them free from dust is usually a forbidding place. But no one has to muster up courage to enter a less pretentious antique shop. There is always hope that in its labyrinth of musty, dark, disordered rooms a real rarity will be found amongst the piles of assorted junk that litter the floors.

No one discovers a rarity by chance. A truly dedicated bargain hunter must have patience, and above all, the ability to recognize the worth of something when he sees it. To do this, he must be at least as knowledgeable as the dealer. Like a scientist bent on making a discovery, he must cherish the hope that one day he will be amply rewarded.

My old friend, Frank Halliday, is just such a person. He has often described to me how he picked up a masterpiece for a mere £5. One Saturday morning, Frank visited an antique shop in my neighbourhood. As he had never been there before, he found a great deal to interest him. The morning passed rapidly and Frank was about to leave when he noticed a large packing - case lying on the floor. The dealer told him that it had just come in, but that he could not be bothered to open it. Frank begged him to do so and the dealer reluctantly prised it open.

The contents were disappointing. Apart from an interesting - looking carved dagger, the box was full of crockery, much of it broken. Frank gently lifted the crockery out of the box and suddenly noticed a miniature painting at the bottom of the box. As its composition and line reminded him of an Italian painting he knew well, he decided to buy it. Glancing at it briefly, the dealer told him that it was worth £5. Frank could hardly conceal his excitement, for he knew that he had made a real discovery. The tiny painting proved to be an unknown masterpiece by Correggio and was worth hundreds of thousands of pounds.

幸运地发现

古玩店对许多人来说有一种特殊的魅力。高档一点的古玩店为了防尘，把文物漂亮地陈列

在玻璃柜子里，那里往往令人望而却步。而对不太装腔作势的古玩店，无论是谁都不用壮着胆子才敢往里进。人们还常常有希望，在发霉、阴暗、杂乱无章、迷宫般的店堂里，从杂乱地摆放在地面上的、一堆堆各式各样的破烂货里找到一件稀世珍品。

发现珍品决非偶然。一个到处找便宜的人必须具有耐心，而且最重要的是看到珍品时要有鉴别珍品的能力。要做到这一点，他至少要像古董商一样在行。他必须像一个专心致志进行探索的科学家那样抱有这样的希望，即终有一天，他的努力会取得丰硕的成果。

我的老朋友弗兰克·哈利戴正是这样一个人。他多次向我详细讲他如何只花5英镑便买到一位名家的杰作。一个星期六的上午，弗兰克去了我家附近的一家古玩店。由于他从未去过那儿，结果他发现了许多有趣的东西。上午很快过去了，弗兰克正准备离去，突然看见地板上放着一只体积很大的货箱。古董商告诉他那只货箱刚到不久，但他嫌麻烦不想把它打开。经弗兰克恳求，古董商才勉强把货箱撬开了。

箱内东西令人失望。除了一柄式样别致、雕有花纹的匕首外，货箱内装满了陶器，而且大部分都已破碎。弗兰克轻轻地把陶器拿出箱子，突然发现在箱底有一幅微型画。这幅画的构图和线条使他想起了一幅他所熟悉的意大利画，于是他决定将它买下来。古董商漫不经心地看了一眼那幅画，告诉弗兰克那画值5英镑。弗兰克几乎无法掩饰自己兴奋的心情，因为他明白自己发现了一件珍品。那幅不大的画原来是柯勒乔的一幅未被发现的杰作，价值几十万英镑。

35. Justice was done

The word justice is usually associated with courts of law. We might say that justice has been done when a man's innocence or guilt has been proved beyond doubt.

Justice is part of the complex machinery of the law. Those who seek it, undertake an arduous journey and can never be sure that they will find it. Judges, however wise or eminent, are human and can make mistakes.

There are rare instances when justice almost ceases to be an abstract conception. Reward or punishment are meted out quite independent of human interference. At such times, justice acts like a living force. When we use a phrase like it serves him right, we are, in part, admitting that a certain set of circumstances has enabled justice to act of its own accord.

When a thief was caught on the premises of a large jewellery store one morning, the shop assistants must have found it impossible to resist the temptation to say 'it serves him right'. The shop was an old - fashioned one with many large, disused fireplaces and tall, narrow chimneys. Towards midday, a girl heard a muffled cry coming from behind one of the walls. As the cry was repeated several times, she ran to tell the manager who promptly rang up the fire brigade. The cry had certainly come from

one of the chimneys, but as there were so many of them, the fire - fighters could not be certain which one it was. They located the right chimney by tapping at the walls and listening for the man's cries. After chipping through a wall which was eighteen inches thick, they found that a man had been trapped in the chimney. As it was extremely narrow, the man was unable to move, but the firemen were eventually able to free him by cutting a huge hole in the wall. The sorry - looking, blackened figure that emerged, at once admitted that he had tried to break into the shop during the night but had got stuck in the chimney. He had been there for nearly ten hours. Justice had been done even before the man was handed over to the police.

伸张正义

“正义”这个词常常是同法庭连在一起的。当某人被证据确凿地证明无罪或有罪的时候，我们也许会说正义得到了伸张。正义是复杂的法律机器的一部分。那些寻求正义的人走的是一条崎岖的道路，从来没有把握他们最终将找到正义。法官无论如何聪明与有名，毕竟也是人，也会出差错的。

在个别情况下，正义不再是一种抽象概念。奖惩的实施是不受人的意志支配的。在这种时候，正义像一种有生命的力量行使其职能。当我们说“他罪有应得”这句话的时候，我们部分地承认了某种特定的环境使得正义自动地起了作用。

一天上午，当一个小偷在一家大型珠宝店里被人抓住的时候，店员们一定忍不住会说：“他罪有应得。”那是一家老式的商店，有许多废置的大壁炉和又高又窄的烟囱。快到中午的时候，一个女售货员听见从一堵墙里传出一种闷声闷气的叫声。由于这种喊叫声重复了几次，她跑去报告了经理，经理当即给消防队挂了电话。喊叫声肯定是从烟囱里传出来的，然而，因为烟囱太多，消防队员无法确定到底是哪一个。他们通过叩击烟囱倾听那人的喊叫声而确定了传出声音的那个烟囱。他们凿透了18英寸厚的墙壁，发现有人卡在烟囱里。由于烟囱太窄，那人无法动弹。消防队员在墙上挖了个大洞，才终于把他解救出来。那个看起来满脸沮丧、浑身漆黑的家伙从烟囱里一出来，就承认头天夜里他企图到店里行窃，但让烟囱卡住了。他已经在烟囱里被困了将近10个小时。甚至在那人还没被送交给警察之前，正义就已得到了伸张。

36. A Chance in a Million

We are less credulous than we used to be. In the nineteenth century, a novelist would bring his story to a conclusion by presenting his readers with a series of coincidences - most of them wildly improbable. Readers happily accepted the fact that an obscure maidservant was really the hero's mother. A long - lost brother, who was presumed dead, was really alive all the time and wickedly plotting to bring about the hero's downfall. And so on. Modern readers would find such naive

solutions totally unacceptable. Yet, in real life, circumstances do sometimes conspire to bring about coincidences which anyone but a nineteenth century novelist would find incredible.

A German taxi - driver, Franz Bussman, recently found a brother who was thought to have been killed twenty years before. While on a walking tour with his wife, he stopped to talk to a workman. After they had gone on, Mrs. Bussman commented on the workman's close resemblance to her husband and even suggested that he might be his brother. Franz poured scorn on the idea, pointing out that his brother had been killed in action during the war. Though Mrs. Bussman was fully acquainted with this story, she thought that there was a chance in a million that she might be right. A few days later, she sent a boy to the workman to ask him if his name was Hans Bussman. Needless to say, the man's name was Hans Bussman and he really was Franz's long - lost brother.

When the brothers were reunited, Hans explained how it was that he was still alive. After having been wounded towards the end of the war, he had been sent to hospital and was separated from his unit. The hospital had been bombed and Hans had made his way back into Western Germany on foot. Meanwhile, his unit was lost and all records of him had been destroyed. Hans returned to his family home, but the house had been bombed and no one in the family was alive. Assuming that his family had been killed during the air - raid, Hans settled down in a village fifty miles away where he had remained ever since.

百万分之一的机遇

我们不再像以往那样轻易相信别人了。在19世纪，小说家常常在小说结尾处给读者准备一系列的巧合——大部分是牵强附会，极不可能的。读者愉快地接受了这样一个事实：一个卑微的女佣实际上是主人公的母亲；主人公一位长期失散的兄弟，大家都以为死了，实际上一一直活着，并且正在策划暗算主人公；如此等等。现代读者会觉得这种天真的结局完全无法接受。不过，在现实生活中，有时确实会出现一些巧合，这些巧合除了19世纪小说家外谁也不会相信。

弗兰兹·巴斯曼是一名德国出租车司机，最近找到了人们以为20年前就已遇害的兄弟。一次，他与妻子徒步旅行。途中，他停下来与一个工人交谈，接着他们继续往前走去。巴斯曼夫人说那工人与她丈夫相貌很像，甚至猜测他可能就是她丈夫的兄弟。弗兰兹对此不屑一顾，指出他兄弟已经在战争中阵亡了。尽管巴斯曼夫人熟知这个情况，但她仍然认为自己的想法仍有百万分之一的可能性。几天后，她派了一个男孩去问那人是否叫汉斯·巴斯曼。不出所料，那人的名字确实是汉斯·巴斯曼，他确实是弗兰兹失散多年的兄弟。

兄弟俩团聚之时，汉斯说明了他活下来的经过。战争即将结束时，他负伤被送进医院，并与部队失去了联系。医院遭到轰炸，汉斯步行回到了西德。与此同时，他所在的部队被击溃，他的所有档案材料全部毁于战火。汉斯重返故里，但他的家已被炸毁，家人也全都身

亡。汉斯以为全家人都在空袭中遇难，于是便在距此50英里外的一座村子里定居下来，直至当日。

37. The Westhaven Express

We have learnt to expect that trains will be punctual. After years of conditioning, most of us have developed an unshakable faith in railway timetables. Ships may be delayed by storms; flights may be cancelled because of bad weather, but trains must be on time. Only an exceptionally heavy snowfall might temporarily dislocate railway services. It is all too easy to blame the railway authorities when something does go wrong. The truth is that when mistakes occur, they are more likely to be ours than theirs.

After consulting my railway timetable, I noted with satisfaction that there was an express train to Westhaven. It went direct from my local station and the journey lasted a mere hour and seventeen minutes. When I boarded the train, I could not help noticing that a great many local people got on as well. At the time, this did not strike me as odd. I reflected that there must be a great many people besides myself who wished to take advantage of this excellent service. Neither was I surprised when the train stopped at Widley, a tiny station a few miles along the line. Even a mighty express train can be held up by signals. But when the train dawdled at station after station, I began to wonder. It suddenly dawned on me that this express was not roaring down the line at ninety miles an hour, but barely chugging along at thirty. One hour and seventeen minutes passed and we had not even covered half the distance. I asked a passenger if this was the Westhaven express, but he had not even heard of it.

I determined to lodge a complaint as soon as we arrived. Two hours later, I was talking angrily to the station master at Westhaven. When I told him that the train was not moving at all, he apologized for the inconvenience. Then he said something which made me think that perhaps this was not his fault after all. 'You see, sir,' he said, 'this isn't the Westhaven express. It's the slow train to Sandy Bay.' He pointed to the right. 'You should have caught the train over there two hours ago.'

开往威斯特海温的快车

我们已经习惯于相信火车总是准点的。经过多年的适应，大多数人对火车时刻表产生了一种不可动摇的信念。轮船可能因风暴而延误，飞机可能因恶劣天气而取消航班，但是火车必须准点。只有非同寻常的大雪才可能暂时打乱铁路运行。因此，一旦铁路运营真的出了

问题，人们很容易责怪铁路部门。事实上，差错很可能是我们自己，而不是铁路当局的。

我查看了列车时刻表，满意地了解到有一趟去威斯特海温的快车。这趟车直接从我家附近的车站开出，全程只需1小时17分钟。上车后，我不禁注意到许多当地人也上了车。当时，我并未感到奇怪。我想除我之外，一定还有许多人想利用这趟便利的列车。火车在沿线数英里以外的一个小站威德里停了下来，我对此也不觉得奇怪。即便是特别快车也可能被信号拦住。但是，当火车一站接着一站往前蠕动时，我便产生了怀疑。我突然意识到这趟快车并非以时速90英里呼啸前进，而是以时速30英里缓缓前行。1小时17分钟过去了，我们连一半的路程还没走完。我问一位乘客，这是不是开往威斯特海温的那趟快车，他说他甚至没听说过有这么一趟快车。

我决定一到目的地就给铁路部门提意见。两小时后，我气呼呼地同威斯特海温站站长说起此事。我告诉他火车根本没开时，他为给我造成的不便表示歉意。接着他讲的一番话使我意识到也许这不是他的过错。“先生，您瞧，”他说，“这不是开往威斯特海温的快车。这是开往桑迪湾的慢车。”他指着右边说：“您本该在两小时之前就上那趟车的。”

38. The first calendar

Future historians will be in a unique position when they come to record the history of our own times. They will hardly know which facts to select from the great mass of evidence that steadily accumulates. What is more, they will not have to rely solely on the written word. Films, videos, CDs and CD-ROMs are just some of the bewildering amount of information they will have. They will be able, as it were, to see and hear us in action. But the historian attempting to reconstruct the distant past is always faced with a difficult task. He has to deduce what he can from the few scanty clues available. Even seemingly insignificant remains can shed interesting light on the history of early man.

Up to now, historians have assumed that calendars came into being with the advent of agriculture, for then man was faced with a real need to understand something about the seasons. Recent scientific evidence seems to indicate that this assumption is incorrect.

Historians have long been puzzled by dots, lines and symbols which have been engraved on walls, bones, and the ivory tusks of mammoths. The nomads who made these markings lived by hunting and fishing during the last Ice Age which began about 35,000 B.C. and ended about 10,000 B.C. By correlating markings made in various parts of the world, historians have been able to read this difficult code. They have found that it is connected with the passage of days and the phases of the moon. It is, in fact, a primitive type of calendar. It has long been known that the hunting

scenes depicted on walls were not simply a form of artistic expression. They had a definite function, for they were as much a part of the ritual of hunting as the killing of the prey itself. This ritual was necessary to calm the gods who controlled the animals. Hunters and fishermen, in particular, were extremely superstitious. Thus, they engraved on the bones of the prey animals the signs of the moon which they had observed. The nomads who made these markings saw the moon as a major influence on their lives. They knew that it would affect the growth of plants and the migration of animals. They were convinced that it was the moon which caused the tides. They noted the phases of the moon in order to predict the times of high and low tides. They made these markings on the bones of the prey animals for two reasons. First, they wanted to record the number of kills they had made. Second, they wanted to mark the passage of days and the phases of the moon.

The ancient hunters' calendar was different from the calendars we use today. For one thing, it was not based on the movement of the sun. It was based on the movement of the moon. For another, it was not a written calendar. It was an engraved calendar. But it was a calendar just the same. It was a means of recording the passage of days and the phases of the moon. It was a way of predicting the times of high and low tides. It was a tool for hunters and fishermen. It was a form of art. It was a form of religious expression. It was a part of the ritual of hunting.

最早的日历

未来的历史学家在写我们这一段历史的时候会别具一格。对于逐渐积累起来的庞大材料，他们几乎不知道选取哪些好，而且，也不必完全依赖文字材料。电影、录像、光盘和光盘驱动器只是能为他们提供令人眼花缭乱的大量信息的几种手段。他们能够身临其境般地观看我们做事，倾听我们讲话。但是，历史学家企图重现遥远的过去可是一项艰巨的任务，他们必须根据现有的不充分的线索进行推理。即使看起来微不足道的遗物，也可能揭示人类早期历史的一些有趣的内容。

到目前为止，历史学家一直认为日历是随农业的问世而出现的，因为当时人们面临着了解四季的实际需要。但近期科学研究发现，好像这种假设是不正确的。

长期以来，历史学家一直对雕刻在墙壁上、骨头上、古代长毛象的象牙上的点、线和形形色色的符号感到困惑不解。这些痕迹是游牧人留下的，他们生活在从公元前约35,000年到公元前10,000年的冰川期的末期，以狩猎、捕鱼为生。历史学家通过把世界各地留下的这种痕迹放在一起研究，终于弄懂了这种费解的代码。他们发现代码与昼夜更迭和月亮圆缺有关，事实上是一种最原始的日历。大家早就知道，画在墙上的狩猎图景并不是单纯的艺术表现形式，它们有着一定的功能，因为它们是狩猎仪式的一个重要部分，就像杀死猎物本身一样。这种仪式是为了安抚控制动物的神灵。尤其是狩猎者和捕鱼者，他们非常迷信。因此，他们在猎物的骨头上刻上月亮的形状，他们相信是月亮导致了潮汐。他们记录月亮的盈亏是为了预测潮汐的涨落。他们在猎物骨头上刻痕有两个原因：一是为了记录捕杀的数量，二是为了记录日期和月亮的圆缺。

古代猎人的日历与我们今天使用的日历不同。首先，它不是根据太阳的运行而制订的，而是根据月亮的运行。其次，它不是写下来的日历，而是刻在东西上的日历。但不管怎么说，它也是一种日历。它是记录日期和月亮圆缺的手段，是预测潮汐涨落的工具，是狩猎者和捕鱼者的行事依据，是一种艺术形式，是一种宗教表现形式，也是狩猎仪式的一部分。

39. Nothing to worry about

The rough road across the plain soon became so bad that we tried to get Bruce to drive back to the village we had come from. Even though the road was littered with boulders and pitted with holes, Bruce was not in the least perturbed. Glancing at his map, he informed us that the next village was a mere twenty miles away. It was not that Bruce always underestimated difficulties. He simply had no sense of danger at all. No matter what the conditions were, he believed that a car should be driven as fast as it could possibly go.

As we bumped over the dusty track, we swerved to avoid large boulders. The wheels scooped up stones which hammered ominously under the car. We felt sure that sooner or later a stone would rip a hole in our petrol tank or damage the engine. Because of this, we kept looking back, wondering if we were leaving a trail of oil and petrol behind us.

What a relief it was when the boulders suddenly disappeared, giving way to a stretch of plain where the only obstacles were clumps of bushes. But there was worse to come. Just ahead of us there was a huge fissure. In response to renewed pleadings, Bruce stopped. Though we all got out to examine the fissure, he remained in the car. We informed him that the fissure extended for fifty yards and was two feet wide and four feet deep. Even this had no effect. Bruce still drove at a terrifying speed, and soon we had left the fissure far behind. We were now in the middle of a forest which grew thicker and thicker. It was so thick that we could hardly move forward any more.

Bruce went into a low gear and drove at a terrifying speed, keeping the front wheels astride the crack as he followed its zig - zag course. We were all sweating profusely. Not for one minute did he look at the map. He was just driving. At last we could see a dim light in the distance, and soon afterwards we arrived at the village.

不必担心

穿越平原的道路高低不平，开车走了不远，路面愈加崎岖。我们想劝说布鲁斯把车开回我们出发的那个村庄去。尽管路面布满石头，坑坑洼洼，但布鲁斯却一点儿不慌乱。他瞥了

一眼地图，告诉我们前面再走不到20英里就是一个村庄。这并不是说布鲁斯总是低估困难，而是他压根儿没有危险感。他认为不管路面情况如何，车必须以最高速度前进。

我们在尘土飞扬的道路上颠簸，车子东拐西弯，以躲开那些大圆石。车轮搅起的石块锤击车身，发出不祥的锤击声。我们相信迟早会飞起一个石块把油箱砸开一个窟窿，或者把发动机砸坏。因此，我们不时地掉过头，怀疑车后是否留下了机油和汽油的痕迹。

突然大石块消失了，前面是一片平地，唯一的障碍只有一簇簇灌木丛。这使我们长长地松了口气。但是更糟糕的事情在等着我们，离我们不远处，出现了一个大裂缝。我们再次央求布鲁斯小心，他这才把车停了下来。我们纷纷下车察看那个大裂缝，他却呆在车上。我们告诉他那个大裂缝长50码，宽2英尺，深4英尺。这也没有对他产生任何影响。布鲁斯仍然以极高的速度开车，不一会儿就把那裂缝远远地抛在我们后面了。我们现在是在密密的森林里，林深树密，我们几乎无法前进。

布鲁斯挂上慢档，把两只前轮分别搁在裂缝的两边，顺着弯弯曲曲的裂缝，以发疯的速度向前开去。我们全都大汗淋漓。他一刻也没有看地图，只是一个劲儿地往前开。最后，我们终于看到远处有微弱的灯光，不久就到达那个村庄了。

40. Food and Talk

Last week at a dinner - party, the hostess asked me to sit next to Mrs. Rumbold. Mrs. Rumbold was a large, unsmiling lady in a tight black dress. She did not even look up when I took my seat beside her. Her eyes were fixed on her plate and in a short time, she was busy eating. I tried to make conversation.

"A new play is coming to 'The Globe' soon," I said. "Will you be seeing it?"

"No," she answered.

"Will you be spending your holidays abroad this year?" I asked.

"No," she answered.

"Will you be staying in England?" I asked.

"No," she answered.

In despair, I asked her whether she was enjoying her dinner.

"Young man," she answered, "if you ate more and talked less, we would both enjoy our dinner!"

进餐与交谈

在上星期的一次宴会上，女主人安排我坐在兰伯尔德夫人的身旁。兰伯尔德夫人是一位身材高大、表情严肃的女人，穿一件紧身的黑衣服。当我在她身旁坐下来的时候，她甚至连头都没有抬一下。她的眼睛盯着自己的盘子，不一会儿就忙着吃起来了。我试图找个话题和她聊聊。

我说：“一出新剧很快就要在‘环球剧场’上演了。”你去看吗？”

“不，”她回答。

“您今年去国外度假吗？”我又问。

“不，”她回答。

“您就呆在英国吗？”我问。

“不，”她回答。

失望之中我问她是否吃得满意。

“年轻人，”她回答说，“如果你多吃点，少说点，我们两个都会吃得好的！”

41. Illusions of Pastoral Peace

A gifted American psychologist has said, "Worry is a spasm of the emotion; the mind catches hold of something and will not let it go." It is useless to argue with the mind in this condition. The stronger the will, the more futile the task. One can only gently insinuate something else into its convulsive grasp. And if this something else is rightly chosen, if it really attended by the illumination of another field of interest, gradually, and often quite swiftly, the old undue grip relaxes and the process of recuperation and repair begins.

The cultivation of a hobby and new forms of interest is therefore a policy of first importance to a public man. But this is not a business that can be undertaken in a day or swiftly improvised by a mere command of the will. The growth of alternative mental interests is a long process. The seeds must be carefully chosen; they must fall on good ground; they must be sedulously tended, if the vivifying fruits are to be at hand when needed.

To be really happy and really safe, one ought to have at least two or three hobbies, and they must all be real. It is no use starting late in life to say: "I will take an interest in this or that." Such an attempt only aggravates the strain of mental effort. A man may acquire great knowledge of topics unconnected with his daily work, and yet get hardly any benefit or relief. It is no use doing what you like; you have to like

what you do. Broadly speaking, human beings may be divided into three classes: those who are toiled to death, those who are worried to death, and those who are bored to death. It is no use offering the manual laborer, tired out with a hard day's work, a seat in a park or a lecture on aesthetics. It is no use inviting the politician or the business man, who has been worried about affairs of state or business all day, to attend a concert or the ballet. It is no use telling the bored, unemployed youth, "Go and play football." The right kind of spiritual food is just as necessary for one class as for another.

Those who are toiled to death are too busy to enjoy life. Those who are worried to death are too nervous to enjoy life. Those who are bored to death are too listless to enjoy life. There is no country in the world where one can not find people who would be happy to spend the rest of their lives in a village if they could. And yet, no country in the world is free from the scourge of poverty. Poverty is like a disease that is constantly spreading. It is not enough to have a good income. One must also have a good way of spending it. There are people who earn a great deal of money, but they are not happy because they do not know how to spend it. There are also people who have very little money, but they are happy because they know how to spend it.

In a world that is constantly changing, the idea of a pastoral idyll is an illusion. The idea of a simple life, free from worry and poverty, is an illusion. The idea of a life where one can do as one pleases, without any restrictions, is an illusion. The idea of a life where one can be completely happy, without any unhappiness, is an illusion. But these illusions are not without value. They give us hope. They give us something to look forward to. They give us the strength to go on.

宁静田园生活的遐想

一位天才的美国心理学家曾经说过：“烦恼是感情的发作，此时脑子纠缠住了某种东西又不肯松手。”在这种情况下，你和头脑争吵让它松手是无济于事的。这种意志越是强烈，这种尝试越是徒劳。你只能耐心地用暗示的方法使其他事进入这张弛状态的头脑中。如果选得合适，而且的确受到别的领域的情趣的启迪，那么渐渐地，往往也是很顺利地，原先不适当的紧张就会松弛下来，恢复和修整的过程就会开始。

因此，对一个从事社会活动的人来说，培养一种业余爱好和各种新的兴趣是头等重要的做法。但这并非一日之功，也不是单凭一蹴而就的事。精神上多种情趣的培养是一个长期的过程。要想在需要的时候可随手摘取充满生机的果实，那就必须从精选良种做起，然后将其植入肥沃的土地，还需要勤勉地护理。

要想真正生活得幸福和平安，一个人至少应该有两三种业余爱好，而且必须是真正的爱好。到了晚年才开始说：“我要培养这个或那个兴趣。”那是毫无用处的，这种尝试只会增加精神上的负担。一个人可能会获得与其日常工作无关的某些课题的渊博知识，而没有从

中得到什么实益或宽慰。干你所喜欢的事是没有用的，你得喜欢你所干的事。广义地说，人可以分为三类：劳累而死的人、忧虑而死的人和无聊而死的人。对于那些体力劳动者来说，经过一天的辛苦劳作，给他们提供一个座位，或者听一场美学讲座是毫无用处的。对于那些政治家或商人来说，他们整天为国务或商务操劳，让他们去听音乐会或者看芭蕾舞也是毫无用处的。对于那些无所事事的失业青年来说，告诉他们“去踢足球吧”也是毫无用处的。不同的人需要不同的精神食粮。

那些劳累而死的人太忙了，没有时间享受生活。那些忧虑而死的人太紧张了，没有心情享受生活。那些无聊而死的人太萎靡不振了，没有劲头享受生活。世界上没有一个国家找不到这样的人：如果可能的话，他们愿意在乡村度过自己的余生。然而，世界上没有一个国家能摆脱贫困的折磨。贫困就像一种不断蔓延的疾病。仅有好的收入是不够的，还必须有的花钱方法。有些人挣了很多钱，但并不幸福，因为他们不知道如何花钱。也有些人钱很少，但很幸福，因为他们知道如何花钱。

在一个不断变化的世界里，田园诗般的宁静生活的想法是一种幻想。没有烦恼和贫困的简单生活的想法是一种幻想。可以随心所欲、没有任何限制的生活的想法是一种幻想。完全幸福、没有任何不幸的生活的想法是一种幻想。但是这些幻想并非毫无价值。它们给我们希望。它们给我们一些可以期待的东西。它们给我们继续前进的力量。

42. Modern Cavemen

Cave exploration, or pot-holing, as it has come to be known, is a relatively new sport. Perhaps it is the desire for solitude or the chance of making an unexpected discovery that lures people down to the depths of the earth. It is impossible to give a satisfactory explanation for a pot-holer's motives. For him, caves have the same peculiar fascination which high mountains have for the climber. They arouse instincts which can only be dimly understood.

Exploring really deep caves is not a task for the Sunday afternoon Rambler. Such undertakings require the precise planning and foresight of military operations. It can take as long as eight days to rig up rope ladders and to establish supply bases before a descent can be made into a very deep cave. Precautions of this sort are necessary, for it is impossible to foretell the exact nature of the difficulties which will confront the pot-holer. The deepest known cave in the world is the Gouffre Berger near Grenoble. It extends to a depth of 3,723 feet. This immense chasm has been formed by an underground stream which has tunnelled a course through a flaw in the rocks. The entrance to the cave is on a plateau in the Dauphine Alps. As it is only six feet across, it is barely noticeable. The cave might never have been discovered had not the entrance been spotted by the distinguished French potholer, Berger. Since its discovery, it has become a sort of pot-holers' Everest. Though a number of descents

have been made, much of it still remains to be explored.

A team of pot - holers recently went down the Gouffre Berger. After entering the narrow gap on the plateau, they climbed down the steep sides of the cave until they came to a narrow corridor. They had to edge their way along this, sometimes wading across shallow streams, or swimming across deep pools. Suddenly they came to a waterfall which dropped into an underground lake at the bottom. They plunged into the lake, and after loading their gear on an inflatable rubber dinghy, let the current carry them to the other side. To their dismay, they found that the caverns were filled with water. This did not deter them, and they were determined to continue their exploration. One of the members of the team pointed out that they could not go on much longer without fresh water. This led to a search for fresh water which ended in failure. They were so thirsty that they drank a lot of the water in which they had been swimming. The water was not fresh, but it was all they had.

Scientists have expressed their dismay at the fate of the pot - holers. Lack of fresh water and food, and exhaustion will soon make it impossible for them to continue their exploration. They hope that a rescue party will be sent as soon as possible.

现代洞穴人

洞穴勘查——或人们通常所说的山洞探险——是一项比较新的运动。也许是对独处的渴望，或是对意外发现的期待吸引着人们来到地球深处。要想对洞穴探险者的动机作出满意的解释是不可能的。对洞穴探险者来说，洞穴有一种特殊的魅力，就像高山对登山者有特殊魅力一样。这种魅力能引发人们难以理解的本能。

探测非常深的洞穴不是那些在星期日下午漫步的人所能胜任的。这种活动需要有军事行动般的周密布署和预见能力。在进入一个很深的洞穴之前，光是装配绳梯和建立供应基地就需要八天之久。作出这样的准备是必要的，因为无法预见到洞穴探险者究竟会遇到什么性质的困难。世界上最深的洞穴是格里诺布尔附近的高弗·伯杰洞，深达3,723英尺。这个深邃的洞穴是由一条地下暗河冲蚀岩石中的缝隙并使之慢慢变大而形成的。此洞的洞口在多芬阿尔卑斯山的一个高原上，仅6英尺宽，很难被发现。若不是法国著名洞穴探险家伯杰由于偶然的机会发现了这个洞口的话，这个洞也许永远不会为人所知。自从被发现以后，这个洞成了洞穴探险者的珠穆朗玛峰。尽管已多次有人进入洞内探险，但仍有不少地方有待勘探。

最近，一队洞穴探险者下到了高弗·伯杰洞里。他们从高原上的窄缝进去后，顺着陡峭的洞壁往下爬，来到了一条狭窄的通道。他们不得不侧着身子往前走，有时还要蹚过浅溪或游过深潭。突然，他们来到一道瀑布前，那瀑布奔泻而下，注入洞底一处地下湖里。他们跳入湖中，把各种器具装上一只充气的橡皮艇，听任水流将他们带往对岸。令他们惊愕的是，他们发现洞穴里到处都是水。但这并没有阻止他们继续探险的决心。队里有位队员指出，如果没有淡水，他们继续下去也支撑不了多久。这促使他们寻找淡水，可惜没有成功。他们渴极了，便大口大口地喝起曾经游过泳的水来。那水虽说不上新鲜，但还能对付。

科学家对洞穴探险者的命运表示忧虑。缺乏淡水和食物，再加上疲惫不堪，会使他们很快就无法再继续探险。他们希望尽快派来一支营救队。

43. Fully Insured

Insurance companies are normally willing to insure anything.

Insuring public or private property is a standard practice in most countries in the world.

If, however, you were holding an open air garden party or a fete it would be equally possible to insure yourself in the event of bad weather.

Needless to say, the bigger the risk an insurance company takes, the higher the premium you will have to pay.

It is not uncommon to hear that a shipping company has made a claim for the cost of salvaging a sunken ship.

But the claim made by a local authority to recover the cost of salvaging a sunken pie dish must surely be unique.

Admittedly it was an unusual pie dish, for it was eighteen feet long and six feet wide.

It had been purchased by a local authority so that an enormous pie could be baked for an annual fair.

The pie committee decided that the best way to transport the dish would be by canal, so they insured it for the trip.

Shortly after it was launched, the pie dish met with some trouble.

The vessel was stranded on a sandbank two days later in a storm.

A tugboat was sent to the ship's assistance.

Despite the fact that a tugboat was towing the pie dish, it could not prevent it from going aground again.

The local authority realized that they could not handle the situation alone, so they decided to call in a dredging company to help them out.

The dredging company sent a huge dredger which could handle the situation.

When the dredger arrived, it began to suck up the sand around the pie dish.

As it sucked up the sand, the dish became lighter and lighter.

Finally, the dish was lifted out of the sand and placed on a barge.

It was then towed to its destination.

The local authority was very pleased with the way things had been handled.

They were also very happy that they had insured the pie dish for the full value.

When they submitted their claim to the insurance company, they were surprised to find that the insurance company was also very happy to pay up.

The insurance company explained that the pie dish was a unique item and that they had no intention of disputing the claim.

After all, they had been fully insured.

全保险

保险公司一般说来愿意承保一切东西。

承办公共财产或私人财产保险是世界上大部分国家的正常业务。

如果你要举办一次露天游园会或盛宴，为避免碰上不好的天气而遭受损失也同样可以保险。

不用说，保险公司承担风险越大，你付的保险费也就越高。

航运公司为打捞沉船而提出索赔，这是常有的事。

但某地当局为打捞一只焙制馅饼的盘子提出索赔，倒是件新鲜事儿。

这个盘子确实少见，有18英尺长，6英尺宽。

某地方当局买下它用来焙制一个巨大的馅饼为一年一度交易会助兴。

馅饼委员会确认运输盘子的最佳方案是通过运河水运。于是，他们对这一运输投保。

盘子下水后不久便遇上了麻烦。

两天后船在风暴中搁浅在沙滩上。

于是，他们派了一艘拖轮去援助那艘船。

尽管拖轮一直拖着盘子，但是它仍无法阻止盘子再次搁浅。

地方当局意识到自己已无法独立处理这件事，于是便决定请挖泥船公司来帮忙。

挖泥船公司派了一艘巨大的挖泥船，能够处理这种情况。

挖泥船到达后，开始吸取盘子周围的沙子。

随着沙子被吸出，盘子变得越来越轻。

最后，盘子被从沙子中吊起，放在驳船上。

然后驳船将盘子拖至目的地。

地方当局对事情的处理方式非常满意。

他们也很高兴自己为盘子足额投保了。

当他们向保险公司提出索赔时，他们惊讶地发现保险公司也很高兴地付了款。

保险公司解释说盘子是独一无二的，他们无意对索赔进行争辩。

毕竟，他们已经得到了全额保险。

44. Speed and Comfort

People traveling long distances frequently have to decide whether they would prefer to go by land, sea, or air. Hardly anyone can positively enjoy sitting in a train for more than a few hours. Train compartments soon get cramped and stuffy. It is almost impossible to take your mind off the journey. Reading is only a partial solution, for the monotonous rhythm of the wheels clicking on the rails soon lulls you to sleep. During the day, sleep comes in snatches. At night, when you really wish to go to sleep, you rarely manage to do so. If you are lucky enough to get a sleeper, you spend half the night staring at the small blue light in the ceiling, or fumbling to find your ticket for inspection. Inevitably you arrive at your destination almost exhausted. Long car journeys are even less pleasant, for it is quite impossible to read. On motorways you can, at least, travel fairly safely at high speeds, but more often than not, the greater part of the journey is spent on narrow, bumpy roads which are crowded with traffic. By comparison, trips by sea offer a great variety of civilized comforts. You can stretch your legs on the spacious decks, play games, swim, meet interesting people and enjoy good food---always assuming, of course, that the sea is calm. If it is not, and you are likely to get seasick, no form of transport could be worse. Even if you travel in ideal weather, sea journeys take a long time. Relatively few people are prepared to sacrifice up to a third of their holidays for the pleasure of traveling on a ship. Aeroplanes have the reputation of being dangerous and even hardened travellers are intimidated by them. They also have the disadvantage of being an expensive form of transport. But nothing can match them for speed and comfort. Traveling at a height of 30,000 feet, far above the clouds, and

at over 500 miles an hour is an exhilarating experience. You do not have to devise ways of taking your mind off the journey, for an aeroplane gets you to your destination rapidly. For a few hours, you settle back in a deep armchair to enjoy the flight. The real escapist can watch a free film show and sip champagne on some services. But even when such refinements are not available, there is plenty to keep you occupied. An aeroplane offers you an unusual and breathtaking view of the world. You soar effortlessly over high mountains and deep valleys. You really see the shape of the land. If the landscape is hidden from view, you can enjoy the extraordinary sight of unbroken cloud plains that stretch out for miles before you, while the sun shines brilliantly in a clear sky. The journey is so smooth that there is nothing to prevent you from reading or sleeping. However you decide to spend your time, one thing is certain: you will arrive at your destination fresh and uncrumpled. You will not have to spend the next few days recovering from a long and arduous journey.

速度与舒适

出远门的人常常需要决定是走旱路、水路，还是坐飞机。很少有人能够真正喜欢坐几个小时以上的火车。车厢很快就变得拥挤、闷热，想摆脱开旅途的困扰是很难的。看书只能解决部分问题。车轮与铁轨间单调的嘎吱声很快就会送你进入梦乡。白天是忽睡忽醒，到了夜晚，你真想睡了，却很难入睡。即使你走运弄到一个卧铺，夜间有一半时间你会盯着车顶那盏小蓝灯而睡不着觉；要不然就为查票摸索你的车票。一旦抵达目的地，你总是疲惫不堪。乘汽车作长途旅行则更加不舒服，因为连看书都几乎不可能。在公路上还好，你至少能以相当快的速度安全地向前行。但旅行的大部分时间都花在路上，而且只有很少的一部分路是宽阔、平坦的。相比之下，海上旅行可提供各种文明的享受。你可以在宽敞的甲板上舒展肢体，游戏，游泳，遇上有兴趣的人还可以与之结识，享受可口的饭菜——当然，这一切只有在大海风平浪静的情况下才有可能。如果大海肆虐起来，你就可能晕船，那种难受劲儿是任何一种别的旅行的方式都不会带来的。即使风平浪静，坐船旅行也要占用很长时间。没有多少人会为享受坐船旅行的乐趣而牺牲假期的三分之一。飞机以危险而著称，连老资格的旅行者也怕飞机。飞机的另一个缺点是昂贵。但就速度与舒适而言，飞机是无与伦比的。腾云驾雾，在30,000

英尺高空以500英里的时速旅行，这种经历令人心旷神怡。你不必想办法去摆脱旅途的困扰，因为飞机会迅速把你送到目的地。几小时之内，你躺在扶手椅上，享受着旅途的欢乐。真正会享受的人还可以在某个航班上看一场免费电影，或者喝香槟酒。即使没有这些消遣条件，也总是有事可做。飞机上，你可以观察世界上非同寻常的奇妙的美景。你毫不费劲地飞越高山幽谷，你确能饱览大地的风貌。如果这种景色被遮住了，你可以观赏一下展现在你面前的、一望数英里的、连绵不断的云海，同时阳光灿烂，天空清澈明朗。旅途平稳，丝毫不妨碍你阅读或睡眠。不管你打算如何消磨时间，有件事是可以肯定的，即当你抵达目的地时，你感到精神焕发，毫无倦意，用不着因为漫长的旅途的辛苦而花几天时间休息来恢复精神。

45. The power of the press

In democratic countries any efforts to restrict the freedom of the press are rightly condemned. However, this freedom can easily be abused. Stories about people often attract far more public attention than political events. Though we may enjoy reading about the lives of others, it is extremely doubtful whether we would equally enjoy reading about ourselves. Acting on the contention that facts are sacred, reporters can cause untold suffering to individuals by publishing details about their private lives. Newspapers exert such tremendous influence that they can not only bring about major changes to the lives of ordinary people but can even overthrow a government.

The story of a poor family that acquired fame and fortune overnight, dramatically illustrates the power of the press. The family lived in Aberdeen, a small town of 23,000 inhabitants in South Dakota. As the parents had five children, life was a perpetual struggle against poverty. They were expecting their sixth child and were faced with even more pressing economic problems. If they had only had one more child, the fact would have passed unnoticed. They would have continued to struggle against economic odds and would have lived in obscurity.

But they suddenly became the parents of quintuplets, four girls and a boy, an event which radically changed their lives. The day after the birth of the five children, an aeroplane arrived in Aberdeen bringing sixty reporters and photographers. The news was of national importance, for the couple had become the parents of the only quintuplets in America.

The rise to fame was swift. Television cameras and newspapers carried the news to everyone in the country. Newspapers and magazines offered the family huge sums for the exclusive rights to publish stories and photographs. Gifts poured in not only from unknown people, but from baby - food manufacturers who wished to advertise their products. The old farmhouse the family lived in was to be replaced by a new \$100,000 home. Reporters kept pressing for interviews so lawyers had to be employed to act as spokes - men for the family at press conferences.

While the five babies were still quietly sleeping in oxygen tents in a hospital nursery, their parents were paying the price for fame. It would never again be possible for them to lead normal lives. They had become the victims of commercialization, for their names had acquired a market value. Instead of being five new family members, these children had immediately become a commodity.

新闻报道的威力

在民主国家里，任何限制新闻自由的企图都理所当然地受到谴责。然而，这种自由很容易

被滥用。常人轶事往往比政治事件更能引起公众注意。我们都喜欢看关于别人生活的报道，但是否同样喜欢看关于自己生活的报道，就很难说了。记者按事实至上的论点行事，发表有关别人生活的细节，有时会给当事人造成极大的痛苦。新闻具有巨大的影响力，它不仅可以给普通人的生活带来重大的变化，甚至还能推翻一个政府。

一个贫困家庭一夜之间成为名户而暴富，这一事件戏剧性地说明了新闻报道的威力。这户人家住在南达科他州一个人口为23,000的小镇阿拜丁。家里已有5个孩子，全家人常年在贫困中挣扎。第6个孩子即将问世，他们面临着更为严峻的经济问题。如果他们只添了1个孩子，这件事本来就不会引起任何人的注意。他们会继续为克服经济上的拮据而奋斗，并默默无闻地活下去。

但是他们突然成了五胞胎的父母，4女1男。这事使他们的生活发生了根本的变化。五胞胎降生第二天，一架飞机飞抵阿拜丁，随机带来60名记者与摄影师。这条新闻具有全国性的重要意义，因为这对夫妇成了美国仅有的五胞胎的父母。

这家一下子名扬四海。电视摄像机和报纸把消息传送到全国。报纸、杂志出高价向他们购买文字、图片的独家报道权。不但素昧平生的人寄来了大量的礼物，而且婴儿食品、婴儿肥皂制造厂商为了替自己产品做广告也寄来了大量的礼物。这家人住的旧农舍将由一座价值10万美元的新住宅所取代。由于记者纷纷要求会见，他们不得不请了律师充当他们家的发言人举行记者招待会。

眼下，五胞胎还静静地躺在医院婴儿室的氧气帐里，他们的父母却为这名声付出了代价，他们再也无法过正常的生活。他们成了商业化的受害者，因为他们的名字具有了市场价值。这些孩子立即成了商品，而不是5个新的家庭成员了。

46. Do it yourself

So great is our passion for doing things for ourselves, that we are becoming increasingly less dependent on specialized labour. No one can plead ignorance of a subject any longer, for there are countless do - it - yourself publications. Armed with the right tools and materials, newly - weds gaily embark on the task of decorating their own homes. Men, particularly, spend hours of their leisure time installing their own fireplaces, laying out their own gardens; building garages and making furniture. Some really keen enthusiasts go so far as to build their own computers. Shops cater for the do - it - yourself craze not only by running special advisory services for novices, but by offering consumers bits and pieces which they can assemble at home. Such things provide an excellent outlet for pent - up creative energy, but unfortunately not all of us are born handymen.

Some wives tend to believe that their husbands are infinitely resourceful and can fix anything. Even men who can hardly drive a nail in straight are supposed to be born

electricians, carpenters, plumbers and mechanics. When lights fuse, furniture gets rickety, pipes get clogged, or vacuum cleaners fail to operate, some women assume that their husbands will somehow put things right. The worst thing about the do - it - yourself game is that sometimes even men live under the delusion that they can do anything, even when they have repeatedly been proved wrong. It is a question of pride as much as anything else.

Last spring my wife suggested that I call in a man to look at our lawn - mower. It had broken down the previous summer, and though I promised to repair it, I had never got round to it. I would not hear of the suggestion and said that I would fix it myself. One Saturday afternoon, I hauled the machine into the garden and had a close look at it. As far as I could see, it only needed a minor adjustment: a turn of a screw here, a little tightening up there, a drop of oil and it would be as good as new. Inevitably the repair job was not quite so simple. The mower firmly refused to mow, so I decided to dismantle it. The garden was soon littered with chunks of metal which had once made up a lawn - mower. But I was extremely pleased with myself. I had traced the cause of the trouble. One of the links in the chain that drives the wheels had snapped.

After buying a new chain I was faced with the insurmountable task of putting the confusing jigsaw puzzle together again. I was not surprised to find that the machine still refused to work after I had reassembled it, for the simple reason that I was left with several curiously shaped bits of metal which did not seem to fit anywhere. I gave up in despair. The weeks passed and the grass grew. When my wife nagged me to do something about it, I told her that either I would have to buy a new mower or let the grass grow. Needless to say, our garden is still a mess.

自己动手

现在我们自己动手做事的热情很高，结果对于专业工人的依赖越来越少了。由于出版了不计其数的教人自己动手做事的书报杂志，没有人再能说对某事一无所知。新婚夫妇找来合适的工具和材料，喜气洋洋地开始布置新房。特别是男人，常利用空闲时间安装壁炉、布置花园、建造车库、制作家具。有些热衷于自己动手的人甚至自己组装电脑。为了满足自己动手热的需要，商店不仅为初学者提供专门的咨询服务，而且为顾客提供可以在家里组装的零件。这些东西为人们潜在的创造力提供了一个绝妙的用武之地。但不幸的是，我们并非人人都是能工巧匠。

有些妻子往往认为她们的丈夫无比聪明能干，什么东西都能修。哪怕是那些连一枚钉子都钉不直的男人都被认为是天生的电工、木匠、水管工和机械师。每当电灯保险丝烧断、家具榫头松动、管道堵塞、吸尘器不动时，有些女人就会认为她们的丈夫总有办法。自己动手的例子中最糟糕的是，有时甚至是男人尽管接连失败却还误以为自己什么都行，原因就是面子。

去年春天，我妻子让我请人检查一下我家的割草机。那台割草机去年夏天就坏了，尽管我答应修，但一直没抽出时间。我不愿听妻子的建议，说我自己会修。一个星期六的下午，我把割草机拉到了花园里，仔细检查了一番。在我看来，只需稍加调整即可。这儿紧紧螺丝，那儿固定一下，再加几滴油，就会像新的一样了。事实上，修理工作远不是那么简单。割草机就是不肯割草，于是我决定把它拆开。一会儿工夫，花园里七零八落到处都是割草机的金属零件儿。但我却非常高兴，因为我找到了毛病所在。驱动轮上的一根链条断了。

我买来一根新链条后，面临的的就是如何把这些令人眼花缭乱的拼板重新组装起来。等我装完后，那台割草机仍然一动不动，对此我倒并不感到吃惊。原因很简单，因为还剩下几个形状奇特的零件似乎哪里也装不上去。我绝望地放弃了。几个星期过去了，草长了起来。妻子喋喋不休让我想点办法。我告诉她，要么买一台新割草机，要么让草长下去。不用说，我家的花园仍然是一片杂草丛生。

47. Too high a price

Pollution is the price we pay for an overpopulated, over industrialized planet. When you come to think about it, there are only four ways you can deal with rubbish: dump it, burn it, turn it into something you can use again, attempt to produce less of it. We keep trying all four methods, but the sheer volume of rubbish we produce worldwide threatens to overwhelm us. Rubbish, however, is only part of the problem of polluting our planet. The need to produce ever - increasing quantities of cheap food leads to a different kind of pollution. Industrialized farming methods produce cheap meat products: beef, pork and chicken. The use of pesticides and fertilizers produces cheap grain and vegetables. The price we pay for cheap food may be already too high: Mad Cow Disease (BSE) in cattle, salmonella in chicken and eggs, and listeria in dairy products. And if you think you'll abandon meat and become a vegetarian, you have the choice of very expensive organically - grown vegetables or a steady diet of pesticides every time you think you're eating fresh salads and vegetables, or just having an innocent glass of water! However, there is an even more insidious kind of pollution that particularly affects urban areas and invades our daily lives, and that is noise. Burglar alarms going off at any time of the day or night serve only to annoy passers - by and actually assist burglars to burgle. Car alarms constantly scream at us in the street and are a source of profound irritation. A recent survey of the effects of noise revealed (surprisingly?) that dogs barking incessantly in the night rated the highest form of noise pollution on a scale ranging from 1 to 7. The survey revealed a large number of sources of noise that we really dislike: lawn mowers, transistor radios, motorcycles, etc. New technology has also made its own

contribution to noise. A lot of people object to mobile phones, especially when they are used in public places like restaurants or on public transport. Loud conversations on mobile phones invade our thoughts or interrupt the pleasure of meeting friends for a quiet chat. The noise pollution survey revealed a rather surprising and possibly amusing old - fashioned source of noise. It seems we are at our noisiest when we are asleep! The rattling noise of the alarm clock at the bedside wakes us up. What an irritating way to start the day! It doesn't have to be this way. There are laws in most cities to stop factories emitting black smoke into the atmosphere, and there are also laws which force people to adopt anti - pollution measures, but these laws are not always rigidly enforced. It is cheaper for companies to break the laws and pay the fines than to buy the expensive equipment that will reduce the pollution. It is also cheaper for people to continue to throw rubbish away than to spend time and money on recycling. Noise pollution is at its worst in cities. It can make people ill, or drive them mad. It is a problem that we cannot afford to ignore.

代价太高

污染就是我们为这个人口过密，过度工业化的星球所付出的代价。当我们开始考虑垃圾问题时，我们只有4种对付垃圾的方法：倾倒、焚烧、把垃圾变成再生材料或试图少产生一些垃圾。我们一直在试这4种方式，但是，我们在世界范围内仅产生的垃圾的量就有把我们覆盖的危险。然而，垃圾只是我们这个星球的污染问题的一个方面。日益增长的对廉价食物的需求导致了另一种形式的污染。工业化的农作方式生产出了廉价的肉类制品——牛肉、猪肉和鸡肉。使用杀虫剂和化肥生产出了廉价的谷物和蔬菜。为了廉价食物我们付出的代价已经太高了：牛肉中的疯牛病，鸡肉和鸡蛋中的沙门氏菌，奶制品中的利斯特杆菌。如果你想放弃肉类而变成一位素食者，那么你可以两者择一：或是选用价格昂贵、有机培植的蔬菜，或是当你认为在享用新鲜色拉和新鲜蔬菜或饮用一杯无害的水的时候，实际上每次都不断吃进杀虫剂。但是，还有一种更加隐蔽有害的污染，它专门影响城镇地区，侵袭我们的日常生活，那就是噪音。防盗警报器在白天和黑夜的任何时候都会响起来，它的作用只是骚扰过路人，而实际上却帮助窃贼入室行窃。在街上，汽车的防盗警报不断对我们吼叫，这是人们极度烦躁的一个原因。最近一个有关噪音的作用的调查（令人吃惊地）指出，夜间连续不断的狗叫声在一个从1级至7级刻度表上应列为最严重的噪音污染。这个调查揭示了我们所不喜欢的大量的噪音的来源：剪草机、收音机、摩托车等等。新技术也为噪音作出了它的贡献。许多人都反对移动式电话，特别是在如饭店，公共交通工具等公共场所使用移动电话。用移动电话大声交谈干扰我们的思路，破坏我们和朋友在一起轻声聊天所得到的乐趣。这个有关噪音的污染调查还揭示了一种出人意外而同时可能会引人发笑的老式噪音源。看起来似乎我们在睡觉时是最吵的！床边闹钟的铃铃响声把我们唤醒。多么令人恼怒的开始一天的方式啊！事情不必定要这样。大多数城市都有制止工厂向大气层排放黑烟的法令，也有些法律要求人们采取措施减少污染，但是这些法律并未被严格执行。对公司来说，违犯法律，交点罚金要比购买昂贵的防止污染设备要便宜得多。对人们来说，继续扔掉垃圾要比花时间和金钱去回收垃圾便宜得多。噪音污染在城市中最严重。它可以使人生病，也能使人发疯。对这个问题我们不能漠然不顾。

48. The Silent Village

In this much - travelled world, there are still thousands of places which are inaccessible to tourists. We always assume that villagers in remote places are friendly and hospitable. But people who are cut off not only from foreign tourists, but even from their own countrymen can be hostile to travellers. Visits to really remote villages are seldom enjoyable - as my wife and I discovered during a tour through the Balkans.

We had spent several days in a small town and visited a number of old churches in the vicinity. These attracted many visitors, for they were not only of great architectural interest, but contained a large number of beautifully preserved frescoes as well. On the day before our departure, several bus loads of tourists descended on the town. This was more than we could bear, so we decided to spend our last day exploring the countryside. Taking a path which led out of the town, we crossed a few fields until we came to a dense wood. We expected the path to end abruptly, but we found that it traced its way through the trees. We tramped through the wood for over two hours until we arrived at a deep stream. We could see that the path continued on the other side, but we had no idea how we could get across the stream. Suddenly my wife spotted a boat moored to the bank. In it there was a boatman fast asleep. We gently woke him up and asked him to ferry us across the stream. The boatman got up, stretched himself and made ready to set off. He was a huge man, well over six feet tall, and broad in proportion, and his muscles bulged out of his shirt sleeves as he rowed. The boat glided smoothly across the lake and we got out on the opposite bank. We were about to walk away when the boatman called out to us. He said something in his local dialect which we could not understand, but he motioned to us to wait. He then went back to the boat and brought out a large tin box. He placed it on the ground in front of us and opened it. Inside were dozens of beautifully carved wooden animals. He had carved them himself, and they were all as different as the villagers whom we had left behind. The boatman wanted an exorbitant amount of money for them, but we had no choice but to pay up. After all, we had no idea how we could get back without his boat. We made our way back to the town as quickly as possible, but we were not in time to catch the bus for our next destination. So we had to hire a car and drive to the airport. The journey was long and tiring, but we were glad to be away from the Silent Village.

沉默的村庄

在这个旅游频繁的世界里，仍有成千上万个游人足迹未至的地方。我们总认为，偏僻地方的村民们是友好、好客的。但是，那些不但与外国旅游者隔绝，而且与本国同胞隔绝的人们有可能对游客抱有敌意。到真正偏僻的村庄去旅游并不是一件愉快的事情，我与妻子在

一次周游巴尔干半岛时对此深有体会。

我们在一座小镇上逗留了几天，参观了附近的许多古老的教堂。这些教堂吸引了大量游客，不仅是因为建筑风格奇特，而且还存有大量保存完好的壁画。在我们离开的前一天，好几辆公共汽车载着游客涌进了小镇。人多得使我们难以忍受，于是我们决定利用最后一天去乡间一游。我们走上了一条出镇的小路，穿过几块农田，来到一片茂密的树林。我们原以为小路会到此突然终止，没想到它在树林中继续向前延伸。我们在树林中跋涉了两个多小时，到了一条深溪边。我们可以看到小路在对岸继续向前伸展，但却不知如何过河。突然，我妻子发现岸边停着一条小船，船上有个船夫睡得正香。我们轻轻地把他唤醒，请他把我们摆渡过溪。船夫站起身来，伸了伸懒腰，就准备出发了。他是个大块头，足有六英尺多高，而且身材魁梧，当他划船的时候，他衬衫的袖子都鼓了起来。小船轻快地划过湖面，我们在对岸下了船。我们正要走开时，船夫朝我们叫了起来。他用当地的方言说了些什么，我们听不懂，但是他示意我们等一下。然后他回到船上，拿出一个大铁皮箱。他把箱子放在我们面前的地上并打开它。箱子里有几十只精心雕刻的木兽。这些木兽都是他亲手雕刻的，每一只都各不相同，就像我们离开的那些村民一样。船夫向我们索要的价钱高得离谱，但我们别无选择，只好照付。毕竟，没有他的船我们不知道怎样才能回去。我们尽快地返回小镇，但还是没能赶上前往下一个目的地的公共汽车。于是我们只好雇了一辆汽车，驱车前往机场。旅途漫长而又劳累，但我们很高兴离开了那个沉默的村庄。

49. The Ideal Servant

It is a good thing my aunt Harriet died years ago. If she were alive today she would not be able to air her views on her favourite topic of conversation: domestic servants. Aunt Harriet lived in that leisurely age when servants were employed to do housework. She had a huge, rambling country house called 'The Gables'. She was sentimentally attached to this house, for even though it was far too big for her needs, she persisted in living there long after her husband's death. Before she grew old, Aunt Harriet used to entertain lavishly. I often visited The Gables when I was a boy. No matter how many guests were present, the great house was always immaculate. The parquet floors shone like mirrors; highly polished silver was displayed in gleaming glass cabinets; even my uncle's huge collection of books was kept miraculously free from dust. Aunt Harriet presided over an invisible army of servants that continuously scrubbed, cleaned, and polished. She always referred to them as 'the shifting population', for they came and went with such frequency that I never even got a chance to learn their names. Though my aunt pursued what was, in those days, an enlightened policy, in that she never allowed her domestic staff to work more than eight hours a day, she was extremely difficult to please. While she always decried the fickleness of human nature, she carried on an unrelenting search for the ideal servant to the end of her days, even after she had been seriously

weakened by a stroke. Even when she was unable to speak, still her eyes, full of pain and suffering, expressed her unspoken thoughts. Her last message to me consisted of a single word: 'Servants'.

理想的仆人

我的姑妈哈丽特好多年前就去世了，这倒是件好事。如果她活到今天，她将不能就她热衷的话题“佣人”发表意见了。哈丽特姑妈生活在一个悠闲的年代，那时家务活是被雇来的佣人做的。她在乡下有一幢巨大杂乱的房子，叫作“山墙庄园”。她对这幢房子在感情上难舍难分。房子实在太大了，但在丈夫去世多年后，她仍然执意长年住在那儿。哈丽特姑妈年轻时，喜欢大摆宴席，招待宾客。我小时候常去“山墙庄园”作客。不管去多少宾客，大房子里总是收拾得干干净净。镶木地板洁如明镜，擦得发亮的银器陈列在明亮的玻璃柜里，连姑夫的大量藏书也保存得很好，奇迹般地一尘不染。哈丽特姑妈统率着一支看不见的佣人大军，他们不停地擦拭、清扫、刷洗。她称这些佣人叫“流动人口”，因为他们来匆匆，所以我甚至都没有机会知道他们的名字。姑妈待佣人在当时算是开明的，比如从来不让佣人每天工作超过8小时，但她很难伺候。她一方面总是批评人的本性朝三暮四，另一方面她又持之以恒地寻找一个理想的佣人。即使在她因中风之后，身体已经很虚弱了，她仍然坚持寻找。甚至当她不能说话的时候，她的眼睛，虽然充满了痛苦，却表达出她未说出口的想法。她给我的最后口信只包含一个词：“佣人”。

50. New Year Resolutions

The New Year is a time for resolutions. Mentally, at least, most of us could compile formidable lists of 'dos' and 'don'ts'. The same old favourites recur year in year out with monotonous regularity. We resolve to get up earlier each morning, eat less, find more time to play with the children, do a thousand and one jobs about the house, be nice to people we don't like, drive carefully, and take the dog for a walk every day. Past experience has taught us that certain accomplishments are beyond attainment. If we remain inveterate smokers, it is only because we have so often experienced the frustration that results from failure. Most of us fail in our efforts at self-improvement because our schemes are too ambitious and we never have time to carry them out. We also make the fundamental error of announcing our resolutions to everybody so that we look even more foolish when we slip back into our bad old ways. Aware of these pitfalls, this year I attempted to keep my resolutions to myself. I limited myself to two modest ambitions: to do physical exercises every morning and to read more of an evening. An all-night party on New Year's Eve provided me with a good excuse for not carrying out either of these new resolutions on the first day of the New Year, but on the second, I applied myself assiduously to the task.

The daily exercises lasted only eleven minutes and I proposed to do them early in the morning before anyone had got up. The self - discipline required to drag myself out of bed eleven minutes earlier than usual was considerable. Nevertheless, I managed to creep down into the living - room for two days before anyone found me out. After jumping about on the carpet and twisting the human frame into uncomfortable positions, I sat down at the breakfast table in an exhausted state. It was this that betrayed me. My wife was sitting opposite me, looking rather glum.

'You don't look very well,' she said. 'Is something wrong?'

'I've been doing my exercises,' I said.

'What exercises?' she asked in surprise.

'Jumping about on the carpet and twisting the human frame into uncomfortable positions,' I replied.

'Good heavens!' she exclaimed. 'Why on earth are you doing that?'

'Well, I've made a resolution to do physical exercises every morning,' I explained.

'But you don't look as if you've been doing physical exercises,' she said.

'I haven't finished yet,' I said. 'I've only been doing them for two days.'

'You're making a fool of yourself,' she said. 'You can't expect to improve your physical condition in two days. You need at least a couple of weeks.'

'I know,' I said. 'But I'm determined to carry out my resolution.'

'I'm sure you are,' she said. 'But you're still making a fool of yourself.'

I decided to give up the exercises, because it was clear that my wife was right. I had been making a fool of myself. It was not so much my appearance that betrayed me as my lack of energy. I realized that if I continued to do the exercises, I would be making a fool of myself even more. So I abandoned the idea of physical exercises and concentrated on my second resolution: reading more of an evening. This was easier said than done, because I soon discovered that I had not got the necessary books. I had been thinking about buying some new books for a long time, but I had always postponed the purchase. Now that I had made a resolution to read more, I needed to buy some books. I went to the local bookstore, but I could not find any books that I really wanted to buy. I was disappointed, but I did not give up. I went to another bookstore, and this time I found some books that I liked. I bought them and took them home. I was pleased with my purchase, but I knew that I still had a long way to go before I could say that I had carried out my resolution. I needed to find

time to read the books, and I needed to make sure that I did not slip back into my bad old ways of not reading enough.

新年的决心

新年是下决心的时候，至少在大多数人的心里会编排出一份“应做什么”和“不应做什么”的令人生畏的单子。相同的决心以单调的规律年复一年地出现。我们决心每天早晨起得早些；吃得少些；多花点时间与孩子们一起做游戏；做大量的家务；对不喜欢的人友善一些；小心驾车；每天都要带着狗散步；以往的经验告诉我们有些事是办不到的。如果我们烟瘾大，戒不掉，那是因为屡戒屡败，失去了信心。我们大多数人想自我完善却遭到失败，这是因为我们的规划过于宏大，而又根本没有时间去实施。我们还犯有一个根本性的错误，即把我们的决心向大家宣布。这样一旦滑回到那些老习惯上去，我们在别人的眼里会显得更加难堪。我深知这些问题，于是，今年我对自己的计划要严加保密。我只给自己定下两项适中的任务：每天早上锻炼身体，每天晚上多看点书。新年除夕举办的一次通宵晚会，使我理直气壮地在新年头一天免去了这两项任务。不过，新年第二天，我全力以赴地照着去做了。

早锻炼一共只有11分钟，我打算在别人起床之前进行。这就要求我比平时早11分钟把自己从床上拽起来，这种自我约束是很艰苦的。不过，两天来我还是成功地偷偷进入了起居室。我在地毯上跳来蹦去，扭曲身子，摆出各种难受的姿势之后，坐到餐桌旁吃早饭，一副筋疲力尽的样子。正是这一点暴露了我的秘密。我的妻子坐在对面，看上去一脸的不高兴。

“你看上去不太好，”她说，“是不是病了？”

“我一直在锻炼。”我说。

“什么锻炼？”她惊讶地问。

“在地毯上跳来蹦去，扭曲身子，摆出各种难受的姿势。”我回答道。

“天哪！”她惊叫道，“你究竟为什么要那样做呢？”

“嗯，我已经决定每天早上做锻炼。”我解释说。

“但你看上去不像是锻炼过的样子。”她说。

“我还没做完呢，”我说，“我才做了两天。”

“你在出自己的洋相。”她说，“你不可能期望在两天之内改善自己的身体状况。你至少需要几个星期。”

“我知道，”我说，“但我决心执行我的计划。”

“我相信你是这样的，”她说，“但你仍然在出自己的洋相。”

我决定放弃锻炼，因为很明显我妻子是对的。我一直在出自己的洋相。与其说是我的外表暴露了我的秘密，不如说是我缺乏精力。我意识到如果我继续锻炼下去，我会更加出自己的洋相。于是我放弃了锻炼计划，集中精力去实现我的第二个计划：晚上多看点书。说起

来容易做起来难，因为我很快发现我没有必要的书。我一直想买几本新书，但总是推迟购买。现在我已决定要多看书，就需要买些书。我去了当地的书店，但找不到我真正想买的书。我很失望，但没有放弃。我又去了另一家书店，这次我找到了一些我喜欢的书。我把它们买回家。我对自己的购买感到满意，但我知道，在我能够说我已经执行了我的计划之前，我还有很长的路要走。我需要找时间读书，而且我需要确保自己不会再滑回到过去读书不够的老习惯中去。

51. Predicting the future

Predicting the future is notoriously difficult. Who could have imagined, in the mid 1970s, for example, that by the end of the 20th century, computers would be as common in people's homes as TV sets? In the 1970s, computers were common enough, but only in big business, government departments, and large organizations. These were the so - called mainframe machines. Mainframe computers were very large indeed, often occupying whole air - conditioned rooms, employing full - time technicians and run on specially - written software. Though these large machines still exist, many of their functions have been taken over by small powerful personal computers, commonly known as PCs.

No one could have foreseen, in those days, the rise of these machines called PCs, in which people could type in commands instead of punching holes in cards. It has become clear that the Internet - the computers - network is one of the most powerful tools for the 21st century. School children who know how to use the Internet will be at a great advantage over those who don't. There is no doubt that all this new technology is changing the way we work and offering many other ways of working. We no longer have to work at the same time, at the same place every day. People can telecommute in their pajamas if they like. A recent survey in the United States showed that 80% of all companies interviewed were either already using or planning to use the Internet in their business.

One of the greatest benefits of Internet shopping is that it is open seven days a week, 24 hours a day. Shoppers no longer have to queue up in stores during the rush - hour. This is a great convenience for those who are too busy to go to the stores during regular business hours. The Internet also makes it easier for companies to keep in touch with their customers and for people to keep in touch with each other. Companies can e - mail newsletters to their customers. And families and friends can send e - mails to each other instead of writing letters or making phone calls.

Another big advantage of the Internet is the amount of information that is available.

There are sites on the Internet that list the full text of books. Some sites allow you to download entire books. Other sites offer encyclopedias, dictionaries, and other reference materials. You can also find newspapers, magazines, and other periodicals on the Internet. And, of course, there are millions of web pages with all kinds of information on them.

Predicting the future of the Internet is also difficult. Some experts believe that the Internet will continue to grow and expand. They think that more and more people will use the Internet, and that it will become even more powerful. Others believe that the Internet will become overcrowded and that its growth will slow down. There are also concerns about security. How can we be sure that our e - mail messages are private? How can we be sure that the information we download from the Internet is accurate? These are all questions that need to be answered as the Internet continues to grow.

But one thing is certain: the Internet has changed our lives, and it will continue to change our lives in the future.

预测未来

众所周知，预测未来是非常困难的。例如，在20世纪70年代中期，谁能想象得到在20世纪末的时候，计算机在人们的家庭会像电视机一样普及呢？在20世纪70年代，计算机已经相当普及了，但只是在大企业、政府部门和大型组织中使用。这些就是所谓的大型主机。大型计算机确实非常大，常常占据整个装有空调的房间，聘用专职的技术人员，而且得用专门编写的软件才能运行。虽然这些大型计算机仍然存在，但是它们的许多功能已被体积小但功能强大的个人计算机（通常称为PC机）所取代了。

当时，没有人能预见到这些被称为PC机的机器的兴起，在PC机上人们可以输入指令，而不是在卡片上打孔。显然，互联网——计算机网络是21世纪最强大的工具之一。会使用互联网的学龄儿童比不会使用的儿童将具有很大的优势。毫无疑问，所有这些新技术正在改变我们的工作方式，并提供许多其他的工作方式。我们不再需要每天在同一时间、同一地点工作。如果愿意的话，人们可以穿着睡衣在家办公。美国最近的一项调查显示，80%接受采访的公司要么已经在业务中使用互联网，要么正计划使用互联网。

网上购物的最大好处之一是它每周7天、每天24小时营业。购物者不再需要在高峰时段在商店里排队等候。这对于那些太忙而无法在正常营业时间去商店的人来说是非常方便的。互联网也使公司更容易与客户保持联系，也使人们更容易相互保持联系。公司可以向客户发送电子邮件时事通讯。家人和朋友可以互相发送电子邮件，而不用写信或打电话。

互联网的另一个巨大优势是可获取的信息量。互联网上有列出书籍全文的网站。有些网站允许你下载整本书。其他网站提供百科全书、词典和其他参考资料。你还可以在互联网上找到报纸、杂志和其他期刊。当然，还有数百万个包含各种信息的网页。

预测互联网的未来也很困难。一些专家认为，互联网将继续发展和扩张。他们认为，将有越来越多的人使用互联网，而且互联网将变得更加强大。其他人则认为，互联网将变得过

于拥挤，其增长速度将会放慢。人们也对安全问题表示担忧。我们如何确保我们的电子邮件是私人的呢？我们如何确保我们从互联网上下载的信息是准确的呢？随着互联网的不断发展，这些都是需要回答的问题。

但有一点是肯定的：互联网已经改变了我们的生活，而且它将继续改变我们的生活。

52. Mud is Mud

My cousin, Harry, keeps a large curiously-shaped bottle on permanent display in his study. Despite the fact that the bottle is tinted a delicate shade of green, an observant visitor would soon notice that it is filled with what looks like a thick, grayish substance.

If you were to ask Harry what was in the bottle, he would tell you that it contained perfumed mud. If you expressed doubt or surprise, he would immediately invite you to smell it and then to rub some into your skin. This brief experiment would dispel any further doubts you might have. The bottle really does contain perfumed mud.

How Harry came into the possession of this outlandish stuff makes an interesting story which he is fond of relating. Furthermore, the acquisition of this bottle cured him of a bad habit he had been developing for years.

Harry used to consider it a great joke to go into expensive cosmetic shops and make outrageous requests for goods that do not exist. He would invent fanciful names on the spot. On entering a shop, he would ask for a new perfume called 'Scented Shadow' or for 'insoluble bath cubes'. If a shop assistant told him she had not heard of it, he would pretend to be considerably put out. He loved to be told that one of his imaginary products was temporarily out of stock and he would faithfully promise to call again at some future date, but of course he never did. How Harry managed to keep a straight face during these performances is quite beyond me.

Harry does not need to be prompted to explain how he bought his precious bottle of mud. One day, while he was on holiday, he visited a temple. He noticed that there was an unusual amount of activity going on around an apparently derelict building. Asking around, he discovered that a monk had been living there for years. The monk had been violating the law, repeatedly begging for alms in the town. The townspeople were not very happy about this, but they did not want to offend the monk. They just wished he would go away.

Finally, the townspeople could not stand it any longer and decided to do something

about it. They called in a local builder. The builder inspected the building and said that he would be able to make it habitable with a bit of repair work. The townspeople were very happy to hear this and immediately set about collecting money from the public. The builder said that he would start work as soon as he received the money.

The monk, who had heard about this, was not very happy. He did not want to lose his home. He thought of a plan. He went to a nearby cosmetics factory and bought a large bottle of perfumed mud. He took it back to the temple and poured it all over the building. When the townspeople and the builder arrived, they were horrified. The building was covered in a thick layer of grayish mud. The builder said that he could not possibly repair the building now. The townspeople were angry with the monk, but they did not want to get their hands dirty trying to clean it up. They just left the monk alone in his muddy building.

Harry, who had witnessed all this, was very amused. He thought that the monk was very clever. He decided to buy the bottle of mud from the monk. The monk was happy to sell it to him. Harry took the bottle home and put it on permanent display in his study.

实事求是

我的堂兄哈里在他的书房里一直摆着一只形状古怪的大瓶子。尽管那只瓶子呈淡绿色，但细心的客人很快就会发现瓶里装的是一种看上去黏稠、颜色发灰的东西。

要是你问哈里瓶里装着什么，他会告诉你是香水泥。如果你表示怀疑或惊奇，他会立即请你闻一闻，然后往你皮肤上擦一些。这一简单的试验会消除你可能存有的一切疑虑。瓶子里装的确的确是香水泥。

哈里如何得到这种稀奇古怪的东西的，这里有个有趣的故事，而且他挺爱把它讲给别人听。此外，得到这瓶香水泥还治好了他多年的一个坏习惯。

哈里过去常常把走进高档化妆品商店，荒腔走板地索求根本不存在的商品当成一大乐事。他会当场编造出一些稀奇古怪的商品名。一走进商店，他就会索要一种名叫“香影”的新型香水或者是“不溶浴皂”。要是女售货员告诉他从未听说过这些东西，他会装出十分懊恼的样子。他爱听售货员说他虚构的商品暂时脱销，于是他就煞有介事地许诺改天再来光顾。当然，他再也不会来了。我真不明白哈里在这些表演中是怎样装出一本正经的样子的。

无须暗示哈里就会向你讲起他买下那瓶珍贵香水泥的经过。一天，他在度假的时候去了一座寺庙。他注意到有一座看上去已被遗弃的建筑物周围活动异常。他四处打听，发现一位和尚已经在那儿住了多年。这位和尚一直违反戒律，在镇上反复化缘。镇上的人对此很不高兴，但又不想得罪这位和尚。他们只希望他能离开。

最后，镇上的人再也无法忍受了，决定采取行动。他们叫来当地的一位建筑工人。建筑工

人查看了这座建筑物后说，稍加修缮就能让它住人。镇上的人听到这个消息非常高兴，立即着手向公众集资。建筑工人说他一收到钱就开工。

和尚听说了这件事，很不高兴。他不想失去自己的住所。他想出了一个主意。他到附近的一家化妆品厂买了一大瓶香水泥。他把香水泥带回寺庙，全部倒在建筑物上。当镇上的人和建筑工人到达时，他们被眼前的景象吓坏了。建筑物被一层厚厚的灰泥覆盖着。建筑工人说他现在根本无法修缮这座建筑物了。镇上的人对和尚很生气，但又不想弄脏自己的手去清理它。他们只好任由和尚独自呆在他那满是泥污的建筑物里。

哈里目睹了这一切，觉得非常好笑。他认为和尚很聪明。他决定从和尚那儿买下那瓶香水泥。和尚很乐意把它卖给他。哈里把瓶子带回家，放在书房里永久展示。

53. In the Public Interest

The Scandinavian countries are much admired all over the world for their enlightened social policies. Sweden has evolved an excellent system for protecting the individual citizen from high - handed or incompetent public officers. The system has worked so well, that it has been adopted in other countries too.

The Swedes were the first to recognize that public official like civil servants, police officers, health inspectors or tax - collectors can make mistakes or act over - zealously in the belief that they are serving the public. As long ago as 1809, the Swedish Parliament introduced a scheme to safeguard the interest of the individual. A parliamentary committee representing all political parties appoints a person who is suitably qualified to investigate private grievances against the State. The official title of the person is 'Justiteombudsman', but the Swedes commonly refer to him as the 'J.O.' or 'Ombudsman'.

The Ombudsman is not subject to political pressure. He investigates complaints large and small that come to him from all levels of society. As complaints must be made in writing, the Ombudsman receives an average of 1,200 letters a year. He has eight lawyer assistants to help him and he examines every single letter in detail. There is nothing secretive about the Ombudsman's work, for his correspondence is open to public inspection. If a citizen's complaint is justified, the Ombudsman will act on his behalf. The action he takes varies according to the nature of the complaint. He may gently reprimand an official or even suggest to parliament that a law be altered. The following case is a typical example of the Ombudsman's work.

A foreigner living in a Swedish village wrote to the Ombudsman complaining that he had been ill - treated by the police, simply because he was a foreigner. The

Ombudsman immediately wrote to the Chief of Police in the district asking him to send a record of the case. There was nothing in the record to show that the foreigner's complaints were justified. The Ombudsman nevertheless decided to carry out an investigation, for he had received similar complaints from other foreigners in the area. He sent a form to the police chief asking him to make a list of all the foreign residents in the district. The police chief did so and sent the list to the Ombudsman. The Ombudsman then sent a letter to each of the foreigners asking them to describe their experiences with the police. In reply, he received a number of letters from the foreigners which told of the same kind of ill - treatment by the police. These letters enabled the Ombudsman to prove that the police had acted unjustly. He reprimanded the police chief in writing and demanded that he send a written apology to the foreigner. The police chief complied and the foreigner was satisfied.

The Ombudsman's job is not an easy one. He often has to work long hours, and he has to be able to stand up to political pressure. But he is highly respected for his integrity and his impartiality.

为了公众的利益

斯堪的纳维亚半岛各国实行的开明的社会政策，受到全世界的推崇。瑞典已制定了一种完善的制度，以保护每个公民不受专横的和不能称职的政府官员的欺压。由于这种制度行之有效，已被其他国家采纳。

瑞典人最早认识到，像公务员、警察、卫生稽查员、税务人员等等这类公职人员可能会犯错误或者工作过度热心，他们深信自己是在为公众服务。早在1809年，瑞典议会就建立了一个保护公民利益的制度。议会内有一个代表各政党利益的委员会，由它委派一位称职的人选专门调查个人对国家的意见。此人官衔为“司法特派员”，但瑞典人一般都称他为“J. O.”或者“特派员”。

司法特派员不受任何政治压力的制约。他调查来自社会各阶层的大大小的申诉案件。由于申诉必须以书面形式提出，司法特派员每年平均收到1,200封信。他有8位律师作他的助手，他们仔细审查每一封信。司法特派员的工作没有什么秘密可言，他的信件是公开的，供公众监督。如果公民的申诉有理，司法特派员便为他伸张正义。司法特派员采取的行动因申诉案件性质的不同而有所不同。他可以善意地批评某位官员，也可以甚至向议会提议修改某项法律。下面是司法特派员工作的一个典型例子。

一个住在瑞典乡村的外国人写信给司法特派员，抱怨说他受到警察的虐待，原因就是他是外国人。司法特派员立即写信给当地的警察局长，请他寄送与此事有关材料。材料中没有任何文字记载表明这个外国人的申诉是有理的。尽管如此，司法特派员还是决定进行调查，因为他收到了这个地区其他外国人的类似申诉。他给警察局长送去一份表格，要他列出这个地区所有的外国居民。警察局长照办了，并把名单送交给司法特派员。司法特派员随后给每个外国人寄去一封信，要他们描述一下他们与警察打交道的经历。他收到了外国人的许多来信，信中讲述了警察同样的虐待行为。这些信件使司法特派员得以证实警察

的行为是不公正的。他书面批评了警察局长，并要求他向这位外国人书面道歉。警察局长照办了，这个外国人满意了。

司法特派员的工作并不轻松。他常常要长时间地工作，而且还要能顶住政治方面的压力。但他因自己的正直和公正而受到高度的尊敬。

54. Instinct or Cleverness

We have been brought up to fear insects. We regard them as unnecessary creatures that do more harm than good. Man continually wages war on them, for they contaminate his food, carry diseases, or devour his crops. They sting or bite without provocation; they fly uninvited into our rooms on summer nights, or beat against our lighted windows.

We live in dread not only of unpleasant insects like spiders or wasps, but of quite harmless one like moths. Reading about them increases our understanding without dispelling our fears. Knowing that the industrious ant lives in a highly organized society does nothing to prevent us from being filled with revulsion when we find hordes of them crawling over a carefully prepared picnic lunch.

No matter how much we like honey, or how much we have read about the uncanny sense of direction which bees possess, we have a horror of being stung. Most of our fears are unreasonable, but they are impossible to erase. At the same time, however, insects are strangely fascinating. We enjoy reading about them, especially when we find that, like the praying mantis, they lead perfectly horrible lives. We enjoy staring at them, entranced as they go about their business, unaware (we hope) of our presence. Who has not stood in awe at the sight of a spider pouncing on a fly, or a column of ants triumphantly bearing home an enormous dead beetle?

Last summer I spent days in the garden watching thousands of ants crawling up the trunk of my prize peach tree. The tree has grown against a warm wall on a sheltered side of the house. I am especially proud of it, not only because it has survived several severe winters, but because it occasionally produces luscious peaches. During the summer, I noticed that the leaves of the tree were beginning to wither. Clusters of tiny insects called aphids were to be found on the underside of the leaves. They were sucking sap from the underside of the leaves of my prize peach tree. I immediately fetched a can of insecticide and sprayed the underside of the leaves thoroughly. I repeated the spraying operation several times before I felt satisfied that I had got rid of all the aphids. For two more weeks, I watched the tree

carefully. It seemed that the aphids were gone and the tree was beginning to thrive again. Then, without warning, a large number of ants began to climb the tree. They were making their way up the trunk in long, thin lines. As soon as they reached the underside of the leaves, they set to work on the aphids. They were carrying the aphids' eggs; they were licking the aphids; they were taking care of the aphids all in return for a little sap which the aphids secrete. I realized that I had been wrong in thinking that the ants were simply thieves. They were in fact the protectors of the aphids. The aphids were supplying the ants with food, and the ants were protecting the aphids from the insecticide spray. It is not always easy to distinguish between things that are beneficial and things that are harmful. It is often necessary to make a distinction between instinct and cleverness.

是本能还是机智

我们自幼就在对昆虫的惧怕中长大。我们把昆虫当作害多益少的无用东西。人类不断地同昆虫斗争，因为昆虫弄脏我们的食物，传播疾病，吞噬庄稼。它们无缘无故地又叮又咬；夏天的夜晚，它们未经邀请便飞到我们房间里，或者对着露出亮光的窗户乱扑乱撞。

我们在日常生活中，不但憎恶如蜘蛛、黄蜂之类令人讨厌的昆虫，而且憎恶并无大害的飞蛾等。阅读有关昆虫的书能增加我们对它们的了解，却不能消除我们的恐惧。即使知道勤奋的蚂蚁生活具有高度组织性的社会里，当看到大群蚂蚁在我们精心准备的午间野餐上爬行时，我们也无法抑制对它们的反感。

不管我们多么爱吃蜂蜜，或读过多少关于蜜蜂具有神秘的识别方向的灵感的书，我们仍然害怕被蜂蜇。我们的恐惧大部分是没有道理的，但却无法消除。同时，不知为什么昆虫又是迷人的。我们喜欢看有关昆虫的书，尤其是当我们了解到螳螂等过着一种令人生畏的生活时，就更加爱读有关昆虫的书了。我们喜欢入迷地看它们做事，它们不知道（但愿如此）我们就在它们身边。当看到蜘蛛扑向一只苍蝇时，一队蚂蚁抬着一只巨大的死甲虫凯旋归时，谁能不感到敬畏呢？

去年夏天，我花了好几天时间站在花园里观察成千只蚂蚁爬上我那棵心爱的桃树的树干。那棵树是靠着房子有遮挡的一面暖墙生长的。我为这棵树感到特别自豪，不仅因为它度过了几个寒冬终于活了下来，而且还因为它有时结出些甘甜的桃子来。到了夏天，我发现树叶开始枯萎，结果在树叶背面找到成串的叫作蚜虫的小虫子。它们正在吸吮汁液，这汁液是从我的心爱的桃树上的树叶背面吸吮出来的。我当即动手作了一只捕虫网，用来捕杀蚜虫。我把树叶的背面彻底地喷了一遍杀虫剂。我反复喷了几次，直到我认为把所有的蚜虫都消灭了为止。之后的两个多星期，我仔细地观察着这棵树。看来蚜虫是消灭了，桃树又开始茁壮成长了。后来，不知怎么搞的，大量的蚂蚁开始爬上树来。它们沿着树干往上爬，长长的队伍成一条细线。它们一到树叶背面，就开始对蚜虫进行工作。它们搬运蚜虫的卵；它们舔食蚜虫；它们照料蚜虫，所有这一切都是为了换取蚜虫分泌的一小点汁液。我这才意识到我错怪了蚂蚁。它们实际上是蚜虫的保护者。蚜虫供给蚂蚁食物，蚂蚁保护蚜虫免遭杀虫剂的毒害。分清有利和有害的事物往往并非易事。常常需要区分本能和机智。

55. From the Earth: Greetings

Recent developments in astronomy have made it possible to detect planets in our own Milky Way and in other galaxies. This is a major achievement because, in relative terms, planets are very small and do not emit light. Finding planets is proving hard enough, but finding life on them will prove infinitely more difficult. The first question to answer is whether a planet can actually support life. In our own solar system, for example, Venus is far too hot and Mars is far too cold to support life. Only the Earth provides ideal conditions, and even here it has taken more than four billion years for plant and animal life to evolve.

Whether a planet can support life depends on the size and brightness of its star, that is its 'sun'. Imagine a star up to twenty times larger, brighter and hotter than our own sun. A planet would have to be a very long way from it to be capable of supporting life. On the other hand, if the star were small, the life - supporting planet would have to have a close orbit round it and also provide the perfect conditions for water: not too hot and not too cold, as otherwise water would turn to vapour or ice.

Secondly, we may wonder whether there is life on other planets. At present we can only detect life - forms that are based on carbon. Consequently, a search for non - carbon - based life forms may prove to be a fruitless search. However, it is probably a mistake to assume that other life - forms would be similar to our own. They might not need water or oxygen, or even light, as we do. Instead, they might have developed other ways of growing, moving or reproducing.

Finally, we may ask whether life on other planets would be friendly or hostile to us. The answer to this question depends on whether we consider them as potential friends or foes. If we consider them as friends, we will be more likely to welcome them. If we consider them as foes, we will be more likely to fear them. However, given the vastness of the universe, it is more likely that we will never know the answer to this question.

来自地球的问候

天文学方面最新发展使得我们能够在银河系和其他星系发现行星。这是一个重要的成就，因为相对来说，行星很小，而且也不发光。寻找行星已被证明是相当困难的，但要在行星上发现生命则是难上加难。第一个需要解答的问题是一颗行星是否有能够维持生命的条件。举例来说，在我们的太阳系里，金星太热，火星太冷，均不适合生命存活。只有地球提供了理想的条件，而即使在这里，植物和动物的进化也用了40多亿年的时间。

一颗行星是否能维持生命取决于它的恒星也就是它的“太阳”的大小和亮度。设想一下，一颗恒星比我们的太阳还要大、还要亮、还要热20倍，那么一颗行星为了维持生命就要离它非常远。另一方面，如果恒星很小，维持生命的行星就要在离它很近的轨道上运行，而

且要有完美的水的条件：不能太热也不能太冷，否则水就会变成蒸气或者冰。

其次，我们也许会想其他行星上是否存在生命。目前我们只能探测到以碳为基础的生命形式。因此，去探寻不以碳为基础的生命形式可能是徒劳无益的。然而，认为其他生命形式会和我们一样，这可能是个错误。它们可能不像我们这样需要水或氧气，甚至不需要光。相反，它们可能已经发展出其他的生长、移动或繁殖方式。

最后，我们也许会问，其他行星上的生命对我们是友好的还是敌对的。这个问题的答案取决于我们把它们看作是潜在的朋友还是敌人。如果我们把它们当作朋友，我们就更有可能欢迎它们。如果我们把它们当作敌人，我们就更有可能害怕它们。然而，鉴于宇宙的浩瀚无垠，我们很可能永远也无法知道这个问题的答案。

56. Our neighbour, the river

The river which forms the eastern boundary of our farm has always played an important part in our lives. Without it we could not make a living. There is only enough spring water to supply the needs of the house, so we have to pump from the river for farm use. We tell the river all our secrets. We know instinctively, just as beekeepers with their bees, that misfortune might overtake us if the important events of our lives were not related to it.

Of course, the great thing is not to allow any dogmatic to creep in, not to become narrow and intolerant. And it is the same with political opinions. We all know people who are so addicted to their particular variety of snobbery that they limit their intercourse to people of their own kind, and are very surprised and even hurt if one day they find that their teenage son or daughter has married outside their own class or group. But on the whole, we all have a very wide common ground of agreement on which we can talk without any feeling of restraint or self-consciousness. We all know that if we overfish, the fish in the river will soon be exhausted, and so we have an agreement not to fish in the river for more than a certain number of fish each season. We also know that if we do not take good care of the river, the fish will die, and so we have an agreement to keep the river clean.

There is also the question of security. We all know that if we are not on our guard, some day we will be invaded by our neighbours on the other side of the river. So we keep a watchful eye on them, and at the same time we make sure that they know that we are watching them. But on the whole, we live in peace with them. We are all neighbours, after all.

Our relationship with the river is like that of the ancient Greeks with their gods. We

have sacrificed a lot to it, and we have also received a lot from it. It is a very important part of our lives.

河流，我们的邻居

形成我们农场东部边界的一条河流一直在我们生活中发挥着重要作用。要是没有这条河，我们就无法生存下去。泉水只能满足家庭生活用水，因此我们必须从河里抽水以用于农业生产。我们向那条河倾诉我们的所有秘密。我们本能地懂得，就像养蜂人和他的蜜蜂那样，如果我们不把生活中的重大事件告诉那条河，就可能大祸临头。

当然，重要的是不要让任何教条主义的东西潜入我们的思想，不要变得狭隘和不容异己。政治观点也是如此。我们都认识一些人，他们太沉溺于自己独特的那种势利观念，以至于他们只与自己同类的人交往，如果有一天他们发现自己十几岁的儿子或女儿与自己阶层或群体之外的人结了婚，他们就会非常惊讶，甚至会感到受了伤害。但总的来说，我们有一个非常广泛的共识基础，在这个基础上我们可以毫无拘束或难为情地进行交谈。我们都知道，如果我们过度捕捞，河里的鱼很快就会枯竭，所以我们达成协议，每个季节在河里捕捞的鱼不得超过一定数量。我们也知道，如果我们不好好保护这条河，鱼就会死去，所以我们达成协议要保持河水清洁。

还有安全问题。我们都知道，如果我们不保持警惕，总有一天我们会遭到河对岸邻居的入侵。所以我们密切注视着他们，同时确保他们知道我们在监视他们。但总的来说，我们与他们和平相处。毕竟，我们都是邻居。

我们与这条河的关系就像古希腊人与他们的神的关系一样。我们为它作出了很多牺牲，也从它那里得到了很多。它是我们生活中非常重要的一部分。

57. Back in the old country

I stopped to let the car cool off and to study the map. I had expected to be near my objective by now, but everything still seemed alien to me. I was only five when my father had taken me abroad, and that was eighteen years ago. When my mother had died after a tragic accident, he did not quickly recover from the shock and loneliness. Everything around him was full of her presence, continually reopening the wound. So he decided to emigrate. In the new country he became absorbed in making a new life for the two of us, so that he gradually ceased to grieve. He did not marry again and I was brought up without a woman's care; but I lacked for nothing, for he was both father and mother to me. He always meant to go back one day, but not to stay. His roots and mine had become too firmly embedded in the new land. But he wanted to see the old folk again and to visit my mother's grave. He became mortally ill a few months before we had planned to go and, when he knew that he was dying, he made me promise to go on my own. I hired a car the day after landing

and bought a comprehensive book of maps, which I found most helpful on the cross-country journey, but which I did not think I should need on the last stage. It was not that I actually remembered anything at all. But my father had described over and over again what we should see at every milestone, after leaving the nearest town, so that I was positive I should recognize it as familiar territory. Well, I had been wrong, for I was now lost. I looked at the map and then at the milometer. I had come ten miles since leaving the town, and at this point, according to my father, I should be looking at farms and cottages in a valley, with the spire of the church of our village showing in the far distance. I could see no valley, no farms, no cottages and no church spire - only a lake. I decided that I must have taken a wrong turning somewhere. So I drove back to the town and began to retrace my steps, taking the routes I had not taken before. It was a slow process, full of frustrations and regular disappointments. Just when I was beginning to despair, I came upon a signpost. And it was only as I was studying it that I realized I had been looking at it from the wrong angle all the time. There was my village, right where my father had said it would be. I drove on for a few miles and then I saw it. My father had described it to me so often that I recognized it immediately - my mother's old home. Then I turned a corner and, as I did so, I realized that I had been deceived by an optical illusion. I had been following a man who was two hundred yards ahead of me and who was also driving slowly. As he turned a corner, I assumed that he must be making for the same destination as myself. I followed him for a long time, but at last I lost him in the darkness. I looked at my watch. It was past midnight. I was very tired and also very hungry by this time, but there was still no sign of the village. I was beginning to wonder if I had made a mistake. Just then I saw a faint light in the distance. I drove towards it, hoping that it was a sign of some sort of habitation. It was a small house, and I could see a man working in the garden. I got out of the car and walked towards him. He stopped his work and looked at me. "You're lost, aren't you?" he said. "Yes," I replied. "I'm looking for my mother's old home." "Your mother's old home?" he said. "There are no houses here." "But it must be here," I said. "My father described it to me so often." "Your father?" he said. "Who was your father?" "His name was Henry," I said. "Henry who?" he asked. "Henry Twycross," I said. "Oh," he said. "I knew him. He used to live here. But that was a long time ago. There's been a lot of change since then." "But where is my mother's old home?" I asked. "It's gone," he said. "It was knocked down years ago." "But why?" I asked. "Because it was in the way of progress," he said. "There was a new road being built and it had to be removed." "So what am I to do?" I asked. "You can stay here if you like," he said. "I have a spare room." "Thank you," I said. "But I think I'll go on." "Where to?" he asked. "I don't know," I said. "I just want to see the old country." "Well," he said. "Good luck." I got back into the car and drove off. I was very sad. I had come

all this way to find my mother's old home, but it was gone. I had been deceived by my father's description and by my own memories. I was lost again, not only in the physical sense but also in the emotional sense. I drove on for a while, but I was not really interested in where I was going. I was just thinking about my father and my mother and the old days. Then I saw a signpost. It said "To the old country". I followed it. I don't know where it led me, but I followed it. I was still lost, but I was following the signpost to the old country.

重返故里

我停下车，让汽车发动机冷却一下，同时查看一下地图。我本以为这时已经接近目的地了，但周围的一切对我来说仍很陌生。我5岁那年，父亲就带我出了国，那是18年前的事了。当时我母亲在一次事故中惨死，父亲未能很快从悲痛与孤独中恢复过来。他身边的一切都有母亲的影子，总让他不断地想起伤心事。于是他决定移居他国。在新的国家里，他专心致志地为我们俩开创一种新的生活，这样他渐渐从悲痛中恢复过来。父亲没有再娶，因此，我在没有母亲的环境里长大成人。但我什么也不缺，因为他既当父亲又当母亲。他一直想有朝一日能回去，但不想在那儿长住。因为他与我一样，已经把根深深地扎在了异国的土地上。但是，他想看一看家乡父老乡亲，为我的母亲扫墓。就在我们计划回国的前几个月，他突然身患绝症。他知道自己已奄奄一息，于是他要我答应一定单独回故乡一趟。我下飞机后租了一辆车，并买了一本详尽的地图册。在乡间行车途中，我觉得它非常有用，但快到家了，我倒觉得它没什么用了。这倒不是我真的已记住了沿途的所有情况，而是父亲曾详细给我讲了在过了离故乡最近的那个小镇后，每一个路标处我们应该看到的东西。因此，我相信这段路对我来说会是很熟悉的。唉，实际我错了，我现在迷路了。我看了看地图，又查了一下里程表。从小镇出来，我已经开车行驶了10英里。照父亲的说法，我应该看到山谷里的农场与村舍，还应该看到远处我们村子里教堂的尖顶。可我看不到山谷，看不见农场，也看不见村舍和教堂尖顶——我只看见一片湖泊。我断定一定是什么地方拐错了弯儿。于是我驾车返回小镇，重新按我先前不走的路线行驶。这是一个缓慢的过程，充满了挫折和不断的失望。就在我开始绝望的时候，我看到了一个路标。就在我仔细查看它的时候，我才意识到自己一直从错误的角度看它。我的村子就在那里，就在父亲说的那个地方。我开车又往前走了几英里，然后我看到了它。父亲多次给我描述过它，所以我一眼就认出了——我母亲的老家。接着我拐过一个弯，就在这时，我意识到我被一种视觉错觉骗了。我一直在跟着一个人，他在我前面200码远的地方，也在慢慢地开车。当他拐弯的时候，我以为他一定是朝着跟我相同的目的地行驶。我跟了他很长时间，最后在黑暗中把他给跟丢了。我看了看表，已经过了午夜。这时我又累又饿，可是还看不到村庄的影子。我开始怀疑自己是不是弄错了。就在这时，我看到远处有微弱的灯光。我朝着灯光开车过去，希望那是某种住所的标志。那是一座小房子，我看到有个人在花园里干活。我下了车，朝他走去。他停下手中的活儿看着我。“你迷路了，是吗？”他说。“是的，”我回答，“我在找我母亲的老家。”“你母亲的老家？”他说，“这儿没有房子。”“但它一定在这儿，”我说，“我父亲多次给我描述过。”“你父亲？”他说，“你父亲是谁？”“他叫亨利。”我说。“亨利谁？”他问。“亨利·特怀克罗斯。”我说。“哦，”他说，“我认识他。他过去就住在这儿。但那是很久以前的事了。从那以后发生了很多变化。”“但我母亲的老家在哪儿呢？”我问。“没了，”他说，“多年前就拆掉了。”“为什么？”我问。“因为要发展，”他说，“当时正在修一条新公路，它必须被拆掉。”“那

我该怎么办呢？”我问。“如果你愿意，可以住在这儿，”他说，“我有一间空房。”“谢谢你，”我说，“但我想我还是继续往前走吧。”“去哪儿？”他问。“我不知道，”我说，“我只想看看故乡。”“嗯，”他说，“祝你好运。”我回到车上，开车走了。我非常难过。我大老远跑来就是为了找我母亲的老家，可它却没了。我被父亲的描述和自己的记忆欺骗了。我又迷失了方向，不仅在地理上，而且在感情上。我继续开车行驶了一会儿，但我对去哪儿已不感兴趣。我只是在想我的父亲、母亲和过去的日子。然后我看到一个路标，上面写着“通往故乡”。我顺着它指的方向开去。我不知道它会把我带到哪里，但我还是跟着它。我仍然迷失着，但我在朝着故乡的方向前行。

58. A Spot of Bother

The old lady was glad to be back at the block of flats where she lived. Her shopping had tired her and her basket had grown heavier with every step of the way home. In the lift her thoughts were on lunch and a good rest; but when she got out at her own floor, both were forgotten in her sudden discovery that her front door was open. She was thinking that she must reprimand her daily maid the next morning for such a monstrous piece of negligence, when she remembered that she had gone shopping after the maid had left and she knew that she had turned both keys in their locks. She walked slowly into the hall and at once noticed that all the room doors were open, yet following her regular practice she had shut them before going out. Looking into the drawing room, she saw a scene of confusion over by her writing desk. It was as clear as daylight then that burglars had forced an entry during her absence. Her first impulse was to go round all the rooms looking for the thieves, but then she decided that at her age it might be more prudent to have someone with her, so she went to fetch the porter from his basement. By this time her legs were beginning to tremble, so she sat down and accepted a cup of very strong tea, while he telephoned the police. Then, her composure regained, she was ready to set off with the porter's assistance to search for any intruders who might still be lurking in her flat.

They went through the rooms, being careful to touch nothing, as they did not want to hinder the police in their search for fingerprints. The chaos was inconceivable. She had lived in the flat for thirty years and was a veritable magpie at hoarding; and it seemed as though everything she possessed had been tossed out and turned over and over. At least sorting out the things she should have discarded years ago was now being made easier for her. Then a police inspector arrived with a constable and she told them of her discovery of the ransacked flat. The inspector began to look for fingerprints, while the constable checked that the front door locks had not been forced, thereby proving that the burglars had either used skeleton keys or entered

over the balcony. There was no trace of fingerprints, but the inspector found a dirty red bundle that contained jewellery which the old lady said was not hers. So their entry into this flat was apparently not the burglars' first job that day and they must have been disturbed. The inspector then asked the old lady to try to check what was missing by the next day and advised her not to stay alone in the flat for a few nights. The old lady thought he was a fussy old fool at first, for to her, nothing seemed to be missing at all. But on entering her bedroom, she was shocked to find that the bed had been stripped of its coverings. At that moment she realized that she had not seen her cat for a long time. She was certain that the burglars had taken it when they had ransacked her flat. Then she began to sob inconsolably. Half an hour later, still sobbing, she telephoned the police and said that she had been wrong to call them fussy old fools. Because, she said, when she went to feed her cat just now she had found it stuffed in the wardrobe in a dirty red bundle.

一点儿小麻烦

老妇人回到了她居住的公寓楼，心里很高兴。去商店买东西把她搞得筋疲力尽；在回家的路上，她每走一步，就感到手里的篮子又重了一点。她乘上电梯后，只想着午餐和好好休息一下。但她到了自己的楼层走出电梯时，就把这两件事忘了个干净，因为她突然发现她家的大门开着。她心想明天上午一定要好好训斥那个干粗活的女佣人，她竟如此疏忽大意。但突然她记起来了，女佣人走后她去买过东西，而且她肯定两把钥匙都锁在屋里了。她慢慢地走进前厅，立即发现所有的房门都敞开着，而她记得在出门买东西前，她按老规矩是把房门——锁上的。她往起居室里看去，写字台边一片狼藉。事情很清楚，在她外出时，窃贼曾闯进家门。她第一个反应是到各个房间里搜寻一下窃贼，但转念一想，像她这个年纪，最好是找个人一起去。于是她到地下室去找看门的人。这时，她两腿累得开始发抖，于是坐了下来，喝了一杯浓茶。与此同时，看门的人给警察挂了电话。此刻老妇人也镇定了下来，准备在看门人的协助下搜寻可能仍躲藏在她房里的窃贼。

他俩搜遍了每一个房间，小心翼翼地不接触任何东西，因为他们怕妨碍警察寻找指纹。房间里的紊乱状况是无法想象的。老妇人在这套公寓里住了30年，她又是个名副其实的收藏家。看来她的每一件东西都被翻了出来，并且被里里外外看了个遍。这样一来，她倒是容易将那些几年前就该扔掉的东西找出来了。过了一会儿，一位巡官带着一名警察来了。她把公寓遭劫的事向他们作了报告。巡官开始搜寻指纹，警察经检查发现大门锁头并无撬过的迹象。由此可以证明，窃贼或者是用了万能钥匙，或者是翻越阳台进来的。巡官没有发现指纹，却发现了一个装有珠宝的、肮脏的红包袱。老妇人说那不是她的。很明显，闯进这套公寓的窃贼那天并不是首次作案，而且他们一定是受了惊吓。巡官请老妇人在次日之前设法查清丢了哪些东西，并劝她几夜之内不要独自一人在公寓过夜。老妇人起先以为他是个大惊小怪的老头；因为对她来说，好像什么东西也没丢。但当她走进卧室时，她震惊地发现床罩被掀开了。就在那一刻，她意识到她已经很久没有见到她的猫了。她肯定是窃贼在屋里乱翻时把猫给吓跑了。然后她就开始不停地哭泣。半小时后，她还在哭，一边哭一边给警察打电话，说她不该把他们叫做大惊小怪的老头。她说，因为刚才她去喂猫时，发现猫被塞在衣柜里的一个肮脏的红包袱里。

59. Collecting

People tend to amass possessions, sometimes without being aware of doing so. Indeed they can have a delightful surprise when they find something useful which they did not know they owned. Those who never have to change house become indiscriminate collectors of what can only be described as clutter. They leave unwanted objects in drawers, cupboards and attics for years, in the belief that they may one day need just those very things. As they grow old, people also accumulate belongings for two other reasons, lack of physical and mental energy, both of which are essential in turning out and throwing away, and sentiment. Things owned for a long time are full of associations with the past, perhaps with relatives who are dead, and so they gradually acquire a value beyond their true worth.

Some things are collected deliberately in the home in an attempt to avoid waste. Among these I would list string and brown paper, kept by thrifty people when a parcel has been opened, to save buying these two requisites. Collecting small items can easily become a mania. I know someone who always cuts sketches out from newspapers of model clothes that she would like to buy if she had the money. As she is not rich, the chances that she will ever be able to afford such purchases are remote; but she is never sufficiently strong - minded to be able to stop the practice. It is a harmless habit, but it litters up her desk to such an extent that every time she opens it, loose bits of paper fall out in every direction.

Collecting as a serious hobby is quite different and has many advantages. It provides relaxation for leisure hours, as just looking at one's treasures is always a joy. One does not have to go outside for amusement, since the collection is housed at home. Whatever it consists of, stamps, records, first editions of books, china, glass, antique furniture, pictures, model cars, stuffed animals, toy animals, there is always something to do in connection with it, from finding the right place for the latest addition, to verifying facts in reference books. This hobby educates one not only in the chosen subject, but also in general matters which have some bearing on it. There are also other benefits. One's friends and relatives, in their turn, may feel obliged to present the collector with gifts related to his collection. And these gifts need not be expensive. A young relative of mine, who is studying for a postgraduate degree in music, recently sent me a present of a book on the history of the piano. It was a very welcome gift as I have an interest in music and am also collecting books related to music.

Collectors may get a feeling of satisfaction from the fact that they have found something rare. But there is also the possibility that they may become obsessed with their hobby and spend all their time and money on it. This can lead to problems. For

example, a collector who has a passion for antique furniture may find it difficult to resist the temptation to buy a very expensive piece, even if he does not have the money to pay for it. Or a stamp collector may become so obsessed with his stamps that he neglects his family and friends. In general, however, the advantages of collecting as a hobby far outweigh the disadvantages.

收藏

人们往往喜欢收藏东西，有时并没有意识到自己在这样做。确实，当他们发现自己不知道自己拥有的有用之物时，可能会得到一个惊喜。那些从不需要搬家的人变成了毫无选择的杂物收藏家。他们把不需要的东西留在抽屉、橱柜和阁楼里多年，相信自己也许有一天会需要这些东西。随着年龄的增长，人们收藏物品还有另外两个原因：缺乏体力和精力（这两者在清理和扔掉东西时是必不可少的）以及情感因素。拥有很长时间的物品充满着与过去的联系，也许与逝去的亲人有关，于是这些东西逐渐获得了超出其实际价值的价值。

在家里人们会有意地收藏一些东西以避免浪费。在这些东西当中我想把细绳和牛皮纸列进去，节俭的人在打开包裹后便把它们留下来，省得再去买这两样必需品。收集小物品很容易成为一种癖好。我认识一个人，她总是从报纸上剪下时装式样的素描，要是她有钱的话就会去买这些时装。由于她并不富裕，她能买得起这些时装的可能性很小；但她又没有足够坚强的意志来停止这种做法。这是一种无害的习惯，但是它把她的书桌弄得乱七八糟，以至于每次她打开书桌时，纸片就到处乱飞。

作为一种严肃的业余爱好的收藏是截然不同的，它有很多好处。它可以在闲暇时间提供休闲，因为仅仅看看自己的珍藏品就是一种乐趣。人们不需要到户外去寻求娱乐，因为收藏品就在家。不管收藏品是什么，邮票、唱片、头版书籍、瓷器、玻璃制品、古董家具、图画、汽车模型、填充动物玩具、玩具动物，从为新增加的收藏品找到合适的摆放位置到参考书中查证相关事实，总是有事情可做。这种爱好不仅能使人在自己选择的专题方面受到教育，而且也能在与之有关的一般事物方面受到教育。还有其他的好处。反过来，一个人的朋友和亲戚可能会觉得有义务赠送与他的收藏品有关的礼物。而且这些礼物不必很昂贵。我的一个年轻亲戚正在攻读音乐研究生学位，最近送了我一本关于钢琴历史的书。这是一件很受欢迎的礼物，因为我对音乐感兴趣，而且也正在收集与音乐有关的书籍。

收藏家可能会从找到稀有物品这一事实中得到一种满足感。但是也有可能他们会对自己的爱好着迷，把所有的时间和金钱都花在上面。这可能会导致问题。例如，一个对古董家具充满热情的收藏家可能会难以抵挡购买一件非常昂贵的家具的诱惑，即使他没有钱来支付。或者一个集邮者可能会对他的邮票如此着迷，以至于忽视了他的家人和朋友。不过，一般来说，收藏作为一种爱好，其好处远远超过其坏处。

60. Too early and too late

Punctuality is a necessary habit in all public affairs in civilized society. Without it, nothing could ever be brought to a conclusion; everything would be in a state of chaos. Only in a sparsely - populated rural community is it possible to disregard it. In ordinary living, there can be some tolerance of unpunctuality. The intellectual, who is working on some abstruse problem, has everything coordinated and organized for the matter in hand. He is therefore forgiven, if late for a dinner party. But people are often reproached for unpunctuality when their only fault is cutting things fine. It is hard for energetic, quick - minded people to waste time, so they are often tempted to finish a job before setting out to keep an appointment. If no accidents occur on the way, like punctured tyres, diversions of traffic, sudden descent of fog, they will be on time. They are often more industrious, useful citizens than those who are never late. The over - punctual can be as much a trial to others as the unpunctual. The guest who arrives half an hour too soon is the greatest nuisance. Some friends of my family had this irritating habit. The only thing to do was ask them to come half an hour later than the other guests. Then they arrived just when we wanted them.

If you are catching a train, it is always better to be comfortably early than even a fraction of a minute too late. Although being early may mean wasting a little time, this will be less than if you miss the train and have to wait an hour or more for the next one; and you avoid the frustration of arriving at the very moment when the train is drawing out of the station and being unable to get on it. An even harder situation is to be on the platform in good time for a train and still to see it go off without you. Such an experience befell a certain young girl the first time she was travelling alone.

She entered the station twenty minutes before the train was due, since her parents had impressed upon her that it would be unforgivable to miss it and cause the friends with whom she was going to stay to make two journeys to meet her. She gave her luggage to a porter and showed him her ticket. To her horror he said that she was two hours too early. She felt in her handbag for the piece of paper on which her father had written down all the details of the journey and gave it to the porter. He agreed that a train did come into the station at the time on the paper, but he said that it only stopped there to take on water, not passengers. So she sat down to wait for the train which was coming in four hours' time. She had been told that her train was the one which left at five o'clock. When she arrived at the station, she found that her train had already left. She had missed it by a few minutes. This was the first time that she had ever been on her own, and she was very frightened. She did not know what to do. She could not go back to her parents because she had no money with

her. She could not stay at the station because it was too cold. She could not go to the friends' house because she did not know where it was. She had to make a decision. She decided to go to a hotel. She found a hotel near the station and went in. She asked for a room. The hotel clerk looked at her and said that she was too young to stay in a hotel alone. She showed him her ticket and told him that she was waiting for a train. He said that she could wait in the lobby. So she sat down in the lobby and waited for the train. She waited for four hours. When the train arrived, she got on it. She was very tired and very cold. She had a very bad experience.

太早和太晚

准时是文明社会中进行一切公共事务时必须养成的习惯。不按时将一事无成，事事都会陷入混乱不堪的境地。只有在人口稀少的农村，才可以忽视准时的习惯。在日常生活中人们可以容忍一定程度的不按时。一个专心钻研某个复杂问题的知识分子，为了搞好手头的研究，要把一切都协调一致、组织周密。因此，他要是赴宴迟到了会得到谅解。但有些人仅仅因为掐算时间太紧而迟到，常会受到指责。精力充沛、头脑敏捷的人极不愿意浪费时间，因此他们常想做完一件事后再去赴约。要是路上没有发生如爆胎、改道、突然起雾等意外事故，他们是决不会迟到的。他们与那些从不迟到的人相比，常常是更勤奋有用的公民。早到的人同迟到的人一样令人讨厌。客人提前半小时到达是最令人讨厌的。我家有几个朋友就有这种令人恼火的习惯。唯一的办法就是请他们比别的客人晚来半小时。这样，他们可以恰好在我们要求的时间到达。

如果赶火车，早到总比晚到好，哪怕早到一会儿也好。虽然早到可能意味着浪费一点时间，但这比误了火车等上一个多小时坐下一班车浪费的时间要少，而且可以避免那种正好在火车驶出站时赶到车站，因上不了车而感到的沮丧。更难堪的情况是虽然及时赶到站台上，却眼睁睁地看着火车开走，而自己没能上去。一个小姑娘第一次单独出门就碰到了这种情况。

在火车进站前20分钟她就进了车站，因为她的父母再三跟她说，如果误了这趟车，她的东道主朋友就得接她两趟，这是不应该的。她把行李交给搬运工并给他看了车票。搬运工说她早到了两个小时，她听后大吃一惊。她从钱包里摸出一张纸条，那上面有她父亲对这次旅行详细说明，她把这张纸条交给了搬运工。搬运工说，纸上写的那趟火车确有其事，但他说那趟火车只在站上加水，不载旅客。于是她就坐下来等那趟四个小时以后才来的火车。她原以为她要搭乘的是五点钟开的那趟车。她到车站时发现她要搭乘的那趟车已经开走了。她只迟到了几分钟。这是她第一次单独出门，她非常害怕。她不知道该怎么办。她不能回父母那儿去，因为她身上没带钱。她不能呆在车站里，因为那里太冷了。她不能到朋友家去，因为她不知道朋友家在哪里。她必须作出决定。她决定去住旅馆。她在车站附近找到一家旅馆就走了进去。她要了一个房间。旅馆职员看着她说，她太小，不能单独住旅馆。她给他看了车票，告诉他自己在等火车。他说她可以在大厅里等。于是她就在大厅里坐下来等火车。她等了四个小时。火车到了，她上了车。她又累又冷。她有一次非常糟糕的经历。

Book 4

1. Finding Fossil Man

We can read of things that happened 5,000 years ago in the Near East, where people first learned to write. But there are some parts of the world where even now people cannot write. The only way that they can preserve their history is to recount it as sagas - legends handed down from one generation of story - tellers to another. These legends are useful because they can tell us something about migrations of people who lived long ago, but none could write down what they did. Anthropologists wondered for a long time how to classify the Pygmies of the Congo Basin and the Bushmen of the Kalahari Desert in Africa. These tribes live by hunting, fishing and gathering, and they do not plant crops. The anthropologists made a mistake, because they thought these people were still in the Stone Age. They forgot that the Pygmies and Bushmen have been in contact with modern civilization for a long time. The Pygmies and Bushmen are not Stone Age people. They are modern people who have not yet learned to write.

发现化石人

我们从书籍中可以读到5000年前近东发生的事情，那里的人最早学会了写字。但直到现在，世界上仍有些地方，人们还不会书写。他们保存历史的唯一办法是将历史当作传说讲述，由讲述人一代接一代地将史实描述为传奇故事口传下来。这些传说很有用，因为它们能告诉我们一些以往人们迁移的情况。但是没有人能把他们所做的事情记载下来。人类学家们长期以来一直在思考如何对刚果盆地的俾格米人和非洲卡拉哈里沙漠的布须曼人进行分类。这些部落靠狩猎、捕鱼和采集为生，不种植庄稼。人类学家们犯了一个错误，因为他们认为这些人仍然处于石器时代。他们忘记了俾格米人和布须曼人已经和现代文明有了很长时间的接触。俾格米人和布须曼人并非石器时代的人，他们是尚未学会写字的现代人。

2. Spare that spider

Why, you may wonder, should spiders be our friends? Because they destroy so many insects, and insects include some of the greatest enemies of the human race. Insects would make it impossible for us to live in the world; they would devour all our crops and kill our flocks and herds, if it were not for the protection we get from insect - eating animals. We owe a lot to the birds and beasts who eat insects but all

of them put together kill only a fraction of the number destroyed by spiders. Moreover, unlike some of the other insect eaters, spiders never do the least harm to us or our belongings.

Spiders are not insects, as many people think, nor even nearly related to them. One can tell the difference almost at a glance, for a spider always has eight legs and an insect never more than six.

How many spiders are engaged in this work on our behalf? One authority on spiders made a census of the spiders in a grass field in the south of England, and he estimated that there were more than 2,250,000 in one acre; that is something like 6,000,000 spiders of different kinds on a football pitch. Spiders are busy for at least half the year in killing insects. It is impossible to make more than the wildest guess at how many they kill, but they are hungry creatures, not content with only three meals a day. It has been estimated that the weight of all the insects destroyed by spiders in Britain in one year would be greater than the total weight of all the human beings in the country.

Spiders are one of the marvels of nature. Their webs are masterpieces of engineering. A spider's web is stronger than it looks. It can be stretched considerably without breaking, and made of a sticky material which traps flying insects. The threads are as fine as a spider's silk but much stronger - human hair is about as strong as spider's silk of the same thickness.

Spiders, then, are our friends. The little we can do to spare them is surely worth doing.

不要伤害蜘蛛

你可能会觉得奇怪，为什么蜘蛛应该是我们的朋友呢？因为它们能消灭那么多的昆虫，而昆虫中包括一些人类最大的敌人。要不是人类受一些食虫动物的保护，昆虫就会使我们无法在地球上生活下去，它们会吞食我们的全部庄稼，杀死我们的成群的牛羊。我们要十分感谢那些吃昆虫的鸟和兽，然而把它们所杀死的昆虫全部加在一起也只相当于蜘蛛所消灭的一小部分。此外，蜘蛛不同于其他食虫动物，它们丝毫不危害我们和我们的财物。

很多人认为蜘蛛是昆虫，但它们不是昆虫，甚至与昆虫毫无关系。人们几乎一眼就能看出二者的差异，因为蜘蛛都是8条腿，而昆虫的腿从不超过6条。

有多少蜘蛛在为我们效力呢？一位研究蜘蛛的权威对英国南部一块草坪上的蜘蛛作了一次调查。他估计每英亩草坪里有225万多只蜘蛛。这就是说，在一个足球场上约有600万只不同种类的蜘蛛。蜘蛛至少有半年在忙于吃昆虫。它们一年中消灭了多少昆虫，我们简直无法猜测，它们是吃不饱的动物，不满意一日三餐。据估计，在英国蜘蛛一年里所消灭昆虫的重量超过这个国家人口的总重量。

蜘蛛是大自然的奇迹之一。它们的网是工程学上的杰作。蜘蛛网比看上去的要结实。它可以大大地伸展而不断裂，它是由一种粘性物质构成的，这种物质能粘住飞虫。这些丝和蜘蛛丝一样细，但是比蜘蛛丝结实得多，人的头发和同样粗细的蜘蛛丝的结实程度差不多。

因此，蜘蛛是我们的朋友。我们能为保护它们所做的一点小事肯定是值得做的。

3. Matterhorn Man

Modern alpinists try to climb mountains by a route which will give them good sport, and the more difficult it is, the more highly it is regarded. In the pioneering days, however, this was not the case at all. The early climbers were looking for the easiest way to the top, because the summit was the prize they sought, especially if it had never been attained before. It is true that during their explorations they often faced difficulties and dangers of the most perilous nature, equipped in a manner which would make a modern climber shudder at the thought, but they did not go out of their way to court such excitement. They had a single aim, a solitary goal---the top!

It is hard for us to realize nowadays how difficult it was for the pioneers. Except for one or two places such as Zermatt and Chamonix, which had rapidly become popular, Alpine villages tended to be impoverished settlements cut off from civilization by the high mountains. Such inns as there were were generally dirty and flea - ridden; the food simply local cheese accompanied by bread often twelve months old, all washed down with coarse wine. Often a valley boasted no inn at all, and climbers found shelter wherever they could---sometimes with the local priest (who was usually as poor as his parishioners), sometimes with shepherds or cheese - makers. Invariably the background was the same: dirt and poverty, and very uncomfortable. For men accustomed to eating seven - course dinners and sleeping between fine linen sheets at home, the change to the Alps must have been very hard indeed.

Why, then, did the early climbers put up with such hardships? The answer, I think, is that they were less interested in the sport than in the sense of accomplishment they got from reaching the top. It is true that they took risks, but in those days they had to take risks. They would never have been able to reach the top at all if they had not been prepared to take risks. They were a hardy race, these early climbers. They were not looking for a comfortable life, but for a challenge, and a sense of pride that they could meet that challenge.

Today, of course, things are different. The modern alpinist may be interested in the

sport as well as in the sense of accomplishment. He may also be interested in getting a good photograph or in making a film. But he will still be looking for a route which will give him good sport, and he will still be looking for a challenge. He will still be a hardy race, these modern alpinists.

马特霍恩山区人

现代登山运动员总想找一条能够给他们带来运动乐趣的路线来攀登山峰。他们认为，道路愈艰险愈带劲儿。然而，在登山运动的初期，全然不是这种情况。早期登山者所寻找的是通往山顶的最简便的途径，因为顶峰——特别是前人未曾到过的顶峰——才是他们寻求的目标。确实，在探险中他们经常遇到惊心动魄的困难和危险，而他们装备之简陋足以使现代登山者一想起来就胆战心惊。但是，他们并非故意寻求这种刺激。他们只有一个目的，唯一的目标——顶峰！

我们今天很难想像昔日的登山先驱们是多么艰苦。除了泽曼特和夏蒙尼等一两个很快出了名的地方外，阿尔卑斯山山区的小村几乎全是高山环抱、与世隔绝的穷乡僻壤。那里的小客栈一般都很肮脏，而且跳蚤猖獗。

食物是当地的干酪和通常存放了一年之久的面包，人们就着劣酒吞下这种食物。山谷里常常没有小客栈，登山者只好随遇而安。有时同当地牧师

（他通常和他的教民一样穷）住在一起，有时同牧羊人或制酪者住在一起。无论何处都是一样的境况：肮脏、贫穷，极其不舒适。对于过惯了一顿饭吃7道菜、睡亚麻细布床单的人来说，变换一下生活环境来到阿尔卑斯山山区，那一定是很艰难的。

那么，早期登山者为什么要忍受如此的艰辛呢？我想，答案是：他们对登山运动的兴趣不如对到达山顶所获得的成就感那么强烈。确实，他们冒了风险，但在当时他们不得不冒风险。如果他们不准备冒风险，他们就永远也不可能到达山顶。这些早期登山者是一个强壮的民族。他们不是在寻求一种舒适的生活，而是在寻求一种挑战，一种他们能战胜挑战的自豪感。

当然，今天的情况不同了。现代登山者对登山运动感兴趣，也对成就感感兴趣。他或许也对拍一张好照片或制作一部影片感兴趣。但他仍然会寻找一条能给他带来运动乐趣的路线，他仍然会寻求一种挑战。这些现代登山者仍然是一个强壮的民族。

4. Seeing hands

Several cases have been reported in Russia recently of people who can read and detect colours with their fingers, and even see through solid doors and walls. One case concerns an eleven-year-old schoolgirl, Vera Petrova, who has normal vision but who can also perceive things with different parts of her skin, and through solid walls. This ability was first noticed by her father. One day she came into his office and happened to put her hands on the door of a locked safe. Suddenly she asked her

father why he kept so many old newspapers locked away there, and even described the way they were done up in bundles. Vera's curious talent was brought to the notice of a scientific research institute in the town of Ulyanovsk, near where she lives, and in April she was given a series of tests by a special commission of the Ministry of Health of the Russian Federal Republic. During these tests she was able to read a newspaper through an opaque screen and, stranger still, by moving her elbow over a child's game of Lotto she was able to describe the figures and colours printed on it; and, in another instance, wearing stockings and slippers, to make out with her foot the outlines and colours of a picture hidden under a carpet. Other experiments showed that her knees and shoulders had a similar sensitivity. During all these tests Vera was blindfolded; and, indeed, except when blindfolded she lacked the ability to perceive things with her skin. It was also found that although she could perceive things with her fingers this ability ceased the moment her hands were wet.

Ernst Weber, a physiologist in Leipzig, was the first to show that people can perceive things through their fingertips as well as they can through their eyes. He found that the smaller the object, the closer it had to be to the eyes for its details to be seen. The same applies to the fingertips. The closer the object is to the fingertips, the larger it seems to be and the more details can be made out. Weber found that when the fingertips were about three inches from an object, the details of the object were as clear as when it was at the normal reading distance of about fourteen inches from the eyes. If the object was moved closer still, the fingertips could no longer make out its details. This shows that the fingertips can perceive objects in the same way as the eyes, but only up to a certain distance.

Vera Petrova's case is a good example of how people can be trained to perceive things in different ways. She was not born with the ability to perceive things with her skin, but she has learned to do so through long practice. Her father started to train her when she was a small child. He would put different objects in front of her and ask her to describe them without looking. At first she could only make out the general shape of the objects, but with more practice she was able to make out more details. As she grew older, she was able to perceive things with different parts of her skin, and through solid walls. This shows that the ability to perceive things with the skin can be developed through training.

能看见东西的手

俄罗斯最近报道了几个事例，有人能用手指看书识字和辨认颜色，甚至能透过厚实的门和墙看到东西。其中有一例谈到有一个名叫维拉·彼得洛娃的11岁女学生。她视力正常，但她还能用皮肤的不同部位辨认东西，甚至看穿坚实的墙壁。是她父亲首先发现她这一功能的

。一天，维拉走进父亲的办公室，偶然把手放在一个锁着的保险柜的门上，她突然问父亲为什么把这么多的旧报纸锁在柜子里，还描述了报纸捆扎的情况。维拉的特异功能引起了她家附近乌里扬诺夫斯克镇一个科研单位的注意。4月里，俄罗斯联邦共和国卫生部的一个特别委员会对她进行了一系列的测试。在这些测试中，她能隔着不透明的屏幕读报纸。更为奇怪的是，她把肘部在儿童玩的“罗托”纸牌上移动一下，便能说出印在纸牌上的数字和颜色。还有一次，她穿着长筒袜子和拖鞋，能用脚识别出藏在地毯下面的一幅画的轮廓和颜色。其他实验表明，她的膝盖和双肩有类似的感觉能力。在所有这些测试中，维拉的双眼都是蒙着的。如果不蒙上双眼她的皮肤就不再具有识别物体的能力。还发现她虽然能用手指识别东西，但她的手一旦弄湿，这种功能便会立即消失。

莱比锡的一位生理学家恩斯特·韦伯首先表明，人能用指尖像用眼睛一样识别东西。他发现物体越小，就必须把它拿得离眼睛越近才能看得清它的细节。这同样适用于指尖。物体离指尖越近，看起来就越大，能识别的细节就越多。韦伯发现，当指尖离物体大约3英寸时，物体的细节就像在正常阅读距离（距眼睛大约14英寸）时一样清晰。如果把物体再移近一些，指尖就无法识别其细节了。这表明指尖能像眼睛一样识别物体，但只能在一定距离之内。

维拉·彼得洛娃的事例是一个很好的例子，说明人们可以通过训练以不同的方式感知事物。她并非生来就具有用皮肤识别事物的能力，而是通过长期的实践学会的。她父亲在她年幼时就开始训练她。他会把不同的物体放在她面前，让她不看就描述它们。起初她只能辨认物体的大致形状，但经过更多的练习，她就能辨认出更多的细节。随着年龄的增长，她能用皮肤的不同部位和透过坚实的墙壁识别事物。这表明用皮肤感知事物的能力是可以通过训练得到发展的。

5. Youth

People are always talking about "the problem of youth". If there is one -- which I take leave to doubt -- then it is older people who create it, not the young themselves. Let us get down to fundamentals and agree that the young are after all human beings -- people just like their elders. There is only one difference between an old man and a young one: the young man has a glorious future before him and the old one has a splendid future behind him: and maybe that is where the rub is.

When I was a teenager, I felt that I was just young and uncertain -- that I was a new boy in a huge school, and I would have been very pleased to be regarded as something so interesting as a problem. For one thing, being a problem gives you a certain identity, and that is one of the things the young are busily engaged in seeking.

I find young people exciting. They have an air of freedom, and they have not a dreary commitment to mean ambitions or love of comfort. They are not anxious

social climbers, and they have no devotion to material things. All this seems to me to link them with life, and the origins of things. It's as if they were in some sense cosmic beings in violent and lovely contrast to us suburban creatures. All that is in my mind when I meet a young person. He may be conceited, ill - mannered, presumptuous or fatuous, but I do not turn for protection to dreary clichés about respect for elders -- as if mere age were a reason for respect. I accept that we are equals, and I will argue with him, as an equal, if I think he is wrong.

This is what I have learned from my own youth. And I have found that the world is in general agreement with my view of youth. At least, when talking about the young, most people will say that they are hope of the world, and that it is necessary to guide them in the right way. But then, they hope that the young will listen to them, and they believe that they are wiser than the young, which is why they are always talking about "the problem of youth".

青年

人们总是在谈论“青年问题”。如果真有这么一个问题——我冒昧对此表示怀疑——那也是由老年人而非青年人造成的。让我们来认真研究一些基本事实：承认青年人和他们的长辈一样也是人。老年人和青年人只有一个区别：青年人有光辉灿烂的前景，而老年人的辉煌已成为过去。问题的症结恐怕就在这里。

我十几岁时，总感到自己年轻，有些事拿不准——我是一所大学校园里的一名新生，如果我当时真的被看成像一个问题那样有趣，我会感到很得意的。因为这至少使我得到了某种承认，这正是年轻人所热衷追求的东西之一。

我觉得年轻人令人振奋。他们无拘无束；既不追逐卑鄙的名利，也不贪图生活的舒适。他们不热衷于向上爬，也不一味追求物质享受。在我看来，所有这些使他们与生命和万物之源联系在了一起。从某种意义上讲，他们似乎是宇宙人，同我们这些凡夫俗子形成了强烈而鲜明的对照。每逢我遇到年轻人，脑子里就想到这些。年轻人也许狂妄自负，举止无理，傲慢放肆，愚昧无知，但我不会用应当尊重长者这一套陈词滥调为自己辩护，似乎年长就是受人尊敬的理由。我认为我和他们是平等的。如果我认为他们错了，我会以平等的身份和他们争个明白。

这是我从自身的青年时期学到的东西。我发现，在这个问题上世人的观点和我是基本一致的。至少，在谈到青年人时，多数人会说他们是世界的希望，有必要引导他们走正道。然而，他们希望青年人能听取他们的意见，他们相信自己比青年人更明智，这就是他们总是谈论“青年问题”的原因。

6. The sporting spirit

I am always amazed when I hear people saying that sport creates goodwill between the nations, and that if only the common peoples of the world could meet one another at football or cricket, they would have no inclination to meet on the battlefield. Even if one didn't know from concrete examples (the 1936 Olympic Games, for instance) that international sporting contests lead to orgies of hatred, one could deduce it from general principles.

Nearly all the sports practised nowadays are competitive. You play to win, and the game has little meaning unless you do your utmost to win. On the village green, where you pick up sides and no feeling of local patriotism is involved, it is possible to play simply for the fun and exercise: but as soon as the question of prestige arises, as soon as you feel that you and some larger unit will be disgraced if you lose, the most savage combative instincts are aroused. Anyone who has played even in a school football match knows this. At the international level, sport is frankly mimic warfare. But the significant thing is not the behaviour of the players but the attitude of the spectators: and, behind the spectators, of the nations who work themselves into furies over these absurd contests, and seriously believe - at any rate for short periods - that running, jumping and kicking a ball are tests of national virtue.

I was once present at a tug - of - war in which the two teams were so evenly matched that neither could win. The umpire in charge of the match was at his wits' end. Finally, one of the teams, by a superhuman effort, managed to drag the other team over the line. The crowd went wild with joy. This incident left a deep impression on me. I saw that in a world where people are obsessed with winning, the slightest advantage can trigger a violent reaction. It is this spirit, I believe, that underlies the modern Olympics. We are so used to seeing champions crowned and anthems played that we forget the darker side of sport. The Olympics should be a celebration of human achievement, not a battleground for national pride.

体育的精神

当我听人们说体育运动可创造国家之间的友谊，还说各国民众若在足球场或板球场上交锋，就不愿在战场上残杀的时候，我总是惊愕不已。一个人即使不能从具体的事例（例如1936年的奥林匹克运动会）了解到国际运动比赛会导致疯狂的仇恨，也可以从常理中推断出结论。

现在开展的体育运动几乎都是竞争性的。参加比赛就是为了取胜。如果不拚命去赢，比赛就没有什么意义了。在乡间的草坪上，当你随意组成两个队，并且不涉及任何地方情绪时，那才可能是单纯的为了娱乐和锻炼而进行比赛。可是一旦涉及到荣誉问题，一旦你想到你和某一团体会因为你输而丢脸时，那么最野蛮的争斗天性便会被激发起来。即使是仅仅

参加过学校足球赛的人也有这种体会。在国际比赛中，体育简直是一场模拟战争。但是，要紧的还不是运动员的行为，而是观众的态度，以及观众身后各个国家的态度。面对着这些荒唐的比赛，参赛的各个国家会如痴如狂，甚至煞有介事地相信——至少在短期内如此——跑跑、跳跳、踢踢球是对一个民族品德素质的检验。

我曾亲眼看到一场拔河比赛，两队的实力相当，不分胜负。负责比赛的裁判员也不知所措。最后，其中一个队作出了极大的努力，把对方的队拉过了线。观众欣喜若狂。这件事给我留下了深刻的印象。我明白了在一个人们都想获胜的世界里，一点点优势就可能引发强烈的反应。我认为正是这种精神是现代奥林匹克运动会的基础。我们已经太习惯于看到冠军们接受奖牌、听到国歌奏响，以至于我们忘记了体育的阴暗面。奥运会应该是人类成就的庆典，而不是民族自豪感的战场。

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Once the games were over, the stadium emptied and the swarms of spectators dispersed, a curious lull ensued. The nations suddenly remembered that they were supposed to be at peace with each other. They rubbed shoulders at the crowded terminals, and at length they went their separate ways without rancour. Even the teams themselves, as they boarded their respective buses and trains, seemed to have forgotten their enmity. But it was only a momentary lull. In less than an hour's time

they would be back at their respective camps, preparing for the next day's play. And so the cycle of hatred and reconciliation continued.

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比赛一旦结束，体育场空无一人，成群的观众一哄而散，接着是一阵异乎寻常的寂静。各国突然想起他们原本是和平相处的。他们在拥挤的终点站互相擦肩而过，然后各自登上火车或汽车，分道扬镳，不再怨恨。甚至连参赛的球队，登上各自的大客车或火车时，似乎也忘记了彼此间的敌意。但这只是短暂的平静。不到一个小时，他们又会回到各自的阵营，准备参加第二天的比赛。于是，仇恨与和解的循环就这样周而复始地继续下去。

8. Trading Standards

Chickens slaughtered in the United States, claim officials in Brussels, are not fit to grace European tables. No, say the Americans: our fowl are fine, we simply clean them in a different way. These days, it is differences in national regulations, far more than tariffs, that put sand in the wheels of trade between rich countries. It is not just farmers who are complaining. An electric razor that meets the European Union's safety standards must be approved by American testers before it can be sold in the United States, and an American-made dialysis machine needs the EU's okay before it hits the market in Europe.

As it happens, a razor that is safe in Europe is unlikely to electrocute Americans. So, ask businesses on both sides of the Atlantic, why have two lots of tests where one would do? Politicians agree, in principle, so America and the EU have been trying to reach a deal which would eliminate the need to double - test many products. They hope to finish in time for a trade summit between America and the EU on May 28th.

Although negotiators are optimistic, the details are complex enough that they may be hard - pressed to get a deal at all.

Why? One problem is that while both America and the EU have schemes to test products, they have different approaches, different priorities and different timetables. Another factor is that European companies are more squeamish about animal testing. The Americans say that by accepting outside testing, they are losing control of their own trade policies. And then there are the costs. The EU's tests are supposed to be more expensive than America's, but some American companies have to pay for both.

There is no sign that consumers are being short - changed as a result of these trade barriers. Indeed, EU consumers are probably better off, since they are protected from products that may not be safe. And American consumers may be better off, too. Since they are not being bombarded with unsafe products, they may have more time to consider the products that are actually available.

The real problem is that trade barriers are rising, not falling. This is a result of political will. Politicians are under pressure from their voters to be tough on trade. They are also under pressure from business lobbyists who want to keep out foreign competitors. But the biggest factor is that trade barriers are easy to erect, and difficult to dismantle. Once a trade barrier is in place, it is hard to get rid of it. This is because it is difficult to prove that a trade barrier is not necessary. And if a trade barrier is not necessary, then it is illegal under international law. So, politicians are reluctant to remove trade barriers, even when they know that they are not necessary.

So, what can be done? One solution is to have more international cooperation. The World Trade Organization (WTO) could play a more active role in reducing trade barriers. Another solution is to have more transparency. Politicians could be more open about the reasons for erecting trade barriers. And then there is the question of consumer education. Consumers could be better informed about the safety of products. But these solutions are not easy to implement. And in the meantime, trade barriers are rising, not falling.

贸易标准

布鲁塞尔的官员说，在美国屠宰的鸡不适于用来装点欧洲的餐桌。不，美国人说，我们的家禽很好，只是我们使用了另一种清洗方式。当前，是各国管理条例上的差异，而不是关税，阻碍着发达国家之间的贸易。并不仅仅是农民在抱怨。一把符合欧盟安全标准的电动剃须刀必须得到美国检测人员的认可，才可在美国市场上销售；而美国制造的透析仪也要得到欧盟的首肯才能进入欧洲市场。

碰巧在欧洲使用安全的剃须刀不大可能使美国人触电身亡。因此，大西洋两岸的企业都在

问，当一套测试可以解决问题时，为什么需要两套呢？政治家在原则上是赞同的，因此，美国和欧盟一直在努力达成协议，以便为许多产品取消双重检查。他们希望能在5月28日美国与欧盟的贸易高峰会之前及时完成。虽然谈判代表们比较乐观，但协议细节如此复杂，他们所面临的困难可能是难以克服的。

为什么呢？一个问题是，虽然美国和欧盟都有产品检验制度，但二者的方法、重点和时间表均不相同。另一个因素是，欧洲的公司更不愿意进行动物实验。美国人说，接受国外的检验会使他们失去对本国贸易政策的控制。还有成本问题。欧盟的检测费用应该比美国的更高，但一些美国公司却既要支付美国的检测费用，又要支付欧盟的检测费用。

没有迹象表明，消费者会由于这些贸易壁垒而受到损失。实际上，欧盟的消费者可能情况更好，因为他们受到了保护，不会买到不安全的产品。美国的消费者可能也是如此。由于他们不会受到不安全产品的轰炸，他们可能有更多的时间来考虑真正可供选择的产品。

真正的问题是，贸易壁垒在不断增加，而不是减少。这是政治意愿的结果。政治家受到选民的压力，要对贸易采取强硬态度。他们也受到企业说客的压力，这些说客希望把外国竞争者挡在门外。但最大的因素是，贸易壁垒容易建立，却难以拆除。一旦建立了贸易壁垒，就很难将其消除。这是因为很难证明贸易壁垒是不必要的。如果贸易壁垒不必要，那么根据国际法它就是非法的。因此，即使政治家们知道贸易壁垒不必要，他们也不愿意拆除。

那么，可以做些什么呢？一个解决办法是加强国际合作。世界贸易组织（WTO）可以在减少贸易壁垒方面发挥更积极的作用。另一个解决办法是增加透明度。政治家可以更公开地说明建立贸易壁垒的原因。还有消费者教育问题。可以让消费者更好地了解产品的安全性。但这些解决办法不容易实施。与此同时，贸易壁垒在不断增加，而不是减少。

9. Royal espionage

Alfred the Great acted as his own spy, visiting Danish camps disguised as a minstrel. In those days wandering minstrels were welcome everywhere. They were not fighting men, and their harp was their passport. Alfred had learned many of their ballads in his youth, and could vary his programme with acrobatic tricks and simple conjuring.

While Alfred's little army slowly began to gather at Athelney, the king himself set out to penetrate the camp of Guthrum, the commander of the Danish invaders. These had settled down for the winter at Chippenham: thither Alfred went. He noticed at once that discipline was slack: the Danes had the self - confidence of conquerors, and their security precautions were casual. They lived well, on the proceeds of raids on neighbouring regions. There they collected women as well as food and drink, and a life of ease had made them soft.

Alfred stayed in the camp a week before he returned to Athelney. The force there assembled was trivial compared with the Danish horde. But Alfred had deduced that the Danes were no longer fit for prolonged battle: and that their commissariat had no organization, but depended on irregular raids. So, faced with the Danish advance, he had to prepare to defend the kingdom. He parcelled out the land into small holdings which were given to the great nobles of the realm in fief. In return for a free gift of the land, the noble swore to perform military service. The king retained a large reserve of land in his own hands. By this policy Alfred managed to create a large army out of very little money. And when the Danes, having had their raids, were again assembled in camp preparing for winter, Alfred struck suddenly. He routed them with his little army and chased them back to their ships. The Danes were not to be seen again in England for many years.

The episode could reasonably be called "Royal espionage". For Alfred had done what no spy had ever done before in the annals of espionage - he had stayed in the enemy's camp and returned with valuable information.

王室谍报活动

阿尔弗雷德大帝曾亲自充当间谍。他扮作吟游歌手到丹麦军队的营地侦察。当时，浪迹天涯的吟游歌手到处受欢迎，他们不是作战人员，竖琴就是他们的通行证。阿尔弗雷德年轻时学过许多吟游歌手的歌曲，而且还能用杂技和简单的魔术使他的节目多样化。

当阿尔弗雷德的小部队慢慢在阿塞尔纳集结时，他本人则出发去刺探丹麦入侵者的营地。这些入侵者在奇彭纳姆扎营过冬，阿尔弗雷德便来到此地。他马上发现丹麦军纪律松弛，他们以征服者自居，安全措施马马虎虎。他们靠掠夺附近地区的财物过着舒适的生活。他们不仅搜刮食物和饮料，而且掳掠妇女，安逸的生活使他们变得软弱。

阿尔弗雷德在敌营呆了一个星期后才返回阿塞尔纳。他集结起来的部队和丹麦大军相比是微不足道的。但是，阿尔弗雷德断定，丹麦人已不再适应持久的战争，他们的军需供应处于无组织状态，只是靠临时抢夺来维持。所以，面对丹麦人的进攻，他必须准备好保卫王国。他把土地分封给贵族，条件是贵族要为王国服兵役，作为对免费赠予土地的回报。国王自己保留了大片土地。通过这一政策，阿尔弗雷德设法不费多少钱就建立了一支庞大的军队。当丹麦人再次把抢来的财物集中到营帐中准备过冬时，阿尔弗雷德突然发起进攻。他率领一小队人马把丹麦人打得落花流水，并把他们驱赶回他们的船上。多年来，丹麦人再未在英格兰出现过。

这一事件可以合理地称为“王室谍报活动”。因为阿尔弗雷德做了间谍史上前所未有的事：他深入敌军营地，然后带着宝贵的情报返回。

10. Silicon Valley

Technology trends may push Silicon Valley back to the future. Carver Mead, a pioneer in integrated circuits and a professor of computer science at the California Institute of Technology, notes there are now workstations that enable engineers to design, test and produce chips right on their desks, much the way an editor creates a newsletter on a Macintosh. As the time and cost of making a chip drop to a few days and a few hundred dollars, engineers may soon be free to let their imaginations soar without being penalized by expensive failures.

Mead predicts that inventors will be able to perfect powerful customized chips over a weekend at the office - spawning a new generation of garage start - ups and giving the U.S. a jump - start on its foreign rivals in getting new products to market faster. "We've got more garages with smart people", Mead observes. "We really thrive on anarchy."

And on Asians. Already, orientals and Asian - Americans constitute the majority of the engineering staffs at many Valley firms. And Chinese, Indian and Pakistani engineers are graduating in droves from California's colleges. As the heads of next - generation start - ups, these Asian innovators can draw on customs and languages to forge tighter links with key Pacific Rim markets.

For instance, Alex Au, a Stanford Ph.D. from Hong Kong, has set up a Taiwanese factory to challenge Japan's near lock on the memory - chip market. India - born N.Damodar Reddy's tiny California company reopened an AT&T chip plant in Kansas City last year to profit from the rapidly falling prices of chips. Before it becomes a retirement village, Silicon Valley may prove a classroom for building a global business.

硅谷

技术的发展趋势有可能把硅谷重新推向未来。卡弗·米德——集成电路的一位先驱，加州理工学院的计算机教授——注意到，现在有些计算机工作站使工程技术人员可以在他们的办公桌上设计、试验和生产芯片，就像一位编辑在苹果机上编出一份时事通讯一样。由于制造一块芯片的时间已缩短至几天，费用也只有几百美元，因此，工程技术人员可能很快就可充分发挥他们的想象力而不会因失败而造成经济上的损失。

米德预言发明者可以在办公室用一个周末的时间生产出完美的、功能很强的、按客户需求设计的芯片——造就新一代从汽车间起家的技术人员，在把新产品推向市场方面使美国把它的外国对手们打个措手不及。“我们有更多的汽车间，而那里有许多聪明人，”米德说。“我们确实是靠这种无政府状态发展起来的。”

靠的是亚洲人。硅谷许多公司中工程技术人员的大多数是东方人和亚裔美国人。中国、印

度和巴基斯坦的工程师一批批地从加州的大学毕业。作为新崛起一代的带头人，这些亚裔发明家可以凭借他们的习俗和语言上的优势与环太平洋地区的主要市场建立起更紧密的联系。

比如说，亚历克斯·奥，一位来自香港的斯坦福大学博士，已经在台湾建厂，对日本在内存条市场上近似垄断的局面提出了挑战。印度出生的N.达莫达·雷迪经营的一家加利福尼亚小公司去年重新启用了美国电话电报公司在堪萨斯城的一家芯片工厂，从迅速下跌的芯片价格中获利。在硅谷变成一个退休村之前，它很可能成为建立全球性企业的一个教学场地。

11. How to Grow Old

Some old people are oppressed by the fear of death. In the young there is a justification for this feeling. Young men who have reason to fear that they will be killed in battle may justifiably feel bitter in the thought that they have been cheated of the best things that life has to offer. But in an old man who has known human joys and sorrows, and has achieved whatever work it was in him to do, the fear of death is somewhat abject and ignoble. The best way to overcome it - so at least it seems to me - is to make your interests gradually wider and more impersonal, until bit by bit the walls of the ego recede, and your life becomes increasingly merged in the universal life. An individual human existence should be like a river - small at first, narrowly contained within its banks, and rushing passionately past boulders and over waterfalls. Gradually the river grows wider, the banks recede, the waters flow more quietly, and in the end, without any visible break, they become merged in the sea, and painlessly lose their individual being. The man who, in old age, can see his life in this way, will not suffer from the fear of death, since the things he cares for will continue. And if, with the decay of vitality, weariness increases, the thought of rest will be not unwelcome. I should wish to die while still at work, knowing that others will carry on what I can no longer do, and content in the thought that what was possible has been done.

Some scientists in the field of artificial intelligence seem to think that a breakthrough in creating true artificial intelligence will be made within the next few decades. I am not so sure. I think it will be much longer before we see machines that can truly think like humans. True artificial intelligence would have to be able to understand the world in the same way that humans do, and this is a very difficult problem. Machines can already do many things that humans can do, but they do not understand what they are doing in the same way that humans do. For example, a computer can play chess very well, but it does not understand the game of chess in the way that a human does. It does not have the same kind of consciousness that a

human has. Consciousness is a very difficult concept to define, but it is something that is very important for understanding the nature of intelligence. Without consciousness, it is difficult to say that a machine is truly intelligent.

Another problem with creating true artificial intelligence is that we do not really know how the human brain works. We know a great deal about the structure of the brain, but we do not know how it processes information and creates thoughts. This is another area where much more research is needed. Some scientists think that we will be able to create artificial intelligence by simulating the structure and function of the human brain, but this is also a very difficult task. The human brain is an extremely complex organ, and it is very difficult to simulate its structure and function accurately.

In conclusion, while the idea of creating true artificial intelligence is very exciting, I think it will be a long time before we see machines that can truly think like humans. There are many difficult problems that need to be solved before we can achieve this goal.

如何安度晚年

有些老年人因为怕死而感到烦恼。青年人有这种感觉是情有可原的。有理由害怕自己会死在战场上的年轻人，一想到自己被剥夺了生活所能给予的最美好的东西时，感到痛苦，这是可以理解的。可是老年人已经饱经了人间的甘苦，一切能做的都做了，如果怕死，就有点儿可怜又可鄙了。克服怕死的最好办法——至少在我看来是这样——就是逐渐使自己的兴趣更加广泛，逐步摆脱个人狭小的圈子，直到自我的围墙一点一点地倒塌下来，自己的生活慢慢地和整个宇宙的生活融合在一起。个人的存在应该像一条河流，开始很小，被紧紧地夹在两岸中间，接着热情奔放地冲过巨石，飞下瀑布。然后河面渐渐地变宽，两岸后撤，河水流得平缓起来，最后连绵不断地汇入大海，毫无痛苦地失去了自我的存在。上了年纪的人这样看待生命，就不会有惧怕死亡的心情了，因为他所关心的事情将继续下去。而且随着精力的衰退，疲倦之感日增，长眠的想法未尝不是一件好事。我希望工作到死为止，明白了有人会继续我未竟的事业，想到能做的事都做了，也就坦然了。

人工智能领域的一些科学家似乎认为，在未来几十年内将在创造真正的人工智能方面取得突破。我不太确定。我认为，要过很长时间我们才能看到能像人类一样真正思考的机器。真正的人工智能必须能够像人类一样理解世界，而这是一个非常困难的问题。机器已经能做很多人类能做的事情，但它们不能像人类一样理解自己在做什么。例如，计算机能下象棋下得很好，但它不能像人类那样理解象棋比赛。它没有人类所具有的那种意识。意识是一个很难定义的概念，但它对于理解智力的本质非常重要。没有意识，很难说一台机器是真正智能的。

创造真正的人工智能的另一个问题是，我们并不真正知道人类大脑是如何工作的。我们对大脑的结构了解很多，但我们不知道它是如何处理信息和产生思想的。这是另一个需要更多研究的领域。一些科学家认为，我们可以通过模拟人类大脑的结构和功能来创造人工智能，但这也是一项非常艰巨的任务。人类大脑是一个极其复杂的器官，很难准确地模拟它

的结构和功能。

总之，虽然创造真正的人工智能这个想法非常令人兴奋，但我认为要过很长时间我们才能看到能像人类一样真正思考的机器。在实现这个目标之前，有很多难题需要解决。

12. Banking and the Economy

Banks are closely concerned with the flow of money into and out of the economy. They often co-operate with governments in efforts to stabilize economies and to prevent inflation. They are specialists in the business of providing capital, and in allocating funds on credit. Banks originated as places to which people took their valuables for safe-keeping, but today the great banks of the world have many functions in addition to acting as guardians of valuable private possessions.

One of the most important of these is regular participation in the foreign exchange market. In this market, banks buy and sell foreign currencies on a continual basis, so that an importer can purchase a shipment of goods from another country and pay for it in the currency of that country. The bank's selling price for a particular currency is always slightly higher than its buying price for the same currency, and the difference represents the bank's profit on the transaction.

Banks also provide a service for exporters. When an exporter arranges a shipment of goods to another country, he may need to finance the operation until he receives payment from the importer. Banks can provide loans to exporters at relatively low rates of interest, and they can also provide insurance against the risk of non-payment by the importer.

In addition to these international functions, banks also play an important role in the domestic economy. They are a major source of loans for businesses and individuals, and they help to allocate capital within the economy. They also play a role in the regulation of the money supply, through their ability to create and destroy money in the form of deposits and loans.

Finally, banks are important because they provide a convenient means of payment. People can use bank cheques, credit cards, or debit cards to pay for goods and services, and this makes economic transactions much easier and more efficient.

银行业与经济

银行与经济活动中的货币流入和流出量息息相关。它们常常与政府合作，共同努力稳定经济，防止通货膨胀。它们是提供资本业务以及信贷配给资金方面的专家。银行最初是人们

存放贵重物品以保安全的地方，但如今世界上的大银行除了充当贵重私人财产的保管者之外，还有许多其他的功能。

其中最重要的功能之一是经常参与外汇市场的交易。在这个市场上，银行持续不断地买卖外币，这样一来，进口商就可以从另一个国家购买一批货物并用该国货币付款。银行对某种特定货币的卖出价总是略高于其买入价，差价就是银行在该项交易中的利润。

银行也为出口商提供服务。当出口商安排将货物运往另一个国家时，在收到进口商的付款之前，他可能需要为这项业务筹措资金。银行可以以相对较低的利率向出口商提供贷款，还可以提供针对进口商不付款风险的保险。

除了这些国际功能之外，银行在国内经济中也扮演着重要的角色。它们是企业和个人贷款的主要来源，有助于在经济体内分配资本。它们还通过创造和消灭以存款和贷款形式存在的货币的能力，在货币供应量的调节方面发挥作用。

最后，银行之所以重要，是因为它们提供了一种便捷的支付手段。人们可以使用银行支票、信用卡或借记卡来支付商品和服务费用，这使得经济交易更加简便、高效。

13. The Search for Oil

The deepest holes of all are made for oil, and they go down to as much as 25,000 feet. But we do not need to send men down to get oil out, as we must with other mineral deposits. The holes are only borings, less than a foot in diameter. My particular experience is largely in oil, and the search for oil has done more to improve deep drilling than any other mining activity. When it has been decided where we are going to drill, we put up at the surface an oil derrick. It has to be tall because it is like a giant block and tackle, and we have to lower into the ground and haul out of the ground great lengths of drill pipe which are rotated by an engine at the top and are fitted with a cutting bit at the bottom.

There is a lot of luck in drilling for oil. The drill may just miss the oil although it is near; on the other hand, it may strike oil at a fairly high level. When the drill goes down, it brings up soil. The samples of soil from various depths are examined for traces of oil. If they are disappointed at one place, the drillers go to another. Great sums of money have been spent, for example in the deserts of Egypt, in 'prospecting' for oil. Sometimes little is found. When we buy a few gallons of petrol for our cars, we pay not only the cost of the petrol, but also part of the cost of the search that is always going on.

When the crude oil is obtained from the field, it is taken to the refineries to be treated. The commonest form of treatment is heating. When the oil is heated, the

first vapours to rise are cooled and become the finest petrol. Petrol has a low boiling point; if a little is poured into the hand, it soon evaporates. The next lot of vapours are cooled and become paraffin. What remains is heavy oil that is used as fuel.

探寻石油

在所有洞穴中，为寻找石油所钻的洞是最深的，这些洞可深达25,000英尺。但是，我们不必像开采其他矿藏那样，把人送到地下去把石油取出。这些洞只不过是一些钻孔，直径不到1英尺。我是专门搞石油的，寻找石油比其他任何采矿业对改进钻探作的贡献都要大。一旦确定了钻孔的地点，我们就在地面上竖起一个井架。井架必须很高，因为它像一个巨型滑轮组。我们必须把很长的钻杆一节节地钻入地下，然后再从地下拉出来。钻杆顶部安装的发动机带动钻杆旋转，它的底部装有钻头。

钻探石油有很大的偶然性。钻头可能到了离油层很近的地方而没有碰到油；另一方面，也可能在相当浅的地方就碰上了油。钻头下钻时，把土壤带上来。从不同深度取出土样以后，便进行检验，看是否有含油的迹象。如果在一个地方没有发现石油，钻井工就要转移到另一个地方。在石油勘探方面，已经花了大笔的钱，比如在埃及的沙漠里进行的勘探工作就是如此。有时收效甚微。当我们为自己的汽车购买几加仑汽油时，我们付的钱不仅是汽油本身的价钱，而且还包括不断进行的勘探费用。

当原油从油田取得以后，就被送往炼油厂去处理。最常见的处理方式是加热。石油经过加热，最先冒出来的蒸汽冷却后就是质量最高的汽油。汽油的沸点低，倒一点在手上，很快就挥发了。下一批冒出来的蒸汽冷却后就变成了石蜡。剩下来的是用作燃料的重油。

14. The Butterfly Effect

Beyond two or three days, the world's best weather forecasts are speculative, and beyond six or seven they are worthless. The Butterfly Effect is the reason. For small pieces of weather -- and to a global forecaster, small can mean thunderstorms and blizzards -- any prediction deteriorates rapidly. Errors and uncertainties multiply, cascading upward through a chain of turbulent features, from dust devils and squalls up to continent - size eddies that only satellites can see. The modern weather models work with a grid of points of the order of sixty miles apart, and even so, some starting data has to be guessed, since ground stations and satellites cannot see everywhere. But suppose the earth could be covered with sensors spaced one foot apart, rising at one - foot intervals all the way to the top of the atmosphere. Suppose every sensor gives perfectly accurate readings of temperature, pressure, humidity, and any other quantity a meteorologist would want. Precisely at noon an infinitely powerful computer takes all the data and calculates what will happen at each point at 12.01, then 12.02, then 12.03... The computer will still be unable to predict whether

Princeton, New Jersey, will have sun or rain on a day one month away. At noon the spaces between the sensors will hide fluctuations that the computer will not know about, tiny variations in the flow of the atmosphere that will interact with other fluctuations and create a turbulence that will spread rapidly and unpredictably. In a very short time, the computer will lose track of where the turbulence is going, and even more important, it will not know if a new disturbance has occurred somewhere else. Even with the most powerful computers, there will always be a degree of uncertainty about whether the weather will change or not, and by how much. This is the essence of the Butterfly Effect. The name comes from an example by the mathematician Edward Lorenz. He was thinking about how small changes in initial conditions can lead to large - scale effects. He imagined a butterfly flapping its wings in Brazil and then considered what would happen. "Could it be," he wondered, "that a single flap of a butterfly's wings could cause a hurricane in Texas?" His answer was yes, in principle. A butterfly flaps its wings and it causes a tiny change in the air pressure. That change in air pressure causes a slightly different pattern of air movement. That slightly different pattern of air movement causes another slightly different pattern, and so on. By the time the air movement has spread across the Atlantic Ocean, the change has become large enough to cause a hurricane in Texas. The Butterfly Effect is not just a theoretical concept. It has practical implications for weather forecasting, climate modelling, and many other fields. For example, in climate modelling, we need to understand how small changes in the Earth's climate system can lead to large - scale changes in the global climate. If we do not understand the Butterfly Effect, we may make incorrect predictions about the future of the Earth's climate. In addition to weather forecasting and climate modelling, the Butterfly Effect has implications for many other fields. For example, in economics, small changes in interest rates or exchange rates can lead to large - scale changes in the economy. In ecology, small changes in the environment can lead to large - scale changes in the ecosystem. In social science, small changes in public opinion or social behavior can lead to large - scale changes in society. The Butterfly Effect is a reminder that the world is a complex and interconnected place, and that small changes can have large - scale effects.

蝴蝶效应

世界上最好的两三天以上的天气预报具有很强的猜测性，超过六七天的天气预报就没有什么价值了。这是由蝴蝶效应造成的。对于小片的天气状况——对一个全球性的气象预报员来说，“小”可以指雷暴和暴风雪——任何预测都会迅速变得不准确。误差和不确定性会成倍增加，通过一连串的不稳定因素向上级联放大，从尘卷风、飑一直到只有卫星才能观测到的大陆大小的涡旋。现代气象模型以间距约为60英里的格点网络来运作，即便如此，有些初始数据还是不得不依靠推测，因为地面观测站和卫星不可能监测到每个地方。

但假设地球上可以布满间距为一英尺的传感器，每个传感器都垂直间隔一英尺一直排列到大气层的顶端。假设每个传感器都能极为精确地读出温度、气压、湿度以及气象学家需要的任何其他数据。在正午时分，一台性能无限强大的计算机采集所有数据并计算出12点01分、12点02分、12点03分.....各个格点将发生的情况。计算机仍然无法预测一个月后的某一天新泽西州的普林斯顿是晴天还是雨天。在正午时分，传感器之间的间距将会隐藏计算机无法得知的波动，大气流动中微小的变化将会与其他波动相互作用，从而产生一种气流扰动，这种扰动会迅速且不可预测地扩散开来。在很短的时间内，计算机就会失去对气流扰动去向的跟踪，更重要的是，它将不知道在其他地方是否已经发生了新的扰动。即使有最强大的计算机，天气是否会变化以及变化多少总是存在一定程度的不确定性。这就是蝴蝶效应的本质。

这个名称来源于数学家爱德华·洛伦兹举的一个例子。他在思考初始条件的微小变化是如何导致大规模影响的。他想象一只蝴蝶在巴西扇动翅膀，然后考虑会发生什么情况。他寻思：“一只蝴蝶扇动一下翅膀有没有可能在得克萨斯州引发一场飓风呢？”原则上，他的答案是肯定的。一只蝴蝶扇动翅膀会引起气压的微小变化。这种气压变化会导致空气流动模式稍有不同。这种稍有不同空气流动模式又会导致另一种稍有不同模式，如此等等。当空气流动扩散到大西洋彼岸时，这种变化已经大到足以在得克萨斯州引发一场飓风了。

蝴蝶效应不仅仅是一个理论概念。它对天气预报、气候模拟以及许多其他领域都有实际意义。例如，在气候模拟方面，我们需要了解地球气候系统的微小变化是如何导致全球气候大规模变化的。如果我们不理解蝴蝶效应，我们可能会对地球气候的未来做出错误的预测。

除天气预报和气候模拟之外，蝴蝶效应对许多其他领域也有影响。例如，在经济学中，利率或汇率的微小变化会导致经济的大规模变化。在生态学中，环境的微小变化会导致生态系统的大规模变化。在社会科学中，公众舆论或社会行为的微小变化会导致社会的大规模变化。蝴蝶效应提醒我们，世界是一个复杂且相互关联的地方，微小的变化可能会产生大规模的影响。

15. Secrecy in industry

Two factors weigh heavily against the effectiveness of scientific research in industry. One is the general atmosphere of secrecy in which it is carried out, the other the lack of freedom of the individual research worker. In so far as any inquiry is a secret one, it naturally limits all those engaged in carrying it out from effective contact with their fellow scientists either in other countries or in universities, or even, often enough, in other departments of the same firm. The degree of secrecy naturally varies considerably. Some of the bigger firms are engaged in researches which are of such general and fundamental nature that it is a positive advantage to them not to keep them secret. Yet a great many processes depending on such research are sought for with complete secrecy until the stage at which patents can be

taken out. Even more processes are never patented at all but kept as secret processes. This applies particularly to chemical industries, where chance discoveries play a much larger part than they do in physical and mechanical industries. Sometimes the secrecy goes to such an extent that the whole nature of the research cannot be mentioned. Many firms, for example, have great difficulty in obtaining technical or scientific books from libraries because they are unwilling to have their names entered as having taken out such and such a book, for fear the agents of other firms should be able to trace the kind of research they are likely to be undertaking.

J. B. S. Haldane once said that he preferred the society of scientists, who did not care whether their ideas were stolen, because he could do more with their ideas than they could do themselves. He was doubtless right, in so far as his own work was concerned; but it may be questioned whether it is always good for the community that a scientist should "do more" than his fellows. It is for such reasons that the case for having a scientific directorate, whose main concern should be the interests of science as a whole, becomes cogent. Such a body would need to be large enough to carry considerable authority, but not so large as to be unmanageable. It would also need to be composed of persons of very different types of scientific interests, so that the board could really be representative of all the different interests in science. There would also need to be a sufficient number of research workers in reserve so that the board could pass on to them any ideas which are likely to be of immediate value. It would be their task to test out all such ideas, and to make what seems best of them. It would also be the task of this body to arrange for the training of the research workers of the future, in so far as this can be done within the firm.

工业中的秘密

有两个因素严重地妨碍着工业中科学研究的效率：一是科研工作中普遍存在的保密气氛；二是研究人员缺乏个人自由。任何一项研究只要是保密的，自然就会限制所有参与其中的人员与其他国家、其他大学，甚至常常是同一公司其他部门的同行科学家进行有效的接触。保密程度自然差别很大。有些大公司进行的研究属于一般性和基础性的研究，因此不保密对它们来说是有利的。然而，依赖这种研究的许多工艺过程在取得专利之前都是严格保密的。更多的工艺过程根本就不会取得专利，而是作为秘方保存着。这在化学工业方面尤其突出，因为在化学工业中，偶然发现比在物理和机械工业中起的作用要大得多。有时保密竟达到了这样的程度，即连研究工作的整个性质都不能提及。例如，许多公司向图书馆借阅科技书籍时感到很困难，因为它们不愿让人家记下它们的名字和借阅的某一本书，生怕别的情报人员由此能追踪到它们可能正在从事的研究。

J. B. S.

霍尔丹曾经说过，他更喜欢科学家的社交圈子，因为科学家不在乎他们的想法是否被人窃取，他可以利用这些想法做更多的事，而这些想法的主人自己却做不到。就他自己的工作而言，他无疑是正确的；但一个科学家比他的同行“做更多的事”是否总是对社会有益，

这也许值得怀疑。正是由于这些原因，建立一个科学指导机构的想法变得很有说服力，这个机构的主要职责应该是关注科学的整体利益。这样一个机构需要足够大以具有相当的权威性，但又不能大到无法管理的程度。它还需要由具有非常不同科学兴趣类型的人员组成，这样委员会才能真正代表科学领域中所有不同的利益。还需要有足够数量的后备研究人员，以便委员会能将可能具有即时价值的想法传递给他们。他们的任务就是对所有这些想法进行检验，并从中挑选出最好的想法。这个机构的任务还包括安排对未来研究人员的培训，只要这种培训能在公司内部进行。

16. The Search for the Earth's Minerals

The earth is a large, rocky planet where there is little free oxygen or water on the surface. However, beneath the surface there is a great deal of activity. Heat from the interior of the earth melts rocks and creates magma. This magma rises to the surface through cracks in the rocks, and when it cools, it forms new rocks.

Minerals are substances that are formed in this way. They are the building blocks of rocks. There are over 3,000 different minerals, but only about 20 are common. These common minerals are found in most rocks.

The search for minerals is an important activity. Minerals are used in many different ways. Some minerals, such as gold and silver, are used for making jewellery. Others, such as iron and copper, are used for making tools and machines. Minerals are also used in building materials, such as cement and bricks.

Geologists are scientists who study the earth. They use many different methods to find minerals. One method is to study the rocks on the surface. Geologists can tell a lot about the minerals that are likely to be found beneath the surface by looking at the rocks on the surface. Another method is to use special instruments to detect the presence of minerals. These instruments can measure the magnetic field, gravity, or electrical conductivity of the rocks.

Once a likely area for minerals has been found, geologists will drill holes to take samples of the rocks. These samples will be analyzed in a laboratory to find out what minerals are present. If minerals are found, mining operations may begin.

探寻地球的矿藏

地球是一个巨大的岩石行星，其表面几乎没有游离氧和水。然而，在地表之下却有大量的活动。地球内部的热量熔化岩石并产生岩浆。这种岩浆通过岩石的裂缝上升到地表，冷却后便形成新的岩石。

矿物就是以这种方式形成的物质。它们是岩石的组成部分。矿物有3000多种，但常见的大约只有20种。这些常见矿物在大多数岩石中都能找到。

寻找矿物是一项重要的活动。矿物有许多不同的用途。有些矿物，如金和银，被用来制作珠宝。其他矿物，如铁和铜，则被用来制造工具和机器。矿物还被用于建筑材料，如水泥和砖块。

地质学家是研究地球的科学家。他们使用许多不同的方法来寻找矿物。一种方法是研究地表的岩石。地质学家通过观察地表的岩石，就能对地下可能发现的矿物了解很多情况。另一种方法是使用特殊仪器来探测矿物的存在。这些仪器能够测量岩石的磁场、重力或导电性。

一旦发现一个可能有矿物的地区，地质学家就会钻孔采集岩石样本。这些样本将在实验室进行分析，以确定存在哪些矿物。如果发现了矿物，就可能开始采矿作业。

17. The Greatest Bridge in the World

Verrazano, an Italian about whom little is known, sailed into New York Harbour in 1524 and named it Angouleme. He described it as 'a very agreeable situation located within two small hills in the midst of which flowed a great river.'. Though Verrazano is by no means considered to be a great explorer, his name will probably remain immortal, for on November 21st, 1964, the longest suspension bridge in the world was named after him.

The Verrazano Bridge, which was designed by Othmar Ammann, joins Brooklyn to Staten Island. It has a span of 4,260 feet. The bridge is so long that the shape of the earth had to be taken into account by its designer. Two great towers support four huge cables. The towers are built on immense underwater platforms made of steel and concrete. The platforms extend to a depth of over 100 feet under the sea. These alone took sixteen months to build. Above the surface of the water, the towers rise to a height of nearly 700 feet. They support the cables from which the bridge has been suspended. Each of the four cables contains 26,108 lengths of wire. It has been estimated that if the bridge were packed with cars, it would still only be carrying a third of its total capacity. However, size and strength are not the only important things about this bridge. Despite its immensity, it is both simple and elegant, fulfilling its designer's dream to create 'an enormous object drawn as faintly as possible'.

世界上最长的吊桥

1524年，一位鲜为人知的意大利人维拉萨诺驾船驶进纽约港，并将该港命名为安古拉姆。

他对该港作了这样的描述：“地理位置十分适宜，位于两座小山的中间，一条大河从中间流过。”虽然维拉萨诺绝对算不上一个伟大的探险家，但他的名字将流芳百世，因为1964年11月21日建成的世界上最长的吊桥是以他的名字命名的。

维拉萨诺大桥由奥斯马·阿曼设计，连结着布鲁克林与斯塔顿岛，桥长4,260英尺。由于桥身太长，设计者不得不考虑了地表的形状。两座巨塔支撑着4根粗大的钢缆。塔身建在巨大的水下钢筋混凝土平台上。平台深入海底100多英尺。仅这两座塔就花了16个月才建成。塔身高出水面将近700英尺。高塔支撑着钢缆，而钢缆又悬吊着大桥。4根钢缆中的每根由26,108股钢绳组成。据估计，若桥上摆满了汽车，也只不过是桥的总承载力的1/3。然而，这座桥重要特点不仅是它的规模与强度。尽管此桥很大，但它的结构简单，造型优美，实现了设计者企图创造一个“尽量用细线条勾画出一个庞然大物”的梦想。

18. Porpoises

There has long been a superstition among mariners that porpoises will save drowning men by pushing them to the surface, or protect them from sharks by surrounding them in defensive formation. Marine Studio biologists have pointed out that, however intelligent they may be, it is probably a mistake to credit dolphins with any motive of life - saving. On the occasions when they have pushed to shore an unconscious human being they have much more likely done it out of curiosity or for sport, as in riding the bow waves of a ship. In 1928 some porpoises were photographed working like beavers to push ashore a waterlogged mattress. If, as has been reported, they have protected humans from sharks, it may have been because curiosity attracted them and because the scent of a possible meal attracted the sharks. Porpoises and sharks are natural enemies. It is possible that upon such an occasion a battle ensued, with the sharks being driven away or killed.

Whether it be bird, fish or beast, the porpoise is intrigued with anything that is alive. They are constantly after the turtles, who peacefully submit to all sorts of indignities. One young calf especially enjoyed raising a turtle to the surface with his snout and then shoving him across the tank like an aquaplane. Almost any day a young porpoise may be seen trying to turn a 300 - pound sea turtle over by sticking his snout under the edge of his shell and pushing up for dear life. This is not easy, and may require two porpoises working together. In another game, as the turtles swim across the oceanarium, the first porpoise swoops down from above and butts his shell with his belly. This knocks the turtle down several feet where another porpoise is waiting to give it another butt. The turtles seem to enjoy it, but perhaps they would not if they could feel the scratches on their shells from the porpoises' teeth. After such a burst of activity they usually take a short rest before they start off

again.

A porpoise will follow a ship for hours at a time, leaping out of the water and doing somersaults. There is no evidence that porpoises have a language but they communicate with one another by squeaks, clicks and whistles. It has been suggested that they may be able to communicate with humans through these sounds, but this has not been proven. One theory is that they use these sounds to navigate, by detecting the echoes of their own voices. Another theory is that they use them to communicate their emotions, such as excitement or fear. Still another theory is that they use them to identify one another, as each porpoise has a unique set of squeaks, clicks and whistles.

海豚

长期以来，海员中有一种迷信说法，认为海豚会把快要淹死的人托出水面使之获救，或者在人们周围形成防御队形来保护他们免受鲨鱼伤害。海洋摄影室的生物学家指出，不管海豚有多聪明，认为它们有救人的动机可能是错误的。当它们把失去知觉的人推到岸边时，很可能是出于好奇或游戏，就像它们追逐船首的浪花一样。1928年，有人拍摄到一些海豚像海狸一样把一只浸透水的床垫推上岸。如果如报道所说，它们保护人类免受鲨鱼伤害，可能是因为好奇吸引了它们，而可能有食物的气味吸引了鲨鱼。海豚和鲨鱼是天敌。在这种情况下，可能会发生一场战斗，鲨鱼被赶走或被杀死。

不管是鸟、鱼还是兽，海豚对任何活物都感兴趣。它们总是追逐海龟，而海龟则温顺地忍受着各种侮辱。有一只小海豚特别喜欢用鼻子把海龟顶出水面，然后像滑水板一样把海龟推过水池。几乎每天都可以看到一只小海豚试图把一只300磅重的海龟翻过来，它把鼻子伸到龟壳边缘下面，拼命往上顶。这可不容易，可能需要两只海豚一起合作。在另一个游戏中，当海龟游过水族馆时，第一只海豚从上方猛扑下来，用肚皮撞击龟壳。这会使海龟下沉几英尺，这时另一只海豚在那里等着再给它一击。海龟似乎很享受这个过程，但如果它们能感觉到海豚牙齿在龟壳上留下的划痕，也许就不会这么想了。这样一阵活动之后，它们通常会休息一会儿，然后再重新开始。

海豚会一次跟着船几个小时，跃出水面并做翻滚动作。没有证据表明海豚有语言，但它们通过吱吱声、咔嗒声和哨声相互交流。有人提出它们也许能够通过这些声音与人类交流，但这还没有得到证实。一种理论认为，它们利用这些声音导航，通过探测自己声音的回声。另一种理论认为，它们用这些声音来传达自己的情绪，如兴奋或恐惧。还有一种理论认为，它们用这些声音来识别彼此，因为每只海豚都有一套独特的吱吱声、咔嗒声和哨声。

19. The Stuff of Dreams

It is fairly clear that the sleeping period must have some function, and because there is so much of it the function would seem to be important. Speculations about its nature have been going on for literally thousands of years, and one odd finding that makes the problem puzzling is that it looks very much as if sleeping is not simply a matter of giving the body a rest. 'Rest', in terms of muscle relaxation and so on, can be achieved by a brief period lying, or even sitting down. The body's tissues are self-repairing and self-restoring to a degree, and function best when more or less continuously active. In fact a basic amount of movement occurs during sleep which is specifically concerned with preventing muscle inactivity. If it is not a question of resting the body, perhaps it is the brain that needs resting? This might be a plausible hypothesis were it not for two factors. First the electroencephalograph (which is simply a device for recording the electrical activity of the brain by attaching electrodes to the scalp) shows that while there is a change in the pattern of activity during sleep, there is no evidence that the total amount of activity is any less. The second factor is more interesting and more fundamental. In 1960 an American psychiatrist named William Dement published experiments dealing with the recording of eye-movements during sleep. He showed that the average individual's sleep cycle is punctuated by peculiar bursts of eye-movements, some slow, some rapid, some in both directions. These periods of eye-movements are called REM sleep (Rapid Eye Movement) periods, and they occur at intervals of about 90 minutes throughout the night with an average duration of about 20 minutes. People woken during these periods of REM sleep generally report that they have been dreaming. When woken at other times they reported no dreams. If one group of people were disturbed from their eye-movement sleep for several nights on end, and another group were disturbed for an equal number of nights but when they were not experiencing eye-movement sleep, the first group began to show some personality disorders while the second group did not. REM sleep seems to be essential for the normal functioning of the brain. REM sleep occurs in both humans and animals. Some animals, such as cats, have large amounts of REM sleep, while others, such as cows, have very little. There is some evidence that the amount of REM sleep is related to the intelligence of the animal. The more intelligent the animal, the more REM sleep it has. But why should REM sleep be essential for the normal functioning of the brain? One theory is that during REM sleep the brain is 'rehearsing' things that it has learned during the day. Another theory is that REM sleep is a time when the brain is 'clearing' itself of useless information. But neither of these theories has been proved yet. So far we have only been able to say that REM sleep seems to be essential for the normal functioning of the brain, and that the

amount of REM sleep is related to the intelligence of the animal. We still do not know what the function of sleep is, or why we need to dream.

话说梦的本质

很清楚，睡眠必然具有某种作用。由于睡眠占去那么多时间，其作用似乎还很重要。人们对睡眠作用的种种猜测，确实有数千年之久。一项使人对这个问题感到困惑的奇怪的发现是，睡眠在很大程度上似乎并不仅仅是为了使身体得到休息。“休息”，从使肌肉得到放松等方面来看，只要稍微躺一躺，甚至坐一坐就能达到。人体组织在一定程度上有自我修补和自我恢复的能力，有张有弛地连续活动时，其功能最佳。事实上，睡眠期间仍有一定基本量的活动，这种活动特别与防止肌肉活动中断有关。如果睡眠的功能不是在于使身体得到休息，也许是大脑需要休息吧？若不是下面两点，这种假使似乎是有道理的。第一点，脑电图记录仪（不过是一种把电极接到头皮上记录脑电活动的仪器）表明，人在睡眠时大脑活动的方式有变化，但没有迹象表明其活动总量有任何减少。第二点更有意思，也更重要。1960年，一位名叫威廉·迪蒙特的美国精神病学家发表了一篇报告，报告中记录了他对睡眠时眼球活动的研究情况。他指出，平常人的睡眠周期中不时穿插着一阵阵奇怪的眼球活动，这些活动有的慢，有的快，有的双向进行。这些眼球活动期间被称为快速眼动（REM）睡眠期，它们在一夜之间每隔大约90分钟发生一次，每次平均持续约20分钟。在快速眼动睡眠期间被叫醒的人一般都说自己在做梦；在其他时间叫醒他们，则说没有做梦。如果有一组人连续几夜在其眼球活动期间被叫醒，而另一组人也是连续几夜被叫醒，但是在其眼球没有活动期间被叫醒，结果，第一组人开始出现一些性格失常，而第二组人则没有。快速眼动睡眠看来对大脑的正常功能是必不可少的。快速眼动睡眠在人和动物身上都会发生。有些动物，如猫，有大量的快速眼动睡眠；而另一些动物，如牛，则有很少的快速眼动睡眠。有证据表明，快速眼动睡眠的量与动物的智力有关：动物越聪明，快速眼动睡眠就越多。但是，为什么快速眼动睡眠对大脑的正常功能是必不可少的呢？一种理论认为，在快速眼动睡眠期间，大脑在“排练”它在白天学到的东西。另一种理论认为，快速眼动睡眠是大脑“清除”无用信息的时候。但这两种理论都尚未得到证实。到目前为止，我们只能说，快速眼动睡眠似乎对大脑的正常功能是必不可少的，而且快速眼动睡眠的量与动物的智力有关。我们仍然不知道睡眠的功能是什么，也不知道我们为什么需要做梦。

20. Snake poison

How it came about that snakes manufactured poison is a mystery. Over the periods their saliva, a mild, digestive juice like our own, was converted into a poison that defies analysis even today. It was not forced upon them by the survival competition; they could have caught and lived on prey without using poison, just as the thousands of non-poisonous snakes still do. Poison to a snake is merely a luxury; it enables it to get its food with very little effort, no more effort than one bite. And why only snakes? Cats, for instance, would be greatly helped; no running fights with large, fierce rats or tussles with grown chickens - the mouse or young chicken goes limply

into the cat's mouth.

The snakes' poison is highly modified saliva containing zootoxins which act on the nervous system and blood circulation. It is different in every single kind of snake - from the cobra's for instance which affects the nerves, to the viper's which, on the contrary, affects the blood.

One wonders also why nature, with some snakes, concocted poison of such extreme potency. In the conversion of saliva into poison, one might suppose that a fixed process took place. It did not; some snakes manufactured a poison different in every respect from that of others, as different as arsenic is from strychnine, and having different effects. One poison acts on the nerves, the other on the blood.

The spitting cobra is another case of a snake that has modified its saliva into a poison different in nature from that of other snakes. This snake, instead of biting, spits out a jet of venom which may reach a distance of two feet. It is not very accurate, but it is enough to cause a lot of pain and some blindness if it gets into the eyes. The spitting cobra has little poison. What is this snake's advantage in having a poison that is not very powerful? The answer is that it has a very good aim; it is almost always successful in hitting its target, which is the eyes of the victim. And why should it spit? There is no obvious reason why it should not bite. The answer is that it has a good aim; it is almost always successful in hitting its target, which is the eyes of the victim. By spitting, it can keep a safe distance from its prey, which is a great advantage in a fight.

蛇毒

蛇是怎样产生毒液的，这是一个谜。蛇的唾液本来和我们人的消化液一样柔和，经过漫长的时间，演变成了今天仍无法分析清楚的毒液。毒液不是生存竞争强加给它们的，它们可以不用毒液捕捉动物而生存，就像今天成千上万的无毒蛇那样。毒液对蛇来说只不过是一种奢侈品，它使蛇可以毫不费力地获取食物，轻咬一口即可。为什么只有蛇才有毒液呢？如果猫有毒液，那对猫会大有帮助，它就不必再和又大又凶的老鼠边跑边搏斗了，也不必再和大鸡扭斗了，只要咬一口，老鼠或小鸡就会瘫软下来成为猫的口中物。

蛇的毒液是高度进化的唾液，含有动物毒素，作用于神经系统和血液循环。不同种类的蛇的毒液各不相同，例如眼镜蛇的毒液作用于神经，而蝰蛇的毒液则相反，作用于血液。

人们还会感到奇怪，为什么大自然在某些蛇身上调制出如此高效的毒液呢？在把唾液转化为毒液时，人们可能认为会有一个固定的程序。事实并非如此，有些蛇产生的毒液在各个方面都与其他蛇的毒液不同，就像砒霜不同于马钱子碱一样，它们产生的效果也不同。一种毒液作用于神经，另一种毒液作用于血液。

喷射毒液的眼镜蛇又是一个例子，这种蛇把自己的唾液转化为一种性质与其他蛇的毒液不同的毒液。这种蛇不是咬，而是喷射出一股毒液，射程可达两英尺。毒液喷射得不是很准

，但如果射进眼睛里，就足以造成剧痛，甚至失明。喷射毒液的眼镜蛇毒液量很少。这种蛇的毒液威力不大，它的优势是什么呢？答案是它的喷射非常精准，几乎每次都能射中目标，也就是受害者的眼睛。那么它为什么要喷射毒液呢？没有明显的理由表明它不应该咬。答案是它的喷射非常精准，几乎每次都能射中目标，也就是受害者的眼睛。通过喷射毒液，它可以与猎物保持安全距离，这在战斗中是一个很大的优势。

21. William S. Hart and the Early "Western" Film

William S. Hart was, perhaps, the greatest of all Western stars, for unlike Gary Cooper and John Wayne he appeared in nothing but Westerns. From 1914 to 1924 he was supreme and unchallenged. It was Hart who created the basic formula of the Western film, and devised the protagonist he played in every film he made, the good - bad man, the accidental - noble outlaw, or the honest - but - framed cowboy, or the sheriff made suspect by vicious gossip; in short, the individual in conflict with himself and his frontier environment.

Hart actually knew something of the old West. He had lived in it as a child when it was already disappearing, and his hero was firmly rooted in his memories and experiences, and in both the history and the mythology of the vanished frontier. And although no period or place in American history has been more absurdly romanticized, myth and reality did join hands in at least one arena, the conflict between the individual and encroaching civilization.

Men accustomed to struggling for survival against the elements and Indians were bewildered by politicians, bankers and businessmen, and unhorsed by fences, laws and alien taboos. Hart's good - bad man was always an outsider, always one of the disinherited, and if he found it necessary to shoot a sheriff or rob a bank along the way, his early audiences found it easy to understand and forgive, especially when it was Hart who, in the end, overcame the attacking Indians or the outlaw gang. Audiences in the second decade of the twentieth century found it pleasant to escape to a time when life, though hard, was relatively simple. We still do; living in a world in which undeclared aggression, war, hypocrisy, chicanery, anarchy and impending doom seem to be the norm, we all want a code to live by.

Carrying a gun in the city is illegal in most countries, but it was not so in the Old West. Hart's audiences knew that they were watching a film about the Old West when they saw a gun on the screen, and they were able to distinguish between the film world and the real world. But most of them, as they watched Hart, were probably unaware that they were also seeing the creation of a new art form. The

Western film has been the most popular genre of American cinema since the early days of the silent era, and it has had a profound influence on the development of cinema around the world.

威廉·S·哈特和早期的“西部”电影

威廉·S·哈特大概是美国西部电影明星中的佼佼者。他和加里·古柏、约翰·韦恩不同，他只在西部电影中扮演角色。在1914年至1924年期间，他首屈一指，独霸影坛。正是哈特创造了西部电影的基本模式，即在他自己的影片中他所塑造的主人公形象：被认为是坏人的好人，出人意料的高尚的逃犯，诚实却遭陷害的牛仔或因流言蜚语蒙受嫌疑的治安官。总之，主人公是一个自相矛盾，又与他的拓荒环境相冲突的人物。

哈特与美国西部确有某种联系。作为一个孩子他曾在西部生活过，当时西部拓荒生活正在消失。他塑造的英雄人物深深地扎根于他本人的记忆和经历之中，也扎根于有关已经消失的拓荒生活的历史和神话之中。虽然在美国历史上没有任何时期或地区像西部拓荒时期那样被荒谬地浪漫主义化了，但神话和现实至少在某一个舞台上共存，也就是存在于个人与渐渐闯入的文明这两者的冲突之中。

习惯与大自然和印第安人作斗争以求生存的拓荒者被政客、银行家和商人搞得晕头转向，最后被圈地、法律和外来清规戒律所击败。哈特扮演的被认为是坏人的好人总是一个局外人，总是一个被剥夺继承权的人。如果他认为在进行过程中有必要枪击一个治安官或抢劫一家银行，他的早期观众很容易理解和原谅他，特别是当哈特最后战胜了前来进攻的印第安人或歹徒的时候。生活在20世纪第二个十年的观众认为，逃到一个即使艰苦但比较简朴的时代中去是件愉快的事，我们今天仍然有这种感觉。如今，不宣而战的侵略、战争、虚伪、诈骗、无政府状态以及即将临头的毁灭似乎成了正常现象，我们都希望有一个赖以生存的行为准则。

在大多数国家，在城市携带枪支是违法的，但在旧西部却不是这样。哈特的观众知道，当他们在银幕上看到一把枪时，他们是在观看一部关于旧西部的电影，他们能够区分电影世界和现实世界。但是，当他们观看哈特的电影时，大多数人可能没有意识到他们也在目睹一种新艺术形式的诞生。西部电影自无声电影时代初期以来一直是美国电影中最受欢迎的类型，并且对世界各地电影的发展产生了深远的影响。

22. Knowledge and Progress

Why does the idea of progress loom so large in the modern world? Surely because progress of a particular kind is actually taking place around us and is becoming more and more manifest. Although mankind has undergone no general improvement in intelligence or morality, it has made extraordinary progress in the accumulation of knowledge. Knowledge began to increase as soon as the thoughts of one individual could be communicated to another by means of speech. With the invention of

writing, a great advance was made, for knowledge could then be not only communicated but also stored. Libraries made education possible, and education in its turn added to libraries: the growth of knowledge followed a kind of compound - interest law, which was greatly enhanced by the invention of printing. All this was comparatively slow until, with the coming of science, the tempo was suddenly raised. Then knowledge began to be accumulated according to a systematic plan. The trickle became a stream; the stream has now become a torrent. Moreover, as soon as new knowledge is acquired, it is now turned to practical account. What is called "modern civilization" is not the result of a balanced development of all man's nature, but of accumulated knowledge applied to practical life. The problem now facing humanity is: What is going to be done with all this knowledge? As is so often pointed out, knowledge is a two - edged weapon which can be used equally for good or evil. It is now being used indifferently for both. Could any spectacle, for instance, be more grimly whimsical than that of gunners using science to shatter men's bodies while, close at hand, surgeons use it to restore them? We have to ask ourselves very seriously what will happen if this two - edged weapon falls into the hands of those who would use it for evil purposes. Newspapers and broadcasters, as well as individuals, now spread that information quickly and widely. Disarmament negotiations in Geneva have been going on for years without accomplishing anything. But suppose we succeed in disarming the atom, our work as moral beings is not yet done. It is a problem that calls for very serious consideration. What is the use of disarming the atom if we do not also disarm the mind? It is not enough to take this weapon out of the hands of the soldiers. We must take it out of the hands of the politicians as well. The more knowledge men have, the more responsible they should be. It is only when we are very much more intelligent than we are at present that we shall be able to realize all that knowledge implies.

知识和进步

为什么进步这个概念在现代世界显得如此突出？无疑是因为有一种特殊的进步实际上正在我们周围发生，而且变得越来越明显。虽然人类在智力和道德上没有得到普遍提高，但在知识积累方面却取得了巨大的进步。一旦一个人的思想能够借助语言传递给另一个人，知识便开始增长了。随着书写的发明，又迈进了一大步，因为这样一来，知识不仅能交流，而且能储存了。图书馆使教育成为可能，而教育反过来又丰富了图书馆：知识的增长遵循着一种复利法则，印刷术的发明又大大提高了知识增长的速度。在科学出现之前，所有这些发展都相当缓慢；随着科学的到来，速度突然加快了。于是，知识开始按照系统的计划积累起来。涓涓细流汇成了小溪，小溪现已变成了奔腾的江河。而且，新知识一旦获得，马上就得到实际应用。所谓“现代文明”并非人的全部天性均衡发展的结果，而是把积累的知识应用于实际生活的结果。现在人类面临的问题是：用这些知识去做什么？正如人们常常指出的，知识是一把双刃剑，既可以用于行善，也可以用于作恶。现在人们正不加区别地把知识用于这两个方面。例如：炮兵利用科学毁坏人的身体、而外科医生就在附近用

科学抢救被炮兵毁坏的人体，还有比这更荒诞离奇的情景吗？我们不得不非常严肃地问自己：如果这把双刃剑落入那些想用它来作恶的人手中，将会发生什么情况呢？现在，报纸、广播电台以及个人都在迅速而广泛地传播着这种信息。日内瓦裁军谈判已经进行了多年，但毫无成果。但是，即使我们成功地解除了原子的武装，我们作为道德存在者的工作还没有完成。这是一个需要非常认真考虑的问题。如果我们不同时解除思想上的武装，解除原子的武装又有什么用呢？仅仅把这种武器从士兵手中拿走是不够的。我们还必须把它从政治家手中拿走。人们的知识越多，他们就应该越有责任感。只有当我们比现在聪明得多的时候，我们才能认识到知识所包含的全部意义。

23. Bird flight

No two sorts of birds practise quite the same sort of flight; the varieties are infinite; but two classes may be roughly seen. Any ship that crosses the Pacific is accompanied for many days by the smaller albatross, Which may keep company with the vessel for an hour without visible or more than occasional movement of wing. The currents of air that the walls of the ship direct upwards, as well as in the line of its course, are enough to give the great bird with its immense wings sufficient sustenance and progress. The albatross is the king of the gliders, the class of fliers which harness the air to their purpose, but must yield to its opposition. In the contrary school, the duck is supreme. It comes nearer to the engines with which man has 'conquered' the air, as he boasts. Duck, and like them the pigeons, are endowed with such-like muscles, that are a good part of the weight of the bird, and these will ply the short wings with such irresistible power that they can bore for long distances through an opposing gale before exhaustion follows. Their humbler followers, such as partridges, have a like power of strong propulsion, but soon tire. You may pick them up in utter exhaustion, if wind over the sea has driven them to a long journey. The swallow shares the virtues of both schools in highest measure. It tires not, nor does it boast of its power; but belongs to the air, travelling it may be six thousand miles to and from its northern nesting home, feeding its flown young as it flies, and slipping through a medium that seems to help its passage even when the wind is adverse. Such birds do us good, though we no longer take omens from their flight on this side and that; and even the most superstitious villagers no longer take off their hats to the magpie and wish it good - morning.

When Bleriot crossed the Channel at last, it was in a monoplane, an appellation which is now indifferently applied to both the single and double - winged machines, because such machines have by now been so far developed that the initial distinction has no longer any real importance. There is no special branch of standard English

for piloting airplanes; still the lingo is so different from that of everyday life that the characters in a play or film have to be made to use some easily recognizable jargon if they are to represent pilots on the stage or screen. So the monoplane became "the thing" with the flying men, a clumsy - looking contrivance of wood and wire and cloth, with something not unlike a box - kite tied in front of it; and so it remained for many years. The word 'aeroplane' was usurped by the newcomers in exactly the same way as the word 'automobile' was usurped by the manufacturers of motor - cars. In England at least, a motor - car was originally a carriage without horses, and the name stuck, even when the horses had been replaced by an engine. The aeroplane, too, at first was an 'air - plane', a structure built to plane in the air, not just to fly as a bird does, or as an insect does, but to glide on a plane, which means, in practice, to float on an air - current, exactly as a sled glides on a snow - current. But the newcomers called their machines 'aeroplanes', and the name has stuck, just as the name 'automobile' has stuck in America. In France, of course, the word 'avion' has always been used, and in Germany the word 'Flugzeug'.

鸟的飞行方法

没有任何两种鸟的飞行方式是相同的。鸟的飞行方式千差万别，但大体上可分为两类。任何一艘横越太平洋的轮船都会有小信天翁伴随飞行许多天。它们随船飞行一小时也难得见其扇动一下翅膀，或者只是偶尔扇动一下。沿船体上升的气流和沿航线向前的气流给这种巨翼大鸟以足够的浮力和推力。信天翁是滑翔鸟类之王，这类鸟能自如地驾驭空气，但必须顺气流飞行。与滑翔鸟相对的另一类鸟中，野鸭是佼佼者。它更近乎于人类自夸的“征服”了空气的发动机。野鸭及与它们相似的鸽子有相似的肌肉，这些肌肉占了鸟体重量的很大一部分。这些肌肉以很大的力量扇动短小的翅膀，使这类鸟能顶着大风飞行很远的距离才会疲劳。次于野鸭和鸽子的鸟，如鹈鹕，有相似的强劲的推动力，但很快会疲劳。如果海风驱使它们飞行很长距离，你可捡到精疲力竭的鹈鹕。燕子充分兼有这两类鸟的长处，它既不疲劳，也不炫耀自己的飞翔力；它在天空中十分自如，可以飞行6,000英里，可以飞往北方做窝的老家，再从老家飞回；一边飞一边喂养会飞的雏燕；甚至在顶风时也能在气流中滑翔，似乎气流在帮它前进。这些鸟对我们有益；虽然我们不再从它们的飞翔姿态来占卜吉凶，连最迷信的村民也不再对喜鹊脱帽行礼，祝它早安了。

布莱里奥最后横渡英吉利海峡的时候，他驾驶的是一架单翼飞机。现在这个名称被不加区别地用来指单翼机和双翼机，因为这两种飞机发展到今天，最初的区别已经没有什么实际意义了。英语中并没有驾驶飞机的专门术语。但是，航空专业术语与日常生活用语是如此不同，以至于戏剧或电影中的角色如果要在舞台或银幕上扮演飞行员，就必须说一些容易被理解的行话。于是单翼机就成了飞行员们的“时髦”货，一种由木头、金属丝和布料制成的看上去很笨拙的装置，前面系着一个有点像箱形风筝的东西，多年来它一直是这个样子。“aeroplane”这个词被新来者篡用，就像“automobile”这个词被汽车制造商篡用一样。至少在英国，“motor - car”原意为“不用马拉的马车”，这个名称就一直沿用下来，即使后来马车被发动机取代了。“aeroplane”最初也是指“air -

plane”，一种为在空中滑翔而制造的结构，不只是像鸟或昆虫那样飞行，而是在一个平面上滑翔，实际上也就是在一股气流上漂浮，就像雪橇在雪流上滑行一样。但是新来者把他们的飞机叫做“aeroplanes”，这个名称就一直沿用下来，就像“automobile”这个词在美国一直沿用下来一样。当然，在法国一直使用“avion”这个词，在德国一直使用“Flugzeug”这个词。

24. Beauty

A young man sees a sunset and, unable to understand or to express the emotion that it rouses in him, concludes that it must be the gateway to a world that lies beyond. It is difficult for any of us in moments of intense aesthetic experience to resist the suggestion that we are catching a glimpse of a light that shines down to us from a different realm of existence, different and, because the experience is intensely moving, in some way higher. And, though the gleams blind and dazzle, yet do they convey a hint of beauty and serenity greater than we have known or imagined. Greater too than we can describe; for language, which was invented to convey the meanings of this world, cannot readily be fitted to the uses of another.

That all great art has this power of suggesting a world beyond is undeniable. In some moods, Nature shares it. There is no sky in June so blue that it does not point forward to a bluer, no sunset so beautiful that it does not waken the vision of a greater beauty, a vision which passes before it is fully glimpsed, and in passing leaves an indefinable longing and regret. But, if this world is not merely a bad joke, life a vulgar flare amid the cool radiance of the cosmos, and existence an empty laugh braying across the mysteries; if these intimations of a something behind and beyond are not evil humour born of indigestion, or whimsies sent by the devil to mock and madden us, if, in a word, beauty means something, yet we must not seek to interpret the meaning. If we glimpse the unutterable, it is unwise to try to utter it, nor should we seek to invest with significance that which we cannot grasp. Beauty in terms of our human meanings is meaningless.

Beauty is not a need but an ecstasy. It is not a mouth thirsting nor an empty hand stretched forth, but rather a heart enflamed and a soul enchanted. It is not the image you would see nor the song you would hear, but rather an image you see though you close your eyes and a song you hear though you shut your ears. It is not the sap within the leaf, nor the dove upon the bough, but rather the mistral to come, the storm to be weathered. It is not a matter of satisfying simple needs, but rather of fulfilling the highest aspirations of the human spirit.

Beauty is an ecstasy; it is as simple as hunger. There is really nothing to be said about it. It is like the perfume of a flower: you can smell it and that is all. It is a common property of all great art, and one that differentiates great art from merely good art. The more we try to explain it in terms of its why and how, the more it eludes us; yet we know when we have met it, and we know when we have missed it. The best we can do is to describe it, to try to put it into words, but then it is no longer beauty. It is like trying to put your finger on the wind. It is always beyond our grasp, and that is why it is beautiful.

美

一个年轻人看到日落，由于无法理解和表达日落在他心中唤起的激情，便得出结论：日落处想必是通往遥远世界的大门。无论是谁，在强烈感受到美的时刻，心中都不禁油然而生一种遐想：我们似乎瞥见从另一个世界射向我们的一线光芒，那个世界不仅不同于我们这个世界，而且由于美感的强烈感染，在某些方面比我们这个世界更美好。虽然这光芒令人眼花缭乱，但它确实给予我们一种不曾经历和无法想象的美感和静谧的启示。这种美感和静谧是我们无法描述的，因为我们发明的语言是用来描述这个世界的含义，不能随便拿来描述另一个世界。

不可否认，一切伟大的艺术都具有使人超尘脱俗的浮想的力量。在某种状态下，大自然也有这种魅力。六月蔚蓝的天空总使人遥想一个更加蔚蓝的苍穹；美丽的落日总会引起一个更加绚丽的景象未及饱览便一闪即逝，并在消逝中给人留下不可名状的渴望和惆怅。如果这个世界不只是一个拙劣的恶作剧，如果人生不只是群星寒光中平凡的一闪，如果存在不只是对神秘事物的一种空虚的笑声，如果某种玄妙事物的暗示不是消化不良引起的邪恶情绪，也不是魔鬼为了捉弄我们，使我们发狂而送给我们的邪念，一句话，如果美有某种意义的话，我们千万不要去阐明它的意义。如果我们瞥见了只可意会不可言传的事物，企图把它说出来，那是不明智的；对于我们不理解的事物，我们也不应该去赋予它某种意义。用人类智慧来解释美是毫无意义的。

美不是一种需要，只是一种狂喜。它不是干渴的嘴唇，也不是伸出的空手，而是一颗燃烧的心，一个陶醉的灵魂。它不是你能看到的形象，也不是你能听到的歌声，而是你闭上眼睛仍能看到的形象，堵住耳朵仍能听到的歌声。它不是树叶中的汁液，也不是栖息在枝头的小鸟，而是即将到来的南风，是要经受的风暴。它不是为了满足简单的需要，而是为了实现人类精神的最高追求。

美是一种狂喜，它和饥饿一样简单。实际上，关于美没什么可说的。它就像花朵的芬芳：你能闻到它，仅此而已。这是所有伟大艺术的共性，也是伟大艺术区别于一般艺术的标志。我们越是想从它的原理和原因方面来解释它，它就越躲着我们；然而我们一旦遭遇它，就会知道它的存在；一旦错过它，也会知道它的消失。我们所能做的最好的事情就是去描述它，设法用语言来表达它，但是这样一来它就不再是美了。这就像想用手指去触摸风一样。美总是在我们够不着的地方，这也是它之所以美的原因。

25. Non-auditory Effects of Noise

Many people in industry and the Services, who have practical experience of noise, regard any investigation of this question as a waste of time; they are not prepared even to admit the possibility that noise affects people. On the other hand, those who dislike noise will sometimes use most inadequate evidence to support their pleas for a quieter society. This is a pity, because noise abatement really is a good cause, and it is likely to be discredited if it gets to be associated with bad science. One allegation often made is that noise produces mental illness. A recent article in a weekly newspaper, for instance, was headed with a striking illustration of a lady in a state of considerable distress, with the caption 'She was yet another victim, reduced to a screaming wreck'. On turning eagerly to the text, one learns that the lady was a typist who found the sound of office typewriters worried her more and more until eventually she had to go into a mental hospital. Now the snag in this sort of anecdote is of course that one cannot distinguish cause and effect. Was it the noise, perhaps, that made the woman ill? Or was it the fact that she was already ill that caused her to be hypersensitive to noise? Another patient might equally well complain that her neighbours were combining to slander her and persecute her, and yet one might be cautious about believing this statement. What is needed in the case of noise is a study of large numbers of people living under noisy conditions, to discover whether they are mentally ill more often than other people are. The United States Navy, for some years, has been conducting an experiment along these very lines. They have in view a new weapon that would produce a very loud sound and wondered whether the noise could be used as a weapon of war. So they are now studying the effects of a very loud noise on a large number of people. For this purpose they have set up a colony of human guinea pigs on an island in the Pacific. They have been studying the effects of the noise on these people for several months now. One result of the study has been to show that people do not become mentally ill as a result of noise, but they do become very irritable. There is, in fact, a growing body of evidence to suggest that noise is a contributory factor in a number of diseases, but not necessarily the cause. Another effect of noise is that it reduces efficiency. There are many cases on record of people who, by some extraordinary good luck, have been able to work in the midst of noise without being distracted. But the number of such people is small. Now the reason why noise reduces efficiency is that it distracts people. It makes them think about the noise instead of about their work. For example, a man working in a factory where there is a great deal of noise will be thinking about the noise all the time, and this will make him less efficient. Noise also has a harmful effect on people's sleep. It is a common experience that people who live in noisy environments are likely to have bad sleep. They may not be able to

fall asleep at all, or they may be woken up several times during the night. This is because noise disturbs their normal sleep pattern. In conclusion, noise has a number of non - auditory effects on people, and these effects are important and should be taken into account.

噪音的非听觉效应

在工业部门工作和在军队中服役的许多人对噪音有切身体会，他们认为对这个问题进行任何调查都是浪费时间；他们甚至不愿承认噪音可能对人有影响。另一方面，那些讨厌噪音的人有时会用很不充分的证据来支持他们希望有一个较为安静的社会环境的要求。这很遗憾，因为要求减少噪音确实是件好事，但是如果与拙劣的科学掺杂在一起的话，就不会被人们所信任。常见的一种指责是，噪音能引起精神病。例如，最近一家周报刊登了一篇文章，文章开头是一幅引人注目的插图，图中是一位表情相当痛苦的女士，文字说明是：“她是又一个受害者，成了只会尖叫的可怜虫。”当人们急切地读完正文后，了解到这位女士是个打字员，她感到办公室里打字机的声音越来越让她受不了，最终不得不进了精神病院。这类奇闻轶事的疑难之处在于人们无法分清因果关系。也许是噪音使这位妇女得病的呢？还是她先已患病因而对噪音特别敏感呢？另有一位病人可能同样有理由抱怨说，她的邻居们正在联合起来对她进行诽谤和迫害，不过，人们对这种说法是不会轻易相信的。对于噪音问题，需要对大量生活在噪音中的人进行研究，看一看他们是否比其他人更易患精神病。美国海军多年来一直在按非常相似的思路进行一项实验。他们在考虑制造一种噪音很大的新式武器，并且想知道能否把噪音用作战争武器。所以他们现在正在研究高强度噪音对大量人群的影响。为了这个目的，他们在太平洋上的一个岛屿上建立了一个人类豚鼠群落。几个月来，他们一直在研究噪音对这些人的影响。这项研究的一个结果表明，噪音不会使人生病，但会使人变得非常易怒。事实上，越来越多的证据表明，噪音是许多疾病的一个致病因素，但不一定是病因。噪音的另一个影响是降低效率。有许多记录在案的事例表明，有些人由于运气特别好，能在噪音环境中工作而不受干扰。但这样的人是少数。噪音降低效率的原因是它使人分心。它使人们去想噪音而不去想工作。例如，在一个噪音很大的工厂里工作的人会一直想着噪音，这就会使他效率降低。噪音对人的睡眠也有不良影响。生活在噪音环境中的人很可能睡眠不好，这是常见的现象。他们可能根本无法入睡，或者可能在夜间多次被吵醒。这是因为噪音打乱了他们正常的睡眠模式。总之，噪音对人有許多非听觉方面的影响，这些影响是重要的，应该予以考虑。

26. The past life of the earth

It is animals and plants which lived in or near water whose remains are most likely to be preserved, for one of the necessary conditions of preservation is quick burial, and it is only in the seas and rivers, and sometimes lakes, where mud and silt have been continuously deposited, that bodies and the like can be rapidly covered over and preserved.

But even in the most favourable circumstances only a small fraction of the creatures that die are preserved in this way before decay sets in or, even more likely, before scavengers eat them. After all, all living creatures live by feeding on something else, whether it be plant or animal, dead or alive, and it is only by chance that such a fate is avoided. The remains of plants and animals that lived on land are much more rarely preserved, for there is seldom anything to cover them over. When you think of the innumerable birds that one sees flying about, not to mention the equally numerous small animals like field mice and voles which you do not see, it is very rarely that one comes across a dead body, except, of course, on the roads. They decompose and are quickly destroyed by the weather or eaten by some other creature.

It is almost always due to some very special circumstances that traces of land animals survive, as by falling into inaccessible caves, or into an ice - crevasse, like the Siberian mammoths, when the whole animal is sometimes preserved, as in a refrigerator. This is what happened to the famous Beresovka mammoth which was found preserved and in good condition. In his mouth were the remains of fir - trees - the last meal that he had before he fell into the crevasse some 10,000 years ago. The mammoth has now been restored in the Museum of Zoology in St. Petersburg.

Other animals were trapped in tar pits, like the elephants, sabre - toothed cats, and numerous other creatures that are found at Rancho La Brea, near Los Angeles. Apparently what happened was that water collected on these tar pits, and the animals came to drink. Once they were in the tar, they were stuck fast, and they eventually died there. As the tar pits were gradually filled up by debris, the remains of the animals were buried deeper and deeper, and so were preserved.

There is one fairly common event that sometimes leads to the preservation of land - animal remains, and that is when the animals die in a river or a lake. This may seem a strange statement, but in fact the water in a river or a lake is more likely to be alkaline than acid, and so the bones are more likely to be preserved in such a water. But, even so, the bones of the animals are very likely to be scattered by scavengers and other agents of decay, and only a small fraction of them are likely to be preserved.

One of the most remarkable preservations of land - animal remains has been discovered on the island of Flores in Indonesia. There, on a ledge of rock about 200 metres above sea - level, an almost complete skeleton of a *Homo floresiensis* was found. The skeleton was so small that it was first thought to be that of a child. But when the bones were analysed, it was discovered that they belonged to an adult. The *Homo floresiensis* was a very small human - like creature that lived about 18,000

years ago. It was only about one metre tall, and its brain was only about 400 cubic centimetres, which is about one - third the size of the brain of a modern human. The discovery of the Homo floresiensis was a great surprise, for it was thought that all humans had evolved into the modern form long ago. But the discovery of this small human - like creature shows that evolution can take different paths in different parts of the world.

地球的昔日生命

只有生活在水中或水边的动植物尸体最有可能被保存下来，因为保存的必要条件之一是迅速掩埋，而只有在海洋、河流，有时在湖泊这些不断有泥沙淤积的地方，尸体之类的东西才能被迅速覆盖并保存下来。

但是即使在最有利的环境下，也只是一小部分死去的生物能在开始腐烂前，或者更可能在食腐动物吃掉它们之前，以这种方式保存下来。毕竟，所有生物都是靠吃别的东西生存的，不管是植物还是动物，死的还是活的，而这样的命运只有偶然才能避免。生活在陆地上的动植物的遗体保存下来的就更为罕见了，因为很少有东西能把它们覆盖起来。当你想到那些无数的在空中飞翔的鸟儿，更不用说那些同样无数的你看不见的像田鼠和鼯鼠之类的小动物时，除了在路上，人们很少能碰到一具动物尸体。它们腐烂并很快被天气破坏或者被其他动物吃掉。

陆栖动物的遗迹能够保存下来几乎总是由于某些非常特殊的情况，比如掉进难以到达的洞穴里，或者掉进冰裂缝里，就像西伯利亚猛犸象那样，整个动物有时会像被保存在冰箱里一样被保存下来。著名的别廖佐夫卡猛犸象就是这样被发现保存完好的。它嘴里还留着冷杉树的残渣——那是它大约一万年掉进冰裂缝之前的最后一餐。这头猛犸象现在已经在圣彼得堡的动物学博物馆里被复原了。

其他动物被困在焦油坑里，比如大象、剑齿虎和在洛杉矶附近的兰乔拉布雷亚发现的许多其他动物。显然，事情的经过是这样的：焦油坑上积了水，动物来喝水。一旦它们陷入焦油中，就被牢牢地粘住，最后死在那里。随着焦油坑逐渐被碎片填满，动物的遗体被埋得越来越深，这样就被保存下来了。

有一个相当常见的事件有时会导致陆栖动物遗体的保存，那就是当动物死在河流或湖泊里的时候。这可能听起来是个奇怪的说法，但实际上河流或湖泊里的水更可能是碱性而不是酸性的，所以骨头更可能在这样的水中保存下来。但即便如此，动物的骨头很可能被食腐动物和其他腐烂因素弄散，只有一小部分可能被保存下来。

在印度尼西亚的弗洛雷斯岛上发现了最令人瞩目的陆栖动物遗体保存之一。在那里，在海平面以上约200米的一个岩石壁架上，发现了一具几乎完整的弗洛雷斯人骨架。这具骨架非常小，起初被认为是儿童的骨架。但当对骨头进行分析时，发现它们属于一个成年人。弗洛雷斯人是一种非常矮小的类人动物，大约生活在1万8千年前。它只有大约一米高，它的大脑只有大约400立方厘米，大约是现代人脑体积的三分之一。弗洛雷斯人的发现是一个巨大的惊喜，因为人们原以为所有人类很久以前就已经进化成现代形态了。但这种矮小类人动物的发现表明，在世界不同的地方进化可以走不同的道路。

27. The 'Vasa'

From the seventeenth - century empire of Sweden, the story of a galleon that sank at the start of her maiden voyage in 1628 must be one of the strangest tales of the sea. For nearly three and a half centuries she lay at the bottom of Stockholm harbour until her discovery in 1956. This was the Vasa, royal flagship of the great imperial fleet.

King Gustavus Adolphus, 'The Northern Hurricane', then at the height of his military success in the Thirty Years' War, had dictated her measurements and armament. Triple gun - decks mounted sixty - four bronze cannon. She was intended to play a leading role in the growing might of Sweden.

As she was prepared for her maiden voyage on August 10, 1628, Stockholm was in a ferment. From the Skeppsbron and surrounding islands the people watched this thing of beauty begin to spread her sails and catch the wind. They had laboured for three years to produce this floating work of art; she was more richly carved and ornamented than any previous ship. The high sterncastle was a riot of carved gods, demons, knights, kings, warriors, mermaids, cherubs; and zoomorphic animal shapes ablaze with red and gold and blue, symbols of courage, power, and cruelty, were portrayed to stir the imaginations of the superstitious sailors of the day.

Then the cannons of the anchored warships thundered a salute as the Vasa moved slowly out to sea. She was a moving sight indeed as the morning sun shone on her sails, turning them to gold. As she gained speed, the wind became too strong for her sails, and the mast snapped. Then she lurched sideways and sank in less than a minute.

More than a thousand people lost their lives in the accident; most of them were women and children, who had been on board to enjoy the voyage. The Vasa was the first modern warship built from the keel up with a triple - gun - deck, and she was also the last of her kind. Her sinking was not the result of her being rammed by another vessel, or of her being caught in a storm. It was the result of her own structural weaknesses. The Vasa was built too tall for her length, and she was too top - heavy. Her builders had violated several of the rules of shipbuilding. They had made her too wide for her length, and they had made her sterncastle too high. They had also made her gun - decks too heavy, and her keel too light. All these factors combined to make her unstable in the water. In 1961, the Vasa was salvaged from the harbour bottom, and she is now on display in a museum in Stockholm.

1628年，一艘大帆船在其处女航开始时就沉没了，这个从17世纪瑞典帝国流传下来的故事一定是航海史上最离奇的事件之一。这艘大船在斯德哥尔摩港口的海底躺了将近3个半世纪之后，直到1956年才被发现。这就是“瓦萨”号，帝国大舰队的皇家旗舰。

当时号称“北方飓风”的古斯塔夫斯·阿道弗斯国王正处在“三十年战争”的军事鼎盛阶段，他亲自规定了这艘船的规模和武器装备。3层的火炮甲板上装着64门青铜加农炮。它本要在日益强大的瑞典发挥主导作用。

1628年8月10日，当“瓦萨”号准备处女航时，斯德哥尔摩一片欢腾。人们从斯开波斯布朗和周围的岛屿前来观看这艘美丽的战船扬帆起航，乘风前进。他们花了3年的时间才建成这件水上艺术品；它比以往任何船只雕刻得都更加精美，装饰得都更加华丽。高耸的船尾楼雕刻着众多的神像、妖魔、骑士、国王、武士、美人鱼和小天使；形态各异的兽形图案被涂得红红火火、金黄金黄、蓝蓝湛湛，这些图案象征着勇敢、力量和残暴，用来激发当时迷信的水手们的想象力。

当“瓦萨”号缓缓驶向大海时，驻泊的战舰鸣炮向它致敬。当早晨的阳光洒在它的风帆上，并把它们染成金色时，它确实是一道亮丽的风景。随着船速的加快，风势变得对风帆来说过于猛烈，桅杆折断了。然后它突然侧向一边，不到一分钟就沉没了。

超过1000人在这次事故中丧生；大多数是妇女和儿童，他们当时正在船上准备享受这次航行。“瓦萨”号是第一艘从龙骨开始建造的3层火炮甲板的现代战舰，也是最后一艘。它的沉没不是因为被另一艘船撞击，也不是因为遭遇风暴。而是由于它自身结构上的缺陷。“瓦萨”号相对于它的长度来说建造得过高了，而且它的重心过于靠上。它的建造者违反了好几条造船规则。他们把船身造得相对于船的长度来说过宽了，而且船尾楼也造得过高了。他们还使火炮甲板过重，而龙骨过轻。所有这些因素加在一起使它在水中不稳定。1961年，“瓦萨”号从港口水底被打捞出来，现在陈列在斯德哥尔摩的一家博物馆里。

28. Patients and Doctors

This is a sceptical age, but although our faith in many of the things in which our forefathers fervently believed has weakened, our confidence in the curative properties of the bottle of medicine remains the same as theirs. This modern faith in medicines is proved by the fact that the annual drug bill of the Health Services is mounting to astronomical figures and shows no signs at all of ceasing to rise. The majority of the patients attending the medical out-patients departments of our hospitals feel that they have not received adequate treatment unless they are able to carry home with them some tangible remedy in the shape of a bottle of medicine, a box of pills, or a small jar of ointment, and the doctor in charge of the department is only too ready to provide them with these requirements.

There is no quicker method of disposing of patients than by giving them what they

are asking for, and since most medical men in the Health Services are overworked and have little time for offering time - consuming and little - appreciated advice on such subjects as diet, right living, and the need for abandoning bad habits etc., the bottle, the box, and the jar are almost always granted them. It is rare for a medical man to give a talk without mentioning the drug companies that finance his research. The more cynical of his profession will even go so far as to claim that "Half of what we are taught about medicine is wrong."

Most doctors, however, still believe that medicine is a science, and they are not prepared to admit that the drugs they prescribe are little more than placebos. They feel that they are being honest when they tell patients that a certain drug may be helpful, but they cannot be certain that it will be. They are also not prepared to admit that the huge sums of money they receive from the drug companies for research are a form of bribery. They believe that their research is for the good of the public and that they are justified in receiving the money.

Few doctors are willing to admit that they are "pill - pushers" and that they prescribe drugs for financial reasons rather than for medical ones. They are afraid that if they do so, they will lose their patients' confidence and that they will no longer be respected as members of a noble profession.

病人与医生

这是一个怀疑一切的时代，可是虽然我们对我们祖先笃信的许多事物已不太相信，我们对瓶装药品疗效的信心仍与祖辈一样坚定。卫生部门的年度药费上升到了天文数字，而且毫无停止上升的迹象，这个事实证实了现代人对药物的依赖。在医院门诊部就医的大多数病人认为，如果不能带一些看得见、摸得着的药物，如一瓶药水、一盒药丸、一小瓶药膏回家的话，就没算得到充分的治疗。负责门诊的医生也非常乐意为前来看病的人提供他们想要的药物。

病人要什么就给什么，没有比这样处理病人更快的方法了。因为卫生部门的大多数医生都超负荷工作，所以没有多少时间提出一些既费时而又不受人欢迎的关于饮食、生活起居以及克服不良习惯必要性的忠告，结果就是把瓶药、盒药、罐药开给看病的人而万事大吉。很少有医生在谈话时不提及资助其研究的制药公司。这个行业中较为愤世嫉俗的人甚至声称：“我们所学的一半医学知识都是错误的。”

然而，大多数医生仍然认为医学是一门科学，而且他们也不愿意承认他们开的药仅仅是安慰剂。当他们告诉病人某种药可能有帮助，但不能肯定其效果时，他们觉得自己是诚实的。他们也不愿意承认从制药公司得到的用于研究的大笔资金是一种贿赂。他们相信自己的研究是为了公众的利益，而且他们得到这笔钱是正当的。

很少有医生愿意承认自己是“药品推销商”，为了金钱而开药而非为了治病。他们担心如果承认了这一点，就会失去病人的信任，而且他们将不再被尊为崇高职业的一员。

29. The hovercraft

Many strange new means of transport have been developed in our century, the strangest of them being perhaps the hovercraft. In 1953, a former electronics engineer in his fifties, Christopher Cockerell, who had turned to boat - building on the Norfolk Broads, suggested an idea on which he had been working for many years to the British government. It was the idea of supporting a craft on a 'pad', or cushion, of low - pressure air, ringed with a curtain of higher pressure air. Ever since, people have had difficulty in deciding whether the craft should be ranged among ships, planes, or land vehicles - for it is something in between a boat and an aircraft. As a shipbuilder, Cockerell was trying to find a solution to the problem of the wave resistance which wastes a good deal of a surface ship's power and limits its speed. His answer was to lift the vessel out of the water by making it ride on a cushion of air, no more than one or two feet thick. This is done by a great number of ring - shaped air jets on the bottom of the craft. It 'flies', therefore, but it cannot fly higher - its action depends on the surface, water or ground, over which it rides.

The first tests on the Solent in 1959 caused a sensation. The hovercraft travelled first over the water, then mounted the beach, climbed up the dunes, and sat down on a road. Later it crossed the Channel, riding smoothly over the waves, which presented no problem.

Since that time, various types of hovercraft have been developed and some of them have entered regular service on both land and water. The hovercraft is particularly useful in large areas with poor communications such as Africa or Australia; it can become a 'flying fruit - bowl', carrying bananas from the plantations to the ports; giant hovercraft liners could span the Atlantic; and the railway of the future may well be the 'hovertrain', riding on its air cushion over a single rail, which it never touches, at speeds up to 300 m.p.h. - the possibilities appear unlimited.

气垫船

本世纪已研制出许多新奇的交通工具，其中最新奇的要数气垫船了。1953年，有一位50多岁名叫克里斯托弗·科克雷尔的原电子工程师，改行在诺福克郡布罗兹区从事造船业，他向英国政府提出了他研究多年的一项计划。他的设想是：用一个低压空气垫或软垫来支撑船体，软垫周围用高压空气环绕。自那以后，人们很难决定是否应该将这种运载工具列为轮船、飞机，或是陆上交通工具，因为它是介于船和飞机之间的东西。作为一个船舶技师，科克雷尔在寻找解决波浪阻力的方法，因为波浪阻力浪费掉了船在水面行驶的大量动力，从而限制了船的速度。他的解决办法是把船体提离水面，让船在一个气垫上行驶，气垫只有一两英尺厚。船底装上大量环状喷气嘴以实现这一目的。这样，船就能飞了，但飞不高。它的飞行限决于它所悬浮的水面或地面。

1959年，在索伦特海峡进行的首次试航引起了轰动。气垫船先是在水面上行驶，后又登上海岸，爬上沙丘，最后停在路上。后来气垫船跨越英吉利海峡，平稳地在波浪上行驶，波浪不再产生什么影响。

从那以后，各种各样的气垫船出现了，并开始了全面的实际应用。气垫船在非洲、澳大利亚等交通不发达的地区特别有用。它能成为“飞行的水果盘子”，把香蕉从种植园直接运到港口；巨型气垫班轮或许能跨越大西洋；未来的火车或许能成为“气垫火车”，靠气垫在单轨上行驶而不接触轨道，时速可达每小时300英里。气垫船的前途是不可限量的。

30. How Animals Migrate

Animal migration, one of the most interesting but least understood biological phenomena, actually refers to the seasonal movement of all or part of an animal population to and from a given area. Familiar migrants include many birds; hoofed animals, especially in East Africa and in the Arctic tundra; bats; whales and porpoises; seals; and fishes, such as salmon.

Migration in some cases is obligatory, and in others facultative. Close and careful study of migratory animals indicates that migratory behavior varies in its adaptability to environmental changes. This variability in migratory behavior has led some scientists to question whether the concept of migration is valid. Certainly the description applied to some animals is difficult to reconcile with the description applied to others. For example, migratory behavior has been described as "traveling some distance in search of a new habitat" and as "a regular, annual movement between two habitats".

An example of facultative migration is the arctic fox. On the Aleutian Islands, which are located at the western extremity of the Alaskan Peninsula, the fox is sedentary and does not migrate, since there is a relatively stable and abundant food supply on those islands. But in some other parts of the Arctic, the food supply is seasonally limited, and arctic foxes may travel long distances in search of food. This type of movement between different habitats for the purpose of exploiting food resources may be termed facultative migration.

Another example of facultative migration is the large North American deer, or wapiti. In the Rocky Mountains, wapiti migrate seasonally from high - altitude summer ranges to the lower valleys in winter. However, when food is plentiful in the highlands, wapiti may not migrate at all or may migrate only short distances to nearby valleys. Thus, wapiti behavior varies in its adaptability to environmental

changes.

The term "obligatory migration" implies that an animal must migrate. One example of obligatory migration is the Atlantic salmon. These fish are born in freshwater streams, and they spend the first few years of their lives in those streams. After that, they migrate to the ocean, where they live for several years. When they reach sexual maturity, they return to their natal streams to spawn. If they are prevented from migrating, they will not reproduce. Another example of obligatory migration is the monarch butterfly. These butterflies are born in North America, and they migrate south to Mexico for the winter. If they are prevented from migrating, they will die.

The reasons for migration are complex. Some animals migrate to find food, while others migrate to find a suitable place to breed. Still others migrate to avoid harsh weather conditions. In general, migration is a strategy that animals use to increase their chances of survival and reproduction.

动物如何迁徙

动物迁徙是最有趣但了解最少的生物现象之一，实际上它指的是部分或全部动物种群在特定区域间的季节性移动。常见的迁徙动物包括很多鸟类；有蹄类动物，尤其是东非和北极苔原地区的；蝙蝠；鲸和鼠海豚；海豹；以及鱼类，如鲑鱼。

在某些情况下，迁徙是强制性的，而在另一些情况下则是兼性的。对迁徙动物细致深入的研究表明，迁徙行为对环境变化的适应性有所不同。这种迁徙行为的变异性使一些科学家质疑迁徙这个概念是否有效。当然，适用于某些动物的描述很难与适用于其他动物的描述相协调。例如，迁徙行为被描述为“长途跋涉寻找新的栖息地”以及“在两个栖息地间定期的年度性移动”。

兼性迁徙的一个例子是北极狐。在位于阿拉斯加半岛西端的阿留申群岛，北极狐是定居的，不迁徙，因为这些岛屿上有相对稳定和丰富的食物供应。但在北极的其他一些地区，食物供应有季节性的限制，北极狐可能会长途跋涉寻找食物。这种为了利用食物资源而在不同栖息地间进行的移动可被称为兼性迁徙。

兼性迁徙的另一个例子是北美大鹿，即马鹿。在落基山脉，马鹿季节性地从高海拔的夏季栖息地迁徙到冬季的低海拔山谷。然而，当高地食物充足时，马鹿可能根本不迁徙，或者只迁徙很短的距离到附近的山谷。因此，马鹿的行为在对环境变化的适应性方面有所不同。

“强制性迁徙”这个术语意味着动物必须迁徙。大西洋鲑鱼就是强制性迁徙的一个例子。这些鱼出生于淡水溪流，它们生命的最初几年是在这些溪流中度过的。之后，它们迁徙到海洋，在那里生活数年。当它们达到性成熟时，就返回出生的溪流产卵。如果它们被阻止迁徙，就不会繁殖。帝王蝶也是强制性迁徙的一个例子。这些蝴蝶出生于北美洲，它们向南迁徙到墨西哥过冬。如果它们被阻止迁徙，就会死亡。

迁徙的原因很复杂。有些动物迁徙是为了寻找食物，而有些动物迁徙是为了寻找合适的繁

殖地。还有些动物迁徙是为了躲避恶劣的天气条件。一般来说，迁徙是动物用以增加其生存和繁殖机会的一种策略。

31. The sculptor speaks

Appreciation of sculpture depends upon the ability to respond to form in three dimensions. That is perhaps why sculpture has been described as the most difficult of all arts; certainly it is more difficult than the arts which involve appreciation of flat forms, shape in only two dimensions. Many more people are 'form-blind' than colour-blind. The child learning to see, first distinguishes only two - dimensional shape; it cannot judge distances, depths. Later, for its personal safety and practical needs, it has to develop (partly by means of touch) the ability to judge roughly three - dimensional distances. But having satisfied the requirements of practical necessity, most people go no further. Though they may attain considerable accuracy in the perception of flat form, they do not make the further intellectual and emotional effort needed to comprehend form in its full spatial existence.

This is what the sculptor must do. He must strive continually to think of, and use, form in its full spatial completeness. He gets the solid shape, as it were, inside his head - he thinks of it, whatever its size, as if he were holding it completely enclosed in the hollow of his hand. He mentally visualizes a complex form from all round itself; he knows while he looks at one side what the other side is like; he identifies himself with its centre of gravity, its mass, its weight; he realizes its volume, as the space that the shape displaces in the air.

And the sensitive observer of sculpture must also learn to feel shape simply as shape, not as description or reminiscence. He must, for example, perceive an egg as a simple single solid shape, quite apart from its significance as food, or from the literary idea that it will become a bird. And so with solids such as a shell, a nut, a plum, a pear, a tadpole, a mushroom, a mountain peak, a kidney, a carrot, a tree - trunk, a bird's beak, a cloud, a flower. From these he can go on to appreciate more complex forms of combinations of several forms.

The story of the discovery of Troy by Heinrich Schliemann is a good example of the fact that the recognition of the form of an object may be quite independent of its significance. Schliemann, as a child, had heard the story of the destruction of Troy from his father. He became obsessed with the idea that he would find the site of ancient Troy. Years later, when he had made a fortune as a merchant in Russia, he set out on his quest. Guided by the description in Homer's Iliad, he dug at a site in

modern Turkey which he thought was the location of Troy. After many years of fruitless digging, he finally found the ruins of a city which he believed was Troy. But what he had really found was a city which had been built on the site of Troy long after the Trojan War. The significance of the discovery was that it showed that the form of the city could be recognized even when its significance had been completely forgotten.

Another example of the independence of form is to be found in the work of the American sculptor Alexander Calder. Calder was famous for his mobiles, which are sculptures that move in the air. Calder's mobiles are made up of simple geometric shapes such as circles, squares, triangles, and rods. These shapes are joined together by wires or rods so that they can move freely in the air. The significance of Calder's mobiles is not in their description of anything in particular, but in their form. They are a celebration of form in movement, of the way in which simple geometric shapes can be combined to create complex and beautiful forms in motion.

雕塑家的语言

对雕塑的鉴赏力取决于对立体的反应能力。也许这就是为什么雕塑被说成是所有艺术中最难的艺术的原因吧；当然，它比涉及只在二维平面上欣赏形状的艺术要难。“形盲”的人数要比色盲的人数多得多。正在学看东西的儿童起初只会分辨二维的形状；他们不能判断距离和深度。后来，由于自身安全和实际需要，他们必须（部分通过触觉）发展粗略判断三维距离的能力。但是，满足了实际需要后，大多数人就不再进一步发展这种能力了。虽然他们对平面形状的感知能达到相当准确的程度，但他们没有在智力和情感上进一步努力去理解存在于空间的整个形态。

这正是雕塑家必须做的。他必须不断努力思考并运用存在于空间的完整形态。可以说，他在脑海里已经有了立体的形状；不管它的大小如何，他都把它当作完全握在自己手心里一样来思考。他从各个角度在心里想象一个复杂的形状；他看一个面的时候就知道另一面是什么样子；他把自己与物体的重心、质量、重量融为一体；他能意识到物体的体积，即物体在空气中所占的空间。

敏锐的雕塑观赏者也必须学会把形状只当作形状来感觉，而不是当作描述或联想。例如，他必须把鸡蛋仅仅看作是一个简单的单一立体形状，完全抛开它作为食物的意义，也抛开它会变成一只鸟这样的文学概念。对于其他立体物，如贝壳、坚果、李子、梨子、蝌蚪、蘑菇、山峰、肾脏、胡萝卜、树干、鸟喙、云朵、花朵等也是如此。从这些物体中，他可以进而欣赏到几种形状组合而成的更复杂的形式。

海因里希·施里曼发现特洛伊城的故事就是一个很好的例子，说明对一个物体形状的认识可能与它的意义完全无关。施里曼小时候听父亲讲过特洛伊城毁灭的故事。他一心想找到古代特洛伊城的遗址。多年以后，当他在俄国做商人发了财后，就开始了他的探寻之旅。在荷马的《伊利亚特》的描述的指引下，他在现代土耳其的一个地方挖掘，他认为那个地方就是特洛伊城的所在地。经过多年毫无结果的挖掘后，他终于发现了一座城市的废墟，他相信那就是特洛伊城。但他真正发现的是一座在特洛伊战争很久以后才建在特洛伊城遗址

上的城市。这个发现的意义在于，它表明即使一个城市的意义完全被遗忘了，它的形状仍然可以被辨认出来。

形式的独立性的另一个例子可以在美国雕塑家亚历山大·卡尔德的作品中找到。卡尔德以他的活动雕塑而闻名，这些雕塑在空中移动。卡尔德的活动雕塑由简单的几何形状，如圆形、方形、三角形和杆状物组成。这些形状通过金属丝或杆状物连接在一起，这样它们就可以在空气中自由移动。卡尔德的活动雕塑的意义不在于它们对任何特定事物的描述，而在于它们的形式。它们是对运动中的形式的赞美，是对简单几何形状如何组合以创造出复杂而美丽的运动形式的赞美。

32. Galileo Reborn

In his own lifetime Galileo was the centre of violent controversy; but the scientific dust has long since settled, and today we can see even his famous clash with the Inquisition in something like its proper perspective. But, in contrast, it is only in modern times that Galileo has become a problem child for historians of science.

The old view of Galileo was delightfully uncomplicated. He was, above all, a man who experimented: who despised the prejudices and book learning of the Aristotelians, who put his questions to nature instead of to the ancients, and who drew his conclusions fearlessly. He had been the first to turn a telescope to the sky, and he had seen there evidence enough to overthrow Aristotle and Ptolemy together. He was the man who climbed the Leaning Tower of Pisa and dropped various weights from the top, who rolled balls down inclined planes, and then generalized the results of his many experiments into the famous law of free fall.

But a closer study of the evidence, supported by a deeper sense of the period, and particularly by a new consciousness of the philosophical underpinning of seventeenth - century science, has profoundly modified this view of Galileo. Today, although the old Galileo lives on in many popular writings, among historians of science a new and more sophisticated picture has emerged. At the same time, our sympathy for Galileo's opponents has grown. His telescopic observations are justly immortal; they aroused great interest at the time, they had important theoretical consequences, and they provided a striking demonstration of the potentialities hidden in instruments. But can we blame those who looked and failed to see what Galileo saw, if we remember that to use a telescope at the end of the sixteenth century was like playing a modern violin for the first time? Was the philosopher who refused to look through Galileo's telescope more culpable than those who alleged that the spiral nebulae observed by Lord Rosse's great telescope in the

eighteen - forties were scratches left by the grinder? We can perhaps forgive those who said that the moons of Jupiter were produced by Galileo's spy - glass if we recall that in his day, as for long afterwards, curved glass was the popular contrivance for producing not truth but illusion, untruth; and if we recall that the concept of an external world was not so much a real concept as a psychological necessity in the minds of seventeenth - century philosophers.

The case of Galileo is sometimes misused to illustrate the thesis that science progresses through the conflict of ideas. But this misrepresents the nature of scientific discovery. The real hero of the story is the slow accretion of the body of knowledge which we call science, and of which Galileo became one of the founders. The most important single aspect of Galileo's work may have been his demonstration of how fundamental questions about the nature of the world could be answered by the use of instruments. Whether his own methods were completely scientific is open to debate; but that he did have a method is beyond dispute. His method was to make hypotheses, let them stand the test of experiment, and then generalize the results. He was a pioneer in the use of scientific method, which is why we remember him today as one of the great scientists.

伽利略的复生

伽利略在世时是激烈论战的中心。但是，自他逝世以来，那场科学上的纷争早已平息了下来，甚至他和宗教法庭的著名冲突，我们今天也能正确如实地看待。但是相比之下，对于科学史家来说，伽利略只是在现代才变成了一个新的难题。

以前对伽利略的看法简单明了，令人欣然。他首先是个实验工作者，他蔑视亚里士多德学派的偏见和空洞的书本知识。他向自然界而不是向古人提出问题，并大胆地得出自己的结论。他是第一个把望远镜对准天空的人，他在那里发现的证据足以推翻亚里士多德和托勒密的全部学说。他就是那个爬上比萨斜塔，从塔顶向下抛掷各种重物的人；他就是那个使球体沿斜面向下滚动，然后将多次实验结果概括成著名的自由落体定律的人。

但是，对那个时代的深化了解，尤其是以十七世纪科学的哲学基础的新认识为依据，进一步仔细研究证据，就会极大地改变对伽利略的看法。今天，虽然老伽利略的形象在许多通俗读物中仍然存在，但是在科学史家中间，一个新的更加复杂的伽利略的形象出现了。与此同时，我们对伽利略的反对派的同情也有所增加。他的望远镜观测结果无疑是不朽的；它们在当时引起了极大的兴趣，具有重要的理论意义，并为仪器中隐藏的潜力提供了惊人的证明。但是，如果我们想到在十六世纪末使用望远镜就像第一次拉现代小提琴一样，我们能责怪那些看过却没有看出伽利略所看到的東西的人吗？拒绝通过伽利略望远镜去看的哲学家比那些声称在十九世纪四十年代罗斯勋爵巨大望远镜中观测到的螺旋星云是磨镜工留下的划痕的人更应受到责备吗？如果我们回想一下，在他那个时代以及之后相当长的一段时间里，曲面玻璃是制造幻觉而不是制造真理的流行工具，而且如果我们回想一下，外部世界的概念在十七世纪哲学家的头脑中与其说是一个真实的概念，不如说是一种心理上的需要，那么我们也许就能原谅那些说木星的卫星是伽利略的小望远镜制造出来的人了。

伽利略的事例有时被误用来证明科学是通过思想冲突而发展的这一论点。但这是对科学发现的本质的歪曲。这个故事的真正英雄是我们称之为科学的知识体系的缓慢积累，而伽利略是这个体系的创始人之一。伽利略工作最重要的一个方面也许是他证明了关于世界本质的基本问题可以通过使用仪器来得到解答。他自己的方法是否完全科学尚有争议；但他确实有一个方法则是无可置疑的。他的方法是提出假设，让它们接受实验的检验，然后推广实验结果。他是使用科学方法的先驱，这就是我们今天把他作为伟大科学家之一来纪念的原因。

33. Education

Education is one of the key words of our time. A man without an education, many of us believe, is an unfortunate victim of adverse circumstances, deprived of one of the greatest twentieth - century opportunities. Convinced of the importance of education, modern states 'invest' in institutions of learning to get back 'interest' in the form of a large group of enlightened young men and women who are potential leaders. Education, with its cycles of instruction so carefully worked out, punctuated by textbooks - those purchasable wells of wisdom - what would civilization be like without its benefits?

So much is certain: that we would have doctors and preachers, lawyers and defendants, marriages and births - but our spiritual outlook would be different. We would lay less stress on 'facts and figures' and more on a good memory, on applied psychology, and on the capacity of a man to get along with his fellow - citizens. If our educational system were fashioned after its bookless past we would have the most democratic form of 'college' imaginable. Among tribal people all knowledge inherited by tradition is shared by all; it is taught to every member of the tribe so that in this respect everybody is equally equipped for life.

It is the ideal condition of the 'equal start' which only our most progressive forms of modern education try to regain. In primitive cultures the obligation to seek and to receive the traditional instruction is binding to all. There are no 'illiterates' - if the term can be applied to peoples without a script - while our own compulsory school attendance became law in Germany in 1642, in France in 1806, and in England in 1876, and is still non - existent in a number of 'civilized' nations. This shows how long it was before we deemed it necessary to make sure that all our children could share in the knowledge accumulated by the 'happy few' during the past centuries.

Education in the wilderness is not a matter of monetary means. All are entitled to an equal start. There is none of the hurry which, in our society, often hampers the full

development of a growing personality. There is no fixed programme, no discrimination between one pupil and another in the matter of talents and abilities. At the same as it is true that all pupils are equal in the wilderness, it is also true that all pupils are different. No two persons are the same in terms of abilities, talents, and interests. But in our educational system, all pupils are measured by a single standard - that of scholastic ability. This is the fallacy of the 'equal start' in our schools. The fact that all pupils are different means that some will learn more quickly than others, some will need more practice than others, some will be more interested in certain subjects than others. But in our schools, all pupils are given the same curriculum, the same textbooks, the same methods of instruction, and the same tests. This is the fallacy of the 'equal start' in our schools.

We may say that, on the whole, the 'equal start' in our schools is a fallacy. But we must also recognize that the fallacy has a certain amount of truth in it. In our modern society, scholastic ability is an important factor in determining a person's success in life. A person with a high scholastic ability is more likely to get a good job, to earn a high salary, to have a high social status, and to be respected by others. But we must also recognize that scholastic ability is not the only factor in determining a person's success in life. There are other factors such as personal qualities, social skills, and work experience. In our modern society, a person with a high scholastic ability but without good personal qualities, social skills, or work experience is not likely to be successful in life. We must also recognize that in our modern society, education is not only a matter of scholastic ability. Education is also a matter of personal qualities, social skills, and work experience. In our modern society, a person who has received a good education is not only a person with a high scholastic ability but also a person with good personal qualities, social skills, and work experience.

教育

教育是我们这个时代的关键词之一。我们许多人都相信，一个没有受过教育的人，是逆境的不幸受害者，被剥夺了20世纪最了不起的机会之一。现代国家由于确信教育的重要性，才向教育机构“投资”，以期获得一大批有知识的男女青年的形式收回“利息”，这些青年是潜在的领导者。教育，其教学周期经过精心安排，又有教科书（那些可以买来的智慧源泉）予以强化，如果不受其惠，文明将会是个什么样子呢？

有一点是肯定的：我们仍然会有医生和牧师、律师和被告、婚姻和生育，但我们的精神面貌将会不同。我们将不那么强调“事实和数字”，而更加重视良好的记忆力、应用心理学以及人们与同胞相处的能力。如果我们的教育制度效仿没有书籍的古代教育，我们将会有能想象到的最民主的“大学”形式。在部落里，通过传统继承的所有知识为全体部落成员所共享；这种知识传授给部落里的每一个成员，因此从这个方面来说，每个人为生活所做的准备都是相同的。

这就是“平等起步”的理想状况，只有我们最先进的现代教育形式才试图恢复这种状况。在原始文化中，寻求并接受传统教育的义务对所有人都有约束力。没有“文盲”（如果这个词可用于没有文字的民族的话），而我们自己的义务教育在1642年于德国成为法律，1806年在法国，1876年在英国成为法律，而在一些“文明”国家里至今仍不存在。这表明，我们过了很久才认识到，确保我们的所有孩子都能分享过去几个世纪中“少数幸运者”积累的知识是必要的。

在未开化地区的教育不是一个钱财问题。所有人都享有平等起步的权利。在我们的社会中常常妨碍个性充分发展的那种匆忙仓促不存在。没有固定的课程表，在才能和能力方面也不存在对一个学生和另一个学生的歧视。虽然在未开化地区所有学生都是平等的这一说法是正确的，但所有学生又都是不同的这一说法也是正确的。就能力、才能和兴趣而言，没有两个人是相同的。但在我们的教育制度中，所有学生都用单一的标准——学习能力来衡量。这就是我们学校里“平等起步”的谬误所在。所有学生都是不同的这一事实意味着，有些人将比其他人学得更快，有些人将比其他人需要更多的练习，有些人将对某些学科比其他人更感兴趣。但在我们的学校里，所有学生都被给予相同的课程、相同的教科书、相同的教学方法和相同的测试。这就是我们学校里“平等起步”的谬误所在。

我们可以说，总的来说，我们学校里的“平等起步”是一个谬误。但我们也必须认识到，这个谬误有一定的真理成分。在我们现代社会中，学习能力是决定一个人生活成功与否的一个重要因素。一个学习能力强的人更有可能得到一份好工作、赚取高薪、拥有较高的社会地位并受到他人的尊重。但我们也必须认识到，学习能力不是决定一个人生活成功与否的唯一因素。还有其他因素，如个人品质、社交技能和工作经验。在我们现代社会中，一个学习能力强但没有良好个人品质、社交技能或工作经验的人不太可能在生活中取得成功。我们也必须认识到，在我们现代社会中，教育不仅仅是一个学习能力的问题。教育也是一个个人品质、社交技能和工作经验的问题。在我们现代社会中，一个接受过良好教育的人不仅是一个学习能力强的人，而且也是一个具有良好个人品质、社交技能和工作经验的人。

34. Adolescence

Parents are often upset when their children praise the homes of their friends and regard it as a slur on their own cooking, or cleaning, or furniture, and often are foolish enough to let the adolescents see that they are annoyed. They may even accuse them of disloyalty, or make some spiteful remark about the friends' parents. Such a loss of dignity and descent into childish behaviour on the part of the adults deeply shocks the adolescents, and makes them resolve that in future they will not talk to their parents about the places or people they visit. Before very long the parents will be complaining that the child is so secretive and never tells them anything, but they seldom realize that they have brought this on themselves.

Disillusionment with the parents, however good and adequate they may be both as parents and as individuals, is to some degree inevitable. Most children have such a high ideal of their parents, unless the parents themselves have been unsatisfactory, that it can, hardly hope to stand up to a realistic evaluation. Parents would be greatly surprised and deeply touched if they realized how much belief their children usually have in their character and infallibility, and how much this faith means to a child. If parents were prepared for this adolescent reaction, and realized that it was a sign that the child was growing up and developing valuable powers of observation and independent judgment, they would not be so hurt, and therefore would not drive the child into opposition by resenting and resisting it.

The adolescent, with his passion for sincerity, always respects a parent who admits that he is wrong, or ignorant, or even that he has been unfair or unjust. What the child cannot forgive is the parents' refusal to admit these charges if the child knows them to be true.

Victorian parents believed that they kept their dignity by retreating behind an unreasoning authoritarianism. In fact they did nothing of the kind, but children were then too cowed to let them know how they really felt. Today we tend to go to the other extreme, but on the whole this change is a healthy one. However, the authoritarian approach and the laissez - faire approach both have their dangers. The former creates inhibitions and resentments; the latter often results in over - indulgence and lack of discipline. In any case, children have to be prepared for dealing with a world that is full of insecurity, and they have to be given the tools for doing so.

These tools include a healthy self - esteem, which is based on a realistic assessment of one's own abilities; a clear sense of values, which enables a person to make good decisions; and a capacity for empathy, which allows a person to understand the feelings of others. All these things are necessary for a person to be able to function well in the world, and they can be taught to children in a variety of ways. For example, a child can be taught to value his own work by having it displayed or praised; he can be taught to respect the feelings of others by being made to feel what it is like to be in their shoes; and he can be taught to have a realistic view of his own abilities by being given tasks that are appropriate to his age and level of development.

There is no reason why parents should not be able to teach these things to their children. In fact, they are the best people to do so, because they know their children better than anyone else does. However, they must be prepared to be honest with themselves and with their children, and they must be willing to learn as well as to

teach.

青春期

当孩子赞扬自己朋友的家时，父母往往会感到不安，认为这是对自己厨艺、打扫或家具的一种诋毁，而且常常愚蠢到让孩子看出自己的恼怒。他们甚至可能会指责孩子不忠，或者对孩子朋友的父母恶语相向。成年人这种有失尊严、近乎孩子气的行为会让青少年大为震惊，使他们决心以后不再向父母谈论自己去过的地方或见过的人。用不了多久，父母就会抱怨孩子守口如瓶，什么都不告诉他们，但是他们很少意识到这是他们自己造成的。

不管父母作为父母和作为个人是多么优秀和称职，孩子对他们感到失望在某种程度上是不可避免的。大多数孩子对自己的父母都抱有很高的理想，除非父母本身不称职，这种理想很难经得起现实的考验。如果父母意识到孩子通常是多么相信他们的品格和绝对正确，以及这种信任对孩子意味着什么，他们会大为惊讶并深受感动。如果父母对孩子的这种青春期反应有所准备，并且认识到这是孩子正在成长、正在发展宝贵的观察力和独立判断力的标志，他们就不会如此伤心，也就不会因为怨恨和抵制这种反应而把孩子逼到对立面。

青少年热爱真诚，总是尊重承认自己错误、无知，甚至承认自己不公平或不公正的父母。如果孩子知道这些指责是事实，父母却拒不承认，这是孩子所不能原谅的。

维多利亚时代的父母认为，他们通过躲在一种非理性的专制主义背后来维护自己的尊严。事实上他们根本不是这么做的，但是当时的孩子太胆小，不敢让父母知道自己的真实感受。今天我们往往走向另一个极端，但总的来说这种变化是健康的。然而，专制的方法和放任自流的方法都有其危险。前者会造成压抑和怨恨；后者往往会导致过度放纵和缺乏纪律。无论如何，孩子必须为应对一个充满不安全因素的世界做好准备，而且必须给予他们这样做的手段。

这些手段包括健康的自尊心，它基于对自己能力的现实评估；明确的价值观，它使人能够做出正确的决策；以及同理心的能力，它使人能够理解他人的感受。所有这些对于一个人在世界上能够正常发挥作用都是必要的，而且可以通过多种方式教给孩子。例如，可以通过展示或赞扬孩子的作品来教导他重视自己的工作；可以通过让孩子设身处地地感受他人的感受来教导他尊重他人的感情；可以通过给孩子布置适合其年龄和发展水平的任务来教导他对自己的能力有一个现实的想法。

父母没有理由不能把这些东西教给自己的孩子。事实上，他们是做这件事的最佳人选，因为他们比任何人都更了解自己的孩子。然而，他们必须准备好对自己和孩子诚实，而且必须愿意既学习又教导。

35. The process of ageing

At the age of twelve years, the human body is at its most vigorous. It has yet to reach its full size and strength, and its owner his or her full intelligence; but at this age the likelihood of death is least. Earlier, we were infants and young children, and consequently more vulnerable; later, we shall undergo a progressive loss of our vigour and resistance which, though imperceptible at first, will finally become so steep that we can live no longer, however well we look after ourselves, and however well society, and our doctors, look after us. This decline in vigour with the passing of time is called ageing. It is one of the most unpleasant discoveries which we all make that we must decline in this way, that if we escape wars, accidents and diseases we shall eventually 'die of old age', and that this happens at a rate which differs little from person to person, so that there are heavy odds in favour of our dying between the ages of sixty - five and eighty. Some of us will die sooner, a few will live longer - on into a ninth or tenth decade. But the chances are against it, and there is a virtual limit on how long we can hope to remain alive, however lucky and robust we are.

Normal people tend to forget this process unless and until they are reminded of it. We are so familiar with the fact that man ages, that people have for years assumed that the process of losing vigour with time, of becoming more likely to die the older we get, was something self - evident, like the cooling of a hot kettle or the wearing - out of a pair of shoes. They have also assumed that all animals, and probably other organisms such as trees, or even the universe itself, must in the course of time 'wear out'. Most animals we commonly observe do in fact age as we do if they survive long enough; and mechanical systems like a wound - up watch, or the sun, do in fact run out of energy in accordance with the second law of thermodynamics (whether the whole universe does so is a moot point at present). But these are not analogous to what happens when man ages. A run - down watch is still a watch and can be rewound. An old watch, by contrast, becomes so worn and unreliable that it eventually stops working altogether. It is rather like the engine of a car, which can be repaired and even remade, but which eventually is replaced by a new engine. But a human body is not a car, no matter how much you may like to think so. There is no sudden change in the human body which marks the oncoming of old age. The changes are gradual and, at first, are often scarcely perceptible. It is often said that age is a state of mind, and this is true in part. If you feel young, you will be young, but this does not mean that you can avoid the ageing process. The ageing process is a biological process which cannot be avoided, no matter how much you may like to think you can.

The best current medical opinion seems to be that we are born with a sort of 'clock' inside us which determines how long we can live. This 'clock' is thought to be in the genes, and it is believed that we inherit it from our parents. The idea is that the 'clock' starts ticking at birth, and that it keeps on ticking until it runs out of time. Some people believe that this 'clock' can be 'reset' by things like diet, exercise, or drugs, but there is no real evidence for this at present. It is also believed that the rate of ageing can be slowed down by diet, exercise, or drugs, but again, there is no real evidence for this at present. The fact that some people live longer than others may be due to differences in their genes, or it may be due to differences in their lifestyle. It is likely that both factors play a role. But whatever the cause, the fact remains that we all age, and that we all die.

The ageing process has many implications for society. For example, as the population ages, there will be more and more people who are no longer able to work, and who will need to be supported by society. There will also be more and more people who are ill, and who will need medical care. This will put a strain on the resources of society, both in terms of money and in terms of manpower. Another implication is that as people age, they will become more and more different from each other. Some people will age gracefully, while others will age badly. Some people will be able to cope with the ageing process, while others will not. This will make it more difficult for society to deal with the ageing population as a whole.

In conclusion, the ageing process is a complex and unavoidable biological process which has many implications for society. We need to understand it better if we are going to be able to deal with it effectively.

衰老过程

人体在12岁时是生命力最旺盛的时期。虽然这个时候人的身材、体力还没有长足，智力也没有完全发育成熟，但是此时死亡的可能性最小。再早一些，我们是婴儿和幼儿，身体更加脆弱；再往后，我们将经历体力和抵抗力的逐渐衰退。这种衰退起初难以察觉，但最终会急转直下，不管我们自己多么精心照料自己，不管社会和医生对我们多么精心照料，我们都无法再活下去。随着时间的流逝，这种体力的衰退被称为衰老。我们都会发现一个最令人不快的事实：我们必然会这样衰退；如果我们躲过了战争、意外事故和疾病，我们最终会“老死”；而且这种情况发生的概率人与人之间相差无几，所以我们极有可能在65岁到80岁之间死去。有些人会死得早一些，少数人会活得更长——活到八九十岁。但这种可能性很小，不管我们多么幸运、多么健壮，我们能够希望存活的时间实际上是有限的。

一般人往往会忘记这个过程，除非有人提醒。我们对人会衰老这一事实太熟悉了，以至于多年来人们一直认为，随着时间的流逝体力逐渐衰退、年纪越大死亡的可能性越高这一过程是不言而喻的，就像热水壶会变凉或者鞋子会穿破一样。人们还认为，所有的动物，也许还有像树木这样的其他生物，甚至整个宇宙本身，必然会随着时间的推移而“磨损”。我们通常观察到的大多数动物，如果活得够长的话，实际上确实和我们一样会衰老；像上

紧发条的手表或太阳这样的机械系统，实际上确实会根据热力学第二定律耗尽能量（整个宇宙是否也如此，目前还是个有争议的问题）。但是这些与人类衰老时发生的情况并不相似。停走的手表仍然是手表，可以重新上弦。相比之下，一只旧手表会磨损得非常厉害，变得非常不可靠，最终完全停止工作。这很像汽车的发动机，可以修理甚至重新制造，但最终还是会被新的发动机所取代。但是人体不是汽车，不管你多么愿意这样想。人体没有突然的变化标志着老年的到来。这些变化是渐进的，而且一开始往往几乎察觉不到。人们常说年龄是一种心态，这在一定程度上是正确的。如果你感觉年轻，你就会年轻，但这并不意味着你可以避免衰老的过程。衰老过程是一个无法避免的生物过程，不管你多么愿意认为自己可以避免。

目前最好的医学观点似乎是，我们生来体内就带有一种“时钟”，它决定我们能活多久。这种“时钟”被认为存在于基因之中，而且人们相信我们是从父母那里遗传得到它的。这种观点认为，这个“时钟”在出生时就开始滴答走动，一直走到它耗尽时间为止。有些人相信，像饮食、运动或者药物这样的东西可以“重置”这个“时钟”，但目前还没有真正的证据证明这一点。人们也相信，饮食、运动或者药物可以减缓衰老的速度，但同样，目前也没有真正的证据证明这一点。有些人比其他人活得长，这一事实可能是由于他们基因的差异，也可能是由于他们生活方式的差异。很可能这两个因素都起作用。但不管原因是什么，事实仍然是我们都会衰老，我们都会死亡。

衰老过程对社会有很多影响。例如，随着人口老龄化，将有越来越多的人不再能够工作，需要社会的赡养。也将有越来越多的人生病，需要医疗照顾。这将在资金和人力两方面给社会资源带来压力。另一个影响是，随着人们年龄的增长，他们彼此之间将变得越来越不同。有些人会优雅地变老，而有些人则会变得很糟糕。有些人能够应对衰老过程，而有些人则不能。这将使社会更难整体应对老龄化人口。

总之，衰老过程是一个复杂而不可避免的生物过程，对社会有很多影响。如果我们要有效地应对它，就需要更好地理解它。

36. The cost of government

If a nation is essentially disunited, it is left to the government to hold it together. This increases the expense of government, and reduces correspondingly the amount of economic resources that could be used for developing the country. And it should not be forgotten how small those resources are in a poor and backward country. Where the cost of government is high, resources for development are correspondingly low.

This may be illustrated by comparing the position of a nation with that of a private business enterprise. An enterprise has to incur certain costs and expenses in order to stay in business. For our purposes, we are concerned only with one kind of cost - the cost of managing and administering the business. Such administrative overheads in a

business are analogous to the cost of government in a nation. The administrative overheads of a business are low to the extent that everyone working in the enterprise realizes clearly what the objectives of the business are and the means of attaining them. If they are not, the enterprise will have to incur extra costs to clarify its objectives. It may have to set up a committee, spend a great deal of time and money on the plan, and then find out that the plan won't work. In the meantime, of course, the business will have been losing money.

If a nation as a whole is to be more efficient, it has to be better organized. Centralized planning, management, and so on, may be highly efficient by themselves, but from the point of view of the nation as a whole we must be careful about charges of inefficiency. There is always another side to the picture. For example, if we look at the matter of centralization of government functions, we find that while centralization may be highly efficient in terms of economic management, it may also lead to a loss of local self - government. We have to keep in mind that in a large nation there will be great differences in the economic development of different regions. If all the economic decisions are made by a central body, some regions will be left behind. In addition, the large - scale centralization of production that is characteristic of some socialist countries may lead to a loss of the incentives that are provided by a competitive market economy. We have to keep in mind that in a competitive market economy there are always incentives to improve the quality of products and services in order to meet the needs of consumers.

In short, we must be careful when we say that a certain government function, measure, or policy is "inefficient". There may be a complex explanation for the apparent inefficiency. There may be some hidden benefits that we have not yet discovered.

政府的开支

如果一个国家实际上处于分裂状态，那它就得由政府把它团结起来。这样一来就增加了政府的开支，从而相应地减少了可用来发展国家的那部分经济资源。不应忘记，在一个贫穷落后的国家里，那部分资源是多么的微小。凡是政府管理费用高的地方，用于发展的资源就会相应地减少。

把国家的状况同私人企业的状况加以比较，就可以看清这个问题。一个企业为了继续经营，不得不支出一定的费用和开销。就我们的目的而言，我们只关心一种费用——企业行政管理费。一家企业的行政管理开支类似于一个国家的政府管理所用的开支。如果企业中的每个人都清楚地知道企业的目标是什么以及实现这些目标的手段是什么，那么企业的行政管理费用就会降低。反之，如果企业的员工不清楚这些，企业就不得不额外支付费用来使目标明确。企业也许不得不建立一个委员会，花大量的时间和金钱来制定计划，结果却发现该计划行不通。在此期间，企业当然会不断亏损。

如果一个国家作为一个整体要更有效率，它就必须组织得更好。集中计划、管理等等本身可能是非常有效的，但是从整个国家的角度来看，我们必须谨慎对待所谓效率不高的指责。事情总有另外一面。例如，如果我们考察一下政府职能集中化的问题，就会发现，虽然在经济管理方面集中化可能非常有效，但也可能导致地方自治权的丧失。我们必须记住，在一个大国里，不同地区的经济发展会有很大的差异。如果所有的经济决策都由一个中央机构来做，有些地区就会被抛在后面。此外，某些社会主义国家特有的大规模生产集中化，可能会导致失去由竞争的市场经济所提供的激励机制。我们必须记住，在竞争的市场经济中，为了满足消费者的需求，总是存在着改进产品和服务质量的激励因素。

简而言之，当我们说某一政府职能、措施或政策“效率不高”时，我们必须小心谨慎。对表面上的效率不高可能有复杂的解释。可能存在一些我们尚未发现的隐藏利益。

37. The process of ageing

At the age of twelve years, the human body is at its most vigorous. It has yet to reach its full size and strength, and its owner his or her full intelligence; but at this age the likelihood of death is least. Earlier, we were infants and young children, and consequently more vulnerable; later, we shall undergo a progressive loss of our vigour and resistance which, though imperceptible at first, will finally become so steep that we can live no longer, however well we look after ourselves, and however well society, and our doctors, look after us. This decline in vigour with the passing of time is called ageing. It is one of the most unpleasant discoveries which we all make that we must decline in this way, that if we escape wars, accidents and diseases we shall eventually 'die of old age', and that this happens at a rate which differs little from person to person, so that there are heavy odds in favour of our dying between the ages of sixty - five and eighty. Some of us will die sooner, a few will live longer - on into a ninth or tenth decade. But the chances are against it, and there is a virtual limit on how long we can hope to remain alive, however lucky and robust we are.

Normal people tend to forget this process unless and until they are reminded of it. We are so familiar with the fact that man ages, that people have for years assumed that the process of losing vigour with time, of becoming more likely to die the older we get, was something self - evident, like the cooling of a hot kettle or the wearing - out of a pair of shoes. They have also assumed that all animals, and probably other organisms such as trees, or even the universe itself, must in the course of time 'wear out'. Most animals we commonly observe do in fact age as we do if they survive long enough; and mechanical systems like a wound - up watch, or the sun, do in fact run out of energy in accordance with the second law of thermodynamics (whether

the whole universe does so is a moot point at present). But these are not analogous to what happens when man ages. A run - down watch is still a watch and can be rewound. An old watch, by contrast, becomes so worn and unreliable that it eventually stops working altogether. It is rather like the human body. A person who has been doing strenuous physical work for a long time may find that his or her body no longer responds as well as it used to; but if he or she takes a long rest, the body will recover some of its vigour. There is a difference between a worn - out watch and a worn - out body. An old watch cannot be made new again; but a human body can be restored to a certain extent, and, if we take good care of it, it can remain in fairly good condition for a long time.

Our so - called 'control of nature' is a phrase full of conceit. It implies that nature is something outside us, which we can control. We forget that we ourselves are part of nature, and that as we do to nature, nature does to us. Our very life depends on our body's adjustment to the changing environment. We are not much different from other animals in this respect. When we are cold, we shiver and try to get closer to a heat source. When we are hot, we sweat and try to find a cooler place. We do these things because our body has been adjusted to the environment in which we live. We also have a built - in thermostat which regulates our body temperature. When our body temperature rises, we sweat more; when it drops, we shiver more. This is how our body keeps itself in balance. If we interfere with this natural adjustment, for example, by wearing too many clothes when we are cold or by not wearing enough when we are hot, we will get sick. So, we can say that our body has a certain amount of self - control. But this self - control is limited. If we are exposed to too much cold or heat, our body will not be able to adjust itself, and we will die. So, we should respect nature and let our body do its job. We should not be too conceited about our 'control of nature'.

衰老过程

人体在12岁时是生命力最旺盛的时期。虽然这个时候人的身材、体力和智力还有待发展完善，但在这个年龄死亡的可能性最小。再早一些，我们是婴儿和幼小的儿童，身体更加脆弱；再迟一些，我们将经历生命力和抵抗力逐步衰退的过程。虽然这个过程起初难以觉察，但最终会急转直下，不管我们自己、社会以及医生怎样精心照料我们，我们也无法再活下去了。生命力随时间的流失而衰退叫做衰老。我们都会发现这是一个最令人不快的发现：我们必然会这样衰老下去；即使我们能逃避战争、意外的事故和各种疾病，我们最终也会“老死”；衰老的速度在人与人之间相差甚微，所以我们最可能死亡的年龄在65至80岁之间。有些人去世得早些，少数人能活到90多岁甚至100岁。但这种可能性很小，不管我们多么幸运、多么健壮，我们所希望的长寿实际上是有限度的。

一般人除非被提醒，否则往往会忘记这个过程。我们对人总是要衰老的这一事实如此熟悉，以至于多年来人们一直认为，随着时间的流逝而丧失生命力、越老越容易死亡这一过程

是不言而喻的，就像热水壶会冷却、鞋子会穿破一样。人们还认为，所有的动物，可能还有像树木这样的其他生物，甚至宇宙本身，最终都会“磨损殆尽”。我们通常看到的大多数动物，如果它们活得够长的话，确实会像我们一样衰老；像上紧发条的手表或太阳这样的机械系统，实际上确实会按照热力学第二定律耗尽能量（整个宇宙是否如此，目前还是一个有争议的问题）。但这些与人类衰老时发生的情况并不相似。停走的手表仍然是手表，可以重新上弦。相比之下，一只旧手表磨损得太厉害，走时不准，最终完全停止走动。这与人的身体非常相似。一个长时间从事剧烈体力劳动的人可能会发现自己的身体不再像以前那样反应灵敏了；但是如果他休息很长时间，身体就会恢复一些活力。磨损的手表和疲惫的身体是有区别的。旧手表不能再变新了；但是人的身体可以在一定程度上得到恢复，如果我们好好照顾它，它可以在相当长的时间内保持较好的状态。

我们所谓的“征服自然”是一个充满自负的说法。它暗示着自然是我们之外的某种东西，我们可以控制它。我们忘记了我们自己也是自然的一部分，我们对自然做什么，自然就会对我们做什么。我们的生命取决于我们的身体对不断变化的环境的适应。在这一点上，我们和其他动物没有太大的区别。当我们感到寒冷时，我们会颤抖并试图靠近热源。当我们感到炎热时，我们会出汗并试图寻找一个凉爽的地方。我们这样做是因为我们的身体已经适应了我们生活的环境。我们体内还有一个恒温器来调节我们的体温。当我们的体温升高时，我们会出更多的汗；当我们的体温下降时，我们会颤抖得更厉害。这就是我们的身体保持自身平衡的方式。如果我们干扰这种自然调节，例如，当我们感到寒冷时穿太多衣服或者当我们感到炎热时穿得太少，我们就会生病。所以，我们可以说我们的身体有一定的自我控制能力。但是这种自我控制能力是有限的。如果我们暴露在过多的寒冷或炎热中，我们的身体将无法自我调节，我们就会死亡。所以，我们应该尊重自然，让我们的身体发挥它的作用。我们不应该对我们的“征服自然”过于自负。

38. Water and the Traveler

Contamination of water supplies is usually due to poor sanitation close to water sources, sewage disposal into the sources themselves, leakage of sewage into distribution systems or contamination with industrial or farm waste. Even if a piped water supply is safe at its source, it is not always safe by the time it reaches the tap. Intermittent tap - water supplies should be regarded as particularly suspect.

Travelers on short trips to areas with water supplies of uncertain quality should avoid drinking tap - water, or untreated water from any other source. It is best to keep to hot drinks, bottled or canned drinks of well - known brand names - international standards of water treatment are usually followed at bottling plants. Carbonated drinks are acidic, and slightly safer. Make sure that all bottles are opened in your presence, and that their rims are clean and dry.

Boiling is always a good way of treating water. Some hotels supply boiled water on

request and this can be used for drinking, or for brushing teeth. Portable boiling elements that can boil small quantities of water are useful when the right voltage of electricity is available. Refuse politely any cold drink from an unknown source.

Ice is only as safe as the water from which it is made, and should not be put in drinks unless it is known to be safe.

Drinking water can be obtained from almost every inhabited building, but the quality should be regarded as suspect, unless it has been treated in some way. If you are worried, buy a water filter from a reliable source and use it. Generally, however, if water has been boiled or treated at a bottling plant, the risk of water - borne disease will be small.

水和旅行者

水源的污染通常是由于接近水源的地方卫生条件太差而造成的：污水排入水源，污水渗入给水系统或工农业污水造成污染。即使管道供水系统在水源处安全的话，等水到达龙头时就不一定总是安全的了。断断续续的水管应该被视为是非常可疑的。

短途旅行到水质不保险的地区时，应避免饮用水龙头的水或未经处理任何其他来源的水。最好仅饮用开水，名牌瓶装或罐装水——装瓶厂通常遵循国际水处理的标准。碳酸饮料是酸性的，稍微安全一些。确保瓶子是当你面开启的，瓶口清洁、干燥。

烧开一直是水处理的一种好办法。有的酒店根据要求可提供开水，这些开水可用于饮用或刷牙。如果有相配的电压，可以买到能煮少量水的便携式煮水器。应谢绝任何不知来源的冷饮。

冰块只有当制造冰块的水安全时才是保险的，只有知道冰块安全时才可以加入饮料。

几乎任何住所都有饮用水，但除非是经过某种方式处理过，否则其质量是不可靠的。如果担心的话，买一个可靠的滤水器并且使用它。然而，一般来说，如果水是烧开过的或是瓶装水厂处理过的，水源性疾病的风险就小得多。

39. Waves

Waves are the children of the struggle between ocean and atmosphere, the ongoing signatures of infinity. Rays from the sun excite and energize the atmosphere of the earth, awakening it to flow, to movement, to rhythm, to life. The wind then speaks the message of the sun to the sea and the sea transmits it on through waves - an ancient, elemental, powerful yet gentle message.

Of all nature's forces, gravity is the most familiar and the most mysterious. Gravity

is the irresistible force of attraction that moves objects towards each other. In the case of the ocean and the atmosphere, gravity is the force that keeps the ocean's surface in its place, while allowing the atmosphere to move freely above it. Waves are the result of the interaction between the ocean and the atmosphere, as the wind blows across the surface of the water, creating ripples that grow into waves.

Waves can be described in terms of their height, length, and period. The height of a wave is the vertical distance between the crest (the highest point) and the trough (the lowest point). The length of a wave is the horizontal distance between two consecutive crests or troughs. The period of a wave is the time it takes for one complete cycle of the wave to occur, from crest to crest or trough to trough.

Waves can also be classified according to their source. Wind - generated waves are the most common type of waves, created by the wind blowing across the surface of the water. Tsunamis, on the other hand, are large - scale waves generated by underwater earthquakes, volcanic eruptions, or landslides. Seiches are standing waves that occur in enclosed or semi - enclosed bodies of water, such as lakes or bays.

The power of waves is truly astonishing. Waves can erode coastlines, build up beaches, and transport sediment across great distances. They can also generate electricity, as the movement of the waves can be harnessed to turn turbines. In addition, waves play an important role in the global climate system, as they help to distribute heat around the world.

In conclusion, waves are a fascinating and important part of nature. They are the result of the interaction between the ocean and the atmosphere, and they possess a wide range of characteristics and functions. Whether we are admiring their beauty from the shore, surfing their crests, or harnessing their power for electricity, waves are an ever - present reminder of the power and mystery of nature.

海浪

海浪是海洋和大气相互作用的产物，象征着无限的生命力。太阳光线刺激和激发地球的大气层，使它活跃起来，流动、运动、有节奏、有生命。然后，风把太阳的信息传递给海洋，海洋又通过海浪将其传播出去——这是一种古老、基本、强大而又温和的信息。

在自然界所有的力量中，引力是最常见也是最神秘的。引力是一种不可抗拒的吸引力，它使物体相互靠近。就海洋和大气而言，引力是使海洋表面保持在原位的力量，同时又允许大气在其上方自由移动。海浪是海洋和大气相互作用的结果，当风吹过水面时，会产生涟漪，涟漪逐渐发展成海浪。

海浪可以用高度、长度和周期来描述。海浪的高度是指波峰（最高点）和波谷（最低点）之间的垂直距离。海浪的长度是指两个连续波峰或波谷之间的水平距离。海浪的周期是指

一个完整的海浪周期所需要的时间，从一个波峰到下一个波峰或者从一个波谷到下一个波谷。

海浪也可以根据其来源进行分类。风生浪是最常见的海浪类型，由风吹过水面而产生。另一方面，海啸是由海底地震、火山爆发或山体滑坡引发的大规模海浪。假潮是发生在封闭或半封闭水体（如湖泊或海湾）中的驻波。

海浪的力量确实惊人。海浪可以侵蚀海岸线、堆积海滩，并将沉积物搬运到很远的地方。它们还可以发电，因为海浪的运动可以被用来驱动涡轮机。此外，海浪在全球气候系统中也起着重要的作用，因为它们有助于将热量分布到世界各地。

总之，海浪是大自然中迷人而又重要的一部分。它们是海洋和大气相互作用的结果，具有各种各样的特征和功能。无论是我们在岸边欣赏它们的美丽，在浪尖上冲浪，还是利用它们的力量发电，海浪都时刻提醒着我们大自然的力量和神秘。

40. Waves

Waves are the children of the struggle between ocean and atmosphere, the ongoing signatures of infinity. Rays from the sun excite and energize the atmosphere of the earth, awakening it to flow, to movement, to rhythm, to life. The wind then speaks the message of the sun to the sea and the sea transmits it on through waves -- an ancient, exquisite, powerful but soothing voice. These ocean waves are among the earth's most complicated natural phenomena. The basic features include a crest (the highest point of the wave), a trough (the lowest point), a height (the vertical distance from the trough to the crest), a wave length (the horizontal distance between two wave crests), and a period (which is the time it takes a wave crest to travel one wave length).

Although an ocean wave gives the impression of a wall of water moving in your direction, in actuality waves move through the water leaving the water about where it was. If the water was moving with the wave, the ocean and everything on it would be racing in to the shore with obviously catastrophic results.

An ocean wave passing through deep water causes a particle on the surface to move in a roughly circular orbit, drawing the particle first towards the advancing wave, then up into the wave, then forward with it and then -- as the wave leaves the particles behind -- back to its starting point again.

From both maturity to death, a wave is subject to the same laws as any other 'living' thing. For a time it assumes a miraculous individuality that, in the end, is reabsorbed into the great ocean of life.

The undulating waves of the open sea are generated by three natural causes: wind, earth movements or tremors, and the gravitational pull of the moon and sun. Once waves have been generated, gravity is the force that drives them in a continual attempt to restore the ocean surface to a flat plain.

海浪

海浪是海洋和大气相斗的产物，无限的一种不间断的标志。太阳光刺激了地球的大气层，并给予它能量；使大气层活跃起来，流动、运动、产生节奏，获得生命。然后，风把太阳的信息带给了大海，海洋用波浪的形式传递这个信息——一种古老、优美、强健而又温和的声音。这些海浪属于地球上最复杂的自然现象。它们的基本特征包括浪峰（波浪的最高点）、波谷（最低点）、浪高（从波谷到浪峰的垂直距离）、波长（两个浪峰间的水平距离）和周期（海峰走过一个波长所需的时间）。

虽然，海浪给人的印象是一堵由水组成的墙向你压过来，而实际上，浪从水中移过，而水则留在原处。如果水和浪一起移动的话，那么大海和海里所有的东西就会向岸边疾涌而来，带来明显的灾难性后果。

穿过深水的海浪使水面上的一个微粒按照一种近乎圆形的轨道移动，先把微粒拉向前移动的海浪，然后推上浪峰，随着波浪一起前进，然后——当波浪把微粒留在身后时——微粒又回到出发点。

从成熟到消亡，波浪和其他任何“活动中”的东西一样，都受制于共同的法则。一度它获得非凡的个性，但最终又被重新融进生命的大洋。

公海上起伏的波浪是由3个自然因素构成的：风、地球的运动或震颤和月亮、太阳的引力。一旦波浪形成，重力是持续不断地促使海面回复到平坦状态的力量。

41. Training elephants

Two main techniques have been used for training elephants, which we may call respectively the tough and the gentle. The former method simply consists of setting an elephant to work and beating him until he does what is expected of him. Apart from any moral considerations this is a stupid method of training, for it produces a resentful animal who at a later stage may well turn man - killer. The gentle method requires more patience in the early stages, but produces a cheerful, good - tempered elephant who will give many years of loyal service.

The first essential in elephant training is to assign to the animal a single mahout who will be entirely responsible for the job. Elephants like to have one master just as dogs do, and are capable of a considerable degree of personal affection. There are even stories of half - trained elephant calves who have refused to feed and pined to

death when by some unavoidable circumstance they have been deprived of their own trainer.

The system which seems to work best for elephants is to assign to them their own trainer, who will stay with them for life. Another essential factor is the establishment of a very definite place where the elephant will be trained. It should be a fairly large area, surrounded by a fence or railing, and it should be in an area where the elephant is not likely to be distracted by other animals. Elephants need to be trained to be stable in various situations, so they should be exposed to different environments. They should be trained to stand still when they are being groomed, for example, and to kneel when they are being loaded or unloaded. They should also be trained to respond to commands given in different ways, such as by voice, by whistle, or by a tug on a rope.

Elephants are very intelligent animals, and they can be trained to perform a wide variety of tasks. They can be trained to carry heavy loads, for example, or to work in the logging industry. They can also be trained to perform in circuses, where they can show off their strength and agility. However, it is important to note that elephants are wild animals, and they should be treated with respect and care. Training elephants should be a process that is based on positive reinforcement, rather than on punishment or coercion.

训练大象

驯象有两种主要的方法，我们分别称之为强硬法和温柔法。前一种方法仅仅是驱使象去干活，把它打到顺从为止。且不说道义问题，这本身就是一种愚蠢的训练方法，因为这种方法训练会使动物反感，在以后某个时期可能会变成伤人的动物。温柔法要求在最初阶段保持较大的耐心，但这种方法可以训练出性情愉快、脾气温顺，能忠实为人服务多年的大象。

驯象中至关重要的是，为大象配备一个专门的驯象员，他将对这项工作负完全的责任。大象和狗一样，喜欢有一个专一的主人，而且能够有相当程度的个人感情。甚至有这样的故事：训练了一半的小象，由于不可避免的情况与他们的主人分离后，竟拒绝吃食，消瘦至死。

对于大象来说似乎最有效的体系是为它们配备一名终身陪伴它们的驯象员。另一个重要的因素是为大象建立一个非常明确的训练场所。这个场所应该相当大，周围用栅栏或栏杆围起来，而且应该位于大象不太可能被其他动物分心的区域。大象需要被训练得在各种情况下都保持稳定，所以它们应该接触不同的环境。例如，它们应该被训练得在接受洗刷时站着不动，在装卸货物时跪下。它们还应该被训练得对以不同方式发出的指令做出反应，比如通过声音、口哨声或者拉绳子。

大象是非常聪明的动物，它们能被训练执行各种各样的任务。例如，它们能被训练来搬运重物，或者在伐木业中工作。它们也能被训练在马戏团表演，在那里它们可以展示自己的

力量和敏捷性。然而，需要注意的是，大象是野生动物，应该受到尊重和关爱。训练大象应该是一个基于正面激励的过程，而不是基于惩罚或强迫。

42. Record of the Past

We might marvel at the progress made in every field of study, but the methods of testing a person's knowledge and ability remain as primitive as ever they were. It really is extraordinary that after all these years, educationists have still failed to device anything more efficient and reliable than examinations. For all the pious claim that examinations test what you know, it is common knowledge that they more often do the exact opposite. They may be a good means of testing memory, or the knack of working rapidly under extreme pressure, but they can tell you nothing about a person's true ability and aptitude.

As anxiety-makers, examinations are second to none. That is because so much depends on them. They are the mark of success or failure in our society. Your whole future may be decided in one fateful day. It doesn't matter that you weren't feeling very well, or that your mother died. Little things like that don't count: the exam goes on. No one can give of his best when he is in mortal terror, or after a sleepless night, yet this is precisely what the examination system expects him to do.

The moment a child begins school, he enters a world of vicious competition where success and failure are clearly defined and measured. Can we wonder at the increasing number of 'drop - outs': young people who are written off as utter failures before they have even embarked on a career? Can we be surprised at the suicide rate among students?

A good education should, among other things, train you to think for yourself. The examination system does anything but that. What has to be learnt is rigidly laid down by a syllabus, so the student is encouraged to memorize. Examinations do not motivate a student to read widely, but to restrict his reading; they do not enable him to seek more and more knowledge, but induce cramming. They lower the standards of teaching, because they deprive the teacher of all freedoms. Teachers themselves are often judged by examination results, and instead of teaching their subjects, they are reduced to training their students in exam techniques which they despise. The most successful candidates are not always the best educated; they are the best trained in the technique of working under duress.

The results on which so much depends are often nothing more than a subjective

assessment by some anonymous examiner. Examiners are only human. They get tired and hungry; they make mistakes. Yet they have to mark stacks of hastily scrawled scripts in a limited amount of time. Most of them are overworked and underpaid. They are in the position of a doctor who has to diagnose a patient's illness without the benefit of laboratory tests. What wonder that in such circumstances, they often make mistakes?

There must surely be many simpler and more effective ways of assessing a person's true abilities. Is it cynical to suggest that examinations are merely a profitable business for the institutions that run them? This is what it boils down to in the last analysis. The best comment on the system is this ill - fated word - 'examination'.

往昔的记载

我们可能对各个学科在知识上所取得的进步感到惊叹，然而测试一个人知识和能力的方法却依然原始如初。经过这么多年，教育家们仍未能设计出比考试更有效、更可靠的东西，这确实是很不寻常的。尽管考试虔诚地声称是测试你所知道的东西，但众所周知，它们往往适得其反。它们可能是测试记忆力或者在极度压力下快速工作的诀窍的好手段，但它们无法告诉你一个人的真正能力和才能。

作为制造焦虑的因素，考试是首屈一指的。这是因为很多事情都取决于考试。它们是我们社会中成功或失败的标志。你的整个未来可能在命运攸关的一天里被决定。你当时感觉不太好或者你母亲去世了，这些都无关紧要：考试照样进行。当一个人处于极度恐惧之中，或者一夜未眠之后，没有人能发挥出自己的最佳水平，然而这正是考试制度期望他做的。

孩子一上学，就进入了一个残酷竞争的世界，在那里，成功和失败都有明确的定义和衡量标准。我们能对越来越多的“辍学者”感到奇怪吗？这些年轻人在甚至还没有开始职业生涯之前就被认为是彻底的失败者。我们能对学生中的自杀率感到惊讶吗？

良好的教育，除其他方面外，应该训练你独立思考。而考试制度却完全做不到这一点。必须学习的内容是由教学大纲严格规定的，因此鼓励学生去死记硬背。考试不能促使学生广泛阅读，反而限制他的阅读；它们不能使他去追求越来越多的知识，反而诱导他去死记硬背。它们降低了教学标准，因为它们剥夺了教师的一切自由。教师们自己也常常根据考试结果来被评判，结果他们不是去教授自己的学科，而是沦落到去训练学生他们自己都瞧不起的应试技巧。最成功的考生并不总是受教育最好的；他们是在胁迫下工作的技巧方面训练得最好的。

这么多事情所依赖的结果往往不过是某个匿名考官的主观评估。考官也是人。他们会疲劳、饥饿；他们会犯错误。然而他们必须在有限的时间内批改一摞摞匆忙潦草写成的试卷。他们中的大多数人工作过度而报酬过低。他们就像没有实验室检验的好处却必须诊断病人病情的医生。在这种情况下，他们经常犯错又有什么奇怪的呢？

肯定有许多更简单、更有效的方法来评估一个人的真正能力。说考试仅仅是举办考试的机构的一项有利可图的生意，这是不是太愤世嫉俗了呢？这就是最终归结起来的情况。对这种制度最好的评论就是这个倒霉的词——“考试”。

43. Are There Strangers in Space?

We must conclude from the work of those who have studied the origin of life, that given a planet only approximately like our own, life is almost certain to start. Of all the planets in our own solar system we are now pretty certain the Earth is the only one on which life can survive. Mars is too dry and poor in oxygen, Venus far too hot, and so on. But other suns, stars as the astronomers call them, are bound to have planets like our own, and as the number of stars in the universe is so vast, this possibility becomes virtual certainty. There are one hundred thousand million stars in our own Milky Way alone, and then there are three thousand million other Milky Ways, or galaxies, in the universe. So the number of stars that we know exist is now estimated at about 300 million million million.

We can make the same kind of argument, and have in recent years. For example, we think that between 80 and 90 per cent of all stars, like our sun, are circled by planets which may be inhabited. That means that our nearest neighbours are perhaps 4.3 light years away, which is much too far to think of in terms of visiting them. But even if we never visit them, if we could get at their language, we might be able to communicate with them.

Recently, two Americans made a startling discovery; they have found sound waves in the space between the stars. If such sound waves really exist, they must be the remains of some very large and powerful explosion that took place thousands of millions of years ago. Since these sound waves are spreading outwards at the speed of light, they are by now far out in the universe. And it is also possible that other civilizations have picked up these waves, and are trying to make something of them. This also gives us a new way to look at the universe, and makes us wonder if there are other intelligent beings out there.

宇宙中有外星人存在吗？

根据研究生命起源的人们所做的工作，我们必然会得出这样的结论：假如有一颗行星和我们地球的情况基本相似，那几乎可以肯定生命会在上面开始。在我们太阳系的所有行星中，我们现在相当肯定地球是生命能存在的唯一行星。火星太干燥又缺氧，金星太热，等等。但是，其他的太阳，也就是天文学家所说的恒星，肯定有像我们地球一样的行星。由于宇宙中恒星的数目极其庞大，这种可能性实际上是肯定的。仅我们的银河系就有1,000亿颗恒星，而且在宇宙中还有30亿个其他的银河系，即星系。因此，我们所知道的存在的恒星数量现在估计约为300,000亿亿颗。

近年来我们也提出了同样的观点。例如，我们认为，像太阳这样的恒星中，有80%到90%是被可能有生命居住的行星所环绕。这意味着我们最近的邻居可能在4.3光年之外，这距离远得无法想象去访问他们。但是即使我们永远不去访问他们，如果我们能了解他们的语言

，我们也许就能和他们交流。

最近，两位美国人有了一个惊人的发现：他们在恒星之间的空间发现了声波。如果这种声波真的存在，它们一定是数千亿年前发生的某种非常巨大和强烈的爆炸的残余。由于这些声波以光速向外传播，它们现在已经远在宇宙之中了。而且也有可能其他文明已经接收到了这些波，并试图对它们加以利用。这也给了我们一个看待宇宙的新视角，让我们想知道是否还有其他智慧生物存在于宇宙之中。

44. Patterns of Culture

Custom has not commonly been regarded as a subject of any great moment. The inner workings of our own brains we feel to be uniquely worthy of investigation, but custom, we have a way of thinking, is behaviour at its most commonplace. As a matter of fact, it is the other way around. Traditional custom, taken the world over, is a mass of detailed behaviour more astonishing than what any one person can ever evolve in individual actions, no matter how aberrant. Yet that is a rather trivial aspect of the matter. The fact of first - rate importance is the predominant role that custom plays in experience and in belief, and the very great varieties it may manifest.

No man ever looks at the world with pristine eyes. He sees it edited by a definite set of customs and institutions and ways of thinking. Even in his philosophical probings he cannot go behind these stereotypes; his very concepts of the true and the false will still have reference to his particular traditional customs. John Dewey has said in all seriousness that the part played by custom in shaping the behaviour of the individual, as against any way in which he can affect traditional custom, is as the proportion of the total vocabulary of his mother tongue against those words of his own baby talk that are taken up into the vernacular of his family. When one seriously studies the social orders that have had the opportunity to develop autonomously, the figure becomes no more than an exact and matter - of - fact observation. The life - history of the individual is first and foremost an accommodation to the patterns of his culture. From his very birth the customs into which he is born shape his experience and behaviour. By the time he can talk, he is the little creature of his culture, and by the time he is grown and able to take part in its activities, its habits are his habits, its beliefs his beliefs, its impossibilities his impossibilities.

Every culture has its own distinctive set of customs and institutions and ways of thinking. These are the building blocks of the culture, and they determine the pattern

of the culture. The culture pattern is the overall design of the culture, the way in which the various building blocks are put together. It is the result of the long - term evolution of the culture, and it is relatively stable. Once a culture pattern is established, it is very difficult to change. It is like a mould into which the members of the culture are poured, and they are shaped by it. The culture pattern is not only a set of rules and regulations, but also a set of values and attitudes. It is the way in which the members of the culture see the world and themselves. It is the way in which they evaluate things and people. It is the way in which they make decisions and take actions.

The study of culture patterns is an important part of anthropology. Anthropologists study the different culture patterns of different peoples, and they try to understand how these patterns are formed, how they function, and how they change. They study the relationships between the culture patterns and the social, economic, political, and religious systems of the peoples. They study the impact of the culture patterns on the individual members of the culture, and they study the impact of the individual members on the culture patterns. They try to understand the dynamics of the culture, the way in which it moves and changes. They try to understand the unity and diversity of the culture, the way in which it is both one and many. The study of culture patterns is also an important part of sociology. Sociologists study the culture patterns of different social groups, and they try to understand how these patterns are formed, how they function, and how they change. They study the relationships between the culture patterns and the social structure, the social relations, and the social processes of the social groups. They study the impact of the culture patterns on the individual members of the social groups, and they study the impact of the individual members on the culture patterns. They try to understand the dynamics of the social group, the way in which it moves and changes. They try to understand the unity and diversity of the social group, the way in which it is both one and many.

The study of culture patterns is also an important part of psychology. Psychologists study the culture patterns of different peoples, and they try to understand how these patterns are formed, how they function, and how they change. They study the relationships between the culture patterns and the mental processes, the mental states, and the mental characteristics of the peoples. They study the impact of the culture patterns on the individual members of the peoples, and they study the impact of the individual members on the culture patterns. They try to understand the dynamics of the mental processes, the way in which they move and changes. They try to understand the unity and diversity of the mental processes, the way in which it is both one and many.

The study of culture patterns is also an important part of history. Historians study the culture patterns of different peoples in different historical periods, and they try to understand how these patterns are formed, how they function, and how they change. They study the relationships between the culture patterns and the historical events, the historical processes, and the historical trends of the peoples. They study the impact of the culture patterns on the individual members of the peoples, and they study the impact of the individual members on the culture patterns. They try to understand the dynamics of the historical processes, the way in which they move and changes. They try to understand the unity and diversity of the historical processes, the way in which it is both one and many.

文化的模式

风俗一般未被认为是什么重要的课题。我们觉得，只有我们大脑内部的活动情况才值得研究，至于风俗呢，只是些司空见惯的行为而已。事实上，情况正好相反。从世界范围来看，传统风俗是由许多细节性的习惯行为组成，它比任何一个人在其个体行为中所能演化出来的东西要复杂得多，不管他的行为多么乖僻。然而，这只是问题的一个次要方面。最重要的是，风俗在实践中和信仰上所起的举足轻重的作用，以及它所表现出来的极其丰富的多样性。

没有人是用纯洁而无偏见的眼光看待世界。人们所看到的是一个受特定的风俗习惯、制度和思想方式剪辑过的世界。甚至在哲学领域的探索中，人们也无法超越这些定型的框框。人们关于真与假的概念依然和特定的传统风俗有关。约翰·杜威曾经非常严肃地指出：风俗在形成个人行为方面所起的作用和一个人对传统风俗的影响相比，就好像他本国语言的总词汇量和他儿时从家庭用语中学会的那些单词之比。当一个人认真地研究自发形成的社会秩序时，杜威的比喻就是他实事求是观察得来的形象化的说法。个人的生活史首先就是适应他的文化的模式。从他呱呱坠地的时刻起，他所生于其中的风俗就开始塑造他的经历和行为规范。到他会说话时，他就是传统文化塑造的一个小孩子了；等他长大成人并能参加该文化的各种活动时，该文化的习惯就是他的习惯，该文化的信仰就是他的信仰，该文化的禁忌就是他的禁忌。

每一种文化都有其独特的一套风俗、制度和思想方式。这些都是文化的组成部分，它们决定了文化的模式。文化模式是文化的总体设计，是各种文化组成部分组合的方式。它是文化长期演变的结果，并且相对稳定。一旦一种文化模式形成，就很难改变。它就像一个模具，文化成员被注入这个模具，他们就被它塑造。文化模式不仅是一套规章制度，而且是一套价值观念和态度。它是文化成员看待世界和自己的方式。它是他们评价事物和人的方式。它是他们做决策和采取行动的方式。

文化模式的研究是人类学的一个重要部分。人类学家研究不同民族的不同文化模式，试图了解这些模式是如何形成的、如何发挥作用的以及如何变化的。他们研究文化模式与各民族的社会、经济、政治和宗教制度之间的关系。他们研究文化模式对该文化的个体成员的影响，也研究个体成员对文化模式的影响。他们试图了解文化的动态，即文化运动和变化的方式。他们试图了解文化的统一性和多样性，即文化既是一个整体又是多种成分的组合方式。文化模式的研究也是社会学的一个重要部分。社会学家研究不同社会群体的文化模

式，试图了解这些模式是如何形成的、如何发挥作用的以及如何变化的。他们研究文化模式与社会群体的社会结构、社会关系和社会过程之间的关系。他们研究文化模式对社会群体的个体成员的影响，也研究个体成员对文化模式的影响。他们试图了解社会群体的动态，即社会群体运动和变化的方式。他们试图了解社会群体的统一性和多样性，即社会群体既是一个整体又是多种成分的组合方式。

文化模式的研究也是心理学的一个重要部分。心理学家研究不同民族的文化模式，试图了解这些模式是如何形成的、如何发挥作用的以及如何变化的。他们研究文化模式与各民族的心理过程、心理状态和心理特征之间的关系。他们研究文化模式对各民族的个体成员的影响，也研究个体成员对文化模式的影响。他们试图了解心理过程的动态，即心理过程运动和变化的方式。他们试图了解心理过程的统一性和多样性，即心理过程既是一个整体又是多种成分的组合方式。

文化模式的研究也是历史的一个重要部分。历史学家研究不同历史时期不同民族的文化模式，试图了解这些模式是如何形成的、如何发挥作用的以及如何变化的。他们研究文化模式与各民族的历史事件、历史进程和历史趋势之间的关系。他们研究文化模式对各民族的个体成员的影响，也研究个体成员对文化模式的影响。他们试图了解历史进程的动态，即历史进程运动和变化的方式。他们试图了解历史进程的统一性和多样性，即历史进程既是一个整体又是多种成分的组合方式。

45. Patterns of culture

Custom has not commonly been regarded as a subject of any great moment. The inner workings of our own brains we feel to be uniquely worthy of investigation, but custom, we have a way of thinking, is behavior at its most commonplace. As a matter of fact, it is the other way around. Traditional custom, taken the world over, is a mass of detailed behavior more astonishing than what any one person can ever evolve in individual actions, no matter how aberrant. Yet that is a rather trivial aspect of the matter. The fact of first - rate importance is the predominant role that custom plays in experience and in belief, and the very great varieties it may manifest.

No man ever looks at the world with pristine eyes. He sees it edited by a definite set of customs and institutions and ways of thinking. Even in his philosophical probing he cannot go behind these stereotypes; his very concepts of the true and the false will still have reference to his particular traditional customs. John Dewey has said in all seriousness that the part played by custom in shaping the behavior of the individual, as against any way in which he can affect traditional custom, is as the proportion of the total vocabulary of his mother tongue against those words of his own baby talk that are taken up into the vernacular of his family. When one

seriously studies the social orders that have had the opportunity to develop autonomously, the figure becomes no more than an exact and matter - of - fact observation. The life history of the individual is first and foremost an accommodation to the patterns of his culture. From the moment of his birth, the customs into which he is born shape his experience and behavior. By the time he can talk, he is the little creature of his culture, and by the time he is grown and able to take part in its activities, his culture's habits are his habits, his culture's beliefs are his beliefs, his culture's impossibilities are his impossibilities.

Every child that is born into his group will share them. And no child born into one on the far side of the globe can ever achieve the thousandth part of it. There is no social problem it is more incumbent upon us to understand than this of the role of custom. Until we are able to do so, we will be in danger of violating it in every direction. Only when we understand can we respect. And only when we respect can we hope to modify, if it becomes necessary to modify. But we can't even start to understand until we rid ourselves of the very common notion that custom is only a quaint relic of bygone days.

It is true that in modern times the automatic nature of traditional custom has been much weakened. We no longer live in a world where custom automatically dictates what we do. But the essential role that custom plays in our lives has not changed. We are still creatures of custom, and custom still shapes our experience and beliefs in countless ways.

Custom can never be used as a ready - made solution to modern social problems. But if we are to understand the nature of these problems, we must first understand the role of custom in our lives.

文化的模式

风俗一般未被认为是什么重要的课题。我们觉得，只有我们大脑内部的活动情况才值得研究，至于风俗呢，只是些司空见惯的行为而已。事实正好相反。从世界范围来看，传统风俗是由许多细节性的习惯行为所组成，它比任何一个人在其个体活动中所表现出来的行为都更加令人惊奇，不管其个人行为多么异常。不过，这只是问题的一个次要的侧面。最重要的是，风俗在实践中和信仰上所起的举足轻重的作用，以及它所表现出来的极其丰富的多样性。

没有一个人是用纯洁而无偏见的眼光看待世界。人们所看到的是一个受特定的风俗习惯、制度和思维方式剪辑过世界。甚至在哲学领域的探索中，人们也无法超越这些定型的框框。人们关于真与假的概念依然和特定的传统风俗有关。约翰·杜威曾经非常严肃地指出：风俗在形成个人行为方面所起的作用和一个人对传统风俗的影响相比，就好像他本国语言的总词汇量和他自己儿时从家庭用语中学会的词汇量之比。当一个人认真地研究自发形成的社会秩序时，杜威的比喻就是他实事求是观察得来的形象化的说法。个人的生活史首先

就是适应他的文化的模式的历史。从他呱呱坠地的时刻起，他所生于其中的风俗就开始塑造他的经历和行为规范。到他会说话时，他就是传统文化塑造的一个小孩子了；等他长大了，能参加各种活动了，他的文化的习惯就是他的习惯，他的文化的信仰就是他的信仰，他的文化不能做的事就是他不能做的事。

每一个和他诞生在同一个群体中的孩子和他一样具有相同的风俗；而在地球的另一边，诞生在另一个群体中的孩子与他就很少有相同的风俗。没有任何一个社会问题比得上风俗的作用问题更要求我们对它加以了解。除非我们能够理解它，否则我们就有在各个方面违反它的危险。只有当我们理解了风俗，我们才能尊重它。只有当我们尊重了风俗，必要时我们才有可能去改变它。然而，在我们抛弃那种认为风俗不过是昔日的遗留物的陈腐观念之前，我们将永远无法理解风俗。

的确，在现代，传统风俗的自动性已大大被削弱。我们不再生活在一个由风俗自动支配行动的世界里。但是，风俗在我们生活中所起的基本作用并未改变。我们仍然是风俗的产物，而且风俗仍然在无数方面塑造着我们的经历和信仰。

风俗决不能被用作解决现代社会问题的现成方案。但是，如果我们要理解这些问题的本质，我们就必须首先理解风俗在我们生活中所起的作用。

46. Hobbies

A gifted American psychologist has said, "Worry is a spasm of the emotion; the mind catches hold of something and will not let it go." It is useless to argue with the mind in this condition. The stronger the will, the more futile the task. One can only gently insinuate something else into its convulsive grasp. And if this something else is rightly chosen, if it is really attended by the illumination of another field of interest, gradually, and often quite swiftly, the old undue grip relaxes and the process of recuperation and repair begins.

The cultivation of a hobby and new forms of interest is therefore a policy of the first importance to a public man. But this is not a business that can be undertaken in a day or swiftly improvised by a mere command of the will. The growth of alternative mental interests is a long process. The seeds must be carefully chosen; they must fall on good ground; they must be sedulously tended, if the vivifying fruits are to be at hand when needed.

To be really happy and really safe, one ought to have at least two or three hobbies, and they must all be real. It is no use starting late in life to say: "I will take an interest in this or that." Such an attempt only aggravates the strain of mental effort. A man may acquire great knowledge of topics unconnected with his daily work, and yet get hardly any benefit or relief. It is no use doing what you like; you have got to

like what you do. Broadly speaking, human beings may be divided into three classes: those who are toiled to death, those who are worried to death, and those who are bored to death. It is no use offering the manual labourer, tired out with a hard day's work, the chance of playing a game of football or baseball. It is no use inviting the politician or the professional or business man, who has been working or worrying about serious things for six days, to work or worry about trifling things at the weekend.

As for the unfortunate people who can neither toil nor worry, right in the middle of one of their periodic ongosings into boredom, no earthly use can be made of them by anybody. In most cases, the so - called hobbies of the average person are really more like habits. For example, one man's hobby is reading, another's is fishing, another's is gardening, another's is playing the piano. But if you were to ask these people how much time they spend on their hobbies, you would be surprised to find that they spend hardly any time at all. They have the habit of reading, fishing, gardening or playing the piano, but they do not really have the hobby. In fact, they are so busy with their daily work that they have no time to develop a real hobby.

A real hobby is an absorbing pursuit outside one's daily work. It is something that one can lose oneself in. It is not something that one does just to kill time. A real hobby gives one a sense of accomplishment and satisfaction. It is something that one can be proud of. A real hobby can also be a great source of relaxation and rejuvenation.

So, if you want to be really happy and really safe, start early in life to develop a real hobby. Choose something that you are really interested in. Do not choose something just because it is fashionable or because other people are doing it. Develop your hobby slowly but surely. Do not expect too much too soon. And do not give up too easily. If you do these things, you will find that your hobby will become a great source of happiness and safety in your life.

爱好

一位天才的美国心理学家曾经说过：“烦恼是感情的发作，此时脑子纠缠住了某种东西又不肯松手。”在这种情况下，你和头脑争吵让它松手是无济于事的。这种意志越是强烈，这种尝试越是徒劳。你只能温和而巧妙地让另一种东西进入痉挛僵持的头脑中。如果选得合适，而且的确受到别的领域的情趣的启迪，那么渐渐地，往往也是很顺利地，原先不适当的紧张就会松弛下来，恢复和修整的过程就会开始。

因此，对一个从事社会活动的人来说，培养一种爱好和新的兴趣是头等重要的做法。但这并非一日之功，也不是单凭毅力就能临时凑成的。精神上多种情趣的培养是一个长期的过程。要想在需要的时候可随手摘取充满生机的果实，那就必须从精选良种做起，然后将其植入肥沃的土地，还需要勤勉地护理。

要想真正生活得幸福和平安，一个人至少应该有两三种业余爱好，而且必须是真正的爱好。到了晚年才开始说“我要培养这个或那个兴趣”是毫无用处的，这种尝试只会增加精神上的负担。一个人可能会在与他日常工作无关的领域中获得渊博的知识，但却很难得到什么益处或放松。做你喜欢做的事是没有用的，你得喜欢你所做的是。广义地说，人可以分为三类：劳累而死的人、忧虑而死的人、无聊而死的人。对于那些体力劳动者来说，经过一天的辛苦劳作，给他们提供踢足球或者打棒球的机会是毫无意义的。对于那些政治家、专业人士或者商人来说，他们已经为严肃的事情操劳或烦恼了六天，再让他们在周末为琐事操劳或烦恼也是毫无意义的。

至于那些不幸的人，他们既劳累又忧虑，就在他们周期性的无聊发作期间，任何人对他们都毫无用处。在大多数情况下，普通人所谓的爱好实际上更像是习惯。例如，一个人的爱好是读书，另一个人的爱好是钓鱼，另一个人的爱好是园艺，另一个人的爱好是弹钢琴。但是如果你问这些人他们在爱好上花了多少时间，你会惊奇地发现他们几乎没有花什么时间。他们有读书、钓鱼、园艺或弹钢琴的习惯，但他们并没有真正的爱好。事实上，他们忙于日常工作，以至于没有时间去发展真正的爱好。

真正的爱好是一种能让人沉浸其中的业余追求，是一种能让人忘却自我的东西，而不是一种仅仅用来消磨时间的东西。真正的爱好能给人一种成就感和满足感，是一种能让人引以为傲的东西。真正的爱好也可以是放松和恢复活力的巨大源泉。

所以，如果你想真正生活得幸福和平安，就趁早开始培养一种真正的爱好吧。选择你真正感兴趣的東西，不要仅仅因为它时髦或者别人都在做就去选择它。慢慢地但踏踏实实地发展你的爱好，不要期望过高过快，也不要轻易放弃。如果你做到了这些，你就会发现你的爱好将成为你生活中幸福和平安的巨大源泉。

47. The Great Escape

Economy is one powerful motive for camping, since after the initial outlay upon equipment, or through hiring it, the total expense can be far less than the cost of hotels. But, contrary to a popular assumption, it is far from being the only one, or even the greatest. The man who manoeuvres carelessly into his twenty pounds' worth of space at one of Europe's myriad permanent sites may find himself bumping a Bentley. More likely, Ford Escort will be hub to hub with Renault or Mercedes, but rarely with bicycles made for two.

That the equipment of modern camping becomes yearly more sophisticated is an entertaining paradox for the cynic, a brighter promise for the hopeful traveller who has sworn to get away from it all. It also provides - and some student sociologist might care to base his thesis upon the phenomenon - an escape of another kind. The modern traveller is often a man who dislikes the Splendide and the Bellavista, not because he cannot afford, or shuns their material comforts. but because he is afraid

of them. Affluent he may be, but he is by no means sure what to tip the doorman or the chambermaid. Master in his own house, he has little idea of when to say boo to a maitre d'hotel.

From all such fears camping releases him. Granted, a snobbery of camping itself, based upon equipment and techniques, already exists; but it is of a kind that, if he meets it, he can readily understand and deal with. There is no superior 'they' in the shape of managements and hotel hierarchies to darken his holiday days.

To such motives, yet another must be added. The contemporary phenomenon of car ownership, which has been mass-produced and which has invaded every aspect of modern life, has helped bring about a situation in which the once - instinctive identification of the person with the place has been weakened. Instead, we have a far more impersonal relationship with the places through which we pass: we view them through car windows at high speed and we are more concerned with the cars in front of us, the cars behind us, the cars to the side. Our sense of place is not the same as that of the ancient hunters and gatherers who knew every rock and tree in their territory. Nor is it the same as that of the peasant who has a deep and personal relationship with the land on which he has worked for generations. In this new situation, camping offers a way of re - establishing a connection with the land, of getting to know a place more intimately than we could from a car window or a hotel balcony. It is a way of getting back to nature, of experiencing the world in a more direct and less artificial way. To some people, camping has become a spiritual as well as a physical escape.

大逃亡

图省钱是露营的一个主要动机，因为除了开始时购置或是租借一套露营装备外，总费用算起来要比住旅馆开支少得多。但是，和一般的看法相反，这决非是仅有的，甚至不是最主要的动机。如果一位游客漫不经心地驾车驶入欧洲无数常年营地之一，花20镑租用一块空位，他可能会碰见一辆本特利汽车，更可能会是一辆福特·康索尔和一辆雷诺或一辆梅塞德斯并排停放着，不过双人自行车则不容易看到。

现代露营装备一年比一年讲究，这对那些厌世嫉俗者来说是一件有趣的自相矛盾的事情，而对于发誓用露营来摆脱烦恼的人来说，却带来了更光明的前景。学社会学的大学生来露营是另一种形式的摆脱现实，他们的目的很可能是根据露营这种现象去写论文。现代露营者往往讨厌住“斯普兰迪德”和“贝拉维斯塔”这样的大酒店，不是因为他们住不起，也不是为了躲避物质享受，而是因为他们害怕酒店。他们可能很富有，但给看门人和房间女服务员多少小费，心中却根本没有数；他们在家可能是主人，但不知道什么时候才能对酒店的经理表示不满。

露营使人们免除了这些忧虑。诚然，露营地本身也存在以露营装备和方式取人的势利现象，但如果有了这种情况，露营者也容易理解，知道如何对付，但在露营地里根本不会有管人

的“人上人”和酒店里的等级制度来使露营者的假日过得阴郁低沉。

除了以上动机外，还应再加上一个。当代拥有汽车的现象，汽车大量生产，遍及现代生活的各个方面，这就使人们过去对地方的本能的认同感变得淡薄了。相反，我们与我们所经过的地方之间有一种极为客观的关系：我们从汽车车窗里以高速看这些地方，我们更关心的是我们前面的汽车、后面的汽车和旁边的汽车。我们对地方的感觉和古代的猎人及采集者不同，他们熟悉自己领地上的每一块石头和每一棵树；我们的感觉也和农民不同，他们世代在一块土地上耕耘，对土地有着深厚的、个人的感情。在这种新的情况下，露营提供了一种重新和土地建立联系的方式，一种比从汽车车窗或酒店阳台了解一个地方更为亲密的方式。这是回归自然的一种方式，以一种更直接、更质朴的方式体验世界。对有些人来说，露营已经成为一种精神上以及肉体上的逃避方式。

48. Planning a share portfolio

There is no shortage of tipsters around offering "get-rich-quick" opportunities. But if you are a serious private investor, leave the Las Vegas mentality to those with money to fritter. The serious investor needs a proper "portfolio" -- a well-planned selection of investments, with a definite structure and a clear aim. But exactly how does a newcomer to the stock market go about achieving that?

Well, if you go to five reputable stock brokers and ask them what you should do with your money, you're likely to get five different answers, -- even if you give all the relevant information about your age, family, finances and what you want from your investments. Moral? There is no one "right" way to structure a portfolio. However, there are undoubtedly some wrong ways, and you can be sure that none of our five advisers would have suggested sinking all (or perhaps any) of your money into Periwigs.

So what should you do? We'll assume that you have sorted out the basics -- like mortgages, pensions, insurance and access to sufficient cash reserves. You should then establish your own individual aims. These are partly a matter of personal circumstances, partly a matter of psychology.

For instance, if you are older you have less time to recover from any major losses, and you may well prefer to boost your pension income. So you might be more conservative with your investments. On the other hand, if you are younger and can afford to take the long view, you may decide to invest in more speculative stocks, hoping for that big kill in a few years' time.

If you are closer to the "get - rich - quick" end of the spectrum, you will be more

interested in speculative stocks that may double or triple in a short time. If you are at the more conservative end, you may prefer bonds or cash deposits. Once you have decided on your investment aims, you can then begin to look for the best investment vehicles to achieve those aims.

The stock market offers a vast array of different investment vehicles, from blue - chip stocks to penny stocks, from bonds to real - estate investment trusts. You need to understand the characteristics of each type of investment vehicle, and how they fit into your overall portfolio. For example, blue - chip stocks are generally considered to be more stable and less risky than penny stocks. Bonds are generally considered to be more conservative than stocks, but they also offer lower returns. Real - estate investment trusts can provide a good income stream, but they are also more sensitive to changes in the real - estate market.

You also need to consider the costs associated with each type of investment vehicle. Some investment vehicles, such as mutual funds, have relatively high management fees. Others, such as exchange - traded funds, have lower management fees. You need to make sure that the costs associated with your investments do not eat up too much of your returns.

Finally, you need to keep an eye on your portfolio. You should review your portfolio regularly, at least once a year, to make sure that it still meets your investment aims. If your circumstances change, such as if you get married, have a child or change jobs, you may need to adjust your portfolio accordingly.

In conclusion, planning a share portfolio is not an easy task. It requires a good understanding of the stock market, a clear set of investment aims, and a willingness to keep an eye on your investments. But if you are a serious private investor, it is well worth the effort.

规划股份投资

我们周围不乏情报贩子，他们主动向人们提供迅速发财致富的机遇。但是，如果你是一个认真的私人投资者，就把拉斯韦加斯的心态留给那些有钱可供挥霍的人。认真的投资者需要一份正规的投资组合表——一种计划周全的投资选择，包括明确的结构和清晰的目标。但是，一个股票市场的新手又如何能做到这一点呢？

如果你去向5位有威望的股票经纪人咨询，询问你应该如何使用你的资金，你可能得到5种不同的答复——即便你提供了所有关于你的年龄、家庭、财源和你想从投资中获得的好处的信息。这是个道德问题吗？没有一种完全“正确”的方法来排列投资组合。然而，却毫无疑问地存在着错误的方法，而且可以肯定我们的5位经纪人中不会有人建议你全部（或一部分）资金投入佩里威格斯公司。

那么你应该怎么做呢？我们假定你已把基本情况弄清楚了，如抵押贷款、养老金、保险金

和足够的现金储备。然后，你一定要建立起自己的目标。这里一方面是个人的环境，另一方面是个人的心理。

例如，如果你年纪较大，你从重大投资损失中恢复过来的时间就较少，你就很可能想增加你的养老金收入。因此，你在投资时可能采取更为保守的策略。另一方面，如果你年轻些，能承担得起放长线钓大鱼的风险，你就可能决定投资于更具投机性的股票，期望几年后大发一笔。

如果你的投资接近“迅速发财”的这一端，你就会更感兴趣于那些在短期内能使资金翻倍或翻三倍的投机性股票。如果你的投资趋于更加保守的一端，你可能宁愿投资于债券或者现金储蓄。一旦你决定了自己的投资目标，你就可以开始寻找最佳的投资工具来实现这些目标。

股票市场提供了从蓝筹股到低价股、从债券到房地产投资信托基金等多种多样的不同投资工具。你需要了解每种投资工具的特性，以及它们如何与你的整个投资组合相匹配。例如，蓝筹股通常被认为比低价股更稳定，风险更小。债券通常被认为比股票更保守，但它们的回报率也较低。房地产投资信托基金能提供良好的收入流，但它们对房地产市场的变化也更敏感。

你还需要考虑与每种投资工具相关的成本。有些投资工具，如共同基金，有相对较高的管理费。其他的，如交易所交易基金，管理费较低。你需要确保与你的投资相关的成本不会吞噬掉太多的回报。

最后，你需要密切关注你的投资组合。你应该定期审查你的投资组合，至少每年一次，以确保它仍然符合你的投资目标。如果你的情况发生变化，例如你结婚了、有孩子了或者换工作了，你可能需要相应地调整你的投资组合。

总之，规划一个股票投资组合并非易事。这需要对股票市场有很好的了解，有一套明确的投资目标，并且愿意密切关注你的投资。但是，如果你是一个认真的私人投资者，那么这一努力是非常值得的。